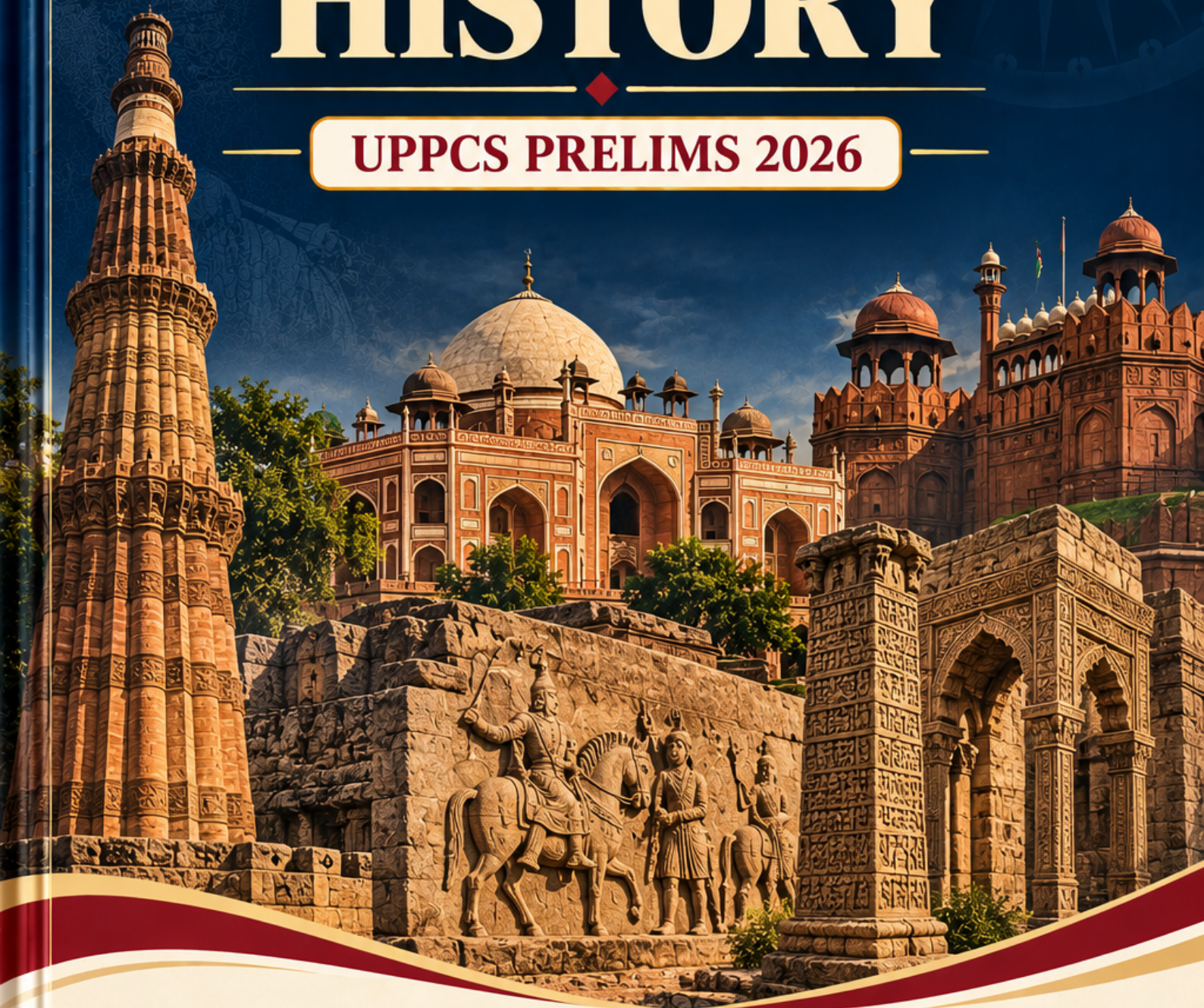




MEDIEVAL HISTORY

UPPCS PRELIMS 2026



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PYQs &
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Previous Year Questions | Topic-wise Analysis | Conceptual Linkages | Exam-Oriented Revision

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All questions in this book are original previous-year questions from UPPSC and other Uttar Pradesh state-level examinations held between 1990 and 2025, cited with their paper and year. Where an answer key is marked (*), is disputed, or has been overtaken by later changes in law or fact, the original key is retained and a Note explains the position at the time of the examination and today.

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Questions = full PYQs plus one-liners in the chapter. Book total: 456.

Chapter 1

Muslim Invasion of India

Medieval Indian history opens with three waves from the north-west. The **Arabs** took Sindh in 712 CE. The **Ghaznavid Turks**, above all Mahmud of Ghazni, raided north India between 1000 and 1027 CE. The **Ghurids** under Muhammad Ghori defeated the Rajput kings at Tarain (1192) and Chandawar (1194), and their generals founded the Delhi Sultanate. This chapter covers the rise of Islam, Muhammad bin Qasim, the Ghaznavid rulers and Mahmud's raids, the scholars of Mahmud's court (Al-Biruni, Utbi, Firdausi), Ghori's battles, Bakhtiyar Khalji in Bihar and Bengal, and the reasons for Turkish success. It contains **18 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. Three blocks carry the weight: the Arabs in Sindh (5 items), Mahmud's court scholars (5 items) and Ghori's battles (5 items).

1.1 The Prophet, the Arabs and the Conquest of Sindh (712 CE)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1996

Q. Hazrat Muhammad, the prophet, was born in the year:

- (a) 570 A.D.
- (b) 622 A.D.
- (c) 642 A.D.
- (d) 670 A.D.

Ans. (a)

The Prophet Muhammad was born at **Mecca** (present Saudi Arabia) in about **570 CE** and died in **632 CE**. In **622 CE** he migrated from Mecca to Medina. This migration is the **Hijra**, and the Islamic lunar calendar (the **Hijri** era) counts from that year. Within a century of his death the Arab Caliphate stretched from Spain to the borders of Sindh.

TRAP ALERT

622 CE is the year of the **Hijra**, not of the Prophet's birth. The 1996 options place both years side by side. Birth 570, Hijra 622, death 632.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2015

Q. The first Muslim invaders of India were -

- (a) The Ghaznavids
- (b) The Ghurids
- (c) The Arabs
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (c)

The first Arab naval raid reached **Thana** near Bombay in **636-637 CE**, in the time of Caliph Umar, and failed. The first successful invasion came in **712 CE**. The Umayyad governor of Iraq, **Al-Hajjaj bin Yusuf**, sent his young nephew and son-in-law **Muhammad bin Qasim** against **Dahir**, the Brahmin king of Sindh. The pretext was the seizure of Arab ships by pirates near **Debal**. Qasim took Debal, defeated and killed Dahir at **Raor** (712), and went on to Brahmanabad, Alor and **Multan** (713).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. When Muhammad-bin-Qasim conquered Sindh

Ans. 712 A.D.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. First Muslim invader in India was

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Muhammad Ghazni
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Qasim
- (d) Muhammad Ghori

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Muhammad-Bin-Qasim was a -

- (a) Turk
- (b) Mongol
- (c) Arab
- (d) Turk-Afghan

Ans. (c)

Qasim was an **Arab**, about 17 years old at the time of the Sindh campaign. Every later invader in this chapter was a **Turk** (Mahmud, Ghori and his slave generals). The Mongols came later still, from 1221. The main source for the conquest is the **Chachnama**, a Persian translation made by Ali Kufi in the early 13th century from an older Arabic account.

Arab administration in Sindh. The Arabs left local chiefs and Brahmin officials in place and collected revenue through them. Hindus and Buddhists were treated as **zimmis** (protected non-Muslim subjects) on payment of **jizya**. Qasim was recalled and executed in 715 after a change of Caliph, and Arab rule stayed confined to Sindh and Multan. Historians describe the conquest as "a triumph without results" because it did not spread further into India.

Term	Meaning	Context
Hijri	Islamic lunar era counted from 622 CE	Hijra of the Prophet from Mecca to Medina
Jizya	Poll tax on non-Muslim subjects under Islamic law	Levied by the Arabs in Sindh, later by the Sultans
Zimmi	Protected non-Muslim subject who pays jizya	Status given to Hindus and Buddhists of Sindh
Kharaj	Land tax	Arab and Sultanate revenue
Khams	One-fifth of war booty, due to the state	Raids of the Ghaznavids and Ghurids

TRAP ALERT

"First Muslim invader" is **Muhammad bin Qasim** (Arab, 712). Mahmud of Ghazni (Turk, 1000 onward) is the first to raid deep into the Ganga plain, and Muhammad Ghori (Turk) is the founder of lasting Turkish rule. Keep the three "firsts" apart.

1.2 The Ghaznavids: Alptigin, Sabuktigin and Mahmud's Seventeen Raids

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2015

Q. Who among the following was the founder of the Ghaznavid dynasty ?

- (a) Alptigin
- (b) Mahmud
- (c) Sebuktigin
- (d) Ismail

Ans. (a)

Note: the source keeps (a). Alptigin, a Turkish slave commander of the Samanids, seized Ghazni in 962 and made it his capital. Many standard textbooks treat his slave and son-in-law Sabuktigin (977 to 997) as the real founder, because the hereditary Ghaznavid line of Mahmud descends from him. Know both. If "founded the kingdom of Ghazni" is asked, Alptigin. If "founder of the ruling Ghaznavid (Yamini) house", Sabuktigin is the likelier key.

Ruler	Years	Key facts for the exam
Alptigin	962 onward	Turkish slave of the Samanids. Seized Ghazni and made it his capital
Sabuktigin	977 to 997	Founder of the hereditary line. Defeated the Hindu Shahi king Jayapala
Ismail	997 to 998	Son of Sabuktigin. Displaced by his brother Mahmud
Mahmud	998 to 1030	Title Yamin-ud-Daula (hence Yamini dynasty). Seventeen raids on India, 1000 to 1027
Masud and later rulers	1030 to 1186	Held Punjab from Lahore. Last ruler Khusrau Malik lost Lahore to Muhammad Ghori in 1186

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. Assertion (A) : Mohd. Ghazni invaded India seventeen times.
Reason (R) : He wanted to establish permanent Muslim Empire in India.

Select the correct answer from the given codes :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (c)

The figure of **seventeen raids** (1000 to 1027) is the standard count, taken from Henry Elliot. The aim was **plunder** of temple treasures and royal cities, the capture of elephants and slaves, and funds for Mahmud's Central Asian wars. He annexed only **Punjab** and Multan, so that he had a gateway into India. He did not try to rule the Ganga plain. Hence (A) true, (R) false.

Year (CE)	Target	Indian ruler
1001	Peshawar, battle near Waihind	Jayapala (Hindu Shahi)
1004-06	Bhera and Multan	Local rulers, Abul Fath Daud of Multan
1008-09	Waihind, then Nagarkot (Kangra)	Anandapala (Hindu Shahi)
1014	Thanesar	Local ruler

Year (CE)	Target	Indian ruler
1018	Baran, Mahaban, Mathura, Kannauj	Hardatta of Baran, Kulachand of Mahaban, Pratihara Rajyapala of Kannauj
1019 and 1022	Chandela kingdom, Gwalior and Kalinjar	Vidyadhara (Chandela)
1025-26	Somnath (Saurashtra, Gujarat)	Bhima I (Chaulukya or Solanki)
1027	Jats of the Salt Range region	Last raid

UP link: the 1018 campaign crossed western UP. Mahmud took **Baran** (Bulandshahr district) and **Mahaban** (Mathura district), plundered **Mathura** and then took **Kannauj** (Kannauj district), the Pratihara capital, whose king Rajyapala fled. **Kalinjar** (Banda district), the Chandela fort, was besieged in 1022.

Somnath. In 1025-26 Mahmud raided the Shiva temple of Somnath on the Saurashtra coast and carried off its treasure. The temple was rebuilt several times over the following centuries. The present temple was rebuilt after Independence and inaugurated in 1951.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. Which of the following Chandela King was not defeated by Mahmud Ghaznavi -

- (a) Dhanaga
- (b) Vidyadhara
- (c) Jayashakti
- (d) Danga

Ans. (b)

Vidyadhara (early 11th century) was the strongest Chandela king and the Indian ruler Mahmud could not break. In 1019 the armies met near a river, the battle was indecisive, and Vidyadhara withdrew at night. In 1022 Mahmud besieged Gwalior and Kalinjar and the two sides made terms. Muslim writers called Vidyadhara the most powerful ruler of his time. He had earlier punished the Pratihara Rajyapala for giving up Kannauj without a fight. The Kandariya Mahadeva temple at Khajuraho is attributed to his reign.

TRAP ALERT

The other names do not fit Mahmud's time. **Dhanga** ruled in the late 10th century and **Jayashakti** (Jejaka) was a 9th century king after whom Bundelkhand was called Jejakabhukti. "Danga" appears to be a variant spelling. The question really asks "which Chandela held his ground": Vidyadhara.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. Who among the following issued silver coins with Sanskrit legend on one side:

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Qasim
- (b) Mahmud of Ghazni
- (c) Sher Shah
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (b)

Mahmud struck bilingual silver dirhams at **Mahmudpur** (Lahore) in the 1020s for circulation in Punjab. One face carried the Arabic legend. The other carried a Sanskrit rendering of the Islamic creed in an Indian script ("avyaktam ekam Muhammada avatara", the Unseen is One, Muhammad is his messenger), with the ruler's name as "Mahamuda". This kept the coins familiar to Indian users.

TRAP ALERT

Sher Shah also used Devanagari on some coins, and Akbar issued Ram-Siya coins. The PYQ asks for silver coins with a **Sanskrit legend** under an early Turkish ruler. That is Mahmud.

1.3 Al-Biruni, Utbi and Firdausi: Scholars of Mahmud's Court

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. Who was the court historian of Mahmud of Ghazni -

- (a) Hassan Nizami
- (b) Utbi
- (c) Firdausi
- (d) Chand Bardai

Ans. (b)

Utbi, Mahmud's secretary, wrote the **Kitab-ul-Yamini** (Tarikh-i-Yamini) in Arabic, a court history of Sabuktigin and Mahmud. Each distractor belongs to a different court. **Hasan Nizami** wrote the Taj-ul-Maasir on Qutbuddin Aibak. **Firdausi** was a poet, not a historian. **Chand Bardai** was the court poet of Prithviraj Chauhan.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Firishta, the author of Shahnama was associated with the court of

- (a) Sebuktigin
- (b) Mahmud Ghaznavi
- (c) Muhammad Ghori
- (d) Alptigin

Ans. (*)

Note: the source marks the question as erroneous (*). The Shahnama was written by Firdausi, not Firishta. Firdausi completed it at the court of Mahmud of Ghazni, so (b) fits the work named. Firishta (Muhammad Qasim Hindu Shah) served at Ahmadnagar and then Bijapur and wrote the Tarikh-i-Firishta (Gulshan-i-Ibrahimi), dedicated to Ibrahim Adil Shah II. He has no link with any of the four rulers in the options.

Author	Origin	Court or ruler	Work and language
Al-Biruni	Khwarizm (Khiva, Central Asia)	Came with Mahmud	Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind), Arabic
Utbi	Persia	Mahmud	Kitab-ul-Yamini (Tarikh-i-Yamini), Arabic
Firdausi	Tus (Persia)	Mahmud	Shahnama , Persian epic. "Homer of the East"
Baihaqi	Persia	Mahmud and Masud	Tarikh-i-Baihaqi, Persian
Hasan Nizami	Nishapur	Qutbuddin Aibak	Taj-ul-Maasir
Ali Kufi	Sindh	Nasiruddin Qubacha period	Chachnama (Persian translation)
Chand Bardai	India	Prithviraj Chauhan	Prithviraj Raso
Firishta	Persia, settled in the Deccan	Ahmadnagar, then Ibrahim Adil Shah II of Bijapur	Tarikh-i-Firishta (Gulshan-i-Ibrahimi)

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2002

Q. The first Muslim who studied Puranas was -

- (a) Abul Fazal
- (b) Abdul Qadir Badayuni
- (c) Al-Biruni
- (d) Dara Shikoh

Ans. (c)

Al-Biruni (973 to 1048) was born in Khwarizm and came to India in the train of Mahmud in the early 11th century. He learnt Sanskrit, read the Puranas, the Gita, Patanjali and the astronomical siddhantas, and translated Sanskrit works into Arabic. His **Kitab-ul-Hind** (c. 1030) describes Indian religion, philosophy, castes, festivals, astronomy, measures and calendars. He was an astronomer and mathematician as much as a historian. The other options came centuries later: Abul Fazl and Badauni under Akbar, and Dara Shikoh under Shah Jahan.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (PRE) 2010

Q. Al-Biruni came to India in

Ans. 11th century A.D.

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Q. Which one of the following statements about Al-biruni is not correct?

- (a) He was a secular author
- (b) His writing was influenced by India
- (c) He was a Sanskrit Scholar
- (d) He was an expert of trigonometry

Ans. (a)

The source key treats "secular author" as the incorrect description. Al-Biruni wrote as a devout Muslim scholar and judged Indian beliefs from within his own faith, even though his tone is careful and he often criticises the Indian learned class for insularity. The other three are standard facts: he read Sanskrit, his work drew heavily on Indian texts, and he wrote on trigonometry and astronomy.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Al-Biruni has come as a "first", a date and a "not correct" statement. The Kitab-ul-Hind and its Arabic language, his birthplace Khwarizm, and a travellers match (Al-Biruni with Mahmud, Ibn Battuta with Muhammad bin Tughluq, Marco Polo with the Kakatiya region) are the natural next angles.

1.4 Muhammad Ghori: Kasahrada, Tarain and Chandawar

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004

Q. Which one of the following rulers from Central Asia conquered North India in 1192 ?

- (a) Jalaluddin Mankbarni
- (b) Mahmud of Ghazni
- (c) Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori
- (d) Genghis Khan

Ans. (c)

Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori (also called Muizzuddin Muhammad bin Sam) governed Ghazni for his elder brother Ghiyasuddin, the ruler of Ghor. Unlike Mahmud he aimed at lasting conquest. He entered India through the **Gomal Pass**, took Multan and Uch (1175), was beaten in Gujarat (1178), took Peshawar (1179) and

ended the last Ghaznavid ruler at Lahore (1186). This opened the road to Delhi and Ajmer, then held by **Prithviraj III Chauhan**.

Battle	Year (CE)	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Raor (Sindh)	712	Muhammad bin Qasim vs Dahir	Arab conquest of Sindh
Waihind (near Peshawar)	1001	Mahmud vs Jayapala	Hindu Shahi power broken
Kasahrada (near Mount Abu)	1178	Mularaja II (Chaulukya) vs Muhammad Ghori	Ghori's first defeat in India
First Tarain	1191	Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori	Ghori wounded and defeated
Second Tarain	1192	Muhammad Ghori vs Prithviraj Chauhan	Foundation of Turkish rule in north India
Chandawar	1194	Muhammad Ghori vs Jayachandra (Gahadavala)	Kannauj and Varanasi opened to the Turks

At the **First Battle of Tarain** (1191) Govindaraja, Prithviraj's commander, wounded Ghori, and the Turkish army fled. Next year Ghori returned with a larger force of mounted archers and won the **Second Battle of Tarain** (1192). Prithviraj was captured and later put to death (accounts differ on the details). Ghori left his slave **Qutbuddin Aibak** in charge of the Indian conquests. Aibak took Delhi in 1193. Tarain is Taraori near Karnal in Haryana.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Battle that laid the foundation of Muslim domination in India was

Ans. Second Battle of Tarain

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. Who defeated Muhammad Ghori for the first time?

- (a) Mularaja II
- (b) Prithviraj Chauhan
- (c) Jai Chand
- (d) Prithviraj-II

Ans. (a)

In 1178 Ghori marched on Gujarat through the desert. The Chaulukya (Solanki) king **Mularaja II** was a boy, and the army was led by his mother **Naikidevi**. They defeated Ghori at **Kasahrada** near Mount Abu. This taught Ghori to approach India through Punjab instead.

TRAP ALERT

Ghori's **first defeat** was at Kasahrada (1178) by **Mularaja II**. His defeat by **Prithviraj Chauhan** at Tarain came in 1191. The 1990 question rewards knowing that Gujarat came before Tarain.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2008

Q. In which battle Muhammad Ghori defeated Jayachandra?

- (a) Battle of Tarain (1191 A.D.)
- (b) Battle of Tarain (1192 A.D.)
- (c) Battle of Chandawar (1194 A.D.)
- (d) Battle of Kannauj (1194 A.D.)

Ans. (c)

Jayachandra (Jaichand) of the **Gahadavala** dynasty ruled the middle Ganga plain from **Kannauj**, with **Varanasi** (Kashi) as the other great centre of the dynasty. He stayed out of the Tarain wars. In 1194 Ghori and Aibak defeated and killed him at **Chandawar** on the

Yamuna. The Turks then moved on to Varanasi.

UP link: **Chandawar** lies on the Yamuna in present **Firozabad district**. The Gahadavala centres **Kannauj** (Kannauj district) and **Varanasi** (Varanasi district) are both in UP. A few years later Aibak took the Chandela fort of **Kalinjar** (Banda district) in 1202-03.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. Which king was defeated by Muhammad Ghori in the battle of Chandawar?

Ans. Jayachandra

TRAP ALERT

"Battle of Kannauj" is a planted distractor. The Battle of Kannauj (also called Bilgram) was fought in **1540**, when Sher Shah defeated Humayun. Jayachandra fell at **Chandawar**, 1194.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Ghori's battles have come five times (1990 to 2016). A chronological-order question on Kasahrada, Tarain I, Tarain II and Chandawar, or a match of battle with defeated king, is the natural next form. Remember Ghori was killed in 1206 near the Jhelum, commonly attributed to the Khokhars, and Aibak took power at Lahore.

1.5 Ghori's Generals: Bakhtiyar Khalji in Bihar and Bengal

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991, 2018

Q. Which slave of Muhammad Ghori conquered Bengal and Bihar -

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Bakhtiyar Khalji
- (d) Yalduj

Ans. (c)

Ikhtiyaruddin Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji was a Khalji Turk officer in Ghori's service who rose through raids east of Awadh. Between about 1193 and 1203 he overran south Bihar and sacked the great Buddhist monasteries of **Nalanda**, **Vikramashila** and **Odantapuri** (dates vary between sources). Minhaj-us-Siraj's Tabaqat-i-Nasiri records the attack on the fortified vihara at Odantapuri. Around 1204-05 he raided **Nadia** in Bengal. The Sena king **Lakshmana Sena** fled east, and Bakhtiyar made **Lakhnauti** (Gaur) his capital. He died in 1206 after a failed expedition towards Tibet.

Ghori's lieutenant	Region held	After 1206
Qutbuddin Aibak	Delhi, Ajmer, Doab, captured Kalinjar	First Sultan at Lahore (Chapter 2)
Tajuddin Yalduz (Yalduz)	Ghazni and Kirman	Rival claimant. Defeated by Iltutmish at Tarain (1215-16)
Nasiruddin Qubacha	Multan and Uch (Sindh)	Rival. Crushed by Iltutmish (1228)
Bakhtiyar Khalji	Bihar and Bengal	Died 1206. Khalji chiefs held Lakhnauti

Current link: the ruins of **Nalanda Mahavihara** (Nalanda district, Bihar) became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2016. The re-established Nalanda University, set up under the Nalanda University Act, 2010, got a new campus at **Rajgir**, inaugurated by the Prime Minister on 19 June 2024.

TRAP ALERT

Itutmish was Aibak's slave, not Ghor's, and came to power only in 1211. Yaloz held Ghazni, not Bengal. The conqueror of Bihar and Bengal is **Bakhtiyar Khalji**, repeated in 1991 and 2018.

1.6 Invader Chronology and Reasons for Turkish Success

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Arrange the following names chronologically and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

1. Genghis Khan
2. Mahmud Ghaznavi
3. Muhammad Ghor
4. Timur

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
(b) 2, 3, 1, 4
(c) 3, 4, 1, 2
(d) 4, 1, 2, 3

Ans. (b)

Invader	Origin	India campaigns (CE)	Outcome
Arab raid on Thana	Arab (Caliph Umar)	636-37	Failed
Muhammad bin Qasim	Arab (Umayyad)	712-713	Sindh and Multan
Sabuktigin	Turk (Ghazni)	980s-990s	Defeated Hindu Shahi Jayapala
Mahmud of Ghazni	Turk (Ghazni)	1000 to 1027	Seventeen raids. Punjab annexed
Muhammad Ghor	Turk (Ghor)	1175 to 1206	Tarain, Chandawar. Delhi Sultanate follows
Genghis Khan	Mongol	1221 (reached the Indus)	Pursued Jalaluddin Mangburni. Did not enter the Sultanate
Timur	Turko-Mongol (Samarkand)	1398	Sacked Delhi under the Tughluqs (Chapter 5)

TRAP ALERT

Genghis Khan is often placed first because he is famous. He came in **1221**, after both Mahmud (died 1030) and Ghor (died 1206). Order: Mahmud, Ghor, Genghis, Timur.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024, 2018

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Turkish invasion on India was successful.

Reason (R): There was no political unity in North India.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
(c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

Ans. (a)

North India in the 11th and 12th centuries was divided among rival Rajput houses (Chauhans, Gahadavalas, Chandelas, Chaulukyas,

Paramaras) that fought one another and seldom combined. The Commission accepts this political disunity as the explanation. Historians add military and organisational factors.

Factor	Turkish side	Indian side
Political	One commander, one objective	No political unity. Rival kingdoms, no common front
Frontier	Held the north-western passes after the fall of the Hindu Shahis	No organised defence of the north-west
Army	Swift cavalry, mounted archers , Central Asian horses	Reliance on elephants and infantry. Feudal levies under many chiefs
Organisation	Paid troops tied to the commander (later the iqta system)	Troops owed loyalty to local chiefs first
Tactics	Reserve cavalry, feigned retreat, flank attacks	Frontal, set-piece battle

UPPSC PATTERN

UPPSC pattern: the 2018 A/R was repeated word for word in 2024. The option order in this A/R is non-standard: (b) is "A false, R true" and (c) is "both true, R not the explanation". Read the code letters before marking.

Chapter 1: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Rise of Islam and the Arab conquest of Sindh	5	1991-2015	Recurring
Scholars of Mahmud's court (Al-Biruni, Utbi, Firdausi)	5	1991-2014	Recurring
Muhammad Ghor: Kasahrada, Tarain, Chandawar	5	1990-2016	Recurring
Ghaznavids: founder, raids, Chandelas, coins	4	1991-2015	Steady
Invader chronology and reasons for Turkish success	2	2008-2024	Recent (2018, 2024)
Bakhtiyar Khalji in Bihar and Bengal	1	1991-2018	Repeated (1991, 2018)

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 22 items (18 PYQs + 4 one-liners). UPPSC tests this chapter through "firsts" (first Muslim invader, first defeat of Ghor, first Muslim to study the Puranas), through matching a chronicler to a court, and through battle and year pairs. Two A/R questions have come, and the 2024 paper repeated the 2018 one on Turkish success. Two items carry Notes: the Ghaznavid founder (Alptigin or Sabuktigin) and the erroneous Firishta-Shahnama question (*). Revise the battle table in 1.4, the chroniclers table in 1.3 and the raids table in 1.2 first.

Chapter 2

Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty

The Delhi Sultanate (1206 to 1526) began with the rulers usually called the Slave dynasty (1206 to 1290). This chapter covers the names given to the dynasty, Qutbuddin Aibak and his capital, Iltutmish as the real consolidator (Delhi as capital, caliphal investiture, iqta, tanka and jital, the Chahalgani), the Mongol threat under Genghis Khan, Razia Sultan and the Turkish nobles, and Balban's theory of kingship. It contains **12 PYQs and 2 one-liners**. Iltutmish alone gives 4 items, and Balban gives 3, including an A/R repeated in 2024.

2.1 Slave, Mamluk or Early Turkish? The Dynasty and Its Founder

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. Who was the founder of the Slave dynasty ?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Balban
- (d) Qutbuddin Aibak

Ans. (d)

Qutbuddin Aibak founded the line in 1206, after the death of Muhammad Ghori. The label "Slave dynasty" is loose. The rulers from 1206 to 1290 came from three different families, and only three of them (Aibak, Iltutmish and Balban) had once been slaves. All three had been freed before they became Sultan. Historians therefore prefer **Early Turkish Sultans** or **Mamluk Sultans** of Delhi.

Name	Meaning	Covers
Mamluk	Arabic "owned". A slave trained for military and state service	The whole line, 1206 to 1290
Ilbari	The Turkish tribe of Iltutmish and Balban	Iltutmish's line and Balban's line
Qutbi	From Qutbuddin Aibak	Aibak and Aram Shah, 1206 to 1211
Shamsi	From Shamsuddin Iltutmish	Iltutmish and his descendants, 1211 to 1266 (first Ilbari dynasty)
Balbani	From Ghiyasuddin Balban	Balban, Kaiqubad, Kaimurs, 1266 to 1290 (second Ilbari dynasty)

Sultan	Reign (CE)	Key facts for the exam
Qutbuddin Aibak	1206 to 1210	Founder. Ruled from Lahore. Lakh Baksh. Died playing chaugan
Aram Shah	1210 to 1211	Removed by Iltutmish
Shamsuddin Iltutmish	1211 to 1236	Real consolidator. Delhi capital. Caliph's investiture 1229. Tanka and jital. Iqta. Chahalgani
Ruknuddin Firuz	1236	Real power with his mother Shah Turkan
Razia Sultan	1236 to 1240	Only woman ruler of the Sultanate
Muizzuddin Bahram Shah	1240 to 1242	Nobles created the office of naib-i-mamlakat (regent)
Alauddin Masud Shah	1242 to 1246	Deposed by the nobles

Sultan	Reign (CE)	Key facts for the exam
Nasiruddin Mahmud	1246 to 1266	Balban (Ulugh Khan) as naib. Minhaj-us-Siraj dedicated Tabaqat-i-Nasiri to him
Ghiyasuddin Balban	1266 to 1287 (often given as 1286)	Theory of kingship, sijda and paibos. Ended the Chahalgani
Muizzuddin Kaiqubad	1287 to 1290	Balban's grandson. Built Kilokhari
Kaimurs	1290	Infant. Jalaluddin Khalji took the throne (Khalji dynasty)

TRAP ALERT

Alauddin Khalji is not in this dynasty at all. The Khaljis came in 1290. The 1990 options also include Iltutmish and Balban, who were later Sultans of the same line.

2.2 Qutbuddin Aibak (1206 to 1210): Lahore, Lakh Baksh and the First Monuments

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. The capital of Qutbuddin Aibak was

- (a) Lahore
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Ajmer
- (d) Lakhnauti

Ans. (a)

After Ghori's death the nobles of **Lahore** invited Aibak to take charge, and he assumed power there in 1206. He ruled from Lahore because Ghori's other lieutenants, Yalduz of Ghazni and Qubacha of Multan, were rivals and Punjab had to be held against them. He did not use the title Sultan at first. He styled himself Malik and Sipahsalar, and received formal manumission in 1208. His generosity earned him the name **Lakh Baksh** (giver of lakhs). In 1210 he died at Lahore after a fall from his horse while playing **chaugan** (a form of polo).

Monument	Builder	Place
Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque	Aibak (screen extended by Iltutmish and later Sultans)	Qutb complex, Mehrauli, Delhi
Qutub Minar	Begun by Aibak, completed by Iltutmish. Upper storeys repaired by Firuz Tughluq	Mehrauli, Delhi. Named after the Sufi saint Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki
Adhai Din ka Jhonpra	Aibak (screen added under Iltutmish)	Ajmer, Rajasthan
Sultan Ghari	Iltutmish, for his son Nasiruddin Mahmud	Delhi. Often called the first Islamic tomb in India
Tomb of Iltutmish	Iltutmish	Qutb complex, Delhi
Tomb of Balban	Balban	Mehrauli, Delhi. Early true arch

TRAP ALERT

Delhi had been Aibak's headquarters as Ghori's commander since 1193, and his monuments stand there. As an independent ruler (1206 to 1210) his capital was **Lahore**. The capital moved to **Delhi** under Iltutmish (2.3). The 1990 key and the 2004 to 2016 key are two halves of one fact.

2.3 Iltutmish (1211 to 1236): Delhi as Capital and the Legal Sultanate

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012, 2014, 2016, U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2004

Q. Who among the following established Delhi as the capital of the Sultanate ?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Muizzuddin Ghori

Ans. (b)

Shamsuddin Iltutmish was an **Ilbari Turk**. Before becoming Sultan he was the iqtadar of **Badaun**. He removed Aram Shah in 1211, made **Delhi** the capital, and spent his reign defeating his rivals: **Yaldoz** at Tarain (1215-16), **Qubacha** of Multan and Uch (1228) and the Khalji chiefs of Bengal. He also completed the Qutub Minar.

UP link: Iltutmish held the iqta of **Badaun** (Budaun district) under Aibak. Badaun was one of the chief iqtas of the early Sultanate, a stepping stone to the throne.

U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. What was the capital of the Sultanate during the reign of Iltutmish?

Ans. Delhi

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Iqta	Assignment of land revenue of an area to an officer in place of salary, with duties of administration and military service	Made a regular system by Iltutmish
Muqti or iqtadar	Holder of an iqta	Iltutmish onward
Tanka	Silver coin of about 175 grains	Introduced by Iltutmish
Jital	Copper coin	Introduced by Iltutmish
Chahalgani (Turkan-i-Chahalgani)	Corps of Forty Turkish slave nobles	Formed by Iltutmish, broken by Balban
Sar-i-jandar	Chief of the royal bodyguard	Post Aibak gave Iltutmish
Lakh Baksh	Giver of lakhs	Title of Aibak

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. Who was the first Muslim ruler of Delhi?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Balban

Ans. (b)

Note: the source keeps (b). Many textbooks and most other exams treat Qutbuddin Aibak (1206) as the first Sultan of Delhi and would mark (a). The source's reasoning is legal: Iltutmish was the first ruler whose sovereignty was recognised by the Abbasid Caliph (1229), and the first to rule from Delhi as capital. If a future question says "first Sultan of Delhi" or "founder of the Delhi Sultanate", mark Aibak. If it says "first legal or sovereign Sultan", mark Iltutmish.

In **February 1229** envoys of the Abbasid Caliph **al-Mustansir** of Baghdad brought Iltutmish a robe of honour and a letter of investiture confirming him as Sultan of the lands he had conquered. This gave the Delhi Sultanate a legal standing independent of Ghor and Ghazni. Iltutmish was also the first Sultan to issue regular pure Arabic coins, the silver **tanka** and copper **jital**, and began the practice of stamping the mint name on coins.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. Who was called 'a slave of a slave'?

- (a) Mohd. Ghori
- (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (c) Balban
- (d) Iltutmish

Ans. (d)

Aibak was himself a slave of Muhammad Ghori, and Aibak bought **Iltutmish**. So Iltutmish was the slave of a slave. Aibak made him **sar-i-jandar** (chief of the bodyguard), later gave him the iqta of Badaun, and married his daughter to him.

TRAP ALERT

Balban was a slave of Iltutmish, so he too could be called "slave of a slave", but Iltutmish is the classic answer and the source key. Ghori was never a slave.

2.4 Genghis Khan on the Indus (1221)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1993, U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. During whose reign the Mongol invader Genghis Khan came through the North-West Frontier of India?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Balban
- (d) Aibak

Ans. (b)

In **1221** Genghis Khan destroyed the Khwarizmian empire and chased its prince **Jalaluddin Mangbarni** to the **Indus**. Mangbarni sought refuge with **Iltutmish**. Iltutmish refused politely, reportedly saying the climate of Delhi would not suit him, and so avoided giving the Mongols a reason to enter India. Genghis Khan turned back, and Mangbarni left India in 1224.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi was a contemporary of the Mongol leader Genghis Khan ?

Ans. Iltutmish

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2015

Q. The original name of Changez (Genghis) Khan was

- (a) Khasul Khan
- (b) Yesugai
- (c) Temuchin (Temujin)
- (d) Ogedei

Ans. (c)

Genghis Khan (c. 1162 to 1227) was born **Temujin**. He took the title Genghis Khan ("universal ruler") in 1206 when the Mongol tribes accepted him. The distractors come from his own family. **Yesugei** was his father and **Ogedei** his son and successor.

Sultan	Mongol pressure
Iltutmish	Genghis Khan reaches the Indus (1221) chasing Mangbarni. Asylum refused
Balban	Frontier forts. His son Prince Muhammad killed fighting the Mongols (1285)
Alauddin Khalji	Repeated large Mongol invasions, including the siege of Delhi (1303). Large standing army and market control
Muhammad bin Tughluq	Tarmashirin's invasion (1320s)

TRAP ALERT

Alauddin Khalji faced the **heaviest** Mongol attacks, so he tempts in the 1993 question. But Genghis Khan himself died in 1227, long before Alauddin. The Sultan contemporary with Genghis Khan is **Iltutmish**.

2.5 Razia Sultan (1236 to 1240) and the Turkish Nobles

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004

Q. Who of the following was the first woman ruler of medieval India ?

- (a) Raziyya Sultan
- (b) Chand Bibi
- (c) Durgavati
- (d) Noor Jahan

Ans. (a)

Iltutmish nominated his daughter **Razia** as heir, passing over his sons. The nobles first raised her brother Ruknuddin Firuz, but the people of Delhi and a section of the army put Razia on the throne in 1236. She was the first and only woman to rule the Delhi Sultanate. She gave up the veil, wore the qaba (coat) and kulah (cap), held open court and led troops herself. Among the options she comes first by three centuries. Strictly, she is the first **Muslim** woman ruler of India, as the source says. Earlier queens such as Didda of Kashmir had ruled in their own right.

Woman	Period	Kingdom and role
Razia Sultan	1236 to 1240	Delhi Sultanate. Ruler in her own right
Rani Durgavati	Died 1564	Gondwana (Garha-Katanga). Regent, fell fighting Akbar's general Asaf Khan
Chand Bibi	Died 1600	Ahmadnagar and Bijapur. Regent, defended Ahmadnagar against the Mughals
Nur Jahan	1611 to 1627 (as empress)	Mughal. Wife of Jahangir, powerful but not a ruler in her own right

U. P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. Who was behind the dethroning of Raziyya Begum?

- (a) Afghans
- (b) Mongols
- (c) Turks
- (d) Arabs

Ans. (c)

Razia's fall was the work of the **Turkish nobles**, the **Chahalgani**. They resented a woman on the throne and her attempt to rule independently. They resented even more her promotion of the Abyssinian **Jamaluddin Yaqut** as **amir-i-akhur** (master of the royal stables), a non-Turk. In 1240 **Malik Altunia**, governor of Bhatinda,

revolted. Yaqut was killed and Razia imprisoned. She married Altunia and marched on Delhi, but both were defeated and killed near Kaithal in 1240.

TRAP ALERT

The Afghans rose to power only under the Lodis (1451). At this stage the struggle was between the Sultan and the Turkish nobility. The period 1236 to 1266 is the peak of the power of the Forty.

2.6 Balban (1266 to 1287): Theory of Kingship and "Blood and Iron"

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi is said to have followed the policy of "blood and iron"?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Balban
- (c) Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji
- (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

Ans. (b)

Ghiyasuddin Balban was an Ilbari Turk, a slave of Iltutmish and a member of the Forty. As **naib** of Nasiruddin Mahmud (title Ulugh Khan) he held real power for twenty years before becoming Sultan. As Sultan he crushed rebels without mercy: the Mewatis near Delhi, the rebels of the Doab and Katehar, and Tughril Khan in Bengal. This severity is described as the policy of "**blood and iron**". The other options are known for mildness: **Jalaluddin Khalji** for leniency and **Firuz Tughluq** for welfare measures.

UP link: Balban's campaigns against the rebels of **Katehar** (later Rohilkhand, the Bareilly, Budaun and Moradabad region) and of the Ganga-Yamuna **Doab** were fought in present western UP.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Zil-i-Ilahi	Shadow of God on earth	Balban's description of the Sultan
Niyabat-i-Khudai	Vicegerent of God	Balban. Kingship as a divine trust
Sijda	Prostration before the Sultan	Introduced by Balban
Paibos	Kissing the Sultan's feet	Introduced by Balban
Nauroz	Persian new year festival	Celebrated at Balban's court
Diwan-i-Arz	Military department under the ariz-i-mumalik	Reorganised by Balban
Barid	News-writer and spy	Balban's intelligence network
Naib-i-Mamlikat	Regent or deputy of the Sultan	Created 1240. Held by Balban under Nasiruddin Mahmud

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Balban made his government firm and centralised all authority in his hands.

Reason (R): He wanted to protect the north-west frontier against Mongol invasions.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

Ans. (c)

Both statements are true. Balban centralised power because of the internal problem: the Turkish nobles (the Forty) had made and unmade four Sultans since 1236. He broke the Chahalgani, removed its leading members, and raised the Sultan above all nobles by divine right, court ceremony and a claim of descent from the Turanian hero **Afrasiyab**. Frontier defence against the Mongols was a separate policy: forts in Punjab, garrisons under his sons, and his elder son **Prince Muhammad**, who was killed by the Mongols in 1285. Hence (c).

TRAP ALERT

This A/R uses the non-standard code order. (b) is "A false, R true" and (c) is "both true, R not the explanation". The same order appeared in the 2018 and 2024 A/R on Turkish success (Chapter 1).

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2014

Q. Which of the following Sultans has called himself the 'Helper of a Caliph' in his inscription on the walls of the Mosque at Garhmukteshwar?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Kaiqubad
- (c) Jalaluddin Khalji
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (a)

In the Garhmukteshwar mosque inscription Balban calls himself **Nasir-i-Amir-ul-Mominin**, helper of the Commander of the Faithful, that is, of the Caliph. By Balban's time the Abbasid Caliphate of Baghdad had been destroyed by the Mongols (1258), yet Balban kept the Caliph's name as a source of legitimacy, just as Iltutmish had sought investiture in 1229.

UP link: Garhmukteshwar, on the Ganga, is in present Hapur district.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Balban has come as a policy label, an A/R and an inscription. A match of Balban with sijda, paibos, zil-i-ilahi and the end of the Chahalgani, or a statement set contrasting Iltutmish (formed the Forty) with Balban (broke the Forty), is the natural next form.

Chapter 2: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Iltutmish: Delhi capital, first legal Sultan, slave of a slave	4	2002-2016	Recurring (asked in 5 papers)
Mongols: Genghis Khan and Iltutmish	3	1993-2015	Recurring
Balban: blood and iron, centralisation, Caliph inscription	3	2009-2024	Rising, recent (2024)
Razia Sultan and the Turkish nobles	2	2004-2010	Steady
Founder and names of the dynasty	1	1990	Early
Aibak's capital	1	1990	Early

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 14 items (12 PYQs + 2 one-liners). Iltutmish is the centre of gravity: capital, legal sovereignty, "slave of a slave" and the Genghis Khan episode make 7 of the 14 items. Capital questions come in a pair: Aibak ruled from Lahore, Iltutmish made Delhi the capital. One item carries a Note: the source keys Iltutmish as the "first Muslim ruler of Delhi", where many books give Aibak. Revise the Sultan chronology table in 2.1 and the terms tables in 2.3 and 2.6 first.

Chapter 3

Khalji Dynasty

The Khaljis ruled Delhi from 1290 to 1320. Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji ended the Ilbari (Mamluk) line in the "Khalji revolution" of 1290, which opened high office to non-Turkish nobles. His nephew Alauddin Khalji (1296 to 1316) turned the Sultanate into an all-India power through the Rajput and Deccan campaigns, held off the Mongols, and ran the most tightly controlled revenue, army and market system of the period. This chapter covers the Khalji rulers and their titles, the Rajput and Gujarat conquests, the Deccan campaigns of Malik Kafur, the Mongol frontier, land revenue and new taxes, and the market reforms. It contains **14 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. The market reforms alone give 4 items, and chronology or matching of Alauddin's conquests gives 3 more.

3.1 The Khalji Sultans: Sikandar-i-Sani and the Caliphal Titles

U.P. LOWER SUB (PRE) 2008

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi assumed the title of Alexander the Second -

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (b)

Alauddin Khalji took the title **Sikandar-i-Sani** (the Second Alexander) and had it inscribed on his coins and in the khutba. Barani records that he also dreamt of founding a new religion and of conquering the world like Alexander. His friend **Ala-ul-Mulk**, the kotwal of Delhi (and Barani's uncle), advised him to first subdue India and to leave religion to the prophets. He dropped both plans.

TRAP ALERT

Sikandar Lodi is the trap. His name is Sikandar, but the title "Second Alexander" (Sikandar-i-Sani) belongs to **Alauddin Khalji**.

UPPSC (EXAM TAG NOT GIVEN IN SOURCE)

Q. Who among the following assumed the titles 'Yamin-ul-Khilafat' and 'Nasir-e-Amir-ul-Momineen'?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Balban
- (c) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (d) Nasiruddin Mahmud

Ans. (a)

Yamin-ul-Khilafat (right hand of the Caliphate) and **Nasir-i-Amir-ul-Mominin** (helper of the Commander of the Faithful) show that Alauddin still paid formal respect to the Abbasid Caliph. He did not seek an investiture from the Caliph, and in practice he kept state policy free of the ulema. Barani's account of his talk with **Qazi Mughisuddin** has him say that he made laws for the good of the state, whatever the Shariat said.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O (RE-EXAM) (PRE) 2016

Q. Which Ruler of Delhi Sultanate declared himself as "Khalifa"?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Mubarak Khalji
- (d) Muhammad bin Tughluq

Ans. (c)

After Alauddin's death, **Malik Kafur** placed a child, Shihabuddin Umar, on the throne and imprisoned or blinded other princes. **Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah** escaped, removed Kafur and became Sultan (1316 to 1320). He was the only Delhi Sultan to declare **himself** Caliph, with the title **al-Imam al-Azam Khalifat-ullah**. Alauddin used caliphal titles that honoured the Caliph. Mubarak claimed the office itself. That is the distinction the question tests.

Sultan	Reign	Key facts for the exam
Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji	1290 to 1296	Khalji revolution of 1290. Crowned at Kilokhri . Mild policy towards nobles. Defeated a Mongol force in 1292 and let some Mongols settle near Delhi ("new Muslims"). Killed by Alauddin at Kara in 1296
Alauddin Khalji	1296 to 1316	Governor of Kara. First Devagiri raid 1296. Sikandar-i-Sani. Rajput, Gujarat and Deccan conquests. Market, revenue and army reforms. Alai Darwaza, Siri
Shihabuddin Umar	1316	Child Sultan under Malik Kafur
Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah	1316 to 1320	Declared himself Caliph. Devagiri finally annexed (1318). Killed by Khusrau Khan
Nasiruddin Khusrau Shah	1320	Removed by Ghazi Malik (Ghiyasuddin Tughluq), who founded the Tughluq dynasty

UP link: Kara, on the Ganga in present **Kaushambi** district (opposite Manikpur in Pratapgarh district), was Alauddin's iqta as governor. He raided Devagiri from Kara in 1296, and Jalaluddin was killed there when he came to meet his nephew.

Buildings and court culture

Monument or work	Builder or author	Exam point
Alai Darwaza (1311)	Alauddin	Southern gateway of the Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque, Qutb complex, Delhi. Early use of the true arch and dome built on scientific lines
Siri fort	Alauddin	New walled city and military camp of Delhi, raised during the Mongol threat (1303)
Hauz-i-Alai (Hauz Khas)	Alauddin	Large reservoir to supply Siri. Later repaired by Firuz Tughluq, who built a madrasa on its bank
Alai Minar	Alauddin	Planned to be twice the Qutb Minar. Left unfinished
Amir Khusrau	Poet at Alauddin's court	Khazain-ul-Futuh (Alauddin's campaigns), Ashiqa, Nuh Sipihir (Mubarak Shah), Tughluq Nama. Called Tuti-i-Hind. Disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya

3.2 Alauddin's Northern and Western Conquests: Order and Opponents

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Arrange the following conquests of Alauddin Khalji in chronological order.

1. Ranthambore 2. Gujarat
3. Warangal 4. Chittor

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code:

- (a) 3, 4, 1, 2
(b) 4, 2, 3, 1
(c) 1, 3, 2, 4
(d) 2, 1, 4, 3

Ans. (d)

Alauddin first secured the west and Rajasthan, then turned south. The Rajput forts guarded the routes to Gujarat, Malwa and the Deccan. Learn one timeline and every order question falls out of it.

Campaign	Year	Ruler defeated	Commander and result
Gujarat	1299	Karnadeva (Karna II Vaghela)	Ulugh Khan and Nusrat Khan. Anhilwara taken. Malik Kafur acquired at Khambhat
Jaisalmer	1299 (Bhati tradition)	Bhati ruler	Date rests on Bhati tradition, not on contemporary Persian chronicles
Ranthambore	1301	Hammiradeva (Chauhan)	Nusrat Khan killed in the siege. Alauddin took the fort himself
Chittor	1303	Rana Ratan Singh (Guhila)	Renamed Khizrabad after prince Khizr Khan
Malwa	1305	Mahlakdeva	Ain-ul-Mulk Multani. Mandu, Ujjain, Dhar, Chanderi followed
Siwana	1308	Sitaladeva	Rajasthan
Jalor	1311	Kanhadadeva	Rajasthan
Warangal	1309 to 1310	Prataparudra II (Kakatiya)	Malik Kafur. See 3.3

UPPSC (EXAM TAG NOT GIVEN IN SOURCE)

Q. Arrange the following victories of Alauddin Khalji in the correct chronological order and choose the right answer from the code given below.

1. Ranthambore 2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal 4. Chittor

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
(b) 2, 1, 4, 3
(c) 2, 1, 3, 4
(d) 1, 2, 4, 3

Ans. (b)

Note: the source prints the list as "2. Warangal". This is an OCR slip for "3. Warangal", as the codes use items 1 to 4. The key places Jaisalmer in 1299. That date comes from Bhati bardic tradition. The rest of the order (Ranthambore 1301, Chittor 1303, Warangal 1310) is standard.

TRAP ALERT

Both order questions end with **Chittor (1303) then Warangal (1310)**. Warangal is a Deccan campaign of Malik Kafur, so it always comes after the Rajput forts. A code that puts Warangal first or second is wrong at sight.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Match the List-I to List-II and choose the correct answer by selecting the options given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Ranthambore	1. Karnadeva
B. Chittor	2. Raja Rai Ramchandra
C. Devagiri	3. Hamirdeva
D. Gujarat	4. Rana Ratan Singh

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 4 3 2 1
(b) 1 4 3 2
(c) 2 4 1 3
(d) 3 4 2 1

Ans. (d)

Read the match from the table above: Ranthambore with **Hammiradeva**, Chittor with **Ratan Singh**, Gujarat with **Karnadeva**. Devagiri was the Yadava capital of **Ramachandradeva** (Rai Ramchandra), whom Alauddin raided in 1296 and Malik Kafur defeated in 1307 to 1308.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The 2017 match paired forts with rulers. The same table can yield a commander match (Nusrat Khan at Ranthambore, Ain-ul-Mulk in Malwa, Malik Kafur in the Deccan) or a renamed-fort question (Chittor as Khizrabad).

3.3 The Deccan Campaigns of Malik Kafur: Wealth, Not Annexation

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Assertion (A) : Alauddin's Deccan expeditions were financial ventures.

Reason (R) : He wanted to annex the Deccan States.

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (c)

Alauddin's southern policy was to defeat the kings, take their treasure and elephants, and bind them to pay annual tribute. He left them on their thrones. K.S. Lal sums it up as "the greed for wealth and the desire for glory". The south was too far to hold from Delhi, and the army was needed at home against the Mongols. So (A) is true and (R) is false.

Kingdom (capital)	Dynasty and ruler	Year	Outcome
Devagiri	Yadava. Ramachandradeva	1296 (Alauddin), 1307 to 1308 (Kafur)	Ramachandra submitted, visited Delhi, got the title Rai Rayan and became an ally who supplied later expeditions
Warangal	Kakatiya. Prataparudra II	1309 to 1310	Siege. King paid treasure and agreed to annual tribute. An earlier attempt of 1302 to 1303 had failed
Dwarasamudra	Hoysala. Ballala III	1310 to 1311	Submitted and paid tribute. Helped Kafur march further south
Madurai	Pandya. Vira Pandya and Sundara Pandya	1311	Kafur exploited the war between the two brothers and raided the Pandya country. Vast booty
Devagiri again	Yadava. Shankaradeva	1313	Kafur killed the rebel king and held the region. Annexation completed under Mubarak Shah (1318)

TRAP ALERT

Devagiri did come under direct rule, but only after 1313 and formally under **Mubarak Shah** in 1318. For Alauddin's own policy the answer stays "tribute, not annexation".

Year	Mongol leader	Result
1305	Ali Beg and Tartaq	Defeated near Amroha by Malik Nayak
1306	Kabak	Defeated on the Ravi by Malik Kafur and Ghazi Malik. Ravi becomes the boundary

UP link: the 1305 Mongol force was routed near **Amroha** (Amroha district), which shows how deep into the Doab the raids reached before Alauddin's frontier reforms.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE.) 2021

Q. Which of the following Sultan appointed a special army to protect the boundaries of the empire?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Nasiruddin Mahmud
- (c) Balban
- (d) Alauddin Khalji

Ans. (d)

After the 1303 siege Alauddin repaired the old frontier forts, built new ones on the Mongol routes, posted garrisons under experienced commanders (Ghazi Malik at Dipalpur is the best known) and raised a large **standing army** at the centre. He was the first Sultan to keep a permanent army recruited and paid in **cash** by the state, not through iqta assignments. To stop fraud at musters he used **dagh** (branding of horses) and **huliya** or **chehra** (a descriptive roll of each soldier). The **Diwan-i-Arz** ran the muster.

TRAP ALERT

Balban also guarded the north-west (through his son Prince Muhammad at Multan) and is the strong distractor. The special frontier army, cash salaries, dagh and chehra are tied to **Alauddin**.

3.4 Mongol Defence, the Frontier and the Standing Army

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. What was the boundary between the Delhi Sultan and the Mongols during the period of Alauddin Khalji after 1306 A.D. ?

- (a) Beas
- (b) Ravi
- (c) Indus
- (d) Sutlej

Ans. (b)

The Mongols of the Chaghatai Khanate attacked almost every year until 1306. In 1306 the army of **Kabak** was crushed on the **Ravi** by Malik Kafur and **Ghazi Malik** (later Ghiyasuddin Tughluq). After this the Ravi became the working boundary, and major Mongol raids stopped for the rest of the reign.

Year	Mongol leader	Result
1298	Kadar	Defeated near Jalandhar by Ulugh Khan and Zafar Khan
1299	Qutlugh Khwaja	Battle of Kili near Delhi. Mongols withdrew. Zafar Khan killed
1303	Targhi	Delhi besieged while the army was at Chittor. Led to the building of Siri and the frontier reforms

3.5 Land Revenue by Measurement and the New Taxes

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1994

Q. Consider the following statements connected with Alauddin Khalji :

- I. He collected revenue by measuring the cultivated land.
- II. He enforced revenue measures in his entire empire.
- III. He abolished the powers of provincial Governors.

Select the correct answer from the coding scheme given below :

- (a) I and II
- (b) II and III
- (c) I and III
- (d) I, II and III

Ans. (c)

Note: statement III is loosely worded. Alauddin did not abolish provincial governors (muqtis). He curbed them through strict audit and removed the old privileges of the rural chiefs. Statement I is clearly true and II clearly false, so (c) is the only code that fits.

Alauddin was the first Sultan to assess land revenue by **measurement (masahat)**, with the **biswa** as the unit, and to fix the demand at **half the produce**. The system ran only in the core region around Delhi, the Doab and parts of Rohilkhand and east Punjab. It did not cover the whole empire, so statement II fails. He took away the collection rights and tax exemptions of the **khuts, muqaddams and chaudharis**, so that in Barani's words the khut and the **balahar** (ordinary peasant) paid alike. A new department, **Diwan-i-Mustakhraj**, recovered arrears from revenue officials.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi was the first to charge 'Ghari' or House-tax ?

- (a) Balban
(b) Alauddin Khalji
(c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
(d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

Ans. (b)

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Kharaj	Land revenue. Fixed at half the produce	Alauddin
Masahat	Measurement of cultivated land for assessment	Alauddin, first Sultan to use it
Biswa	Unit of land used in measurement (a fraction of a bigha)	Alauddin
Ghari	House tax on houses and huts	Alauddin, first to levy
Charai (chari)	Grazing tax on milch cattle	Alauddin
Jizya	Poll tax on non-Muslims	Sultanate generally
Khams	Share of war booty. Alauddin took four-fifths for the state instead of one-fifth	Alauddin. Firuz Tughluq returned to one-fifth
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Department to recover arrears from revenue officials	Alauddin
Khut, muqaddam, chaudhari	Hereditary rural chiefs and revenue intermediaries	Privileges cut by Alauddin, restored by Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
Balahar	Ordinary peasant	Barani
Shahna-i-Mandi	Superintendent of the grain market	Alauddin (Malik Qabul). See 3.6
Diwan-i-Riyasat	Department controlling the markets and enforcing prices	Alauddin
Dagh and huliya or chehra	Branding of horses and descriptive roll of soldiers	Alauddin's army. Revived later by Sher Shah and Akbar

TRAP ALERT

Ghari (house tax) and charai (grazing tax) are **Alauddin's** additions. The irrigation tax (**haq-i-sharb**) belongs to **Firuz Tughluq** (Chapter 4). Do not swap the two sets.

3.6 Market Control: Prices, Rationing and the Shahna-i-Mandi

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Assertion (A): Alauddin Khalji introduced price control in Delhi. Reason (R) : He wanted to pay lower wages to the artisans building his palaces in Delhi.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (c)

Barani gives the purpose plainly: a large army was needed against the Mongols, and it could be paid modest cash salaries only if grain, cloth and horses were cheap. Price control made the cash salary enough to live on. Barani also links it to curbing the wealth of potential rebels. Nothing in the sources ties it to artisans' wages, so the Reason is false.

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 1998, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Which Muslim ruler enforced a strict price control system during his time?

Ans. Alauddin Khalji

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. The attempt of Alauddin Khalji to control the market prices

- (a) led to agricultural progress
(b) benefited only Nobles/Courtiers
(c) was highly successful
(d) alienated ruler from masses

Ans. (c)

Barani, who was hostile to Alauddin in many ways, still says prices stayed fixed through his reign, even in years of poor rain. The machinery explains the success.

Element	How it worked
Four markets	Mandi (grain), Sarai-i-Adl (cloth, sugar, oil and other goods, with state loans to traders), a market for horses, slaves and cattle, and a general market
Shahna-i-Mandi	Superintendent of the market. Malik Qabul held the post and had wide powers
Diwan-i-Riyasat	Department at the head of market control
Supply	Revenue in the Doab taken in kind and stored in state granaries. Grain carriers (karwanis or banjaras) registered and bound to bring grain to Delhi
Rationing	In scarcity, grain issued to households in fixed quantities. Hence the "public distribution system" credit
Checks	Barids and munhiyans (spies) reported daily. Short weight was punished severely
Limits	Worked in Delhi and its neighbourhood. Ended with Alauddin's death

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Which one of the following Kings of medieval India began the 'Public Distribution System' ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Balban
- (c) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Ans. (a)

TRAP ALERT

"Highly successful" (2017) does not mean the system spread across the empire. It was confined to Delhi and lapsed after 1316. If a statement says it covered the whole Sultanate or outlived Alauddin, mark it wrong.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Market control appears in 4 items across 7 papers from 1992 to 2017, in four formats (one-liner, Assertion-Reason, outcome, PDS). The officer names (Shahna-i-Mandi, Diwan-i-Riyasat, Malik Qabul) and the Sarai-i-Adl are the untested details most likely to become statements.

Chapter 3: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Market control and PDS	4	1992-2017	Recurring
Titles and caliphal claims	3	2008-2016	Steady
Rajput and Gujarat conquests: order and rulers	3	2017-2022	Recent (2017, 2022)
Mongol frontier and special army	2	2014-2021	Recent (2021)
Land revenue and new taxes	2	1994-2011	Occasional
Deccan campaigns	1	1997	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (14 PYQs + 1 one-liner), every one of them on Alauddin except the Mubarak Khalji caliph question. Economic reforms (market control plus revenue) give 6 items, the largest block. Conquests give 4 and come as order or match questions, so the campaign timeline in 3.2 is the first thing to revise. Two Assertion-Reason items (Deccan motive, price-control motive) both hinge on rejecting a plausible but wrong Reason. Two items carry Notes: the Jaisalmer order question (OCR slip and bardic date) and the governors statement in 1994.

Chapter 4

Tughluq Dynasty

The Tughluqs ruled Delhi from 1320 to 1414, the longest of the five Sultanate dynasties. Ghiyasuddin Tughluq restored order after the fall of the Khaljis. Muhammad bin Tughluq (1325 to 1351), the most learned of the Sultans, tried bold experiments in capital, currency and taxation that mostly failed. Firuz Shah Tughluq (1351 to 1388) turned to welfare, canals, new towns and a stricter religious policy. The dynasty collapsed after Timur sacked Delhi in 1398. This chapter covers the founder and the dynasty's span, Muhammad bin Tughluq's projects, Ibn Battuta, Firuz Shah's welfare departments, taxes and buildings, and Timur's invasion. It contains **18 PYQs and 2 one-liners**. Firuz Shah alone accounts for 9 items.

4.1 Ghiyasuddin Tughluq and the Span of the Dynasty

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1999

Q. Who among the following Generals of Alauddin Khalji, ultimately became the first Sultan of Tughluq dynasty:

- (a) Ghazi Malik
- (b) Malik Kafur
- (c) Zafar Khan
- (d) Ubigh Khan

Ans. (a)

Ghazi Malik was Alauddin's warden of the marches at **Dipalpur**. An inscription he set up in Multan, recorded by Ibn Battuta, claims 29 victories over the Mongols, hence the title Malik-ul-Ghazi. In 1320 he overthrew **Nasiruddin Khusrau Shah** and took the throne as **Ghiyasuddin Tughluq** (1320 to 1325). He followed a middle path (rasm-i-miyana): he restored the privileges of the muqaddams and khuts that Alauddin had cut, limited increases in revenue demand, and built **Tughluqabad**, the third city of Delhi. He died in 1325 when a wooden pavilion built by his son Ulugh Khan (Jauna Khan) collapsed at **Afghanpur** as he returned from Bengal.

TRAP ALERT

Zafar Khan was Alauddin's general killed at Kili (1299), and **Malik Kafur** was killed in 1316. Neither founded a dynasty. The founder is Ghazi Malik.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. With reference to digging canals for enriching agriculture, who among the following is given the credit of being the first ruler of the 14th century?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
- (d) Raziyya Begum

Ans. (c)

Ghiyasuddin Tughluq is credited as the first Sultan to dig canals for irrigation. The other three options ruled in the 13th century, so the phrase "14th century" already removes them. **Firuz Shah Tughluq** built the largest canal network later (4.5). Remember the pair: first canals Ghiyasuddin, largest network and irrigation tax Firuz.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2008

Q. The Sultans of which dynasty ruled the country for the longest period ?

- (a) Khalji dynasty
- (b) Lodi dynasty
- (c) Slave dynasty
- (d) Tughluq dynasty

Ans. (d)

Dynasty	Period	Span (approx.)
Mamluk (Slave) or Ilbari	1206 to 1290	84 years
Khalji	1290 to 1320	30 years
Tughluq	1320 to 1414	about 94 years (to 1412 if counted to the death of Nasiruddin Mahmud)
Sayyid	1414 to 1451	37 years
Lodi	1451 to 1526	75 years

Tughluq Sultan	Reign	Key facts for the exam
Ghiyasuddin Tughluq (Ghazi Malik)	1320 to 1325	Founder. Tughluqabad. First canals. Died at Afghanpur
Muhammad bin Tughluq (Jauna Khan, Ulugh Khan)	1325 to 1351	Daulatabad, token currency, Doab tax, Khurasan and Qarachil plans. Ibn Battuta. Died near Thatta
Firuz Shah Tughluq	1351 to 1388	Welfare departments, canals, haq-i-sharb, jizya on Brahmans, new towns, Ashokan pillars, Futuh-i-Firozshahi
Ghiyasuddin Tughluq II, Abu Bakr, Nasiruddin Muhammad Shah	1388 to 1394	Succession wars
Nasiruddin Mahmud	1394 to 1412	Rival Sultan Nusrat Shah at Firozabad. Timur's invasion 1398
Daulat Khan Lodi	1412 to 1414	Noble in power. Khizr Khan took Delhi in 1414 (Sayyid dynasty)

4.2 Muhammad bin Tughluq: The Scholar-Sultan and His Five Projects

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. The most learned ruler of the Delhi Sultanate who was well versed in various branches of learning including Astronomy, Mathematics and Medicine was

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (c)

Contemporaries describe **Muhammad bin Tughluq** as a master of Persian poetry, calligraphy, logic, philosophy, astronomy, mathematics and medicine. **Alauddin**, by contrast, was not formally educated. **Sikandar Lodi** wrote Persian verse under the pen name Gulrukhi, which makes him the usual distractor, but the "most learned" label belongs to Muhammad bin Tughluq. Barani lists five projects that defined the reign.

Project (Barani's list)	What was done	Why it failed or what followed
Taxation in the Doab	Revenue demand raised in the Ganga-Yamuna Doab, with new cesses	Came with a famine. Peasants fled. Relief loans (sondhar) and wells came too late
Transfer of capital (commonly dated 1327)	Delhi to Daulatabad (Devagiri). Nobles, ulema and many residents moved	Distance and hardship. Delhi restored as capital within a few years
Token currency (c. 1329 to 1330)	Bronze or copper coins given the face value of the silver tanka	No state monopoly over minting. Forgery everywhere. Token coins withdrawn and exchanged for silver and gold
Khurasan expedition	A large army raised for a campaign in Central Asia	Plan dropped. Army disbanded after about a year at great cost
Qarachil expedition	Campaign into the Himalayan hills (commonly placed in Kumaon-Garhwal)	Army destroyed by terrain and rain. A tribute agreement followed

UP link: the **Doab taxation** fell on the Ganga-Yamuna Doab, most of which lies in western and central Uttar Pradesh. Barani, himself from Baran (Bulandshahr), describes peasants abandoning their fields there.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2002, 2004

Q. Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq had transferred his capital from Delhi to -

- (a) Daulatabad
- (b) Kalinjar
- (c) Kannauj
- (d) Lahore

Ans. (a)

Barani says Devagiri was chosen because it lay at the **centre of the empire**, well placed to control the newly won Deccan. The city was renamed **Daulatabad**. Only part of the Delhi population was moved, but the upheaval was severe. The distractors **Kalinjar** (Banda district) and **Kannauj** (Kannauj district) are both in UP and were never Tughluq capitals.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004, 2017, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. For the first time the token currency was introduced in India by :

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Bahlul Lodi
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2006

Q. Consider the following statements

Assertion (A) : The scheme of the token currency of Muhammad Tughluq proved unsuccessful.

Reason (R) : Muhammad Tughluq did not have the proper control over currency issue.

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) is individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) is individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (a)

A token coin works only if the state alone can issue it. Muhammad bin Tughluq's bronze coins were simple to copy, and the state could not tell its own coins from forged ones. Barani says every Hindu house became a mint. People paid revenue and tribute in forged tokens and hoarded gold and silver. The Sultan finally redeemed the tokens from the treasury, which drained it. The model probably came from the paper money of the Mongol rulers of China and Iran.

TRAP ALERT

The failure was **administrative** (no control over minting), not a shortage of copper or a refusal of the ulema. The **Bahlul Lodi** option points to the bahloli, a copper coin of the Lodis, which was ordinary currency, not token money.

4.3 Ibn Battuta, the Postal System and the End of Muhammad bin Tughluq

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1991, 1994, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Ibn Battuta, the Moorish traveller, visited India during the reign of :

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (b) Babar
- (c) Akbar
- (d) Mahmud Ghazni

Ans. (a)

Ibn Battuta came from **Tangier** in Morocco and reached India in 1333. Muhammad bin Tughluq made him **qazi of Delhi**, and in 1342 sent him as his envoy to the **Mongol (Yuan) emperor of China**. His travel account, the **Rehla** (Kitab-ul-Rehla), is a key source for the court, the economy and the roads of the period.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. Who of the following has given a detailed description of the postal system obtaining during the Sultanate period?

- (a) Amir Khusrau
- (b) Ibn Battuta
- (c) Sultan Firuz Shah
- (d) Ziyauddin Barani

Ans. (b)

The **Rehla** describes two kinds of post: a **horse post** (uluq) with relays of royal horses, and a **foot post** (dawa) with runners stationed at short intervals who carried letters and even fresh fruit from Khurasan to the Sultan. It was faster than the horse post over short stages.

Traveller or author	Origin	Ruler served or visited	Work
Ibn Battuta	Tangier, Morocco	Muhammad bin Tughluq (qazi of Delhi, envoy to China)	Rehla
Ziyauddin Barani	Baran (Bulandshahr, UP)	Muhammad bin Tughluq, Firuz Shah	Tarikh-i-Firozshahi, Fatawa-i-Jahandari
Shams-i-Siraj Afif	India	Firuz Shah	Tarikh-i-Firozshahi (a separate work with the same name)
Firuz Shah Tughluq	Delhi	Himself	Futuhat-i-Firozshahi (his own account of his reign)
Amir Khusrau	Patiali (Kasganj, UP)	Khalji Sultans, Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Tughluq Nama
Isami	India	Bahmani court	Futuh-us-Salatin (critical of Muhammad bin Tughluq)
Badauni	India	Akbar	Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh

TRAP ALERT

Fatawa-i-Jahandari is Barani's treatise on statecraft. It is **not** by Firuz Shah. Firuz wrote the **Futuhat-i-Firozshahi**. Also note two different **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi** works, one by Barani and one by Afif.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. 'The king was freed from his people and they from their king.' On whose death did Badauni comment this ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Balban
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Ans. (d)

The last years of Muhammad bin Tughluq were spent crushing revolts. The south broke away: the Madurai Sultanate (1335), **Vijayanagara** under Harihara and Bukka (1336) and the **Bahmani** kingdom (1347). Chasing the rebel **Taghi** from Gujarat into Sindh, he fell ill and died near **Thatta** in March 1351. Badauni's remark sums up a reign that exhausted both ruler and subjects.

4.4 Firuz Shah Tughluq: Welfare Departments and Public Works

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (MAINS) 2010

Q. Who among the following Sultans of Delhi established an 'Employment Exchange' to help the unemployed ?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

Ans. (d)

Firuz Shah ran the Sultanate as a paternal welfare state. The kotwal was told to list the unemployed, and an office found them posts according to their merit. Almost every "first welfare measure"

question in the Sultanate period points to him.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Employment bureau	Office that placed the unemployed in jobs	Firuz Shah
Diwan-i-Khairat	Charity department. Helped poor Muslims, including marriage of daughters	Firuz Shah
Diwan-i-Istihqaq	Department of pensions and grants to the deserving	Firuz Shah
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Department of slaves. Afif puts their number at about 1,80,000	Firuz Shah
Dar-ul-Shifa	Free hospital with state-paid physicians	Firuz Shah
Haq-i-sharb	Irrigation tax, one-tenth of produce, on land watered by state canals	Firuz Shah (first to levy)
Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi	Department of agriculture to extend cultivation	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Sondhar	State loans to peasants for cultivation (taqavi)	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Token currency	Bronze or copper coin with the face value of the silver tanka	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Uluq and dawa	Horse post and foot post	Ibn Battuta's account
Jizya	Poll tax on non-Muslims. Extended to Brahmins	Firuz Shah
Khams	State share of war booty. Firuz restored the lawful one-fifth	Firuz Shah

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2000, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2006

Q. Public Works Department was primarily established by-

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Balban
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

Ans. (d)

Firuz Shah set up a department of public works that built canals, towns, mosques, madrasas, hospitals, sarais and bridges, and repaired older monuments such as the Qutb Minar and the Hauz-i-Alai. The source credits him with founding about 200 towns. The main ones are in the table in 4.6. His chief architect was Malik Ghazi Shahna.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL.) (MAINS) 2004

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi established a 'Translation Department' to help both communities to understand each other's ideas better ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Firuz Tughluq
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (b)

Sanskrit works found at **Nagarkot** (Kangra) were translated into Persian under Firuz Shah. The best known is the **Dalail-i-Firozshahi** on astronomy and related sciences. Under Sikandar Lodi a Sanskrit medical work was rendered as Tibb-i-Sikandari, which makes him a close distractor, but the translation department in the PYQ is Firuz's.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998

Q. The first Indian ruler to organize Hajj pilgrimage from the State Exchequer was:

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Firuz Tughluq
- (c) Akbar
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (b)

Note: the source key is (b). Several GK sources instead name Akbar, who appointed a Mir Hajj and funded pilgrim caravans from 1576. For this UPPSC question follow the source key, but be aware that other exams have keyed Akbar.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2013

Q. What was 'Dar-ul-Shifa' established by Firuz Tughluq?

Ans. A free hospital

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Firuz's welfare offices have been asked five times (employment, PWD, translation, Hajj, Dar-ul-Shifa). Diwan-i-Khairat, Diwan-i-Istihqaq and Diwan-i-Bandagan are the untested names in the same set and fit a match question.

4.5 Firuz Shah's Revenue and Religious Policy: Haq-i-Sharb and Jizya

U. P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2008, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Who was the first Sultan of Delhi to have levied 'Haqqi-Sharb' or irrigation tax?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Firuz Tughluq

Ans. (d)

Firuz Shah dug the largest canal network of the Sultanate, drawing on the **Yamuna** and the **Sutlej**. The canal from the Yamuna to Hisar is the ancestor of the **Western Yamuna Canal**. After taking the opinion of the ulema he charged **haq-i-sharb**, one-tenth of the produce, on land watered by state canals. He said he levied only the taxes sanctioned by Islamic law (kharaj, jizya, khams and zakat) and abolished many other cesses.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1996

Q. 'Sharb' was a tax levied on:

Ans. Irrigation

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2011

Q. Which Sultan of Delhi had levied 'Jizya' on Brahmins?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Firuz Tughluq
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Ans. (b)

Brahmins had been exempt from jizya until Firuz Shah. Afif records that when Firuz extended it to them, the Brahmins of Delhi protested with a fast, and other Hindus of Delhi agreed to pay the amount on their behalf. Firuz also made the iqta and army posts hereditary, which weakened central control after him.

TRAP ALERT

Three "first" taxes, three Sultans: **ghari** (house tax) Alauddin, **haq-i-sharb** (irrigation) Firuz, **jizya on Brahmins** Firuz. Ghiyasuddin is first for canals, not for the canal tax.

4.6 Ashokan Pillars, New Towns and Tughluq Buildings

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1996, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Who brought two Ashoka Pillars to Delhi from Topra and Meerut?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (c) Muhammad Ghori
- (d) Sikandar Lodhi

Ans. (b)

Firuz Shah had two Ashokan pillars moved to Delhi. The **Topra** pillar (now Yamunanagar district, Haryana) was set up on his palace-citadel of **Firozabad** (Feroz Shah Kotla). It is the only pillar carrying Ashoka's **seventh pillar edict**. The **Meerut** pillar was set up on the Delhi **Ridge** near his hunting lodge. Afif describes the Topra pillar being wrapped in silk cotton and floated down the Yamuna on a large boat.

UP link: the second pillar came from **Meerut** (Meerut district). Firuz also founded **Jaunpur** on the Gomti (Jaunpur district), commonly said to be named after Muhammad bin Tughluq, whose earlier name was **Jauna Khan**. He began the **Atala Masjid** there, completed in 1408 by Ibrahim Shah Sharqi. Jaunpur later became the capital of the independent **Sharqi** kingdom, founded by the Tughluq noble Malik Sarwar (Malik-us-Sharq) in 1394.

Monument or town	Builder	Place
Tughluqabad fort and Ghiyasuddin's tomb (sloping walls)	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Delhi (third city)
Jahanpanah and Adilabad fort	Muhammad bin Tughluq	Delhi (fourth city, joining Siri and Qila Rai Pithora)
Daulatabad	Muhammad bin Tughluq (renamed Devagiri)	Maharashtra
Firozabad (Feroz Shah Kotla)	Firuz Shah	Delhi (fifth city). Topra pillar
Hauz Khas madrasa and repairs to Hauz-i-Alai	Firuz Shah	Delhi
Tomb of Khan-i-Jahan Tegalani	Firuz's wazir (built by his son)	Delhi. First octagonal tomb in Delhi
Hisar (Hisar-i-Firoza), Fatehabad	Firuz Shah	Haryana
Jaunpur	Firuz Shah	UP (Jaunpur district)
Firozpur	Firuz Shah (attributed in the source)	Punjab

TRAP ALERT

Ashokan pillars moved to Delhi = **Firuz Shah**. The Mehrauli iron pillar is a Gupta pillar, not Ashokan.

4.7 The Later Tughluqs and Timur's Invasion (1398)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. In whose reign did Timur invade India?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Bahlul Lodi
- (c) Firuz Tughluq
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

Ans. (*)

Note: none of the options is correct. Timur invaded in 1398 during the reign of Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughluq (1394 to 1412). Firuz Tughluq had died ten years earlier (1388). If forced to choose, Firuz is the nearest in time, but the correct ruler is Nasiruddin Mahmud.

After Firuz's death in 1388 princes and nobles fought over the throne. By 1394 two rival Sultans held court, **Nasiruddin Mahmud** at Delhi and Nusrat Shah at Firozabad. **Timur**, ruler of Samargand, crossed the Indus in 1398, defeated Mahmud's army outside Delhi in December 1398 and sacked the city. He left in January 1399 by way of Firozabad, Meerut, Haridwar, Kangra and Jammu, and appointed **Khizr Khan** governor of Multan, Lahore and Dipalpur. Khizr Khan took Delhi in 1414 and founded the **Sayyid** dynasty.

UP link: Timur's return march passed through **Meerut** (Meerut district), which he attacked in January 1399.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

A reworded version could list Nasiruddin Mahmud as an option, or ask whom Timur left in charge (Khizr Khan). The 1398 date and the Khizr Khan link to the Sayyids are the two facts to fix.

Chapter 4: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Firuz Shah: welfare departments and public works	5	1998-2013	Recurring
Muhammad bin Tughluq: learning, capital, token currency	4	2002-2017	Recurring (token currency asked 4 times)
Ghiyasuddin Tughluq and span of the dynasty	3	1999-2017	Steady
Ibn Battuta and end of Muhammad bin Tughluq	3	1991-2011	Recurring
Firuz Shah: haq-i-sharb and jizya	3	1996-2011	Steady
Ashokan pillars moved to Delhi	1	1996-2009	Occasional (2 papers)
Timur's invasion	1	2002	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 20 items (18 PYQs + 2 one-liners). Firuz Shah Tughluq dominates with 9 items, nearly all of the "who was the first Sultan to..." type (employment bureau, PWD, irrigation tax, jizya on Brahmins, Hajj, translation department). Muhammad bin Tughluq gives 7 items built around Barani's five projects and Ibn Battuta. The Tughluq questions are mostly direct attribution questions, so the ruler-to-measure tables in 4.1, 4.2 and 4.4 are the fastest revision. Two items carry Notes: the Timur question keyed (*) and the Hajj question, where other sources name Akbar. No Tughluq PYQ has appeared after 2017 in this source.

Chapter 5

Sayyid and Lodi Dynasties

Timur's sack of Delhi in 1398 broke the Tughluq Sultanate. Out of the ruins came the **Sayyids** (1414 to 1451), who began as Timur's governors, and the **Afghan Lodis** (1451 to 1526), who restored some strength to the Sultanate until Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi at Panipat. This chapter covers Timur's invasion, the Sayyid rulers in order, the Afghan origin of the Lodis, Sikandar Lodi's reign (Agra, gaz-i-sikandari, Gulrukhi, abolition of the grain tax) and the order of the five Sultanate dynasties. It contains **5 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. The founding of Agra alone has been asked in seven papers.

5.1 Timur's Invasion (1398) and the Sayyid Sultans

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. What is the correct chronological order of the Sultans of Sayyid dynasty?

1. Khizr Khan
2. Muhammad Shah
3. Mubarak Shah
4. Ala-ud-Din Alam Shah

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code -

- (a) 1, 4, 2, 3
- (b) 1, 2, 3, 4
- (c) 1, 3, 2, 4
- (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

Ans. (c)

In 1398 **Timur**, the Turko-Mongol ruler of Samarkand, invaded India in the reign of the last Tughluq, **Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah**. He defeated the Sultan's army outside Delhi, sacked the city in December 1398 and left early in 1399. Before leaving he made **Khizr Khan** governor of Multan. Khizr Khan took Delhi in 1414 and founded the Sayyid dynasty, so called because the family claimed descent from the Prophet.

Sayyid ruler	Reign (CE)	Key facts for the exam
Khizr Khan	1414 to 1421	Did not take the title Sultan. Called himself Rayat-i-Ala (exalted standard-bearer) and ruled as deputy of Timur's son Shah Rukh
Mubarak Shah	1421 to 1434	Took the title Shah and struck coins in his own name. Yahya Sirhindi wrote the Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi in his reign
Muhammad Shah	1434 to 1445	Weak ruler. Leaned on Bahlul Lodi against the Sultan of Malwa
Alauddin Alam Shah	1445 to 1451	Withdrew to Badaun and left Delhi to Bahlul Lodi (1451)

UP link: the last Sayyid, Alauddin Alam Shah, retired to **Badaun** (Budaun district) and lived there after handing Delhi to Bahlul Lodi. By then the Sultan's writ barely ran beyond Delhi, while the **Sharqis of Jaunpur** held eastern UP.

TRAP ALERT

Order: **Khizr Khan, Mubarak Shah, Muhammad Shah, Alam Shah**. The trap is to put Muhammad Shah second because he is listed second. Mnemonic: **K-M-M-A**, with Mubarak before Muhammad (alphabetical order helps here).

5.2 The Lodis: The Afghan Dynasty and Bahlul Lodi

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1993, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008, 2011, 2016

Q. Who among the following Sultanate rulers was of Afghan origin?

- (a) Khalji
- (b) Tughluq
- (c) Sayyid
- (d) Lodi

Ans. (d)

The **Lodis** were the first Afghan dynasty to rule Delhi (1451 to 1526). **Bahlul Lodi** (1451 to 1489) had served the Sayyids as governor of Sirhind and Lahore. He ruled as first among equals of the Afghan chiefs. By tradition he would not sit on the throne in their presence and shared a carpet with them. His great success was the conquest of the **Sharqi Sultanate of Jaunpur**, which had rivalled Delhi for most of the 15th century. He issued a copper coin called the **Bahloli**.

Dynasty	Origin
Slave (Mamluk, Ilbari)	Turk
Khalji	Turkish tribe long settled in Afghanistan. Sometimes wrongly called Afghan
Tughluq	Turk (Qarauna Turks, as Ibn Battuta describes them)
Sayyid	Claimed descent from the Prophet
Lodi	Afghan . The first Afghan dynasty of Delhi. The Surs (Sher Shah) were the second

UP link: **Jaunpur** (Jaunpur district), capital of the Sharqi Sultans, was annexed by Bahlul Lodi, who placed his son Barbak Shah there. The Atala and Jama mosques of Jaunpur are Sharqi monuments.

TRAP ALERT

The **Khaljis** are the usual trap. They lived long in Afghanistan and took on Afghan ways, so the Turkish nobles of Delhi treated them as outsiders. They were Turks by origin. The Afghan answer is **Lodi**.

5.3 Sikandar Lodi (1489 to 1517): Agra, Gaz-i-Sikandari and Gulrukhi

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1993, 2004, 2011, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005, 2011, 2008, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Agra city was founded by :

- (a) Balban
- (b) Bahlul Lodi
- (c) Sikandar Lodi
- (d) Firuz Tughluq

Ans. (c)

Sikandar Lodi (Nizam Khan), son of Bahlul, was the ablest Lodi. In **1504** he founded a new town at **Agra** on the Yamuna to watch over the Rajput chiefs of the Gwalior and Dholpur region, and made it his capital. Agra later became the capital of Babur and Akbar. He had land measured with a standard yard, the **gaz-i-sikandari**, which stayed in use until Akbar's **Ilahi gaz**. He wrote Persian verse under the pen name **Gulrukhi** and had crops and accounts checked closely.

UP link: **Agra** (Agra district) was founded by Sikandar Lodi in 1504. **Sikandra**, where Akbar's tomb stands, is named after him.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. Who composed poems with the pen-name 'Gulrukhi'?**Ans.** Sikandar Lodi

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (PRE) 2010

Q. Which one of the following Sultans is known for having abolished the tax on grains?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
(b) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
(c) Firuz Tughluq
(d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (d)

Sikandar Lodi abolished the **zakat on grain**, here meaning the duty charged on grain in trade and transit, which made food cheaper and helped trade. Each distractor is known for a different economic measure.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Rayat-i-Ala	Exalted standard-bearer	Title used by Khizr Khan instead of Sultan
Bahloli	Copper coin	Bahlul Lodi. Remained in use into Akbar's time
Gaz-i-sikandari	Standard measuring yard for land	Sikandar Lodi
Gulrukhi	Pen name for Persian verse	Sikandar Lodi
Zakat	Religious tax on Muslims. Also used for trade and transit duties such as the duty on grain	Grain duty abolished by Sikandar Lodi

Sultan	Economic measure often tested
Alauddin Khalji	Market control and fixed grain prices, land measurement
Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Moderate land revenue, care for cultivation
Firuz Tughluq	Abolished many cesses and kept four taxes sanctioned by Islamic law (kharaj, jizya, khams, zakat). Canals
Sikandar Lodi	Abolished zakat on grain. Gaz-i-sikandari

TRAP ALERT

Firuz Tughluq founded several towns (Jaunpur, Hisar, Firozabad), which makes him plausible in the Agra question. Agra is **Sikandar Lodi**, 1504. Do not confuse the founding of Agra with Babur or Akbar, who only made it the Mughal capital.

5.4 Ibrahim Lodi, Panipat (1526) and the Order of the Sultanate Dynasties

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. In which order did the following dynasties rule Delhi ?

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

1. Khalji
2. Lodi
3. Sayyid
4. Slave

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 4, 3
(b) 1, 2, 3, 4
(c) 2, 3, 4, 1
(d) 4, 1, 3, 2

Ans. (d)

Dynasty	Years (CE)	Founder	Last ruler
Slave (Mamluk)	1206 to 1290	Qutbuddin Aibak	Kaimurs
Khalji	1290 to 1320	Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji	Khusrau Khan (usurper) after Mubarak Shah
Tughluq	1320 to 1414	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah (died 1412)
Sayyid	1414 to 1451	Khizr Khan	Alauddin Alam Shah
Lodi	1451 to 1526	Bahlul Lodi	Ibrahim Lodi

Ibrahim Lodi (1517 to 1526) tried to reduce the Afghan nobles to obedience, and many turned against him. **Daulat Khan Lodi**, governor of Punjab, and Ibrahim's uncle **Alam Khan** invited **Babur**. At the **First Battle of Panipat** on 21 April 1526 Babur's field artillery and the tulughma flanking tactic defeated Ibrahim's much larger army. Ibrahim was killed on the field, the only Sultan of Delhi to die in battle. The Delhi Sultanate ended and the Mughal empire began.

Battle	Year (CE)	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Timur's attack on Delhi	1398	Timur vs Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughluq	Delhi sacked. Tughluq power collapses. Khizr Khan left in Multan
First Panipat	1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	End of the Delhi Sultanate. Mughal rule begins

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The Sayyid order came in 2023 and the dynasty order in 2012. A chronology of the Lodi rulers (Bahlul, Sikandar, Ibrahim), or a match of Sultan with measure (Khizr Khan and Rayat-i-Ala, Sikandar Lodi and gaz-i-sikandari, Bahlul and the Bahloli), is the natural next form.

Chapter 5: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Sikandar Lodi: Agra, Gulrukhi, grain tax	3	1993-2015	Most recurring (Agra in 7 papers)
Afghan origin of the Lodis	1	1993-2016	Recurring (asked in 4 papers)
Order of the Sultanate dynasties	1	2012	Occasional
Sayyid rulers in order	1	2023	New (2023)

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 6 items (5 PYQs + 1 one-liner), but heavily repeated. The Agra question has come in seven papers from 1993 to 2011 and the Afghan-origin question in four. Chronology is the other staple: the order of the Sultanate dynasties (2012) and the order of the Sayyid rulers (2023). No item needs a Note. Revise the dynasty table in 5.4 and the Sayyid table in 5.1 first.

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Chapter 6

Vijayanagara Empire

The Vijayanagara Empire was founded in 1336 by **Harihara I and Bukka I**, two of the five sons of Sangama, on the south bank of the Tungabhadra. Four dynasties ruled it: Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva and Aravidu. Its high point came under **Krishnadeva Raya** (1509 to 1529). Its capital was sacked after the **Battle of Talikota** (1565), but the Aravidu line ruled from Penukonda and Chandragiri for decades more. This chapter covers the founders and Sangama patronage of learning, Krishnadeva Raya and Telugu literature, the foreign travellers, Talikota, and the ruins at Hampi with the key administrative terms. It contains **8 PYQs and 3 one-liners**. Krishnadeva Raya and Telugu literature account for 5 items.

6.1 Foundation, the Four Dynasties and Sangama Patronage of Learning

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008

Q. Sayan, the famous commentator of the Vedic texts, was patronized by -

- (a) Paramara rulers
- (b) Satavahana rulers
- (c) Vijayanagara rulers
- (d) Vakataka rulers

Ans. (c)

Harihara and Bukka founded the city of Vijayanagara in **1336** on the south bank of the **Tungabhadra**, opposite the fort of **Anegondi** on the north bank. Tradition credits their inspiration to the scholar-saint **Madhava Vidyaranya**, associated with the Sringeri matha, and his brother **Sayana**. Sayana wrote the great commentary on the Vedas (Vedartha Prakasha) under the patronage of the early Sangama kings, Bukka I and Harihara II. The distractors fail on date alone. The Satavahanas and Vakatakas belong to the ancient period, and the Paramaras of Malwa (Bhoja) ruled in the 10th and 11th centuries.

Dynasty	Period	Founder	Key rulers and facts
Sangama	1336 to 1485	Harihara I and Bukka I	Harihara II, Deva Raya I (Nicolo Conti), Deva Raya II (Abdur Razzaq, took Muslims into the army)
Saluva	1485 to 1505	Saluva Narasimha	Seized power from a weak Sangama line
Tuluva	1505 to 1570	Vira Narasimha (Tuluva Narasa Nayaka was regent before him)	Krishnadeva Raya 1509 to 1529, Achyuta Raya, Sadashiva Raya (Rama Raya regent, Talikota 1565)
Aravidu	1570 to mid-17th century	Tirumala (brother of Rama Raya)	Capital moved to Penukonda, later Chandragiri and Vellore

TRAP ALERT

Vijayanagara (**1336**) and the Bahmani kingdom (**1347**) both broke away from Muhammad bin Tughluq. Examiners swap the two years in option sets (see Chapter 11). Rama Raya was the real power at Talikota, but the reigning king was **Sadashiva Raya**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. The lady poet who described the victorious expeditions of her husband in her work 'Madura-Vijayam' was :

- (a) Bharati
- (b) Ganga Devi
- (c) Varadambika
- (d) Vijjika

Ans. (b)

Kumara Kampana, son of Bukka I, led the campaign that ended the **Madurai Sultanate** and brought the Tamil south under Vijayanagara. His wife **Gangadevi** wrote the Sanskrit poem **Madhura Vijayam** (also called Vira Kamparaya Charitam) on his campaigns. It is a key source for early Vijayanagara history.

TRAP ALERT

Varadambika is a trap. She is the subject, not the author, of Varadambika Parinayam, written by the poetess **Tirumalamba** on the marriage of Achyuta Raya. Two women poets, two different works.

6.2 Krishnadeva Raya and the Golden Age of Telugu Literature

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2001

Q. Who were the 'Ashta Diggajas' in the court of Krishnadeva Raya?

- (a) Eight ministers
- (b) Eight Telugu poets
- (c) Eight great warriors
- (d) Eight advisors

Ans. (b)

The **Ashtadiggajas** ("eight elephants of the quarters") were eight Telugu poets at the court of Krishnadeva Raya. The foremost was **Allasani Peddana**, called Andhra Kavita Pitamaha, author of **Manucharitram** (Svarochisha Manusambhavam). Tenali Ramakrishna and Nandi Timmana are the other names most often asked. The king himself wrote **Amuktamalyada** in Telugu, counted among the five great Telugu kavyas, and **Jambavati Kalyanam** in Sanskrit. He took the title **Andhra Bhoja**.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2006

Q. The ruling period of Krishnadeva Raya was the golden age of which literature?

Ans. Telugu

TRAP ALERT

Eight ministers is the Maratha **Ashtapradhan** of Shivaji. Ashtadiggajas are poets. Do not mix the two "eight" councils.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL.) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Who was enthroned 500 years ago ?

- (a) Harihara- I
- (b) Krishnadeva Raya
- (c) Kulottunga- I
- (d) Raja Raya- I

Ans. (b)

Note: the question is loosely framed. Krishnadeva Raya's accession in 1509 was about 500 years before the 2008 exam, which makes (b) the intended answer. Harihara I (1336), Kulottunga I (1070) and Rajaraja I (985) had all come to the throne far more than 500 years earlier.

Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva dynasty) ruled from **1509 to 1529**. He defeated the Bahmani successor states, took **Raichur** from Bijapur in **1520**, and campaigned against the Gajapatis of Odisha. The Raichur doab between the Krishna and the Tungabhadra was the constant bone of contention with the Deccan sultans. **Kulottunga I** (1070 to 1120) was the Eastern Chalukya prince who took the Chola throne. **Rajaraja I** began his reign in 985.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. Which city was founded by Krishnadeva Raya?

Ans. Nagalapura

Krishnadeva Raya built **Nagalapura**, named after his mother Nagala Devi, as a suburb of the capital. It is commonly identified with modern **Hosapete** (Hospet), now the headquarters of the new Vijayanagara district of Karnataka (see 6.5).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2012

Q. Who among these was famous for Telugu translation?

1. Kamban
2. Kuttan
3. Nannaya
4. Tikkana

Choose the answer from the codes :

- (a) only 1, 2
- (b) only 2, 3
- (c) only 3, 4
- (d) only 4, 1

Ans. (c)

The Telugu **Mahabharata** was begun by **Nannaya** (11th century, Eastern Chalukya court), continued by **Tikkana** (13th century) and completed by **Yerrana** (14th century). The three are the **Kavitraya** of Telugu. **Kamban** wrote the Tamil Ramayana (Ramavataram), and **Kuttan** (Ottakkuttan) was a Tamil poet of the later Chola court. Both belong to Tamil, so any code containing 1 or 2 fails.

Author	Work	Language	Context
Krishnadeva Raya	Amuktamalyada , Jambavati Kalyanam	Telugu, Sanskrit	Vijayanagara king
Allasani Peddana	Manucharitram	Telugu	Chief of the Ashtadiggajas
Gangadevi	Madhura Vijayam	Sanskrit	Wife of Kumara Kampana
Tirumalamba	Varadambika Parinayam	Sanskrit	Court of Achyuta Raya
Sayana	Vedartha Prakasha (Veda commentary)	Sanskrit	Early Sangama kings
Nannaya, Tikkana, Yerrana	Telugu Mahabharata	Telugu	Kavitraya, 11th to 14th century
Kamban	Ramavataram	Tamil	Chola period

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Krishnadeva Raya has produced five items across 2001 to 2016. Amuktamalyada, Peddana and the Raichur campaign are the untested facts closest to the questions already asked.

6.3 Foreign Travellers at Vijayanagara

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Abdur Razzaq visited Vijayanagara during the reign of

- (a) Devaraya - I
- (b) Devaraya - II
- (c) Krishnadeva Raya
- (d) Vira Vijaya

Ans. (b)

Abdur Razzaq came as envoy of the Timurid ruler **Shah Rukh** of Herat and reached Vijayanagara in 1443, in the reign of **Deva Raya II** (1422 to 1446) of the Sangama dynasty. The option pair Deva Raya I and Deva Raya II is the real test. Pair each traveller with his king.

Traveller	Origin	Vijayanagara ruler	Remark
Nicolo Conti	Venice, Italy	Deva Raya I	Visited c. 1420
Abdur Razzaq	Persia (envoy of Shah Rukh)	Deva Raya II	Visited 1443
Afanasy Nikitin	Russia	Not Vijayanagara	Visited the Bahmani kingdom (1469 to 1472)
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	Krishnadeva Raya	Early 16th century
Domingo Paes	Portugal	Krishnadeva Raya	Detailed account of the city, c. 1520 to 1522
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal (horse trader)	Achyuta Raya	History of the kingdom, c. 1535 to 1537

TRAP ALERT

Conti (Italian) goes with **Deva Raya I**, Abdur Razzaq (Persian) with **Deva Raya II**. Paes goes with Krishnadeva Raya, Nuniz with his successor **Achyuta Raya**. Nikitin never visited Vijayanagara.

6.4 The Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi), 1565

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. The Battle of Talikota was fought between -

- (a) Akbar and Sultan of Malwa
- (b) Vijayanagara and the Bahmani Kingdom
- (c) Vijayanagara and combined forces of Bijapur, Ahmadnagar and Golconda
- (d) Sher Shah and Humayun

Ans. (c)

On **23 January 1565** the combined armies of **Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda and Bidar** defeated Vijayanagara. **Berar** was the only Deccan sultanate that stayed out. The name Talikota comes from Ferishta, but the fighting took place between the villages of **Rakshasi and Tangadi**, so the battle is also called Rakshasi-Tangadi. The king was **Sadashiva Raya**, but power lay with his minister **Rama Raya**, whose playing off of the sultans against one another had united them. **Husain Nizam Shah** of Ahmadnagar had Rama Raya beheaded, and the capital was sacked for months afterwards.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1993

Q. The Battle of Talikota was fought in

Ans. 1565 A.D.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Raichur	1520	Krishnadeva Raya vs Ismail Adil Shah of Bijapur	Raichur doab taken by Vijayanagara
Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi)	1565	Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda and Bidar vs Vijayanagara (Rama Raya)	Capital sacked. Aravidu kings moved to Penukonda

TRAP ALERT

Talikota was **not** fought against the Bahmani kingdom, which had already broken up into five sultanates by 1528. The year **1565** is also not a Mughal battle year. Akbar's Malwa campaign (Baz Bahadur) was in 1561.

6.5 Hampi: The Capital, Its Monuments and Vijayanagara Administration

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007, 2008

Q. Ruins of which of the following represent the old capital of Vijayanagara ?

- (a) Ahmadnagar
- (b) Bijapur
- (c) Golconda
- (d) Hampi

Ans. (d)

The ruins at **Hampi** in northern Karnataka mark the old city of Vijayanagara. The **Group of Monuments at Hampi** was inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List in **1986**. Hampi now lies in **Vijayanagara district**, carved out of Ballari as Karnataka's 31st district, with headquarters at Hosapete. The three distractors were capitals of the Deccan sultanates that defeated Vijayanagara at Talikota.

Monument at Hampi	Builder or period	Feature
Virupaksha temple	Older shrine, enlarged in the Vijayanagara period. Krishnadeva Raya added a gopura	Still a living temple. Tutelary deity of the rulers
Vittala temple	Begun in the 15th century, enlarged under Krishnadeva Raya and his successors	Stone chariot (Garuda shrine) and musical pillars
Hazara Rama temple	Commonly dated to the early 15th century (Deva Raya I)	Royal chapel with Ramayana friezes
Mahanavami Dibba	Vijayanagara kings	Platform for the Mahanavami (Dussehra) festival described by Paes
Lotus Mahal, Elephant Stables	Vijayanagara period	Indo-Islamic features in the royal centre

The empire rested on military chiefs called **nayakas**. Each held a territory called **amaram** in return for maintaining troops for the king. Village affairs were run by the **ayagars**. After Talikota several nayakas (Madurai, Thanjavur, Keladi) became independent, and in Madurai the system produced the **palaiyakkarars** or Polygars (see Chapter 11).

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Nayankara	System of granting territory to military chiefs (nayakas)	Vijayanagara
Amaram, amaranayaka	Territory held for military service, and its holder	Vijayanagara
Ayagar	Twelve hereditary village functionaries paid with tax-free land	Vijayanagara villages
Palaiyakkarar (Polygar)	Holder of a palayam with military and administrative duties	Madurai Nayakas and later
Raya	Title of the Vijayanagara king	All four dynasties

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

No PYQ in this chapter has yet tested nayankara, amaram or ayagar, but the Polygar question (2015, Chapter 11) shows UPPSC does ask South Indian administrative terms. A term-meaning pair is the likely form.

Chapter 6: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Krishnadeva Raya and Telugu literature	5	2001-2016	Recurring
Foundation and Sangama patronage (Sayana, Madhura Vijayam)	2	2000-2008	Occasional
Battle of Talikota	2	1993-2014	Steady
Foreign travellers (Abdur Razzaq)	1	2010	Occasional
Hampi as the capital	1	2007-2008	Occasional (2 papers)

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 11 items (8 PYQs + 3 one-liners). Almost half concern Krishnadeva Raya and literature: the Ashtadiggajas, Telugu as the golden-age language, Nagalapura, his accession date and the Telugu Mahabharata translators. UPPSC treats Vijayanagara mainly as a culture and attribution topic. Travellers, Talikota and Hampi each give one direct question. One item carries a Note: the loosely framed "500 years ago" question from 2008. The traveller table in 6.3 and the literature table in 6.2 cover most of what has been asked.

Chapter 7

Delhi Sultanate: Administration

The Delhi Sultanate (1206 to 1526) ran a centralised state built on three supports: a Turkish ruling class of nobles and slaves, a revenue system that split the land into **khalisa** (crown land) and **iqta** (revenue assignments), and a cash economy based on the silver **tanka** and the copper **jital**. This chapter covers the nobility, the central ministries and the office of the wazir, state law (zawabit), the iqta system and its terms, the taxes of the Sultanate, the special departments created by individual Sultans, and coinage with its link to the Caliphate. It contains **11 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. The iqta and khalisa block and the Sultans' departments together account for 8 items.

7.1 The Sultan, the Turkish Nobility and the Slaves

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. Most of the rulers (amirs) and sultans of the Sultanate period belonged to the class

- (a) Turkish
- (b) Mongols
- (c) Tatars
- (d) Arabs

Ans. (a)

The Sultan was the head of the state, the army and the law. Almost everyone in a high post was called an **amir**. From 1206 to 1290 the Sultans and most amirs were **Turks**, many of them former slaves (**bandagan**). Iltutmish formed a corps of forty leading Turkish slave-officers, the **Turkan-i-Chahalgani**, which Balban later broke up. The **Khalji revolution** of 1290 opened high office to non-Turks and Indian Muslims, but the Tughluqs were also of Turkish descent. Only the **Lodis** (1451 to 1526) were Afghans. Amirs grew powerful whenever the Sultan was weak or a minor, as in the years between Iltutmish and Balban.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Amir	Noble holding high office. Ranks rose from amir to malik to khan	Whole Sultanate
Bandagan	Slaves of the Sultan, trained for army and office	Mamluk Sultans. Firuz Shah kept about 1,80,000 (Afif)
Turkan-i-Chahalgani	The Forty, a corps of Turkish slave-nobles	Formed by Iltutmish, crushed by Balban
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Separate department of slaves	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Dastar-bandan	Turban-wearers, the ulema (see Chapter 10)	Religious and judicial class

TRAP ALERT

Mongols and Tatars were the **invaders** the Sultanate fought, not its rulers. Arabs ruled Sindh from 712 CE but never Delhi. "Most" in the question matters: the Lodis were Afghans, so "all" would be wrong.

7.2 Central Ministries, the Wazir and State Law

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Under which dynasty did the Wizarat reach its highest point?

- (a) Ilbari
- (b) Khalji
- (c) Tughlaq
- (d) Lodi

Ans. (c)

The **wazir** was the chief minister and head of the **Diwan-i-Wizarat**, the finance and revenue ministry. He supervised land revenue, taxation, charity and military expenditure. Under the Ilbari Sultans the office was overshadowed by the Forty and, later, by Balban's personal rule. Under the **Tughluqs** it reached its peak. Ghiyasuddin Tughluq consulted former wazirs with respect, and under **Firuz Shah** the wazir **Khan-i-Jahan Maqbul Telangani** ran the government almost on his own, with the office later passing to his son.

Ministry	Head	Function
Diwan-i-Wizarat	Wazir	Finance and revenue. The chief ministry
Diwan-i-Arz	Ariz-i-Mumalik	Military department: recruitment, muster, inspection, pay. Set up by Balban
Diwan-i-Insha	Dabir-i-Khas	Royal correspondence and drafting of farmans
Diwan-i-Risalat	Sadr-us-Sudur (commonly)	Religious affairs and grants to scholars and the pious. Some historians read it as the department of appeals or of foreign correspondence
Diwan-i-Qaza	Qazi-ul-Quzat	Justice. Often held with the office of Sadr-us-Sudur
Diwan-i-Barid	Barid-i-Mumalik	News and intelligence. Barids reported from every province

Wizarat, Arz, Insha and Risalat are usually called the **four pillars** of the central government.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Zawabit were concerned with :

- (a) State laws
- (b) Law regulating mansab system
- (c) Laws regulating mint house
- (d) Agricultural taxes

Ans. (a)

Zawabit were state regulations issued by the Sultan to meet needs the Sharia did not cover. Barani discusses them in his **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** and argues that a ruler may frame such laws for the good of the state. Alauddin's market and revenue orders are the classic example.

TRAP ALERT

The **mansab** system belongs to the Mughals (Akbar), not the Sultanate. Any option that ties a Sultanate term to mansab is a planted anachronism.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Who was 'Kharitadar'?

- (a) Chief Officer of Pargana
- (b) Main custodian of royal palace
- (c) An officer who was trained in keeping accounts
- (d) Dispatcher of royal decrees

Ans. (d)

A **kharita** was the pouch in which official letters were sent. The **kharitadar** was the officer who dispatched farmans (royal orders), which ties him to the correspondence work of the Diwan-i-Insha. The distractors describe other officers: the pargana was headed by officials such as the **amil** and **shiqdar**, accounts were kept by the **mushrif** and **mustaufi** at the centre and the **patwari** in the village.

Unit	Officer	Role
Iqta or wilayat (province)	Muqti or wali	Collected revenue, kept troops, kept order
Shiq (division of a province)	Shiqdar	Order and military duties in the shiq
Pargana (group of villages)	Amil , with the chaudhari as local headman	Revenue collection at the pargana level
Village	Muqaddam (headman), patwari (accountant), khut	Assessment and collection from peasants

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Recent papers have turned to administrative terms (kharitadar 2023, the iqta terms 2023, khalisa 2025). Officer-to-function questions on barid, ariz, dabir-i-khas, shiqdar and muqaddam fit the same pattern.

7.3 Khalisa and Iqta: The Revenue Map of the Sultanate

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Given below are two statements one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) The territories of the Sultanate could be broadly divided into two parts - the Khalisa and the Jagirs.

Reason (R): The Jagirs comprised of the land under the control of the State.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Ans. (c)

Land in the Sultanate fell into two broad classes. **Khalisa** was crown land under the direct control of the state. Its revenue went straight to the royal treasury and paid the Sultan's household and his central troops. The rest was assigned as **iqtas** (the question uses the later word **jagir**) to nobles who collected the revenue and met their own military costs from it. So (A) is true and (R) describes khalisa, not jagir. Smaller grants to scholars and religious men (**inam**, **milk**, **waqf**) formed a third, minor category.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Which one of the following is NOT the characteristics of 'Iqta System'?

- (a) Iqta was a revenue collection system
- (b) Siyasatnama was the source of information for the Iqta system
- (c) Revenue from Iqta was directly deposited in Sultan's account
- (d) Muqti was supposed to maintain troops out of the revenue collected from Iqta

Ans. (c)

The iqta holder (**muqti** or **iqtdar**) collected the revenue of his area, paid himself and his troops out of it, and sent any surplus (**fawazil**) to the centre. The revenue did **not** go straight to the Sultan. That is true only of khalisa. The **Siyasatnama** of **Nizam-ul-Mulk Tusi**, wazir of the Seljuk Sultans in the 11th century, describes the early iqta and the duties of the muqti, so (b) is a genuine feature. The institution came to India with the Turks and was made the backbone of the state by Iltutmish.

U. P. P. C. S. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which medieval king of India introduced the 'Iqta System'?**Ans.** Iltutmish

Sultan	What happened to the iqta
Iltutmish (1211 to 1236)	Made the iqta the main unit of revenue and military administration. Iqtas were transferable and not hereditary
Balban (1266 to 1287)	Placed a khawaja (accountant) beside the muqti to check the income of the iqta. Tried to resume old service grants in the Doab
Alauddin Khalji (1296 to 1316)	Brought large areas into khalisa, audited muqtis strictly, paid the standing army in cash
Ghiyasuddin Tughluq (1320 to 1325)	Eased the harsh audit and followed a middle path (rasm-i-miyana)
Firuz Shah Tughluq (1351 to 1388)	Made iqtas and army posts hereditary , which weakened central control

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2023

Q. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Iqta	i. A portion
B. Mahrousa	ii. Land under state administration
C. Khalisa	iii. Land revenue
D. Shiq	iv. Protected town

Codes :

- (a) A-i, B-ii, C-iii, D-iv
- (b) A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii
- (c) A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii
- (d) A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i

Ans. (d)

Iqta literally means a portion, but in practice it was an assignment of **land revenue**, which is how the key pairs it. **Mahrousa** means "protected". The phrase mamalik-i-mahrousa ("the protected realms") was used for the Sultan's dominions, and the key pairs it with a protected town. **Khalisa** is land under direct state administration. **Shiq** is a part or division of a province. Use the certain pairs first: Khalisa-ii and Mahrousa-iv leave only option (d).

TRAP ALERT

Iqta and shiq both carry the sense of "a portion", which is why option (a), pairing iqta with a portion, tempts. Pair iqta with **revenue** and shiq with **portion**, as the key does.

Taxes of the Sultanate

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Kharaj	Land tax on non-Muslim cultivators	Main revenue. Alauddin fixed it at half the produce
Ushr	Land tax on land held by Muslims, about one-tenth	Islamic law
Jizya	Poll tax on non-Muslims, graded by wealth. Women, children and the infirm exempt	Extended to Brahmins by Firuz Shah
Khams	State share of war booty, lawfully one-fifth	Alauddin and Muhammad bin Tughluq took four-fifths. Firuz restored one-fifth
Zakat	Religious tax on the wealth of Muslims (2.5 per cent), for Muslim welfare	Islamic law
Ghari and charai	House tax and grazing tax	Alauddin Khalji
Haq-i-sharb	Irrigation tax, one-tenth of produce	Firuz Shah Tughluq

Firuz Shah claimed to collect only the four taxes sanctioned by Islamic law: **kharaj, jizya, khams and zakat**. A match of tax with its base (land, person, booty, wealth) is the natural question form.

7.4 Departments Created by Individual Sultans

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008

Q. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched:

- (a) Diwan-i-Mustakhraj - Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Diwan-i-Amir Kohi - Muhammad bin Tughluq
- (c) Diwan-i-Khairat - Firuz Tughluq
- (d) Diwan-i-Riyasat - Balban

Ans. (d)

The **Diwan-i-Riyasat** was Alauddin Khalji's department for enforcing his market regulations in Delhi, not Balban's. The other three pairs are correct. The **Diwan-i-Mustakhraj**, also Alauddin's, recovered arrears of revenue from officials and muqtis. The source explanation calls it the revenue department, but its specific task was the recovery of arrears.

Department	Function	Sultan
Diwan-i-Arz	Military department	Balban
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Recovery of revenue arrears	Alauddin Khalji
Diwan-i-Riyasat	Market control in Delhi	Alauddin Khalji
Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi	Agriculture: extension of cultivation	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Diwan-i-Khairat	Charity	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Diwan-i-Istihqaq	Pensions and grants	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Slaves	Firuz Shah Tughluq

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2004, U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. During Sultanate period, 'Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi' was related to which of the following?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Firuz Tughluq
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

Ans. (c)

Muhammad bin Tughluq set up the **Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi** to bring more land under cultivation by direct state help to peasants. A tract of about 30 kos by 30 kos was chosen, and crops were rotated on it under official supervision. The scheme spent large sums and was abandoned after about three years with little result. It sits with his loans to peasants (**sondhar**) as his agrarian measures.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Which ruler established 'Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi' department?

Ans. Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. During the Sultanate period, the department of 'Diwan-e-Amir Kohi' was related to

Ans. Agriculture

TRAP ALERT

"Kohi" suggests hills (koh), which pulls students toward a mountain or forest department. Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi is the **agriculture** department. Do not confuse it with Muhammad bin Tughluq's **Qarachil** hill expedition.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi has come four times (1997 to 2017). The untested names in the table (Mustakhraj alone, Istihqaq, Bandagan, Arz) fit a four-pair match of department with Sultan.

7.5 Coinage: Tanka, Jital and the Caliph's Name

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2001

Q. Find out the two main currencies of the Sultanate period from the code given below :

- 1. Dam
- 2. Jital
- 3. Rupiya
- 4. Tanka

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 2 and 4

Ans. (d)

Iltutmish was the first Turkish ruler to issue a pure Arabic coinage, and he standardised the two coins of the Sultanate: the silver **tanka** (about 175 grains) and the copper **jital**. The source gives the ratio as 1 tanka to 48 jitals. The **rupiya** (silver) and the **dam** (copper) are the coins of **Sher Shah Suri**, later continued by the Mughals. So both of the wrong options bring in Sur and Mughal coins.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2008, UPPCS (PRE) 2013

Q. Who did started 'Tanka' silver coin?

Ans. Iltutmish

Coin	Metal	Ruler
Tanka	Silver	Iltutmish
Jital	Copper	Iltutmish
Token coin	Bronze or copper with the value of the silver tanka	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Adha and bikh	Half and quarter jital	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Bahloli	Copper	Bahlul Lodi
Rupiya and dam	Silver and copper	Sher Shah Suri

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2012

Q. On whose coins did the name of the last Caliph of Baghdad appeared for the first time?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Alauddin Masud Shah

Ans. (d)

The last Abbasid Caliph of Baghdad was **al-Mustasim** (1242 to 1258), killed when the Mongols under Hulagu sacked Baghdad in 1258. He came to power in the same year as **Alauddin Masud Shah** (1242 to 1246), whose coins were the first in India to carry his name. **Iltutmish** had received a letter of investiture in 1229 from the earlier Caliph **al-Mustansir** (1226 to 1242), whose name he placed on his coins. The trap is to pick Iltutmish because he is the famous "Caliph's recognition" Sultan.

TRAP ALERT

Two caliphs, two Sultans: **al-Mustansir** on Iltutmish's coins, **al-Mustasim** (the last at Baghdad) first on Alauddin Masud Shah's coins. No coins in Aibak's own name are securely known.

Chapter 7: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Departments created by individual Sultans (Amir-Kohi, Riyasat)	4	1997-2017	Recurring
Khalisa and iqta	4	2010-2025	Rising (2019, 2023, 2025)
Coinage and the Caliph's name	3	2001-2013	Steady
Ministries, wazir, zawabit and kharitadar	3	1997-2023	Occasional, returned in 2023
Turkish nobility	1	1991	Rare

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (11 PYQs + 4 one-liners). The Sultanate administration questions are almost entirely term questions: what a word means (iqta, khalisa, mahrusa, shiq, zawabit, kharitadar) or which Sultan created a department (Amir-Kohi, Riyasat, Mustakhraj, Khairat). The iqta and khalisa block is the rising area, with three papers between 2019 and 2025, so learn the khalisa versus iqta distinction and the iqta terms precisely. Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi alone has four items. The Term | Meaning | Ruler tables in 7.2, 7.3 and 7.4 are the fastest revision.

Chapter 8

Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture

The Turks brought to India the building methods of the Islamic world: the true arch, the dome, lime mortar, and decoration by calligraphy and geometric patterns in place of human figures. Blended with the skill of Indian masons, this produced the **Indo-Islamic** style. The Sultanate phase runs from the Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque and the Qutb Minar of the 1190s to the octagonal tombs of the Lodis, and regional Sultanates such as Jaunpur, Malwa and the Bahmanis built their own versions. This chapter covers the features of the style and its firsts, the Qutb Minar, builders of the early Delhi monuments, and regional monuments. It contains **4 PYQs and 1 one-liner**.

8.1 Features of Indo-Islamic Architecture and the "Firsts"

U.P. P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. India's first tomb constructed in the Indo-Islamic style was -

- (a) Humayun's Tomb
- (b) Balban's Tomb
- (c) Aybak's Tomb
- (d) Alauddin's Tomb

Ans. (b)

Early Sultanate buildings were raised by Indian masons who knew the **trabeate** (beam and lintel) method. Their "arches" were **corbelled**: courses of stone stepped inward until they met. The **true arch**, built of wedge-shaped voussoirs held by a keystone, appears for the first time in the **tomb of Balban** (c. 1287) at Mehrauli, Delhi. The source therefore calls it the first tomb in the pure Islamic style. The **Alai Darwaza** (1311) then shows the first dome built on true scientific lines.

Feature	What it means	Earlier Indian practice
Arcuate construction	True arch, dome and vault carry the load	Trabeate : beams, lintels, corbelled arches
Lime mortar	Cementing agent that allowed arches and domes	Dry masonry or clamps
Squinch	Corner arch that turns a square room into an octagon to carry a round dome	Not used
Calligraphy	Quranic verses in Kufic and Naskh scripts as decoration	Figural sculpture
Arabesque	Geometric and interlacing floral patterns	Figural and narrative panels
No human or animal figures	Figural images avoided in religious buildings	Rich figural art
Minaret, mihrab, courtyard	Tower for the call to prayer, niche facing Mecca, open prayer court	Temple plan

First	Monument	Date
First mosque in Delhi	Quwwat-ul-Islam (Aibak)	1190s

First	Monument	Date
First monumental Islamic tomb in India (commonly cited)	Sultan Ghari (Iltutmish, for his son Nasiruddin Mahmud)	1231
First true arch	Tomb of Balban , Mehrauli	c. 1287
First true dome on scientific lines	Alai Darwaza (Alauddin Khalji)	1311
First mosque wholly in the Islamic style (source)	Jamaat Khana Masjid, Nizamuddin	Alauddin's reign
First octagonal tomb in Delhi	Tomb of Khan-i-Jahan Telangani	1368 to 1369
Double dome (commonly cited as the earliest in India)	Tomb of Sikandar Lodi	c. 1517 to 1518

TRAP ALERT

Sultan Ghari (1231) and Iltutmish's own tomb (c. 1235) are **older** than Balban's tomb. The key picks Balban because his tomb is the first with a **true arch**, the defining Islamic technique. **Humayun's Tomb** (1560s) is Mughal and is the first garden tomb, a different "first". Keep the three straight: true arch Balban, true dome Alai Darwaza, garden tomb Humayun.

8.2 The Qutb Minar and the Qutb Complex

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2003, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Who among the following did not contribute to the construction of Qutub Minar?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

Ans. (c)

Qutbuddin Aibak began the minar around 1199 and completed only the first storey. **Iltutmish** added three more. Lightning damaged the top in 1368, and **Firuz Shah Tughluq** replaced the fourth storey with two storeys faced partly in white marble, giving the present **five storeys** and a height of about **72.5 m**. **Sikandar Lodi** carried out repairs in the early 16th century. The name is linked to the Sufi saint **Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki**, though some connect it with Aibak himself. **Alauddin Khalji** did not work on the minar. He began a second, much larger tower, the **Alai Minar**, which stopped at the first storey when he died.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. Which Sultan built the fifth story of Qutub Minar?

Ans. Firuz Shah Tughluq

Qutb complex monument	Builder	Point to remember
Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque	Qutbuddin Aibak (1190s), extended by Iltutmish and Alauddin	First mosque in Delhi. Its inscription records the use of material from 27 temples. Corbelled arch screen
Qutb Minar	Aibak, Iltutmish, Firuz Shah	Five storeys, about 72.5 m
Iron pillar	Gupta period (inscription of a king Chandra)	Older than the complex. Rust-resistant iron
Tomb of Iltutmish	Iltutmish (c. 1235)	Richly carved interior, no surviving dome

Qutb complex monument	Builder	Point to remember
Alai Darwaza	Alauddin Khalji (1311)	Southern gateway. True dome and true arches
Alai Minar	Alauddin Khalji	Unfinished, first storey only

The whole group is inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List as "**Qutb Minar and its Monuments, Delhi**" (1993).

TRAP ALERT

"Did not contribute" asks for the odd one out. Firuz Shah is the trap because he came long after the minar was "complete", but his repairs gave the tower its fifth storey. Alauddin's tower is the separate Alai Minar.

8.3 Builders of the Early Sultanate Monuments

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List-I (Building)	List-II (Builders)
A. Sultan Garhi	1. Alauddin Khalji
B. Red Palace	2. Qutbuddin Aibak
C. Jamaat Khana Masjid	3. Iltutmish
D. Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra	4. Balban

Code :

A B C D

(a) 3 4 2 1

(b) 4 3 2 1

(c) 3 4 1 2

(d) 4 3 1 2

Ans. (c)

Sultan Ghari (1231) was built by Iltutmish as the tomb of his eldest son **Nasiruddin Mahmud**. The **Red Palace** (Lal Mahal, Qasr-i-Lal) was Balban's palace in Delhi. The **Jamaat Khana Masjid** at the dargah of Nizamuddin Auliya dates from Alauddin's reign. The source credits its construction to his son **Khizr Khan**, a disciple of the saint, so it is keyed to Alauddin. The **Adhai Din ka Jhonpra** at Ajmer was built by Aibak in the 1190s, and Iltutmish added the arched screen. Once A-3 and D-2 are fixed only (c) remains.

Monument	Builder	Place and feature
Quwwat-ul-Islam	Qutbuddin Aibak	Delhi, Qutb complex
Adhai Din ka Jhonpra	Qutbuddin Aibak (screen by Iltutmish)	Ajmer, Rajasthan
Sultan Ghari	Iltutmish	Delhi. Tomb of his son Nasiruddin Mahmud
Lal Mahal (Red Palace)	Balban	Delhi
Tomb of Balban	Balban	Mehrauli, Delhi. First true arch
Alai Darwaza, Siri, Hauz-i-Alai	Alauddin Khalji	Delhi. Siri is the second city of Delhi
Jamaat Khana Masjid	Alauddin's reign (Khizr Khan per the source)	Nizamuddin, Delhi
Tughluqabad and Ghiyasuddin's tomb	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Delhi. Massive sloping (battered) walls

Monument	Builder	Place and feature
Firozabad (Feroz Shah Kotla)	Firuz Shah Tughluq	Delhi. Topra Ashokan pillar on top
Lodi tombs (Lodi Gardens)	Lodi Sultans and nobles	Delhi. Octagonal and square tombs, double dome

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

This 2022 match mixed well-known and little-known buildings (Red Palace, Jamaat Khana). Other builder pairs from the table, such as Siri, Tughluqabad with its sloping walls, Kotla and the Lodi tombs, fit the same format.

8.4 Monuments of the Regional Sultanates

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2011

Q. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

(a) Ajmer - Quwwat-ul-Islam

(b) Jaunpur - Atala Masjid

(c) Malwa - Jahaz Mahal

(d) Gulbarga - Jama Masjid

Ans. (a)

The **Quwwat-ul-Islam** mosque is in **Delhi**. Aibak's mosque at **Ajmer** is the **Adhai Din ka Jhonpra**, so the setters swapped the two early mosques. The other three pairs are regional Sultanate buildings of the 14th and 15th centuries.

Monument	Builder or dynasty	Place
Atala Masjid	Begun under Firuz Shah, completed 1408 by Ibrahim Shah Sharqi	Jaunpur (UP)
Jama Masjid, Lal Darwaza Masjid	Sharqi Sultans	Jaunpur (UP)
Jahaz Mahal	Malwa Sultans (commonly attributed to Ghiyasuddin Khalji of Malwa)	Mandu, Malwa (Madhya Pradesh)
Jama Masjid	Bahmani Sultans (1367)	Gulbarga (Kalaburagi), Karnataka. Courtyard wholly roofed with domes
Adhai Din ka Jhonpra	Qutbuddin Aibak	Ajmer
Quwwat-ul-Islam	Qutbuddin Aibak	Delhi

UP link: **Jaunpur** (Jaunpur district), capital of the Sharqi Sultans, developed its own style. Its mosques have a huge arched screen (pylon) across the front of the prayer hall in place of minarets. The Atala Masjid is the model for the later Jama Masjid of Jaunpur.

TRAP ALERT

Ajmer and Delhi each have an Aibak mosque. **Ajmer = Adhai Din ka Jhonpra**, **Delhi = Quwwat-ul-Islam**. Swapping them is the whole trick of this question.

Chapter 8: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Qutb Minar builders	2	2002-2013	Recurring (4 papers)
Firsts of Indo-Islamic architecture (Balban's tomb)	1	2004	Occasional
Builders of early Delhi monuments	1	2022	Recent
Regional Sultanate monuments	1	2011	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 5 items (4 PYQs + 1 one-liner). Every item is a Monument | Builder | Place question. The Qutb Minar is the single most repeated monument, asked in four papers through the "who did not contribute" and "fifth storey" forms. The 2022 match shows the setters moving to less familiar buildings (Red Palace, Jamaat Khana), so learn the builder table in 8.3 in full, along with the arch and dome firsts in 8.1.

Chapter 9

Delhi Sultanate: Literature

The Sultanate period (1206 to 1526) produced a large body of Persian court history, Sufi literature, poetry in Persian and early Hindavi, translations of Sanskrit texts into Persian, and new regional literatures. UPPSC tests this area mainly through **authorship**: who wrote which work, for which Sultan, in which language. This chapter covers Amir Khusrau (his birth, patrons, language, poetry and music), Amir Hasan Dehlavi and Sufi malfuzat, Persian translations of Sanskrit works, the Persian chronicles of the Sultanate, the chronology of key texts, histories of the regional kingdoms, and Hindavi and Sanskrit literature of the period. It contains **20 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. Amir Khusrau alone accounts for 10 items.

9.1 Amir Khusrau: Birth at Patiali and the Parrot of India

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2003, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002

Q. Amir Khusrau was born in :

- (a) Agra
- (b) Barabanki
- (c) Etah
- (d) Etawah

Ans. (*)

Note: the source key is (*). At the time of these exams (2002 and 2003) Patiali lay in Etah district, so (c) Etah was the correct answer then. Kasganj district was carved out of Etah on 17 April 2008, and Patiali is now a tehsil of **Kasganj district**. Since none of the options names Kasganj, the question has no correct option today.

Abul Hasan Yaminuddin Khusrau was born at **Patiali** (Patiyali) in 1253 (NCERT gives 1252). His father was a Turkish officer in the service of the Delhi Sultans and his mother was Indian. He died in Delhi in 1325 and lies buried close to his spiritual master **Nizamuddin Auliya**. He called himself **Tuti-i-Hind**, the Parrot of India, for the sweetness of his verse.

UP link: Patiali is in **Kasganj district** (it was in Etah district until 2008). Kasganj district was first named Kanshiram Nagar and reverted to the name Kasganj in 2012.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Amir Khusrau, the "Parrot of India," was born at

Ans. Patiyali

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Who called himself the 'Parrot of India' ?

Ans. Amir Khusrau

TRAP ALERT

The options list four UP districts. **Etah** was right for the 2002 and 2003 papers. Today the answer is **Kasganj**. If a new paper offers Kasganj, choose it. If it offers only Etah, Etah is the intended answer.

9.2 Amir Khusrau at Court: Patrons and the Seven Sultans

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Amir Khusrau was court poet of :

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Sher Shah Suri
- (d) Humayun

Ans. (b)

Khusrau's longest and most productive service was under **Alauddin Khalji**, whose conquests he recorded in the **Khazain-ul-Futuh**. Earlier he served Balban's eldest son, Prince Muhammad (the source calls him Mahmud), at Multan. When the prince was killed fighting the Mongols in 1285, Khusrau was taken prisoner and later escaped. **Sher Shah** and **Humayun** came two centuries later. **Muhammad bin Tughluq** became Sultan in 1325, the year Khusrau died, so he cannot be Khusrau's main patron.

Work of Amir Khusrau	Sultan or patron	Subject
Qiran-us-Sadain	Kaiqubad	Meeting of Kaiqubad with his father Bughra Khan
Miftah-ul-Futuh	Jalaluddin Khalji	Jalaluddin's military campaigns
Khazain-ul-Futuh (Tarikh-i-Alai)	Alauddin Khalji	Alauddin's conquests, in prose
Ashiq (Deval Rani Khizr Khan)	Alauddin Khalji period	Romance of Prince Khizr Khan and Deval Rani
Nuh Sipih	Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah	Praise of India, its people, languages and climate
Tughluq Nama	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq	Rise of Ghiyasuddin Tughluq to the throne
Ijaz-i-Khusravi	Court prose	Prose and letter-writing
Khamsa	Literary	Five masnavis modelled on the Persian poet Nizami Ganjavi

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Who among the following witnessed the reign of Seven Sultans of Delhi ?

- (a) Amir Khusrau
- (b) Sheikh Nizamuddin Auliya
- (c) Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (*)

Note: the source key is (*) because both (a) and (b) fit. Amir Khusrau (1253 to 1325) and Nizamuddin Auliya (died 1325) each lived through the reigns of seven or more Sultans. The phrase is commonly attached to Amir Khusrau, so (a) is the usual intended answer.

The source lists the seven Sultans in Khusrau's lifetime of service as **Balban, Kaiqubad, Jalaluddin Khalji, Alauddin Khalji, Mubarak Shah, Ghiyasuddin Tughluq and Muhammad bin Tughluq**. Short reigns such as Kaimars, Shihabuddin Umar and Khusrau Khan push the true count higher. **Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti** of Ajmer died in 1236, early in the Sultanate, so he fails.

TRAP ALERT

Khusrau served the Mamluks, the Khaljis and the first Tughluqs. He did **not** serve any Sayyid, Lodi or Mughal ruler. Any option naming a 15th or 16th century ruler is out.

9.3 Amir Khusrau: Hindavi, Khari Boli, Indian Themes and Music

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Who among the following is known as the 'Father of Hindi Khari Boli'?

- (a) Amir Khusrau
- (b) Malik Muhammad Jayasi
- (c) Kabir
- (d) Abdur Rahim-Khan-e-Khanan

Ans. (a)

Khusrau wrote mainly in Persian, but riddles (paheliyan), mukriyan and songs in **Hindavi**, the speech of the Delhi region, are traditionally attributed to him. This is why he is called the pioneer or father of **Khari Boli**. He is also regarded as a pioneer of the Indian style of Persian poetry, **Sabk-i-Hindi**. He wrote that Hindi words are no less than Persian ("Na lafz-e Hindi ast az Farsi kam"). **Jayasi** (Padmavat) wrote in Awadhi, **Kabir** in a mixed sadhukkadi idiom, and **Rahim** in Braj and Awadhi.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. The savant of both languages "Hindi and Persian" was
Ans. Amir Khusrau

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2008, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. Amir Khusrau played a pioneering role in the development of
Ans. Khari Boli

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Who among the following was the first Persian poet to depict Indian environment in his poetry?

- (a) Amir Khusrau
- (b) Amir-Hasan
- (c) Abu Talib Kalim
- (d) Faizi

Ans. (a)

In the **Nuh Sipih** Khusrau praises India above other lands, its climate, flowers, birds, learning and languages. This makes him the first Persian poet to place the Indian setting at the centre of his verse. **Abu Talib Kalim** was Shah Jahan's poet laureate and **Faizi** was Akbar's, both much later. **Amir Hasan** was Khusrau's contemporary (9.4) but is not credited with this first.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2009

Q. 'Tabla' was introduced by :

- (a) Adil Shah
- (b) Amir Khusrau
- (c) Tansen
- (d) Baiju Bawara

Ans. (b)

Note: the key (b) follows popular tradition. There is no contemporary evidence that Khusrau invented the tabla or the sitar, and many historians treat these attributions as legend. Keep (b) for the exam.

Tradition credits Khusrau with the **qawwali** and **tarana** forms, early **khayal**, and the **sitar** and **tabla**. The qawwali link rests on his role in the Chishti sama (music assembly) of Nizamuddin Auliya. The instrument attributions are tradition, not documented fact. **Tansen** and **Baiju Bawra** belong to the 16th century, and **Adil Shah** is a Bijapur dynasty name (Ibrahim Adil Shah II wrote the Kitab-i-Nauras on music).

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Khusrau items have come in eight different papers. The untested angles are his patrons by work (the table in 9.2), his burial beside Nizamuddin Auliya, and the Nuh Sipih as the work praising India.

9.4 Amir Hasan Dehlavi and the Sufi Malfuzat

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Who among the following is called the 'Sadi of India'?

- (a) Amir Hasan
- (b) Amir Khusrau
- (c) Abu Talib Kalim
- (d) Chandrabhan Brahman

Ans. (a)

Amir Hasan Sijzi Dehlavi, a friend of Khusrau and a fellow disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, was called the **Sadi of India** for the quality of his ghazals, after the Persian master Sadi of Shiraz. **Chandrabhan Brahman** was a Persian poet and munshi at Shah Jahan's court. Khusrau's own title is Tuti-i-Hind.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2021

Q. The book 'Fawaid-ul-Fawad' is the record of the conversations of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya, it was compiled by :

- (a) Amir Hasan Sijzi
- (b) Amir Khusro
- (c) Ziauddin Barrani
- (d) Hasan Nizami

Ans. (a)

The same **Amir Hasan Sijzi** recorded the table talk of his master in the **Fawaid-ul-Fuad**. Such records of a Sufi master's sayings are called **malfuzat**. They are a key source for the social and religious life of the Sultanate.

Term or work	Meaning or author	Context
Malfuzat	Recorded conversations of a Sufi master	Sufi literature
Maktubat	Collected letters of a Sufi master	Sufi literature
Tazkira	Biographical accounts of saints	Sufi literature
Fawaid-ul-Fuad	Amir Hasan Sijzi	Sayings of Nizamuddin Auliya
Khair-ul-Majalis	Hamid Qalandar	Sayings of Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Dehli
Siyar-ul-Auliya	Amir Khurd	Lives of the Chishti saints

TRAP ALERT

Two Hasans in one paper: **Amir Hasan Sijzi** is the Sufi poet (Sadi of India, Fawaid-ul-Fuad). **Hasan Nizami** is the court historian of Aibak (Taj-ul-Maasir, 9.6).

9.5 Sanskrit into Persian: Tutinama and the Nagarkot Books

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Who among the following had translated Chintamani Bhatt's Sanskrit text 'Shuka Saptati' in Persian and gave it the title 'Tutinama'?

- (a) Abdur Razzak
- (b) Amir Khusro
- (c) Khwaja Ziya-uddin Nakhshabi
- (d) Shihabuddin-al-Umari

Ans. (c)

The **Shukasaptati** (Seventy Tales of a Parrot) was rendered into Persian as the **Tutinama** by **Ziauddin Nakhshabi**, a physician and Sufi of the Tughluq period (the work is commonly dated c. 1330, under Muhammad bin Tughluq). Akbar's famous illustrated Tutinama is based on this version. The distractors are writers of other kinds: **Abdur Razzaq** was the Timurid envoy to Calicut and Vijayanagara, and **Shihabuddin al-Umari** wrote the Arabic Masalik-ul-Absar describing the court of Muhammad bin Tughluq.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Who among the following translated 300 volumes Sanskrit books collected by Firoz Tuglaq during the campaign of Nagarkot?

- (a) Talib Amuli
- (b) Mulla Abdul Baqi
- (c) Mirza Muhammad Ali
- (d) Azizuddin Khan

Ans. (d)

During his campaign against **Nagarkot** (Kangra) Firuz Shah Tughluq collected about 300 Sanskrit books from the Jwalamukhi temple area. **Azizuddin Khalid Khani** translated a part of them into Persian as the **Dalail-i-Firozshahi**, on astronomy and allied sciences. **Talib Amuli** was a poet laureate of Jahangir, which rules him out by period.

Sanskrit original	Persian work	Translator or patron	Period
Shukasaptati	Tutinama	Ziauddin Nakhshabi	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Nagarkot books (astronomy)	Dalail-i-Firozshahi	Azizuddin Khalid Khani, for Firuz Shah	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Mahabharata, Kalhana's Rajatarangini	Persian versions	Zain-ul-Abidin of Kashmir (patron)	15th century
Ayurvedic medical texts	Tibb-i-Sikandari (Madan-ul-Shifa)	Under Sikandar Lodi	Lodi period

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Both translation PYQs are recent (2022, 2023). Zain-ul-Abidin of Kashmir, who had the Mahabharata and Rajatarangini put into Persian, is the natural next name in this set.

9.6 Persian Chronicles of the Sultanate: Who Wrote What

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Futuh-us-Salatin	1. Firoz Shah Tughlaq
B. Futuh-i-Firoz Shahi	2. Abdul Malik Isami
C. Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	3. Amir Khusrau
D. Khazain-ul-Futuh	4. Ziauddin Barani

Code -

- (a) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
- (b) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
- (c) A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- (d) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Ans. (d)

Three near-identical titles carry three different authors. **Futuh-us-Salatin** is a verse history by **Isami**, written at the Bahmani court and dedicated to Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah. It is hostile to Muhammad bin Tughluq. **Futuh-i-Firozshahi** is Firuz Shah's own account. **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi** has two authors, **Barani** and **Shams-i-Siraj Afif**. **Khazain-ul-Futuh** is Khusrau's record of Alauddin's conquests.

U.P. P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2008

Q. The Delhi Sultan who wrote his memoirs, was :

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Balban
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Firuz Tughluq

Ans. (d)

Firuz Shah wrote the **Futuh-i-Firozshahi** to present himself as an ideal Muslim ruler. It lists the taxes he abolished, the practices he stopped and the buildings he repaired. Its welfare measures are covered in Chapter 4.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Ziyauddin Barani	1. Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi
B. Hasan Nizami	2. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri
C. Minhaj-us-Siraj	3. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi
D. Yahya-bin-Ahmad	4. Taj-ul-Maasir
	5. Tabaqat-i-Akbari

Code:

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 3 4 5 1
- (c) 5 3 4 2
- (d) 3 4 2 1

Ans. (d)

U.P.B.E.O. (PRE) 2019

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below the lists.

List-I	List-II
A. Taj-ul-Maasir	1. Ziauddin Barani
B. Khazain-ul-Futuh	2. Hasan Nizami
C. Tarikh-e-Mubarakshahi	3. Amir Khusro
D. Fatawa-i-Jahandari	4. Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi

Code :

A B C D

(a) 2 3 4 1

(b) 2 4 1 3

(c) 2 1 4 3

(d) 1 3 4 2

Ans. (a)

The 1997 and 2019 matches use the same four authors. **Taj-ul-Maasir** by **Hasan Nizami** is the first official history of the Sultanate (Aibak and early Iltutmish). **Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi** by **Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**, written for the Sayyid Sultan Mubarak Shah, is the main contemporary source for the Sayyids. The extra option **Tabaqat-i-Akbari** belongs to Akbar's historian **Nizamuddin Ahmad**. It sits next to **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** only to trap on the word **Tabaqat**.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Tarikh-i-Hind	1. Ibn Battuta
B. Tarikh-i-Delhi	2. Minhaj
C. Rihla	3. Al-Biruni
D. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	4. Khusrau

Code:

A B C D

(a) 1 3 2 4

(b) 2 1 4 3

(c) 3 4 1 2

(d) 4 2 3 1

Ans. (c)

Al-Biruni's Arabic work on India is known as **Kitab-ul-Hind**, **Tahqiq-i-Hind** or **Tarikh-ul-Hind**. The source key pairs **Tarikh-i-Delhi** with Khusrau. This title is not among Khusrau's commonly listed works, so solve the item by elimination: **Rihla** with Ibn Battuta and **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** with Minhaj together leave only code (c).

Work	Author	Language	Patron or period
Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind)	Al-Biruni	Arabic	Mahmud of Ghazni's time (c. 1030)
Taj-ul-Maasir	Hasan Nizami	Persian	Aibak and early Iltutmish
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj	Persian	Dedicated to Nasiruddin Mahmud (c. 1260)

Work	Author	Language	Patron or period
Qiran-us-Sadain, Miftah-ul-Futuh, Khazain-ul-Futuh , Ashiqa, Nuh Sipahr, Tughluq Nama	Amir Khusrau	Persian	Kaiqubad to Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
Tutinama	Ziauddin Nakhshabi	Persian	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Rehla (Rihla)	Ibn Battuta	Arabic	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Masalik-ul-Absar	Shihabuddin al-Umari	Arabic	Muhammad bin Tughluq (described from reports)
Futuh-us-Salatin	Abdul Malik Isami	Persian verse	Bahmani court, Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah
Tarikh-i-Firozshahi and Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani	Persian	Muhammad bin Tughluq and Firuz Shah
Tarikh-i-Firozshahi	Shams-i-Siraj Afif	Persian	Firuz Shah
Futuhat-i-Firozshahi	Firuz Shah Tughluq	Persian	His own reign
Dalail-i-Firozshahi	Azizuddin Khalid Khani	Persian	Firuz Shah
Fawa'id-ul-Fuad	Amir Hasan Sijzi	Persian	Nizamuddin Auliya's sayings
Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi	Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi	Persian	Sayyid Sultan Mubarak Shah
Tabaqat-i-Akbari (distractor)	Nizamuddin Ahmad	Persian	Akbar

TRAP ALERT

Futuh-us-Salatin (Isami) and Futuhat-i-Firozshahi (Firuz) differ by one syllable. **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** is Barani's treatise on statecraft, not a Firuz work. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** is Minhaj, **Tabaqat-i-Akbari** is Nizamuddin Ahmad.

UP link: Barani came from **Baran**, the old name of Bulandshahr (Bulandshahr district).

9.7 Chronology of Key Texts

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Consider the following text and arrange them in chronological order:

1. Fatawa-i-Jahandari
2. Prithviraja-Raso
3. Kitab-ul-Hind
4. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Codes:

- (a) 2, 3, 4, 1
- (b) 3, 1, 2, 4
- (c) 4, 3, 1, 2
- (d) 3, 2, 4, 1

Ans. (d)

Note: the key places the Prithviraj Raso in the late 12th century, following the tradition that Chand Bardai was the court poet of Prithviraj Chauhan. Many scholars date the surviving text of the Raso several centuries later. Keep (d) for the exam.

Order	Text	Author	Commonly dated
1	Kitab-ul-Hind	Al-Biruni	c. 1030 (Ghaznavid period)
2	Prithviraj Raso	Chand Bardai (traditional attribution)	Late 12th century by tradition
3	Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj	c. 1260, reign of Nasiruddin Mahmud
4	Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani	Mid 14th century, reign of Firuz Shah

The fastest route is to anchor each text to a ruler: Mahmud of Ghazni, then Prithviraj Chauhan, then Nasiruddin Mahmud, then Firuz Shah. Only code (d) starts with Kitab-ul-Hind and ends with Fatawa-i-Jahandari.

9.8 Histories of the Regional Kingdoms

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Match list-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists -

List-I (Book)	List-II (Context)
A. Mirat-e-Sikandari	(1) History of Bengal
B. Burhan-e-Maasir	(2) History of Bahmani's Ahmad Nagar
C. Riyaz-us-Salatin	(3) Collection of Mahmud Gawan's letters
D. Riyaz-ul-Insha	(4) Victory of Gujarat

Code -

- (a) A-(4), B-(2), C-(1), D-(3)
- (b) A-(2), B-(4), C-(1), D-(3)
- (c) A-(1), B-(2), C-(4), D-(3)
- (d) A-(4), B-(2), C-(3), D-(1)

Ans. (a)

As the Delhi Sultanate weakened, the regional Sultanates had their own histories written, many of them in the Mughal period or later. Tie each book to its kingdom.

Book	Kingdom	Author	Content
Mirat-i-Sikandari	Gujarat	Sikandar bin Muhammad (Manjhu)	History of the Gujarat Sultans, written in Jahangir's time
Burhan-i-Maasir	Bahmani and Ahmadnagar	Ali bin Aziz Tabataba	Bahmanis and the Nizam Shahis of Ahmadnagar
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Bengal	Ghulam Husain Salim	History of Bengal, late 18th century
Riyaz-ul-Insha	Bahmani	Letters of Mahmud Gawan	Correspondence of the Bahmani wazir

TRAP ALERT

Riyaz-us-Salatin (Bengal history) and **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (Mahmud Gawan's letters) share the first word. Insha means letter-writing, which is the clue.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. Which statements is/are correct regarding the book 'Mirat-e-Sikandari'?

1. There is a description of the happiness and prosperity of the Kingdom of Sultan Mahmud Begada of Gujarat.
2. There is a description of proper arrangement for the security of trade routes.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code -

- (a) Only 2
- (b) Neither 1 nor 2
- (c) Only 1
- (d) Both 1 and 2

Ans. (d)

The Mirat-i-Sikandari praises the reign of **Mahmud Begada** (1458 to 1511), the best known Gujarat Sultan. It describes a prosperous kingdom and records that merchants and travellers benefited from the security of the roads under him. Both statements come from the text itself.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Both 2023 papers asked Mirat-i-Sikandari. A follow-up could pair Mahmud Begada with his conquests of Girnar and Champaner, or ask the kingdom of Burhan-i-Maasir or Riyaz-us-Salatin in a single-answer form.

9.9 Hindavi, Regional and Sanskrit Literature of the Period

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Mulla Daud	1. Chandayan
B. Damodar Kavi	2. Ashiq
C. Somnath	3. Padmavati Katha
D. Amir Khusro	4. Rag Vibodh

Code :

A B C D

(a) 1 3 2 4

(b) 1 3 4 2

(c) 2 4 1 3

(d) 1 2 3 4

Ans. (b)

Mulla Daud (Maulana Daud), a Chishti Sufi, composed the **Chandayan** in 1379 in **Awadhi**, written in the Persian script, during the reign of Firuz Shah Tughluq. It is regarded as the first Hindi Sufi premakhyan (love romance), the genre later carried on by Qutban's Mrigavati (1503, Jaunpur court of Husain Shah Sharqi) and Jayasi's Padmavat (1540). **Damodar Kavi** wrote the **Lakhansen Padmavati Katha** in the 15th century. **Somanatha's Rag Vibodh** is a Sanskrit treatise on music of the early 17th century. **Ashiq** is Khusrau's romance of Khizr Khan and Deval Rani (9.2).

UP link: the Chandayan was composed at **Dalmau** (Rae Bareilly district), where Mulla Daud was attached to the local court.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Who among the following medieval scholars/writers belonged to the Jain religion?

- (a) Maladhar Vasu
- (b) Hemachandra Suri
- (c) Parthasarathi
- (d) Sayan

Ans. (b)

Hemachandra Suri was a Jain monk-scholar at the court of the Chaulukya (Solanki) kings of Gujarat, **Jayasimha Siddharaja** and **Kumarapala**. He wrote the Sanskrit and Prakrit grammar Siddha-Hemashabdanushasana and the Trishashti-shalaka-purusha-charita. He lived before the Sultanate, so "medieval" here is used in the broad sense. The other three were Brahmanical scholars.

Writer	Work or field	Language	Court or context
Hemachandra Suri (Jain)	Grammar, Jain lives, lexicons	Sanskrit, Prakrit	Chaulukyas of Gujarat
Maladhar Basu	Sri Krishna Vijaya (Bhagavata retold)	Bengali	Bengal Sultans, title Gunaraj Khan
Sayana	Commentaries on the Vedas	Sanskrit	Vijayanagara (Bukka I, Harihara II)
Parthasarathi Mishra	Mimamsa philosophy	Sanskrit	Kumarila school of Mimamsa
Mulla Daud	Chandayan (1379)	Awadhi	Dalmau, Firuz Shah's reign

Writer	Work or field	Language	Court or context
Damodar Kavi	Lakhansen Padmavati Katha	Hindi (Rajasthani)	15th century
Somanatha	Rag Vibodh	Sanskrit	Music treatise, early 17th century

TRAP ALERT

A Bengal Sultan patronising a Bengali retelling of the Bhagavata (Maladhar Basu) surprises students. Regional languages grew under the regional Sultans, not only under Hindu kings.

Chapter 9: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Persian chronicles: authorship matching	5	1997-2023	Recurring (4 match questions)
Amir Khusrau: Hindavi, Khari Boli, Indian themes, music	5	1990-2017	Recurring
Amir Khusrau: birth at Patiali, Parrot of India	3	2002-2013	Recurring
Amir Khusrau: patrons and seven Sultans	2	1995-2005	Occasional
Amir Hasan Dehlavi and Sufi malfuzat	2	2013-2021	Occasional
Sanskrit into Persian translations	2	2022-2023	Emerging
Regional kingdom histories (Mirat-i-Sikandari etc.)	2	2023	Emerging (2 papers in 2023)
Hindavi, regional and Sanskrit writers	2	2009-2019	Occasional
Chronology of key texts	1	2020	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 24 items (20 PYQs + 4 one-liners). Amir Khusrau alone gives 10 items, mostly before 2018, on his birthplace, title, patrons, Khari Boli and music. Since 2019 the pattern has shifted to authorship matches and less familiar texts: Persian translations (Tutinama, Dalail-i-Firozshahi), regional histories (Mirat-i-Sikandari, Burhan-i-Maasir, Riyaz-us-Salatin) and a text chronology. The master table in 9.6 is the fastest revision tool. Four items carry Notes: the birthplace question (Etah then, Kasganj now), the seven Sultans question keyed (*), and the tabla and Prithviraj Raso attributions, which rest on tradition.

Chapter 10

Delhi Sultanate: Miscellaneous

This chapter collects the Sultanate questions that do not sit under a single dynasty. Some test the court and society of the Turks (polo, the ulema, the court of Khusrau Shah) and the crops of the period. Others are cross-period items that begin in the Sultanate and run into the Mughal age: ruler-to-measure matches, foreign travellers, chronological order of rulers and events, and battle dates from Kalinga to Plassey. It contains **12 PYQs** and no one-liners. Seven of the twelve are Match or order questions, so the chronology and battle tables in 10.5 and 10.6 carry most of the weight.

10.1 The Turkish Court and Society

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2001

Q. The game of Polo was introduced in India by -

- (a) Unani
- (b) Britishers
- (c) Turks
- (d) Mughals

Ans. (c)

The Turks brought **chaugan** (polo on horseback) to north India. **Qutbuddin Aibak** was a keen player and died in 1210 at **Lahore** after a fall from his horse during a game. The Mughals also played chaugan, but they came three centuries later. The British organised the modern game after meeting it in Manipur in the 19th century, which is why "Britishers" tempts.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. Who were called 'Dastar-Bandan'?

- (a) Sufi Saint
- (b) Khan
- (c) Malik
- (d) Ulema

Ans. (d)

Dastar-bandan means "turban-wearers". The **ulema**, the scholars who held religious and judicial posts (qazi, mufti, sadr), wore a prescribed turban and were known by this name. **Khan** and **malik** are ranks of nobles, and Sufi saints were a separate group who often kept away from the court.

Group	Who they were
Ahl-i-Saif (men of the sword)	Military nobles: khan, malik, amir
Ahl-i-Qalam (men of the pen)	Administrators and scholars
Dastar-bandan	The ulema: qazis, muftis and other religious officers
Sufis	Mystics of the Chishti, Suhrawardi and other orders
Khuts, muqaddams, chaudharis	Rural headmen and intermediaries
Bandagan	Slaves of the Sultan and nobles

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. During the reign of which of the following Sultan of Delhi, Hindu gods and goddesses were worshipped in royal palaces?

- (a) Qutb-ud-din Mubarak Khalji
- (b) Nasiruddin Mahmud
- (c) Nasiruddin Khusro Shah
- (d) Alauddin Masud Shah

Ans. (c)

Khusrau Khan, a convert from the Baradu (Parwari) community of Gujarat, rose to high office under Qutbuddin Mubarak Khalji. In 1320 he had Mubarak killed and took the throne as **Nasiruddin Khusrau Shah**. Barani, a hostile chronicler, records that idol worship took place in the palace during his short reign. Ghazi Malik overthrew him within a few months and founded the Tughluq dynasty (Chapter 4).

TRAP ALERT

Two Sultans named **Nasiruddin** appear in the options. Nasiruddin Mahmud (1246 to 1266) was the pious Ilbari Sultan who copied the Quran. Nasiruddin **Khusrau Shah** (1320) is the answer.

10.2 Crops and Technology in the 13th and 14th Centuries

U.P. P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2008, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2011

Q. During the 13th and 14th Centuries AD the Indian peasants did not cultivate :

- (a) Wheat
- (b) Barley
- (c) Gram
- (d) Maize

Ans. (d)

Maize is an American crop. It reached India only after the Portuguese opened the sea route in the 16th century, along with other New World crops such as tobacco, potato, chillies and pineapple. In the Sultanate period peasants grew wheat, barley, rice, gram, pulses, cotton, sugarcane and oilseeds.

Most modern histories place the wider spread of several crafts in north India in the Sultanate period: the **spinning wheel** (charkha), the carder's bow, **paper** for official and literary use, and the geared **Persian wheel** (saqiya) for lifting water from wells.

TRAP ALERT

Any New World crop (maize, tobacco, potato, chillies, tomato) is wrong for a pre-1500 Indian question. That single rule answers this item.

10.3 Rulers and Their Measures: Cross-Period Matches

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Match List- I with List- II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Firuz Tughluq	1. Diwan-i-Riyasat
B. Balban	2. Nauroz
C. Alauddin	3. Construction of Canals
D. Jahangir	4. Sir Thomas Roe

Code:

A B C D

(a) 1 2 3 4

(b) 3 2 1 4

(c) 4 1 2 3

(d) 4 3 2 1

Ans. (b)

Firuz Shah built the largest canal network of the Sultanate (Chapter 4). **Balban** brought the Persian new-year festival **Nauroz** into the Delhi court, along with *sijda* and *paibos*, to raise the dignity of the throne. **Alauddin** set up the **Diwan-i-Riyasat** to enforce his market rules (Chapter 7). **Sir Thomas Roe** was the English ambassador of James I at Jahangir's court (1615 to 1619). D-4 and C-1 alone fix option (b).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Match List- I with List- II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List- I	List- II
A. Akbar	1. Sarak-e-Azam
B. Muhammad Tughluq	2. Chahalgani nobles
C. Iltutmish	3. Ain-i-Dahsala
D. Sher Shah	4. Token currency

Code:

A B C D

(a) 1 2 3 4

(b) 3 4 2 1

(c) 2 3 1 4

(d) 4 1 3 2

Ans. (b)

Akbar's Ain-i-Dahsala (1580) fixed revenue on the average produce and prices of the previous ten years. **Muhammad bin Tughluq** issued the **token currency**. **Iltutmish** formed the **Turkan-i-Chahalgani**. **Sher Shah** rebuilt the great road from Sonargaon in Bengal to the north-west, the **Sarak-e-Azam**, later known as the Grand Trunk Road. The source describes it as running from Lahore to Sonargaon.

Ruler	Measure	Chapter
Iltutmish	Chahalgani, iqta, tanka and jital	2, 7
Balban	Nauroz, sijda and paibos, Diwan-i-Arz	2, 7
Alauddin Khalji	Diwan-i-Riyasat, Diwan-i-Mustakhraj, market control	3, 7
Muhammad bin Tughluq	Token currency, Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi, Daulatabad	4, 7

Ruler	Measure	Chapter
Firuz Shah Tughluq	Canals, haq-i-sharb, Diwan-i-Khairat	4, 7
Sher Shah	Sarak-e-Azam, rupiya	Mughal volume
Akbar	Ain-i-Dahsala, mansab	Mughal volume
Jahangir	Sir Thomas Roe's embassy	Mughal volume

TRAP ALERT

Both matches were set in the same 1997 paper and both keys are (b). Do not carry that as a rule. Solve from the one or two pairs you are sure of.

10.4 Foreign Travellers: Origin and Order of Arrival

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched? (Traveller) (Country)

(a) Ibn Battuta Morocco

(b) Marco Polo Italy

(c) Abdur Razzaq Turkey

(d) Nuniz Portugal

Ans. (c)

Abdur Razzaq was a Persian envoy sent by the Timurid ruler **Shah Rukh** of Herat. He visited Calicut and then **Vijayanagara** under **Devaraya II** in 1443. He was not from Turkey. The other three pairs are correct.

Traveller	Origin	Ruler visited or served	Period
Al-Biruni	Khwarizm (Central Asia)	Came with Mahmud of Ghazni	11th century
Marco Polo	Venice (Italy)	Pandya kingdom (source: Maravarman Kulasekhara)	Late 13th century
Ibn Battuta	Tangier (Morocco)	Muhammad bin Tughluq. Work: Rehla	1333 onwards
Nicolo Conti	Italy	Vijayanagara, Devaraya I	c. 1420
Abdur Razzaq	Persia (envoy of Shah Rukh)	Vijayanagara, Devaraya II	1443
Domingo Paes	Portugal	Vijayanagara, Krishnadeva Raya	c. 1520
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal (horse trader)	Vijayanagara, Achyuta Deva Raya	1530s
Tavernier	France (jeweller)	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb. Six visits	1640s to 1660s
Manucci	Venice (Italy)	Dara Shikoh's artillery, later a physician. Storia do Mogor	From 1656

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1997 U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. What is the sequence of arrival of these travellers ?

1. Ibn Battuta
2. Tavernier
3. Al-Biruni
4. Manucci

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
(b) 3, 1, 2, 4
(c) 2, 3, 4, 1
(d) 4, 1, 2, 3

Ans. (b)

Al-Biruni (11th century) comes first and Ibn Battuta (14th century) second, which already leaves only (b). The close pair is Tavernier and Manucci, both in the Mughal age. **Tavernier** began his Indian journeys around 1640, while **Manucci** reached India only in 1656, so Tavernier comes first.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Travellers have come in both "origin" and "order" forms. Vijayanagara visitors (Conti, Abdur Razzaq, Paes, Nuniz) and the Mughal-age visitors (Hawkins, Roe, Bernier, Tavernier, Manucci) are the likely sets for a future order question.

10.5 Chronological Order of Rulers and Events

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. The following persons ruled in India at different periods of time. Select the correct chronological order of their rule from the coding scheme given at the end :

1. Sher Shah
2. Akbar
3. Alauddin Khalji
4. Raziya Sultan

Code :

- (a) 4, 1, 3, 2,
(b) 1, 2, 3, 4
(c) 4, 3, 1, 2
(d) 3, 4, 1, 2

Ans. (c)

Ruler	Reign
Raziya Sultan	1236 to 1240
Alauddin Khalji	1296 to 1316
Sher Shah	1540 to 1545
Akbar	1556 to 1605

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Consider the following events and arrange these in chronological order:

1. Transfer of capital by Mohd. Tughluq
2. Afghanpur conspiracy
3. Murder of Jalal-ud-Din Khalji
4. Second Battle of Tarain

Select correct answer from the codes given below :

- (a) 4, 3, 2, 1
(b) 3, 1, 2, 4
(c) 1, 2, 3, 4
(d) 1, 2, 4, 3

Ans. (a)

Event	Year	Note
Second Battle of Tarain	1192	Ghuri defeats Prithviraj Chauhan
Murder of Jalaluddin Khalji	1296	Killed at Kara by his nephew Alauddin
Afghanpur pavilion collapse	1325	Death of Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
Transfer of capital to Daulatabad	Commonly dated 1327	Muhammad bin Tughluq

The "Afghanpur conspiracy" refers to the wooden pavilion built by Ulugh Khan (the future Muhammad bin Tughluq) that fell on Ghiyasuddin in 1325. Ibn Battuta says it was planned. Barani treats it as an accident. The question only needs the year, and it must come before the transfer of capital because Muhammad bin Tughluq had to be Sultan first.

TRAP ALERT

In a four-event order question, look for a cause-and-effect pair. Afghanpur (1325) made Muhammad bin Tughluq Sultan, so it must precede his transfer of capital. That alone removes (b), (c) and (d).

10.6 Battles and Their Dates

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Match the List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer from codes given below :

List-I (Battle)	List-II (Year)
A. Battle of Chandawar	1. 1398
B. Attack of Timur	2. 1194
C. Battle of Talikota	3. 1529
D. Battle of Ghaghra	4. 1565

Code :

- A B C D
(a) 1 2 3 4
(b) 2 3 4 1
(c) 1 4 3 2
(d) 2 1 4 3

Ans. (d)

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002, 2003

Q. Match List-I with List -II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below :

List-I	List -II
A. Battle of Plassey	1. 261 BC
B. Battle of Kalinga	2. 1576 AD
C. Battle of Haldighati	3. 1192 AD
D. Battle of Tarain	4. 1757 AD

Code:

- A B C D
(a) 1 2 3 4
(b) 2 1 3 4
(c) 4 1 2 3
(d) 3 4 1 2

Ans. (c)

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Kalinga	c. 261 BCE	Ashoka vs Kalinga	Rock Edict XIII records the suffering. Ashoka turned to dhamma
Tarain II	1192	Muhammad Ghori vs Prithviraj Chauhan	Turkish rule in north India
Chandawar	1194	Muhammad Ghori vs Jayachandra (Gahadavala)	Kannauj and Varanasi opened to the Turks
Timur's invasion	1398	Timur vs Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughluq	Sack of Delhi. Sayyids followed
Ghaghra	1529	Babur vs Mahmud Lodi and Nusrat Shah of Bengal	Babur's last major battle
Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi)	1565	Deccan Sultanates vs Vijayanagara (Rama Raya)	Fall of Vijayanagara
Haldighati	1576	Mughal army under Man Singh vs Maharana Pratap	Mughal victory. Pratap kept up resistance
Plassey	1757	East India Company (Clive) vs Siraj-ud-Daulah	Company power in Bengal

UP link: **Chandawar** lies on the Yamuna in present **Firozabad district**. Timur attacked **Meerut** (Meerut district) on his return march in January 1399.

TRAP ALERT

In the second match "Battle of Tarain" without a number is keyed to **1192**, the second battle. The first battle, won by Prithviraj, was in **1191**. If both years ever appear, read the numeral.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Battle-year matches have come in 2002, 2003 and 2017, mixing periods from Kalinga to Plassey. Khanwa 1527, Chanderi 1528, Chausa 1539, Kannauj 1540 and Panipat 1526, 1556 and 1761 are the untested dates in this format.

Chapter 10: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Turkish court and society (polo, dastar-bandan, Khusrau Shah)	3	2001-2021	Steady
Rulers and their measures (matches)	2	1997	Occasional (one paper)
Foreign travellers	2	1997-2017	Recurring
Chronology of rulers and events	2	2010-2017	Steady
Battles and dates	2	2002-2017	Recurring
Crops of the 13th and 14th centuries	1	2008-2011	Occasional (2 papers)

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 12 PYQs and no one-liners. Seven of the twelve are Match-the-Following or order questions, and most of them cross periods, from Kalinga (c. 261 BCE) to Plassey (1757). This chapter rewards a single master timeline of rulers, events and battles more than any Sultanate detail. Anchor years such as 1192, 1194, 1296, 1325, 1398, 1529, 1565, 1576 and 1757 unlock most items by elimination. The society items (polo, dastar-bandan, Khusrau Shah) are one-fact questions best learnt from the tables in 10.1.

Chapter 11

Provincial Dynasties of North India and the Deccan

As the Delhi Sultanate weakened after Muhammad bin Tughluq and Timur's invasion (1398), provincial governors and local chiefs founded independent kingdoms: the Bahmanis in the Deccan (1347), the Sharqis at Jaunpur (1394), and sultanates in Kashmir, Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa and Khandesh, while the Sisodias of Mewar rose in Rajasthan. The Bahmani kingdom later split into five Deccan sultanates. This chapter also covers the southern dynasties the Khaljis met (Yadava, Kakatiya, Hoysala, Pandya), Bengal and Jaunpur monuments, and South Indian official titles. It contains **20 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. Jaunpur alone gives 6 items, which makes it the chapter's UP core.

11.1 Kashmir: Zain-ul-Abidin, the "Budshah"

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Which among the following ruler of Kashmir abolished Jizya and Cow Slaughter?

- (a) Sikandar Shah
- (b) Shamsuddin Shah
- (c) Haider Shah
- (d) Zain-ul-Abidin

Ans. (d)

The Shah Mir dynasty of Kashmir was founded by **Shamsuddin Shah** (Shah Mir) in 1339. **Sikandar Shah** (c. 1389 to 1413), called But-shikan, imposed jizya and destroyed temples. **Zain-ul-Abidin** (1420 to 1470), whose earlier name was **Shahi Khan**, reversed this policy. He abolished jizya, banned cow slaughter and invited back Brahmins who had left the valley. Kashmiris remember him as **Budshah** (the Great King), and he is often compared to Akbar. He had the Mahabharata and Kalhana's Rajatarangini translated into Persian. **Jonaraja** continued the Rajatarangini at his court, and Srivara took it further. **Haider Shah** was his son and successor.

UPPSC (EXAM TAG NOT GIVEN IN SOURCE)

Q. What was the real name of the Kashmir ruler Zain-ul-Abidin?

Ans. Shahi Khan

TRAP ALERT

Sikandar Shah of Kashmir (But-shikan) **imposed** jizya. Zain-ul-Abidin **abolished** it. Do not confuse him with Sikandar Shah of Bengal, builder of the Adina Masjid (115).

11.2 Jaunpur and the Sharqi Dynasty: the "Shiraz of India"

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2003, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002, U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004

Q. The city of Jaunpur was founded in the memory of :

- (a) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
- (b) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq
- (c) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (b)

Firuz Shah Tughluq founded Jaunpur on the **Gomti** and named it after his cousin Muhammad bin Tughluq, whose earlier name was **Jauna Khan**. In 1394 **Malik Sarwar**, a Tughluq noble, received the title **Malik-us-Sharq** (Lord of the East) and the governorship of the eastern provinces from Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughluq. He soon ruled independently, and his line took the name **Sharqi** from his title. He also bore the title Khwaja-i-Jahan.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2006

Q. Who had established Jaunpur?

Ans. Firuz Shah Tughluq

TRAP ALERT

Two different questions, two different answers. Jaunpur was **founded by** Firuz Shah Tughluq, **in memory of** Muhammad bin Tughluq. The **Sharqi** kingdom at Jaunpur was founded by Malik Sarwar in 1394.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004, U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2001, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Which one of the following places was called "Shiraz of India" ?

- (a) Agra
- (b) Allahabad
- (c) Jaunpur
- (d) Lucknow

Ans. (c)

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. Given below are two statements, in which one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): Jaunpur is known as Siraj-e-Hind.

Reason (R): Jaunpur was a great centre of education during the Sharqi period.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code -

- (a) (A) is false but (R) is true.
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
- (d) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not correct explanation of (A).

Ans. (b)

Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (1402 to 1440) was the greatest Sharqi ruler. He patronised scholars who came from Delhi after Timur's sack, and Jaunpur became a centre of Islamic learning. Hence the title **Shiraz-i-Hind** (Shiraz of India), after the Persian city famous for poets and scholars. The **Sharqi style** of architecture used huge propylon-like gateways (pylons) on the prayer hall in place of tall minarets, and shows Hindu craft traditions in its pillars and brackets. The 2023 assertion-reason question tests the same fact from the causal side: learning is why Jaunpur earned the title.

UP link: all Sharqi monuments are in **Jaunpur** (Jaunpur district). The **Atala Masjid**, begun under Firuz Shah, was completed by Ibrahim Shah in 1408. The **Lal Darwaza Masjid** dates from the reign of Mahmud Shah Sharqi, and the **Jama Masjid** was completed under Husain Shah. The Jhanjhri Masjid is also Ibrahim's. The bridge over the Gomti at Jaunpur is Mughal (Akbar's reign), not Sharqi.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2017

Q. Who was the last ruler of 'Jaunpur' state?

- (a) Mohammad Shah
(b) Hussain Shah
(c) Mubarak Shah
(d) Ibrahim Shah

Ans. (b)

Sharqi ruler	Reign	Exam fact
Malik Sarwar (Khwaja-i-Jahan, Malik-us-Sharq)	1394 to 1399	Founder
Mubarak Shah	1399 to 1402	First to take royal title and issue coins in his own name
Ibrahim Shah	1402 to 1440	Shiraz-i-Hind. Completed the Atala Masjid (1408)
Mahmud Shah	1440 to 1457	Lal Darwaza Masjid period
Muhammad Shah	1457 to 1458	Short reign
Husain Shah	1458 to 1479	Last ruler. Defeated by Bahlul Lodi . Jama Masjid completed

The Sharqis ruled for about 85 years. Their long wars with the Lodis ended when **Bahlul Lodi** took Jaunpur in **1479** (the date given in the source) and placed his son Barbak Shah there. Husain Shah fled east and died in exile.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2021

Q. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

(Ruler) (State)

- (a) Rana Hamir - Mewar
(b) Rana Chunda - Marwar
(c) Malik Raja Farooqi - Khandesh
(d) Malik Sarwar Khwaja Jahan - Malwa

Ans. (d)

Malik Sarwar (Khwaja-i-Jahan) founded the Sharqi kingdom of **Jaunpur**, not Malwa. The other three pairs are correct. **Rana Hammir** recovered Chittor for the Sisodia branch in the 14th century. **Rao Chunda** of the Rathores took Mandore and built up Marwar. **Malik Raja Faruqi** founded the Faruqi kingdom of Khandesh (later capital Burhanpur). The table below pairs each provincial kingdom with its founder and capital.

Kingdom	Capital	Founder	Notable ruler	Monument
Jaunpur (Sharqi)	Jaunpur (UP)	Malik Sarwar, 1394	Ibrahim Shah	Atala Masjid
Kashmir (Shah Mir)	Srinagar	Shamsuddin Shah, 1339	Zain-ul-Abidin	Zaina Kadal (bridge)
Bengal (Ilyas Shahi, Husain Shahi)	Pandua, Gaur	Ilyas Shah (1340s)	Sikandar Shah, Alauddin Husain Shah	Adina Masjid, Chhota Sona Masjid
Gujarat	Anhilwara, then Ahmedabad	Zafar Khan as Muzaffar Shah, 1407	Ahmad Shah I, Mahmud Begada	Teen Darwaza, Jama Masjid (Ahmedabad)
Malwa	Dhar, then Mandu	Dilawar Khan Ghuri	Hoshang Shah, Mahmud Khalji, Baz Bahadur	Hoshang Shah's tomb, Jahaz Mahal

Kingdom	Capital	Founder	Notable ruler	Monument
Khandesh (Faruqi)	Thalner, then Burhanpur	Malik Raja Faruqi, 1382	Nasir Khan (founded Burhanpur)	Asirgarh fort
Mewar (Sisodia)	Chittor	Rana Hammir (14th century)	Rana Kumbha, Rana Sanga	Vijay Stambh, Kumbhalgarh
Marwar (Rathore)	Mandore, then Jodhpur	Rao Chunda	Rao Jodha	Mehrangarh

TRAP ALERT

Malwa, not Jaunpur, is the home of **Baz Bahadur** and Rupmati (Mandu). Baz Bahadur lost Malwa to Akbar's general Adham Khan in 1561.

11.3 Mewar: Rana Kumbha, the Victory Tower and Music

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008, 2011, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2010

Q. 'Kirti Stambha' of Chittor was constructed during the rule of -

- (a) Rana Kumbha
(b) Rana Hammir
(c) Rana Ratan Singh
(d) Rana Sangram Singh

Ans. (a)

Note: the tower Rana Kumbha built to celebrate his victory over Mahmud Khalji of Malwa is properly the Vijay Stambh (Tower of Victory). Some books call it the Kirti Stambha, and the source key follows that usage. Chittor also has a separate, older Jain Kirti Stambh (Tower of Fame) of the 12th century, built by a Jain merchant. For this question keep (a).

Rana Kumbha (1433 to 1468) was the greatest Sisodia ruler before Rana Sanga. He defeated **Mahmud Khalji** of Malwa and raised the nine-storey **Vijay Stambh** at Chittor to mark the victory. He built **Kumbhalgarh** and many other forts. **Rana Hammir** (14th century) restored Sisodia rule at Chittor. **Rana Ratan Singh** lost Chittor to Alauddin Khalji in 1303 (Chapter 3). **Rana Sangram Singh** (Rana Sanga) fought Babur at Khanwa in 1527.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Who among the following Rajput rulers is known to have written a book on music ?

- (a) Jayachandra Gahadavala
(b) Prithviraj Chauhan
(c) Rana Kumbha
(d) Man Singh

Ans. (c)

Kumbha was a scholar and musician. Works on music credited to him include **Sangitaraja** and Sangita Mimamsa, and he wrote **Rasikapriya**, a commentary on Jayadeva's Gita Govinda.

TRAP ALERT

Man Singh here usually means Akbar's general, Raja Man Singh of Amber, who wrote no music treatise. But **Raja Man Singh Tomar** of Gwalior (1486 to 1516) is linked with the music text **Man Kutuhāl**, compiled under his patronage. If an option names Man Singh Tomar, read it carefully. The keyed answer here is Rana Kumbha.

11.4 The Bahmani Kingdom and the Five Deccan Sultanates

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. The Bahmani Kingdom was founded in the year

- (a) 1336
- (b) 1338
- (c) 1347
- (d) 1361

Ans. (c)

The Bahmani kingdom arose from the revolt of the **amiran-i-sadah** (centurion nobles) of the Deccan against Muhammad bin Tughluq. In **1347 Zafar Khan**, better known as **Hasan Gangu**, took the title **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah**. He made **Gulbarga** his capital and renamed it Ahsanabad. **1336** is the Vijayanagara year, the obvious trap.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Who was founder of the Bahmani Kingdom in Deccan

Ans. Hasan Gangu

Bahmani ruler or figure	Period	Exam fact
Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu)	1347 to 1358	Founder. Capital Gulbarga (Ahsanabad)
Firoz Shah Bahmani	1397 to 1422	Scholar king. Built Firozabad on the Bhima. Wars with Vijayanagara
Ahmad Shah I (Wali)	1422 to 1436	Moved the capital to Bidar
Mahmud Gawan	Wazir, executed 1481	Persian minister of Muhammad Shah III. Madrasa at Bidar . Land survey and provincial reforms
Afanasy Nikitin	1469 to 1472	Russian traveller in the Bahmani kingdom

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. Match List- I with List- II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below :

List- I	List- II
A. Adil Shahi	1. Ahmednagar
B. Qutb Shahi	2. Bijapur
C. Nizam Shahi	3. Golconda
D. Sharqi Shahi	4. Jaunpur

Code:

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 2 3 4 1
- (c) 3 4 1 2
- (d) 2 3 1 4

Ans. (d)

After Mahmud Gawan's death the provincial governors broke away, and by 1528 the Bahmani kingdom had split into five sultanates. The Mughals absorbed them in the 17th century.

Sultanate	Dynasty	Founder	Notable ruler	Monument	End
Bijapur	Adil Shahi	Yusuf Adil Shah (1489 to 1490)	Ibrahim Adil Shah II	Gol Gumbaz , Ibrahim Rauza	Aurangzeb, 1686
Golconda	Qutb Shahi	Sultan Quli Qutb Shah (1518)	Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah	Charminar (Hyderabad, 1591)	Aurangzeb, 1687
Ahmadnagar	Nizam Shahi	Malik Ahmad (Ahmad Nizam Shah), 1490	Chand Bibi (regent)	Ahmadnagar fort	Shah Jahan, 1633
Berar	Imad Shahi	Fathullah Imad-ul-Mulk (1490)		Gawilgarh	Taken by Ahmadnagar, 1574
Bidar	Barid Shahi	Qasim Barid, Amir Barid (1528)		Barid Shahi tombs	Taken by Bijapur, 1619

TRAP ALERT

Adil Shahi = Bijapur, Qutb Shahi = Golconda, Nizam Shahi = Ahmadnagar. The two small sultanates, Berar and Bidar, are the ones that match questions leave out. At Talikota (1565) four of the five fought together. Only Berar stayed away (Chapter 6).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Who among the following was the author of the book 'Kitab-i-Nauras'?

- (a) Ibrahim Adil Shah II
- (b) Ali Adil Shah
- (c) Quli Qutb Shah
- (d) Akbar II

Ans. (a)

Ibrahim Adil Shah II of Bijapur (1580 to 1627) wrote **Kitab-i-Nauras**, a set of songs in the **Dakhani** language set to Indian ragas, with hymns to Saraswati and Ganesha. His tolerance earned him the title **Jagadguru**. Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah of Golconda is the other poet-king of the Deccan, known for Dakhani Urdu verse.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2004

Q. Name the pair which is not correctly matched:

- (a) Baz Bahadur - Malwa
- (b) Qutb Shah - Golconda
- (c) Sultan Muzaffar Shah - Gujarat
- (d) Yusuf Adil Shah - Ahmadnagar

Ans. (d)

Yusuf Adil Shah founded the Adil Shahi dynasty of **Bijapur**. Ahmadnagar belonged to the Nizam Shahis. **Muzaffar Shah** (Zafar Khan) founded the Gujarat sultanate in 1407, and his grandson **Ahmad Shah I** founded Ahmedabad. **Baz Bahadur** was the last independent sultan of Malwa.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Deccan sultanates have been asked through dynasty-to-capital pairs twice (2002, 2004). The founders (Yusuf Adil Shah, Quli Qutb Shah, Malik Ahmad) and signature monuments (Gol Gumbaz, Charminar) are the next logical pairs.

11.5 Provincial Architecture: Bengal, Jaunpur and Gujarat

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- (a) Adina Masjid - Mandu
- (b) Lal Darwaza Masjid - Jaunpur
- (c) Dakhil Darwaza - Gaur
- (d) Tin Darwaza - Ahmedabad

Ans. (a)

The **Adina Masjid** is at **Pandua** (Malda district, West Bengal). It was built by **Sikandar Shah** of the Ilyas Shahi dynasty of Bengal in the second half of the 14th century and was among the largest mosques in the subcontinent. **Mandu** is the Malwa capital (Hoshang Shah's tomb, Jahaz Mahal, Rupmati's pavilion). The **Dakhil Darwaza** is the main gateway of the citadel at **Gaur**, the later Bengal capital. The **Teen Darwaza** at Ahmedabad was built by Ahmad Shah I of Gujarat.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists :

List-I (Monument)	List-II (Builder)
A. Atala Devi Masjid	1. Nusrat Shah
B. Chhota Sona Masjid	2. Ibrahim Shah Sharqi
C. Qadam Rasul	3. Sikandar Shah
D. Adina Masjid, Pandua	4. Wali Muhammad

Code :

- A B C D
- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 2 4 1 3
- (c) 2 1 3 4
- (d) 1 3 4 2

Ans. (b)

Monument	Builder	Place
Atala Masjid	Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (completed 1408)	Jaunpur, UP
Lal Darwaza Masjid, Jama Masjid	Sharqi period (Mahmud Shah, Husain Shah)	Jaunpur, UP
Adina Masjid	Sikandar Shah (Ilyas Shahi)	Pandua, West Bengal
Chhota Sona Masjid	Wali Muhammad, in the reign of Alauddin Husain Shah	Gaur (now in Bangladesh)
Qadam Rasul	Nusrat Shah (son of Alauddin Husain Shah)	Gaur, West Bengal
Dakhil Darwaza	Bengal sultans (15th century)	Gaur, West Bengal
Teen Darwaza	Ahmad Shah I	Ahmedabad, Gujarat
Jahaz Mahal, Hoshang Shah's tomb	Malwa sultans	Mandu, Madhya Pradesh
Vijay Stambh	Rana Kumbha	Chittor, Rajasthan
Gol Gumbaz	Muhammad Adil Shah	Bijapur (Vijayapura), Karnataka
Charminar	Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah	Hyderabad, Telangana

UP link: the Atala Masjid is in **Jaunpur** (Jaunpur district). Both questions put a Jaunpur monument next to Bengal ones. The Atala is often called "Atala Devi Masjid" because it stands on the site of an earlier Atala Devi temple, as the name in the 2021 question reflects.

TRAP ALERT

Two Sikandar Shahs. **Sikandar Shah of Bengal** built the Adina Masjid. **Sikandar Shah of Kashmir** was But-shikan (11.1). The Chhota Sona Masjid was built by **Wali Muhammad**, an official, not by a Sultan.

11.6 Southern Kingdoms on the Eve of the Khalji Invasions

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003, U.P. LOWER SUB (PRE) 2008

Q. Which one of the following is correctly matched ?

- (a) Kakatiya : Devagiri
- (b) Hoysala : Dwarasamudra
- (c) Yadava : Warangal
- (d) Pandya : Madurai

Ans. (b) & (d)

Note: the source keys two options. Both are correct pairs: the Hoysala capital was Dwarasamudra and the later Pandya capital was Madurai (the early Pandya capital was Korkai). The swapped pairs (a) and (c) are wrong, since Devagiri was the Yadava capital and Warangal the Kakatiya capital.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I (Ruling Dynasties)	List-II (Capitals)
A. Pallava	1. Warangal
B. Pandya	2. Kanchi
C. Yadava	3. Madura
D. Kakatiya	4. Devagiri

Codes :

- A B C D
- (a) 2 1 4 3
- (b) 2 3 4 1
- (c) 1 2 3 4
- (d) 2 4 3 1

Ans. (b)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched? State Ruler

- (a) Devagiri Shankar Dev
- (b) Warangal Ramchandra Dev
- (c) Hoysala Veer Ballal
- (d) Madura Veer Pandya

Ans. (b)

When Alauddin Khalji's armies under Malik Kafur came south, **Ramachandra Deva** ruled **Devagiri**. His son **Shankara Deva** succeeded him and was later killed. **Warangal** was ruled by the Kakatiya **Pratapardura II**, not Ramachandra. **Ballala III** (Vira Ballala) ruled the Hoysalas, and **Vira Pandya** was fighting his brother Sundara Pandya for Madurai. Option (b) puts the Yadava king on the Kakatiya throne.

Dynasty	Capital	Ruler at the Khalji invasions	Now in
Yadava (Seuna)	Devagiri (later Daulatabad)	Ramachandra Deva, then Shankara Deva	Maharashtra (Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district)
Kakatiya	Warangal	Prataparudra II	Telangana
Hoysala	Dwarasamudra (Halebidu)	Ballala III	Karnataka (Hassan district)
Pandya	Madurai (earlier Korkai)	Vira Pandya and Sundara Pandya	Tamil Nadu
Pallava (earlier period)	Kanchi	Ended in the 9th century	Tamil Nadu

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003

Q. What is the modern name of Hoysaleswara's ancient capital of Dwarasamudra?

- (a) Sringeri
(b) Belur
(c) Halebid
(d) Somnathpur

Ans. (c)

Dwarasamudra is modern **Halebidu** (Halebid) in **Hassan district**, Karnataka. It holds the 12th century **Hoysaleswara temple**. **Belur** (Chennakeshava temple) was the earlier Hoysala capital, and **Somanathapura** (Keshava temple) is a later Hoysala temple site. In **September 2023** the three were inscribed together as the **Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas**, India's 42nd World Heritage Site. **Sringeri** is the matha associated with Adi Shankaracharya.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2014

Q. 'Dwarasamudra' was the capital of which dynastic power?
Ans. Hoysala

TRAP ALERT

Examiners swap **Devagiri and Warangal** between the Yadavas and Kakatiyas in almost every version. Fix it once: Yadava goes with Devagiri, Kakatiya with Warangal. **Belur** is a Hoysala site but not Dwarasamudra.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Match List - I with List-II and select the correct option from the code given below the lists.

List - I (Officer)	List - II (Duty)
A. Talar	1. Guard of Octroi
B. Pattakola	2. Officer of cases of Dacoity
C. Sahasadhipati	3. Officer of Night Guards
D. Baladhip	4. Village Tax Collector

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 2 1 4 3
(b) 3 4 2 1
(c) 1 2 3 4
(d) 4 3 1 2

Ans. (b)

These titles come from early medieval inscriptions. The source key gives the pairs below. The Sanskrit roots help with elimination: **sahasa** means violent crime, so Sahasadhipati deals with dacoity and robbery, and **pattakila** is a village-level office tied to revenue.

Term	Meaning (per source key)	Remark
Talar (Talara)	Officer of the night watch	Local police function
Pattakila	Village tax collector	Also read as village headman in some inscriptions
Sahasadhipati	Officer for cases of dacoity, theft and robbery	From sahasa (violent crime)
Baladhipa	Guard of octroi (toll collection)	D.C. Sircar treats it as a military officer
Palaiyakkarar (Polygar)	Territorial military and administrative chief	Madurai Nayakas

TRAP ALERT

Baladhipa looks like "bala" (army), and D.C. Sircar reads it as a military officer. The source key pairs it with the octroi guard. In the 2022 code only (b) fits the other three pairs, so elimination gives the answer without resolving Baladhipa.

11.7 Polygars and Early Medieval Officer Titles

U.P.P.C.S. (RE. EXAM) (PRE) 2015

Q. Who were Polygars of South India?

- (a) Ordinary Zamindars
(b) Mahajans
(c) Territorial Administrative and Military Governors
(d) Newly enriched traders

Ans. (c)

The **Polygars** (palaiyakkarars) held territories called **palayams** under the **Nayaka** rulers of Madurai and other successor states of Vijayanagara, roughly from the 16th to the 18th century. They collected revenue, kept troops and policed their areas, so they were territorial military and administrative chiefs, not ordinary zamindars. The system grew out of the Vijayanagara **nayankara** arrangement (Chapter 6). Later Polygars such as **Veerapandiya Kattabomman** resisted the East India Company in the Polygar wars at the end of the 18th century.

Chapter 11: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Jaunpur and the Sharqi dynasty	6	2001-2023	Recurring (UP core)
Bahmani kingdom and Deccan sultanates	5	1995-2020	Recurring
Southern kingdoms and capitals (Yadava, Kakatiya, Hoysala, Pandya)	5	2003-2019	Recurring
Mewar: Rana Kumbha	2	2007-2011	Steady (4 papers)
Provincial monuments (Bengal, Jaunpur, Gujarat)	2	2018-2021	Rising
Kashmir: Zain-ul-Abidin	2	2023	Recent
Polygars and officer titles	2	2015-2022	Recent

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 24 items (20 PYQs + 4 one-liners). Jaunpur is the anchor, with 6 items on its founding, the Shiraz-i-Hind title, its last ruler and Malik Sarwar. Pair-matching dominates the rest: 9 of the 20 PYQs are "correctly matched", "not correctly matched" or List-I List-II items built on dynasty, capital, ruler and builder pairs. The capital table in 11.6 and the sultanate table in 11.4 answer most of them. Items from 2018 to 2023 have moved to Bengal monuments, Kashmir and officer titles, so older ruler-capital drills are not enough on their own. Two items carry Notes: the double-keyed Hoysala and Pandya question and the Kirti Stambha naming issue.

Chapter 12

Bhakti and Sufi Movement

Between the 13th and 17th centuries two devotional currents reshaped religious life in India. The **Bhakti movement** began with the Alvar and Nayanar saints of the Tamil country, gained a philosophical base from the Vedanta acharyas, and reached North India through Ramananda, Kabir, Raidas, Surdas, Tulsidas, Mirabai, Chaitanya, Shankaradeva and Guru Nanak. The **Sufi movement** brought Islamic mysticism through orders (silsilas) such as the Chishti, Suhrawardi, Qadiri, Naqshbandi and Shattari. UPPSC tests this chapter through philosophy-to-acharya matches, chronological order of saints, guru-disciple pairs, the Chishti chain with dargah locations and titles, and the contrast between the orders. Uttar Pradesh is central: Varanasi, Prayag, Maghar, Rajapur, Kara, Mathura-Vrindavan and Fatehpur Sikri all appear. It contains **40 PYQs** and **9 starred one-liners** (one starred item is a List match and is shown in a match box). It is the heaviest chapter of the Medieval book.

12.1 Origins: Alvars, Nayanars and the Northern Revival

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2001

Q. The Bhakti movement was started by -

- (a) Alvar Saints
- (b) Sufi Saints
- (c) Surdas
- (d) Tulsidas

Ans. (a)

Bhakti as a popular movement first arose in the **Tamil country** between the 6th and 9th centuries CE. The **Alvars** (12 Vaishnava saints, including the woman saint Andal) and the **Nayanars** (63 Shaiva saints, including Karaikkal Ammaiyar) sang in Tamil, travelled from shrine to shrine and drew followers from many castes. A well-known verse of the Bhagavata Mahatmya says that Bhakti was born in the Dravida country, grew in Karnataka, stayed for a time in Maharashtra and grew weak in Gujarat. **Surdas** and **Tulsidas** belong to the 16th century, and the Sufis are a separate Islamic current, so all three distractors fail.

Group	Deity	Number	Compilation	Names to know
Alvars	Vishnu	12	Nalayira Divya Prabandham (compiled by Nathamuni)	Andal (woman saint), Nammalvar
Nayanars	Shiva	63	Tevaram hymns in the Tirumurai, lives in Sekkizhar's Periya Puranam	Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, Karaikkal Ammaiyar
Virashaivas (Lingayats)	Shiva	Movement	Kannada vachanas	Basava (12th century), minister of the Kalachuri king Bijjala at Kalyani

The Alvar and Nayanar distinction is also taught in the Ancient History book (Chapter 6). Here the point is that medieval North Indian Bhakti grew out of this southern root.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1993

Q. The Bhakti culture reborn in India during-

- (a) Vedic age
- (b) 10th century AD
- (c) 12th century AD
- (d) 15th -16th century AD

Ans. (d)

The word "reborn" points to the second, northern wave. In the **15th and 16th centuries** Bhakti became a mass movement in North and East India under **Kabir, Guru Nanak, Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai and Chaitanya**. They used regional languages (Awadhi, Braj, Punjabi, Bengali, Rajasthani) instead of Sanskrit, criticised caste and ritual to varying degrees, and reached ordinary people.

TRAP ALERT

"Started by" means the Alvars (and Nayanars) of the 6th to 9th centuries. "Reborn" or "revived in the North" means the 15th and 16th centuries. Do not mix the two dates.

12.2 The Vedanta Acharyas: One Philosophy, One Founder

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. Ramanujacharya is related to -

- (a) Bhakti
- (b) Dvaitvad
- (c) Vishishtadvaita
- (d) Monotheism

Ans. (c)

Ramanuja (traditionally 1017 to 1137) of Sriperumbudur near Chennai taught **Vishishtadvaita**, qualified non-dualism. Brahman is one, but the individual souls and the world are real and form its body or attributes. Salvation comes through bhakti and surrender (prapatti) to a personal, saguna God, Vishnu. He headed the Sri Vaishnava tradition at Srirangam. Option (a) Bhakti is too broad and (b) Dvaita belongs to Madhva.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1999

Q. The followers of Ramanuja are known as

Ans. Vaishnava

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002

Q. "Shuddha Advaitvad" was propounded by -

- (a) Madhvacharya
- (b) Vallabhacharya
- (c) Shrikantacharya
- (d) Ramanuja

Ans. (b)

Vallabhacharya (1479 to 1531) taught **Shuddhadvaita** (pure non-dualism) and the path of grace called **Pushtimarg**. He developed the Rudra Sampradaya of Vishnuswami and worshipped Krishna as Shrinathji. **Shrikantha** is the distractor. He wrote a Shaiva commentary on the Brahma Sutras (Shaiva Vishishtadvaita), not a Vaishnava one.

UP link: Vallabha spent most of his life at **Kashi** (Varanasi), **Arail** across the Yamuna from Prayagraj (Prayagraj district), and the **Braj** region of Mathura district, where the image of Shrinathji was first worshipped on the Govardhan hill. He died at Varanasi.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Which one of the following is correctly matched ?

- (a) Advaitvad - Ramanuja
 (b) Vishishtadvaitvad - Shankaracharya
 (c) Dvaitvad - Madhvacharya
 (d) Dvaitadvaitvad - Vallabhacharya

Ans. (c)

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Vallabhacharya	1. Dvaitvad
B. Ramanuja	2. Pushtimarg
C. Madhvacharya	3. Vishishtadvait
D. Shankar	4. Advaitvad

Ans. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List-I (Philosopher)	List-II (Philosophy)
A. Ramanuja	1. Shuddhadvait
B. Madhvacharya	2. Dvaitadvait
C. Nimbarka	3. Dvaita
D. Vallabhacharya	4. Vishishtadvaita

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 3 1 4 2
 (b) 4 3 2 1
 (c) 2 4 1 3
 (d) 1 2 3 4

Ans. (b)

Three papers (2005, 2017, 2022) test the same five pairs. Learn them as one table and the three questions become one.

Acharya	Philosophy	Meaning	Sect or school	Region and period
Shankaracharya	Advaita	Non-dualism. Brahman alone is real, the world is maya	Smarta, four mathas	Kaladi (Kerala), commonly dated 8th century
Ramanuja	Vishishtadvaita	Qualified non-dualism	Sri Vaishnava (Sri Sampradaya)	Tamil Nadu, 11th to 12th century
Nimbarka	Dvaitadvaita	Dualistic non-dualism (bhedabheda). Radha-Krishna worship	Sanakadi (Nimbarka) Sampradaya	Telugu region and Braj, date disputed (commonly 12th to 13th century)
Madhva	Dvaita	Dualism. God and soul are eternally distinct	Brahma Sampradaya	Udupi (Karnataka), 13th century
Vallabha	Shuddhadvaita	Pure non-dualism. Path of grace	Pushtimarg, Rudra Sampradaya	Varanasi, Prayag, Braj, 1479 to 1531

Acharya	Philosophy	Meaning	Sect or school	Region and period
Chaitanya (12.8)	Achintya Bhedabheda	Inconceivable difference and non-difference	Gaudiya Vaishnava	Bengal and Puri, 1486 to 1533

TRAP ALERT

Two traps recur. **Dvaita** (Madhva) and **Dvaitadvaita** (Nimbarka) differ by one word. **Advaita** (Shankara) and **Shuddhadvaita** (Vallabha) also differ by one word. In the 2005 question every option except (c) swaps two acharyas.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Recent memorials keep these names in current affairs. The 216-foot **Statue of Equality** of Ramanuja at Muchintal near Hyderabad was inaugurated on 5 February 2022 to mark his 1000th birth anniversary. The 108-foot **Statue of Oneness** of Adi Shankaracharya at Omkareshwar (Khandwa district, Madhya Pradesh) was unveiled on 21 September 2023. A statue-to-acharya-to-philosophy match is a natural next step.

12.3 Ramananda: The Bridge from South to North

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Who among the following Saints of the medieval Age India was born in Prayag?

- (a) Kumbhandas
 (b) Ramanand
 (c) Raidas
 (d) Tulsidas

Ans. (b)

Ramananda carried Bhakti from the Ramanuja tradition to North India. Tradition places his birth at **Prayag** in a Kanyakubja Brahmin family, with the date 1299. Many historians place his active life later, in the late 14th or early 15th century, so treat the year as traditional. He studied at Prayag and Varanasi, made **Rama and Sita** the object of devotion and preached in **Hindi** rather than Sanskrit. His disciples, by tradition, included Kabir (a weaver), Raidas (a leather worker), Sena (a barber), Dhanna (a Jat peasant) and Pipa (a Rajput).

UP link: the options hold four UP-linked saints with four different places. Ramananda, **Prayag** (Prayagraj district). Raidas, **Varanasi**. Tulsidas, **Rajapur** (Chitrakoot district). Kumbhandas, one of the Ashtachhap poets, the **Braj** region near Govardhan (Mathura district).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2009

Q. 'Let no man ask a man's sect or caste' whose dictum was this?"

- (a) Kabir
 (b) Ramananda
 (c) Ramanuja
 (d) Chaitanya

Ans. (b)

The saying is the English rendering of the line attributed to Ramananda, "Jati panti puchhe nahin koi, Hari ko bhaje so Hari ka hoi" (let no one ask about caste or sect, whoever worships Hari belongs to Hari). His open admission of disciples from every caste and from both religions is the proof. **Kabir** taught the same idea, which makes him the strongest distractor, but the dictum belongs to his guru.

TRAP ALERT

Ramananda was a **saguna** devotee of Rama, yet his most famous disciple Kabir was **nirguna**. UPPSC uses this to test whether students know that a guru and disciple need not share a form of devotion.

12.4 Kabir and the Guru-Disciple Chains

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. Kabir was disciple of -

- (a) Chaitanya
- (b) Ramananda
- (c) Ramanuja
- (d) Tukaram

Ans. (b)

By tradition **Kabir** was one of the twelve principal disciples of Ramananda. Popular legend says he was born near Varanasi to a Brahmin widow and was raised by a Muslim weaver couple, **Niru and Nima**. He was a nirguna saint who rejected idol worship, pilgrimage, caste and the authority of both Brahmin priests and mullahs. His traditional dates are 1398 to 1518, and many scholars prefer c. 1440 to 1518. He was a contemporary of Sikandar Lodi. **Ramanuja** lived three centuries earlier, **Chaitanya** was a younger saguna saint of Bengal, and **Tukaram** belongs to 17th century Maharashtra.

UP link: Kabir lived and taught at **Varanasi** (Kabir Chaura and the Lahartara pond are linked to him). He went to **Maghar** to die, rejecting the belief that death at Kashi brings salvation and death at Maghar does not. Maghar is in **Sant Kabir Nagar district**, created on 5 September 1997 out of Basti district and named after him. A samadhi and a mazar of Kabir stand side by side there.

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2003

Q. A collection of dialogues between Kabir and Dharamdas is titled :

- (a) Sabad
- (b) Amarmool
- (c) Sakhi
- (d) Ramaini

Ans. (b)

Kabir's verses survive in three main collections: the **Bijak** of the Kabirpanthis, the **Kabir Granthavali** of the Dadupanthis tradition in Rajasthan, and the hymns in the **Guru Granth Sahib**. The **Bijak** is arranged by verse form: **Sakhi** (couplets), **Sabad** (songs) and **Ramaini** (chaupai verses). **Amarmool** is the text cast as dialogues between Kabir and his chief disciple **Dharamdas**, who founded the Dharamdasi branch of the Kabirpanth. The three distractors are verse forms, not dialogues.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the code given below:

List-I (Disciple)	List-II (Teacher)
A. Kabir	1. Guru Nanak Dev
B. Amir Khusro	2. Swami Ramananda
C. Surdas	3. Nizamuddin Auliya
D. Mardana	4. Vallabhacharya

Code :

A B C D

(a) 3 2 4 1

(b) 3 2 1 4

(c) 2 3 4 1

(d) 2 3 1 4

Ans. (c)

Kabir with Ramananda and Amir Khusrau with **Nizamuddin Auliya** (Chapter 9) fix A-2 and B-3, which leaves (c) and (d). **Bhai Mardana**, a Muslim rabab player, was Guru Nanak's lifelong companion, so D-1 and the answer is (c). The link of **Surdas** with Vallabha comes from the Pushtimarg tradition (the Chaurasi Vaishnavan ki Varta). Some historians doubt it, but it is the accepted exam pairing.

Saint	Place	Guru or sect	Language	Key work or teaching
Ramananda	Prayag, Varanasi	Ramanuja tradition, Ramanandi sect	Hindi	Rama-Sita bhakti, open to all castes
Kabir	Varanasi, died at Maghar	Ramananda (tradition)	Sadhukkadi (mixed Hindi)	Bijak , Sakhi, Sabad, Ramaini. Nirguna
Raidas (Ravidas)	Varanasi	Ramananda (tradition)	Hindi	Nirguna. Hymns in the Guru Granth Sahib
Dadu Dayal	Born Ahmedabad, active in Rajasthan	Founded the Dadupanth	Hindi, Rajasthani	Nirguna. Followers compiled Kabir's verses
Surdas	Braj (Mathura-Agra region)	Vallabha (tradition), Ashtachhap	Braj Bhasha	Sursagar . Krishna bhakti, saguna
Tulsidas	Rajapur, Varanasi	Narharidas, Rama bhakti	Awadhi, Braj	Ramcharitmanas , Vinay Patrika (12.9)
Mirabai	Merta and Mewar (Rajasthan)	Raidas named as guru in tradition	Rajasthani, Braj	Padas to Krishna (Giridhar Gopal)
Guru Nanak	Talwandi (Nankana Sahib), died at Kartarpur	Founder of Sikhism	Punjabi	Nirguna. Hymns in the Adi Granth (12.6)
Lal Ded (Lalleshwari)	Kashmir	Kashmir Shaivism	Kashmiri	Vakhs (sayings), 14th century

TRAP ALERT

In a disciple-teacher match, anchor the two certain pairs first (Kabir with Ramananda, Khusrau with Nizamuddin) and then decide between the last two. **Mardana** is the less familiar name, and that is exactly where the 2025 paper set its trap.

12.5 Chronology of the Saints: Namdev, Kabir, Nanak, Chaitanya, Mira

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. Select the correct chronological order of the Bhakti Saints from the following:

- Kabir, Guru Nanak, Chaitanya, Mirabai
- Kabir, Chaitanya, Guru Nanak, Mirabai
- Kabir, Mirabai, Chaitanya, Guru Nanak
- Guru Nanak, Chaitanya, Mirabai, Kabir

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Arrange the following saints in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the code given below.

- Nanak
- Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
- Namdev
- Kabir

Code :

- 3, 4, 2, 1
- 4, 3, 1, 2
- 3, 4, 1, 2
- 4, 3, 2, 1

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Arrange the following Saints in their chronological order:

- Kabir
- Namdev
- Mirabai
- Nanak

Code :

- 1, 2, 3, 4
- 4, 3, 2, 1
- 2, 1, 4, 3
- 4, 1, 3, 2

Ans. (c)

All three questions are solved by one sequence: **Namdev, Kabir, Nanak, Chaitanya, Mirabai**. Namdev is the only one from the 13th to 14th century, so he always comes first. Kabir is the oldest of the 15th century group. Nanak (born 1469) is older than Chaitanya (born 1486), who is older than Mira (born c. 1498).

Order	Saint	Commonly given dates	Region
1	Jnaneshwar	1275 to 1296	Maharashtra
2	Namdev	1270 to 1350	Maharashtra, later Punjab
3	Ramananda	Birth 1299 by tradition (disputed)	Prayag, Varanasi
4	Kabir	1398 to 1518 (traditional), c. 1440 to 1518 (many scholars)	Varanasi
5	Shankaradeva	1449 to 1568	Assam
6	Guru Nanak	1469 to 1539	Punjab
7	Vallabhacharya	1479 to 1531	Varanasi, Braj
8	Chaitanya	1486 to 1533	Bengal, Puri
9	Mirabai	c. 1498 to c. 1547 (some books give 1557)	Rajasthan
10	Tulsidas	1532 to 1623 (birth also given as 1497)	UP
11	Tukaram and Ramdas	17th century (Shivaji's time)	Maharashtra

TRAP ALERT

Chaitanya was younger than Nanak but died first (1533 against 1539). Order questions go by **birth**. In the 2025 Prelims option (a) placed Chaitanya before Nanak to catch students who go by death year.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Mirabai was contemporary of :

- Tulsidas
- Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
- Guru Nanak
- Ramakrishna Paramahansa

Ans. (*)

Note: the source key is (*) because three options fit. Mirabai (c. 1498 to c. 1547) overlapped with Guru Nanak (1469 to 1539), Chaitanya (1486 to 1533) and Tulsidas (born 1532 on the common date, earlier on another). Only (d) Ramakrishna Paramahansa (1836 to 1886) is wrong.

Mirabai was the daughter of Ratan Singh Rathore of Merta. She was married to **Bhojraj**, the eldest son of Rana Sanga of Mewar. After his early death she gave her life to Krishna, whom she called Giridhar Gopal, and composed padas in Rajasthani and Braj. She is said to have spent her last years at Dwarka.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Five chronology items in five papers (1995 to 2025) make this one of the most reliable patterns in the chapter. The next version may add Vallabha, Shankaradeva or Tulsidas to the same set. The table above covers all of them.

12.6 Guru Nanak and the Sikh Gurus

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2023

Q. Before his death in 1539 A.D., whom did Baba Guru Nanak choose as his successor ?

- Guru Angad
- Guru Namdev
- Guru Arjan
- Guru Tegh Bahadur

Ans. (a)

Guru Nanak (1469 to 1539) was born at Talwandi (now Nankana Sahib, Pakistan) and spent his last years at **Kartarpur** on the Ravi. He named his disciple **Bhai Lehna** as successor and renamed him **Angad**, who became the second Guru. Nanak died on 22 September 1539. **Namdev** was a Maharashtrian saint whose verses are in the Guru Granth Sahib, but he was never a Sikh Guru. **Arjan** and **Tegh Bahadur** are the 5th and 9th Gurus.

No.	Guru	Period as Guru	Fact for the exam
1	Guru Nanak	Founder, died 1539	Nirguna devotion, langar, sangat. Companion Mardana
2	Guru Angad	1539 to 1552	Developed the Gurmukhi script (tradition)
3	Guru Amar Das	1552 to 1574	Manji system, Goindwal
4	Guru Ram Das	1574 to 1581	Founded Ramdasapur, later Amritsar
5	Guru Arjan Dev	1581 to 1606	Compiled the Adi Granth (1604). Executed under Jahangir (1606)

No.	Guru	Period as Guru	Fact for the exam
6	Guru Hargobind	1606 to 1644	Akal Takht, miri and piri
7, 8	Guru Har Rai, Guru Har Krishan	1644 to 1664	Har Krishan became Guru as a child
9	Guru Tegh Bahadur	1664 to 1675	Executed in Delhi under Aurangzeb (1675)
10	Guru Gobind Singh	1675 to 1708	Founded the Khalsa (1699). Died at Nanded. Granth declared the eternal Guru

The Adi Granth includes hymns of non-Sikh saints too: **Kabir, Namdev, Ravidas** and the Sufi **Baba Farid** (12.13). This is why "Guru Namdev" sounds plausible as a distractor.

12.7 Namdev, the Varkaris and the Nirguna-Saguna Divide

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002, 2004

Q. Who among the following was the Saint of the Varkari Sect?

- (a) Nimbarka
- (b) Chakradhara
- (c) Namdev
- (d) Ramdas

Ans. (c)

The **Varkari** sect worships **Vithoba (Vitthal)** of **Pandharpur**, and its members make the annual wari (pilgrimage) on foot. Jnaneshwar gave it a philosophical base and **Namdev**, a tailor by caste, spread it widely. His guru in mystical life was **Visoba Khechar**. **Chakradhara** founded the separate **Mahanubhava** sect in the 13th century. **Ramdas** founded the Samarth (Ramdasi) sampradaya and worshipped Rama and Hanuman. **Nimbarka** is a Vedanta acharya (12.2).

Saint	Period	Sect	Work or contribution
Jnaneshwar (Dnyaneshwar)	13th century	Varkari	Jnaneshwari , a Marathi commentary on the Gita. Amritanubhav
Namdev	13th to 14th century	Varkari	Marathi abhangas and Hindi padas. Hymns in the Guru Granth Sahib
Eknath	16th century	Varkari	Eknathi Bhagavat. Edited the Jnaneshwari
Tukaram	17th century	Varkari	Abhangas. Contemporary of Shivaji
Ramdas	17th century	Samarth (Ramdasi)	Dasbodh . Regarded as Shivaji's guru in tradition
Chakradhara	13th century	Mahanubhava	Krishna worship, rejected caste. Lilacharitra records his life

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (PRE) 2010, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (MAINS) 2010

Q. Which one of the following leaders of the Bhakti Movement was influenced by Islam?

- (a) Chaitanya
- (b) Mirabai
- (c) Namdev
- (d) Vallabhacharya

Ans. (c)

Namdev began as a Vitthal devotee, but in his later years, spent partly in Punjab, his Hindi verses turned **nirguna**. He rejected idol worship, vows, fasts, pilgrimage and harsh austerities, and textbooks read this as the influence of Islamic monotheism and of the Sufis. **Chaitanya, Mirabai and Vallabha** were saguna devotees of Krishna, so the key picks Namdev. Historians also trace nirguna ideas to the Nath yogis and to older Bhakti, so read "influenced by Islam" as the textbook line, not as the whole story.

Feature	Nirguna Bhakti	Saguna Bhakti
God	Formless, without attributes	With form and attributes (Rama, Krishna)
Idols and temples	Rejected	Accepted
Caste and ritual	Sharply criticised	Softened within tradition, caste order largely accepted
Influences	Nath yoga, Vaishnava bhakti, Sufism	Vedanta acharyas, Puranas, Bhagavata
Saints	Kabir, Nanak, Raidas, Dadu, Namdev (Hindi verses), Malukdas	Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya, Vallabha, Ramananda
Language	Mixed popular speech	Awadhi, Braj, Bengali, Rajasthani

TRAP ALERT

Namdev appears on both sides. As a Varkari he worshipped Vitthal (saguna). His Hindi verses in the Guru Granth Sahib are nirguna. For "influenced by Islam", UPPSC keys Namdev.

12.8 Eastern Vaishnavism: Chaitanya and Shankaradeva

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. Chaitanya Mahaprabhu is related to which sect?

- (a) Vaishnava
- (b) Shaiva
- (c) Buddhist
- (d) Sufi

Ans. (a)

Chaitanya (1486 to 1533), named Vishvambhar and called Nimai as a child, was born at **Nabadwip** (Nadia, Bengal). He founded **Gaudiya Vaishnavism**, worshipped Krishna with Radha, and made **sankirtan**, group singing and dancing in the streets, the main form of devotion. He spent his last years at **Puri**. His disciples, the six Goswamis, settled at Vrindavan and wrote the theology of the sect.

UP link: Chaitanya visited **Vrindavan** (Mathura district) and his followers, led by the Goswamis, identified and revived its sacred sites in the 16th century. Vallabha's Pushtimarg (12.2) also centred on Braj. This is why Mathura-Vrindavan became the heart of Krishna bhakti.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002

Q. Vaishnavism in Kamarupa was popularised by -

- (a) Chaitanya
- (b) Nimbarka
- (c) Ramananda
- (d) Shankaradeva

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2015

Q. Famous medieval saint Shankaradeva belonged to**Ans.** Vaishnava Cult

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Who among the following introduced Vaishnavism in Assam and Cooch Bihar?

- (a) Chaitanya
- (b) Madhva
- (c) Shankaradeva
- (d) Vallabhacharya

Ans. (c)

Shankaradeva (Srimanta Sankardev, 1449 to 1568) spread Vaishnavism in Assam (ancient Kamarupa) and in the Koch kingdom of **Cooch Behar**, where King Naranarayana gave him shelter. His faith, **Ekasarana Nama Dharma**, means surrender to one God, Krishna as a form of Vishnu. It rejected idol worship and Vedic ritual and relied on chanting the Name.

Feature	Chaitanya	Shankaradeva
Region	Bengal, Odisha (Puri)	Assam, Cooch Behar
Sect	Gaudiya Vaishnava	Ekasarana (Mahapurushia) Dharma
Deity	Krishna with Radha	Krishna alone, no Radha, no idol worship
Practice	Sankirtan	Nama-kirtan in the namghar (prayer hall)
Institutions	Goswamis of Vrindavan	Satras (monasteries), e.g. on Majuli island
Art and literature	Padavali songs in Bengali	Borgeet songs, Ankiya Naat plays, Kirtan Ghosha. Disciple Madhavadeva

TRAP ALERT

Kamarupa or Assam means **Shankaradeva**, not Chaitanya, even though both were eastern Vaishnavas of the same period. The name also invites confusion with the Advaita philosopher **Shankaracharya** of the 8th century.

12.9 Tulsidas: Rajapur, Varanasi and the Ramcharitmanas

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. With reference to Tulsidas, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tulsidas was born in village named Rajapur in Banda district.
2. His wife's name was Geetawali

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code -

- (a) Both (a) and (b)
- (b) Only (b)
- (c) Only (a)
- (d) Neither (a) nor (b)

Ans. (d)

Statement 2 is plainly wrong. His wife was **Ratnavali**. **Gitavali** is one of his works, a set of songs on the Rama story. Statement 1 fails on the district. Tradition places his birth at **Rajapur** on the Yamuna, which today lies in **Chitrakoot district**. His parents are named in tradition as Atmaram Dubey and Hulsi.

UP link: Chitrakoot district was carved out of Banda district on 6 May 1997 as Chhatrapati Shahuji Maharaj Nagar and renamed Chitrakoot on 4 September 1998. Rajapur is one of its tehsils. Tulsidas spent much of his life at **Varanasi** and died there in 1623 (Assi Ghat by tradition). He also had close links with Chitrakoot and Ayodhya.

TRAP ALERT

Before 1997 Rajapur was in Banda district, so "Rajapur in Banda" was true in older books. For a 2023 paper the current district, Chitrakoot, decides the answer. Note also a rival tradition that places his birth at **Soron** (Kasganj district). The exam follows Rajapur.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. Whose contemporary was Tulsidas?

- (a) Akbar and Jahangir
- (b) Shah Jahan
- (c) Aurangzeb
- (d) Babur and Humayun

Ans. (a)

On the common dates (1532 to 1623) Tulsidas lived under Humayun, the Sur rulers, Akbar and Jahangir. Shah Jahan came to the throne in 1628, after Tulsidas's death on these dates. His creative life falls under **Akbar (1556 to 1605) and Jahangir (1605 to 1627)**, so (a) is the best fit. He never served at court. **Aurangzeb** came after his death.

Work	Language	Note
Ramcharitmanas	Awadhi	Rama story in seven kandas. Begun at Ayodhya in 1574 by tradition, completed at Varanasi
Vinay Patrika	Braj	Petition-prayers to Rama
Kavitavali, Gitavali , Krishna Gitavali	Braj	Songs and verses on Rama and Krishna
Dohavali, Barvai Ramayana, Parvati Mangal, Janaki Mangal	Awadhi and Braj	Shorter works

12.10 Bhakti Literature and the Saint-Poets of UP

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Malukdas was a saint poet of -

- (a) Agra
- (b) Ayodhya
- (c) Kashi
- (d) Kada

Ans. (d)

Malukdas (born 1574) was a nirguna saint-poet born in a Khatri family at **Kara** (Kada) on the Ganga. He is remembered for the couplet "Ajgar kare na chakri, panchhi kare na kaam, Das Maluka kah gaye, sabke data Ram" (the python serves no master, the bird does no work, says Maluka, Rama provides for all).

UP link: Kara is in **Kaushambi district**, carved out of Allahabad (now Prayagraj) district on 4 April 1997. Kara was also the seat of the Kara-Manikpur iqta where Alauddin Khalji was governor before he became Sultan (Chapter 3).

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- (a) Dhruvadas - Bhagat Namawali
- (b) Nabhdas - Bhaktamal
- (c) Raskhan - Rasikpriya
- (d) Usman - Chitrawali

Ans. (c)

Rasikpriya is a work on poetics by **Keshavdas** of the Orchha court, who also wrote Kavipriya and Ramchandrika. **Raskhan**, a Muslim devotee of Krishna, wrote **Premvatika** and the verses collected as Sujan Raskhan. The other three pairs are correct.

Poet	Work	Type
Nabhdas	Bhaktamal (c. 1600)	Lives of Bhakti saints (Ramanandi tradition)
Dhruvadas	Bhaktnamawali (Bhagat Namawali)	List of devotees (Radhavallabh sect)
Raskhan	Premvatika , Sujan Raskhan	Krishna bhakti in Braj
Keshavdas	Rasikpriya , Kavipriya, Ramchandrika	Riti poetics, Orchha court
Usman	Chitravali (1613)	Sufi premakhyan (love romance), Jahangir's reign
Malik Muhammad Jayasi	Padmavat (1540)	Sufi premakhyan in Awadhi
Qutban, Manjhan	Mrigavati, Madhumalati	Sufi premakhyan
Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan	Rahim's dohas	Hindi verse, Akbar's court

UP link: a samadhi of Raskhan is maintained at **Mahaban** near Gokul (Mathura district).

TRAP ALERT

Raskhan sounds like "Rasikpriya". The match is a sound trap. Raskhan goes with Premvatika, Keshavdas with Rasikpriya.

12.11 Sufism: Core Terms, Sama and Who Was a Sufi

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Q. Which of the following is not related to Sufism ?

- (a) Ulema
- (b) Khanqah
- (c) Shaikh
- (d) Sama

Ans. (a)

The **ulema** are scholars of Islamic law (sharia) and theology. They are part of orthodox Islam and were often critical of Sufi practices such as music. **Khanqah**, **shaikh** and **sama** are all Sufi terms. Sufism stressed love of God, a personal master and inner experience over legal formalism.

Term	Meaning	Context
Silsila	Chain linking master and disciple back to the Prophet. Also an order	Chishti, Suhrawardi silsilas
Shaikh / Pir / Murshid	Spiritual master	Guides the disciple
Murid	Disciple	Amir Khusrau was Nizamuddin's murid
Khalifa	Successor appointed by the master	Carries the order to a new region
Khanqah	Hospice where the shaikh lived with disciples	Open kitchen (langar), visitors of all faiths
Sama	Musical assembly to induce ecstasy	Chishti practice. Naqshbandis opposed it
Wali (plural auliya)	Friend of God, a saint	Nizamuddin Auliya
Dargah, urs	Shrine at a saint's grave, death anniversary festival	Ajmer, Nizamuddin (Delhi)
Wahdat-ul-wujud	Unity of being (Ibn Arabi)	Accepted by most Indian Sufis
Wahdat-ul-shuhud	Unity of appearance or witness	Ahmad Sirhindi , Naqshbandi (12.15)
Malfuzat, maktubat, tazkira	Recorded sayings, letters, biographies of saints	Fawaid-ul-Fuad (Chapter 9)
Ulema	Scholars of Islamic law	Not a Sufi term (the 2014 answer)
Ba-sharia, be-sharia	Orders that follow or ignore sharia	Qalandars were be-sharia

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 1998

Q. Who of the following saints were Sufi

1. Rahim
2. Nizamuddin Auliya
3. Muinuddin Chishti
4. Raskhan

Choose your answer from the codes given below-

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 1, 2 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 2 and 4

Ans. (c)

Nizamuddin Auliya and **Muinuddin Chishti** were Chishti shaikhs. **Rahim** (Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan) and **Raskhan** were Muslim poets of Hindi and Krishna bhakti (12.10), but neither headed a Sufi

order. A Muslim name in a Bhakti context does not make someone a Sufi.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : Many Sanskrit works on music were translated into Persian during the medieval period.

Reason (R) : The early Chishti Sufis were fond of musical assemblies called, 'sama'.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (b)

Both statements are true. Sanskrit texts on music were rendered into Persian under court patronage, for example the **Ghuniyat-ul-Munya** (14th century) and Faqirullah's **Rag Darpan** under Aurangzeb, a version of the Man Kautuhal's **Rag Darpan** under Aurangzeb, a version of the Man Kautuhal's **Rag Darpan** under Aurangzeb. The Chishtis held **sama** as a path to God. But the translations came from the interest of rulers and scholars, not from the sama of the Chishtis, so R does not explain A.

TRAP ALERT

In A-R questions on Sufism, check whether the Reason is the **cause** or just a related true fact. Sama is true but does not cause translations.

12.12 The Chishti Order Comes to India: Muinuddin at Ajmer

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. The "Chishti Sufi Order" in India was established by-

- (a) Khwaja Badaruddin
- (b) Khwaja Muinuddin
- (c) Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi
- (d) Shaikh Bahauddin Zakariya

Ans. (b)

The order takes its name from **Chisht**, a town near Herat in Afghanistan. **Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti**, a disciple of **Khwaja Usman Haruni**, came to India in the late 12th century and settled at **Ajmer**. He died there, commonly dated 1236. His dargah is the most visited Sufi shrine in India. He is popularly called Gharib Nawaz. **Bahauddin Zakariya** founded the Suhrawardi order in India (Multan) and **Ahmad Sirhindi** was a Naqshbandi (12.15).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. The first Sufi Saint of Chishti Sect who settled in Ajmer was

Ans. Shaikh Muinuddin Chishti

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2011

Q. Who was the founder of Chishti branch of Sufism?

Ans. Khwaja Abu-Abdal

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. Whose disciple was Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti?

Ans. Khwaja Usman Haruni

"Founded in India" and "founded" are different questions. The order began at Chisht. Tradition names **Abu Ishaq Shami** as the first master to settle there and his disciple **Khwaja Abu Ahmad Abdal Chishti**, a native of Chisht, as the one who built it up. The 2011 key gives Abu Abdal. In India the founder is Muinuddin.

Chishti saint	Centre	Died (commonly)	Fact for the exam
Muinuddin Chishti	Ajmer	1236	Founder in India. Disciple of Usman Haruni. Gharib Nawaz
Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki	Delhi (Mehrauli)	1235	Disciple of Muinuddin. Contemporary of Iltutmish
Hamiduddin Nagauri	Nagaur (Rajasthan)	1274	Disciple of Muinuddin. Lived as a peasant, vegetarian
Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar (Baba Farid)	Ajodhan (Pakpattan, Pakistan)	1265	Disciple of Bakhtiyar Kaki. Verses in the Adi Granth
Nizamuddin Auliya	Ghiyaspur, Delhi	1325	Disciple of Farid. Mahbub-i-Ilahi, Sultan-ul-Auliya
Alauddin Sabir	Kaliyar (Uttarakhand)	1291	Disciple of Farid. Sabiri branch
Nasiruddin Mahmud	Delhi	1356	Disciple of Nizamuddin. Chirag-i-Delhi
Burhanuddin Gharib	Khuldabad near Daulatabad	1337	Took the order to the Deccan
Muhammad Hussaini Gesudaraz	Gulbarga (Kalaburagi)	1422	Disciple of Chirag-i-Delhi. Bande Nawaz
Salim Chishti	Sikri (Fatehpur Sikri)	1572	Blessed Akbar with a son. Shaikh-ul-Hind

TRAP ALERT

Read the chain in order: **Usman Haruni, Muinuddin, Bakhtiyar Kaki, Farid, Nizamuddin, Nasiruddin Chirag**. Most Chishti questions ask one link of this chain.

12.13 Baba Farid and Nizamuddin Auliya: Titles, Disciples, Dargahs

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1994

Q. The thought of which of the following Sufi saints has been incorporated in the religious book 'Adi Granth' of the Sikh?

- (a) Shaikh Muinuddin Chishti
- (b) Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki
- (c) Fariduddin-Ganj-i-Shakar
- (d) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya

Ans. (c)

Shaikh Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar, called **Baba Farid**, made **Ajodhan** (now Pakpattan in Pakistani Punjab) his centre, after an earlier stay at Hansi. He composed in the Punjabi of his region, and his verses (shlokas) were included in the **Adi Granth** compiled by Guru Arjan in 1604. That makes him the only Sufi in this list linked to the Sikh scripture.

U. P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. Dargah of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya is situated in -

- (a) Agra
- (b) Ajmer
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Fatehpur

Ans. (c)

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2014

Q. Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti was a disciple of**Ans.** Khwaja Usman Haruni

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2006

Q. Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya was the disciple of**Ans.** Baba Farid

Nizamuddin Auliya died in 1325 and was buried at **Ghiyaspur** in Delhi, now the Nizamuddin area. His disciple Amir Khusrau lies buried close to him. Baba Farid's two leading disciples were Nizamuddin (the Nizami branch) and Alauddin Sabir (the Sabiri branch).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Which one of the following is not correctly matched ?

- (a) Akbar's Tomb - Sikandara
- (b) Jahangir's Tomb - Shahdara
- (c) Tomb of Shaikh Salim Chishti - Fatehpur Sikri
- (d) Tomb of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya - Ajmer

Ans. (d)

Nizamuddin is buried in Delhi. Ajmer holds **Muinuddin**. The other pairs are correct. Akbar's tomb is at **Sikandra** near Agra, Jahangir's at **Shahdara** near Lahore (Pakistan) and Salim Chishti's in the courtyard of the Jama Masjid at **Fatehpur Sikri**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. Which Sufi Saint was called 'Mahbub-e-Ilahi' ?

- (a) Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti
- (b) Baba Farid
- (c) Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki
- (d) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. The most reputed disciple of Shaikh Farid who had seen the reign of as many as seven sultans of Delhi was**Ans.** Nizamuddin Auliya

Nizamuddin Auliya was called **Mahbub-i-Ilahi** (Beloved of God) and **Sultan-ul-Auliya** (King of Saints). He lived through the reigns of seven or more Delhi Sultans, from the later Mamluks to Muhammad bin Tughluq, but never visited the court of any of them. The Chishtis kept a distance from the state and refused royal grants as a rule. The "seven Sultans" phrase is also used for Amir Khusrau (Chapter 9).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Which of the following is NOT correctly matched ?

- (a) Shaikh Muinuddin Chishti - Ajmer
- (b) Shaikh Burhanuddin Gharib - Daulatabad
- (c) Shaikh Mohammad Hussaini - Gulbarga
- (d) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya - Multan

Ans. (d)

Multan was the centre of the **Suhrawardi** saint Bahauddin Zakariya, not of any Chishti. **Burhanuddin Gharib**, sent south by Nizamuddin, is buried at Khuldabad near Daulatabad (now Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district, Maharashtra). **Muhammad Hussaini Gesudaraz** took the order to the Bahmani capital Gulbarga, now Kalaburagi (Karnataka).

UP link: Nizamuddin Auliya was born at **Badaun** (Budaun district). He studied there before joining Baba Farid at Ajodhan and later settled in Delhi.

Title	Saint
Gharib Nawaz	Muinuddin Chishti
Ganj-i-Shakar (treasury of sugar), Baba Farid	Fariduddin
Mahbub-i-Ilahi , Sultan-ul-Auliya	Nizamuddin Auliya
Chirag-i-Delhi (Lamp of Delhi)	Nasiruddin Mahmud
Bande Nawaz	Gesudaraz of Gulbarga
Shaikh-ul-Hind	Salim Chishti
Tuti-i-Hind (Parrot of India)	Amir Khusrau (poet, murid of Nizamuddin)
Mujaddid-i-Alf-i-Sani	Ahmad Sirhindi (Naqshbandi)

TRAP ALERT

Dargah-location pairs are the commonest Sufi trap: **Muinuddin, Ajmer. Bakhtiyar Kaki, Mehrauli. Nizamuddin, Delhi. Salim Chishti, Fatehpur Sikri. Bahauddin Zakariya, Multan.** The 2007 and 2020 papers both put Nizamuddin in the wrong city.

12.14 Later Chishtis: Chirag-i-Delhi and Salim Chishti

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Who among the following Chisti Saints is known as 'Chirag-e-Delhi'?

- (a) Muinuddin
- (b) Fariduddin
- (c) Nizamuddin Auliya
- (d) Nasiruddin

Ans. (d)

Shaikh Nasiruddin Mahmud, the chief successor of Nizamuddin Auliya, is known as **Chirag-i-Delhi**, the Lamp of Delhi. He died in 1356 in the reign of Firuz Shah Tughluq. His sayings were recorded in the Khair-ul-Majalis. After him the Chishti order in Delhi declined and spread to the provinces, including the Deccan (Gesudaraz).

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004, 2008

Q. Who among the following was given the title of 'Shaikh-ul-Hind' ?

- (a) Baba Fariduddin
- (b) Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki
- (c) Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti
- (d) Shaikh Salim Chishti

Ans. (d)

Shaikh Salim Chishti (1478 to 1572) spent many years in Arabia, where he received the title **Shaikh-ul-Hind**. He then settled at **Sikri**, about 36 km from Agra. Akbar, who had no surviving son, sought his blessing, and Prince Salim (later Jahangir) was born at Sikri in 1569 and named after the saint. Akbar then built his new capital, **Fatehpur Sikri**, around the saint's hospice.

UP link: Fatehpur Sikri is in **Agra district**. Salim Chishti's white marble tomb stands in the courtyard of the Jama Masjid, entered through the **Buland Darwaza**. The 2007 PYQ in 12.13 also tests this tomb.

TRAP ALERT

Muinuddin is popularly called **Sultan-ul-Hind** and Gharib Nawaz. Shaikh-ul-Hind is **Salim Chishti**. The two titles look alike and the distractor list in 2004 and 2008 exploits this.

12.15 Other Silsilas: Suhrawardi, Qadiri and Naqshbandi

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti	1. Suhrawardiya
B. Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi	2. Qadiriya
C. Dara Shikoh	3. Chishtiya
D. Shaikh Shahabuddin	4. Naqshbandiya

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 2 3 1 4
- (b) 1 4 2 3
- (c) 3 4 2 1
- (d) 4 2 3 1

Ans. (c)

Shaikh Shihabuddin Suhrawardi of Baghdad founded the Suhrawardi order, and his disciple Bahauddin Zakariya established it at Multan. **Dara Shikoh** was a **Qadiri**, a disciple of Mulla Shah Badakhshi in the line of Mian Mir of Lahore. He wrote the Majma-ul-Bahrain (Mingling of Two Oceans) and had the Upanishads translated into Persian as the Surr-i-Akbar. **Ahmad Sirhindi** was a Naqshbandi.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2003, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Which of the following order of Sufism was against music :

- (a) Chishtiya
- (b) Suhrawardiya
- (c) Qadiriya
- (d) Naqshbandiya

Ans. (d)

The **Naqshbandi** order was founded in Central Asia by **Khwaja Bahauddin Naqshband** (14th century) and brought to India by **Khwaja Baqi Billah** in Akbar's reign. It was the most orthodox order and opposed sama. Baqi Billah's disciple **Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (1564 to 1624), called **Mujaddid-i-Alf-i-Sani** (reformer of the second millennium), opposed Akbar's liberal religious policy and the influence of non-Muslim practices. He put forward **wahdat-ul-shuhud** against Ibn Arabi's wahdat-ul-wujud. His letters are collected as the Maktubat. The source notes that Aurangzeb was close to this order.

Silsila	Founder (abroad)	In India	Centre	Stand on state and music
Chishti	Abu Ishaq Shami, Abu Ahmad Abdal (Chisht)	Muinuddin Chishti , late 12th century	Ajmer, Delhi	Kept away from the court. Sama central
Suhrawardi	Shihabuddin Suhrawardi (Baghdad)	Bahauddin Zakariya , 13th century	Multan , Sindh, Punjab	Accepted state grants and posts. Zakariya was Iltutmish's Shaikh-ul-Islam
Firdausi	Branch of the Kubrawi order	Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri , 14th century	Maner , Bihar	Letters (Maktubat-i-Sadi)
Qadiri	Abdul Qadir Jilani (Baghdad)	15th century	Uch, later Lahore	Mian Mir, Mulla Shah, Dara Shikoh
Shattari	Shah Abdullah Shattari	15th century	Gwalior	Muhammad Ghaus . Yoga and Indian ideas (12.16)
Naqshbandi	Bahauddin Naqshband (Bukhara)	Baqi Billah , late 16th century	Delhi, Sirhind	Most orthodox. Opposed sama . Ahmad Sirhindi
Rishi	Indigenous to Kashmir	Nuruddin Rishi (Nund Rishi), 15th century	Kashmir	Influenced by Lal Ded and Kashmir Shaivism

TRAP ALERT

Shihabuddin Suhrawardi founded the order, **Bahauddin Zakariya** brought it to India. **Bahauddin Naqshband** founded the Naqshbandis. Two Bahauddins, two different orders. Check the surname before matching.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The Firdausi order of **Maner** in Bihar has not yet been asked by UPPSC, but it is the Sufi item most often tested by BPSC. A five-order match with centres (Ajmer, Multan, Maner, Gwalior, Sirhind) fits the recent match pattern.

12.16 Shattari Sufis, Hath Yoga and the Bhakti-Sufi Meeting Ground

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2003, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Which of the following Sufis regarded Krishna among the auliyas :

- (a) Shah Muhammad Ghaus
- (b) Shah Abdul Aziz
- (c) Shah Waliullah
- (d) Khwaja Mir Dard

Ans. (a)

Shah Muhammad Ghaus of Gwalior was the leading saint of the **Shattari** order in the 16th century. He was close to Humayun and is linked with the singer **Tansen**, whose tomb lies beside his own at Gwalior. The Shattaris drew Hindu and Muslim religious ideas together and accepted Krishna as a wali. The distractors are 18th century Delhi figures: **Shah Waliullah**, a Naqshbandi reformer, his son **Shah Abdul Aziz**, and the Urdu poet **Khwaja Mir Dard**.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. With reference to Hath Yoga, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Hath Yoga was practiced by Nathpanthis.
 2. Hath Yoga technique was also adopted by the Sufis.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Codes :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c)

The **Nathpanthi** yogis, founded by tradition by **Matsyendranath** and his disciple **Gorakhnath**, made Hath Yoga their core practice. Sufis adopted these breathing and posture techniques too. A Sanskrit yoga text, the *Amritakunda*, was rendered into Arabic and Persian, and Muhammad Ghaus wrote the Persian **Bahr-ul-Hayat** describing yogic practices. Both statements are correct.

UP link: the **Gorakhnath Math** at **Gorakhpur** (Gorakhpur district) is the chief centre of the Nath tradition and gives the city its name.

TRAP ALERT

Hath Yoga links the Naths and the Sufis, not the Naths and the Naqshbandis. The orthodox Naqshbandis rejected such borrowing. The Shattaris and Chishtis were the open orders.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

A second Shattari-style meeting point sits in UP. **Mir Abdul Wahid Bilgrami** of **Bilgram** (Hardoi district) wrote the **Haqaiq-i-Hindi** (1566), which reads Vaishnava terms such as Krishna, Radha and Braj in Sufi meanings. With Dara Shikoh's *Majma-ul-Bahrain* it is a likely companion to the Krishna-as-wali question.

Chapter 12: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Chishti saints: Farid, Nizamuddin, titles, dargahs	8	1994-2020	Recurring (5 PYQs + 3 one-liners)
Vedanta acharyas and their philosophies	6	1991-2022	Recurring (3 matches)
Chronology of saints, Mirabai's contemporaries	4	1995-2025	Recurring, recent
Chishti order: founding, Muinuddin at Ajmer	4	2002-2014	Recurring (one-liners)
Eastern Vaishnavism: Chaitanya, Shankaradeva	4	1990-2015	Recurring
Kabir and guru-disciple pairs	3	2002-2025	Recurring, recent
Sufi terms, sama, who was a Sufi	3	1998-2018	Occasional
Origins: Alvars and the northern revival	2	1993-2001	Occasional, older
Ramananda: birthplace and dictum	2	2009-2010	Occasional
Namdev, Varkaris, nirguna and saguna	2	2002-2010	Occasional
Tulsidas: birthplace, wife, contemporaries	2	2004-2023	Occasional, recent
Bhakti literature and UP saint-poets	2	2008-2018	Occasional
Later Chishtis: Chirag-i-Delhi, Salim Chishti	2	2004-2017	Occasional
Other silsilas: Suhrawardi, Qadiri, Naqshbandi	2	2002-2013	Recurring (Naqshbandi asked in 3 papers)
Shattari Sufis and Hath Yoga	2	2002-2019	Occasional
Guru Nanak and the Sikh Gurus	1	2023	Emerging

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 49 items (40 PYQs + 9 starred one-liners, one of them a List match). The Sufi half (21 items) is led by the Chishti chain: who taught whom, which saint bears which title, and where each dargah stands. The Bhakti half (28 items) rests on three tables: acharya to philosophy (12.2), the saints' chronology (12.5) and the North Indian saints table (12.4). Recent papers (2022 to 2025) prefer matches and order questions, such as the 2022 philosophy match, the 2025 chronology and the 2025 disciple-teacher match, along with district-sensitive statements like Tulsidas at Rajapur. One item carries a Note: Mirabai's contemporaries, keyed (*). Revise the Chishti table in 12.12 and the title table in 12.13 first.

Chapter 13

Mughal Dynasty: Babur

Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur (ruled in India 1526 to 1530) founded the Mughal Empire. He was a Chaghtai Turk who descended from Timur on his father's side and from Chingiz Khan on his mother's side. He lost Farghana and Samarqand to the Uzbeks, built a base at Kabul, and then turned to Hindustan. Four battles in four years (Panipat 1526, Khanwa 1527, Chanderi 1528, Ghaghra 1529) gave him North India. He recorded his life in the Baburnama, written in Chaghtai Turkish. This chapter covers his ancestry and early career, the First Battle of Panipat and its tactics, the Rajput and Afghan wars, the Baburnama, and the Babri mosque question. It contains **12 PYQs and 3 one-liners**. Panipat alone accounts for 5 items.

13.1 Ancestry and Early Career: Farghana, Samarqand and Kabul

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010

Q. The Mughal rulers of medieval India were -

- (a) Persian (Iranian)
- (b) Afghans
- (c) Chagatai Turk
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (c)

Babur was born in 1483 at Andijan in **Farghana** (in the Fergana valley of present-day Uzbekistan). His father, Umar Shaikh Mirza, was a fifth-generation descendant of **Timur**. His mother, Qutlugh Nigar Khanum, descended from **Chingiz Khan** through his second son **Chaghtai**, whose line ruled Central Asia and Turkistan. The family were Turks of the **Chaghtai** branch and called themselves Timurids. The name "Mughal" comes from the Persian word for Mongol and was applied by others. So the Mughals were neither Persians nor Afghans. Persian was their court language, which explains the Persian distractor.

TRAP ALERT

Do not mark "Mongol" or "Persian" for the dynasty's origin. The keyed answer is **Chaghtai Turk**. The Afghans (Lodis, Surs) were the Mughals' rivals.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2015

Q. Who among the following defeated Babur in the Battle of Sar-e-Pul?

- (a) Abdullah Khan Uzbek
- (b) Shaibani Khan
- (c) Ubaydullah Khan
- (d) Jani Begh

Ans. (b)

Babur inherited Farghana in 1494 at the age of eleven. He took **Samarqand**, Timur's old capital, more than once but could not hold it. In 1501 the Uzbek chief **Shaibani Khan** defeated him at **Sar-e-Pul** and drove him out of Samarqand. The source notes that Shaibani used the Uzbek flanking tactic, **tulughma**, in this battle. Babur learnt from the defeat and used the same tactic at Panipat in 1526. **Abdullah Khan Uzbek** is a later Uzbek ruler of Akbar's time, which makes him the period trap.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. Babur adopted the title of 'Padshah' first at -

- (a) Ferghana
- (b) Kabul
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Samarqand

Ans. (b)

Having lost both Samarqand and Farghana, Babur captured **Kabul** in 1504. Around 1507, at Kabul, he dropped the family title **Mirza** and took the title **Padshah** to raise the standing of his house and the morale of his followers. After Panipat he proclaimed himself Padshah of Hindustan (April 1526), but the title was first adopted at Kabul.

Year	Event in Babur's early career
1483	Born at Andijan, Farghana
1494	Becomes ruler of Farghana on his father's death
1501	Defeated by Shaibani Khan at Sar-e-Pul . Samarqand lost
1504	Captures Kabul
c. 1507	Adopts the title Padshah at Kabul
1519	First expedition into India. Takes Bajaur and Bhera, where he records his first use of firearms
1526	First Battle of Panipat. Mughal rule in India begins

13.2 The Invitation and the First Battle of Panipat (1526)

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. During the annexation of Afghanistan, who invited Babur to invade India?

- (a) Ustad Ali
- (b) Mustafa
- (c) Daulat Khan
- (d) Hasan Khan

Ans. (c)

Daulat Khan Lodi, governor of Punjab, had fallen out with Sultan **Ibrahim Lodi**. He sent envoys to Babur at Kabul, along with **Alam Khan Lodi**, Ibrahim's uncle and a rival claimant. Daulat Khan expected Babur to plunder and leave, weakening Ibrahim and leaving Punjab to him. Babur says he set out for Hindustan **five times**, starting with Bajaur and Bhera in 1519. The fifth expedition (1525 to 1526) ended at Panipat. The distractors **Ustad Ali** and **Mustafa** were Babur's own gunners, and **Hasan Khan** recalls Hasan Khan Mewati, who fought against Babur at Khanwa.

Babur also claims that **Rana Sanga** of Mewar sent him an offer of joint action against Ibrahim. Sanga's side never confirmed this (13.4).

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1996, U. P. C. S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. The First Battle of Panipat was fought between -

- (a) Babur and Rana Sanga
- (b) Hemu and Mughals
- (c) Humayun and Sher Khan
- (d) Babur and Ibrahim Lodi

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. In which year, did Babur defeat Sultan Ibrahim Lodi at the battle of Panipat?

Ans. 1526 A.D.

The battle was fought on **21 April 1526** at Panipat (now Panipat district, Haryana). Babur estimated Ibrahim's army at about one lakh men and a thousand elephants, far larger than his own. Ibrahim was killed on the field, the only Delhi Sultan to die in battle, and his tomb stands at Panipat. Babur took Delhi and Agra and proclaimed himself **Padshah** of Hindustan. The options test the three battles of Panipat and the other early Mughal wars.

Battle of Panipat	Year	Victor vs Defeated
First	1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi
Second	1556	Akbar (under Bairam Khan) vs Hemu
Third	1761	Ahmad Shah Abdali vs the Marathas

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. The reason for Babur's victory over Ibrahim Lodi was-

- (a) Bravery of Babur
- (b) Artillery
- (c) Weakness of Ibrahim
- (d) Skilled commandant

Ans. (d)

Note: the source key is (d), skilled generalship. Several other guides key (b) artillery for this question. Historians usually credit the win to Babur's generalship in combining tulughma, the Rumi cart line and his guns, so the artillery was one tool of that generalship. Follow the source key for UPPSC.

Babur's plan at Panipat combined three elements. Each was useful only because of how he arranged them, which is why the source credits his **generalship**.

Element	What it was	Role at Panipat
Rumi (Ottoman) device	A line of carts (araba) bound together with ropes of raw hide, with gaps and breastworks for gunners	Anchored the front. One flank rested on the town of Panipat, the other on ditches and felled trees
Tulughma	Uzbek tactic: small flanking parties wheel round the enemy's sides and rear	Ibrahim's army was pressed into a crowd in the centre and shot at from all sides
Artillery and matchlocks	Guns under Ustad Ali Quli , matchlockmen under Mustafa	Fired from behind the carts. The noise also panicked Ibrahim's elephants

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1996

Q. At which of the following battles was artillery used for the first time by one of the two armies?

- (a) First Battle of Panipat
- (b) Battle of Khanwa
- (c) Battle of Plassey
- (d) Third Battle of Panipat

Ans. (a)

Among the four options the First Battle of Panipat is the earliest, and Babur's field artillery there is the standard answer. Babur himself records using guns earlier, at **Bajaur** in 1519 (now in Pakistan), and he is generally credited with bringing field artillery into North Indian warfare. Khanwa (1527) came a year after Panipat, and Plassey (1757)

and the Third Panipat (1761) are much later.

TRAP ALERT

"First use of artillery in India" is keyed to **First Panipat** only because Bajaur is not among the options. If Bajaur 1519 appears as an option, it is the earlier use recorded by Babur.

13.3 Khanwa, Chanderi and Ghaghra: Rajputs and Afghans (1527 to 1529)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. During which one of the following battles, did Babur declare 'Jihad'?

- (a) Battle of Panipat
- (b) Battle of Khanwa
- (c) Battle of Chanderi
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (b)

Rana Sanga (Sangram Singh) of Mewar led a large Rajput coalition, joined by **Hasan Khan Mewati** and Ibrahim's brother Mahmud Lodi. Babur's troops were shaken by reports of Sanga's strength. To rally them Babur declared the war a **jihad**, renounced wine and broke his drinking vessels, and remitted the **tamgha** (a trade toll) for Muslims. He won at **Khanwa** on 17 March 1527, using the same cart line and flanking tactics as at Panipat, and took the title **Ghazi**. Khanwa lies near Fatehpur Sikri, in present Bharatpur district of Rajasthan. The source adds that some scholars say he proclaimed jihad at Chanderi too, but the standard answer is Khanwa.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010

Q. In which battle, Rana Sanga fought against Babur?

Ans. Battle of Khanwa

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004

Q. The ruler of Mewar who was defeated in the Battle of Khanwa by Babur in 1527 was

Ans. Rana Sanga

TRAP ALERT

Panipat (1526) was against a Muslim Sultan and carried no jihad declaration. **Jihad and the title Ghazi** belong to **Khanwa** (1527).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2015

Q. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- (a) First Battle of Panipat:1526
- (b) Battle of Khanwa:1527
- (c) Battle of Ghaghra:1529
- (d) Battle of Chanderi:1530

Ans. (d)

Babur fought one major battle a year from 1526 to 1529. **Chanderi** fell in January 1528, not 1530. Its Rajput chief **Medini Rai**, an ally of Sanga, was defeated and the women of the fort performed jauhar. At the **Ghaghra** (6 May 1529) Babur defeated the eastern Afghans under Mahmud Lodi, backed by Sultan Nusrat Shah of Bengal. 1530 is the year of Babur's death.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Sar-e-Pul	1501	Shaibani Khan (Uzbek) vs Babur	Babur loses Samarqand. Sees tulughma used against him

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
First Panipat	21 April 1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	End of the Lodi Sultanate. Mughal rule begins
Khanwa	17 March 1527	Babur vs Rana Sanga (with Hasan Khan Mewati, Mahmud Lodi)	Rajput challenge broken. Jihad declared. Title Ghazi
Chanderi	January 1528	Babur vs Medini Rai	Malwa frontier secured. Jauhar at the fort
Ghaghra	6 May 1529	Babur vs Afghans under Mahmud Lodi , with Nusrat Shah of Bengal	Afghan threat in the east checked. Babur's last major battle

Places today: Panipat in Haryana, Khanwa in Rajasthan (Bharatpur), Chanderi in Madhya Pradesh (Ashoknagar). The Ghaghra battle was fought near the river's junction with the Ganga, in present-day **Bihar** (Saran area). The Ghaghra river flows through eastern UP, but the battlefield is not in UP.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Year-to-battle pairs have been asked once (2015) and battle-to-opponent items three times. A sequence question on Panipat, Khanwa, Chanderi and Ghaghra, or a pair such as Chanderi to Medini Rai, fits the same pattern.

13.4 The Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Babur wrote Tuzk-e-Babri in Chagatai Turki.

Reason (R): Turki was the official language of the Mughal Court.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Ans. (c)

Babur's memoir, the **Baburnama** (also called **Tuzuk-i-Baburi** or **Waqiat-i-Baburi**), was written in his mother tongue, **Chaghtai Turkish**. So (A) is true. The language of the Mughal court and revenue records was **Persian**, so (R) is false. Under **Akbar** the memoir was translated into Persian by **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana** (1589), and this Persian version circulated widely and was illustrated in the imperial studio. Babur also wrote Turki poetry, collected in his **Diwan**.

Work	Author	Language	Note
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	Babur	Chaghtai Turkish	Autobiography. Covers Farghana, Kabul and Hindustan with gaps
Persian translation of the Baburnama	Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana	Persian	Made under Akbar (1589)
Humayun-nama	Gulbadan Begum (Babur's daughter)	Persian	Life of Babur and Humayun (Chapter 14)

Work	Author	Language	Note
Tarikh-i-Rashidi	Mirza Haidar Dughlat (Babur's cousin)	Persian	History of the Mughals of Central Asia

TRAP ALERT

Assertion-Reason trap: Babur **wrote in Turki**, but the court language of the Mughals was **Persian**. Both halves sound Turkic, only one is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Which Hindu State has been mentioned by Babur in his Baburnama :

- (a) Orissa
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Mewar
- (d) Kashmir

Ans. (c)

Babur says that when he came, Hindustan had **five Muslim kings** (the Afghans of Delhi, and the rulers of Gujarat, the Bahmani Deccan, Malwa and Bengal) and **two non-Muslim (pagan) powers**, **Vijayanagara** and **Mewar** under Rana Sanga. He records that Sanga had sent him word at Kabul offering to attack Agra while Babur marched on Delhi. Gujarat was a Muslim sultanate, Kashmir too was under Muslim rulers, and Orissa is not in his list of the seven powers.

Babur's view of Hindustan is often quoted. He found it a country of few charms, with no good horses, grapes, musk melons, cold water, baths or colleges. He admired its wealth of gold and silver, its large population and its workmen of every craft. He also laid out gardens in the Persian **charbagh** style.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The Baburnama has been asked for its language (2025) and its account of Indian powers (1995). The Persian translator **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana** and the second named Hindu power, **Vijayanagara**, are the adjacent facts.

13.5 Babur's Last Years, Death, and the Babri Mosque

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Who built the Babri mosque established in Ayodhya?

- (a) Babur
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Nizam-ul-Mulk
- (d) Mir Baqi

Ans. (d)

Inscriptions on the mosque recorded that it was built in AH 935 (1528 to 1529) by **Mir Baqi**, a noble of Babur, which is why it carried Babur's name. Babur himself is not the builder in the exam sense. The structure was demolished on 6 December 1992. In the title suit, a five-judge bench of the Supreme Court, in its verdict of **9 November 2019**, awarded the disputed site to a trust to be set up by the Central Government for building a temple, and directed that 5 acres of alternative land in Ayodhya be given to the Sunni Central Waqf Board for a mosque.

UP link: Ayodhya is in Ayodhya district, renamed from Faizabad district in 2018.

Babur ruled India for only four years. He made **Agra** his base and laid out gardens on the Yamuna there. In 1530 Humayun fell gravely ill at Sambhal. Gulbadan Begum records that Babur walked round his son's bed praying to take on the illness. Humayun recovered, and Babur died at **Agra** on 26 December 1530. He was first buried at the Aram Bagh in Agra, and his remains were later taken to **Kabul**, as he had wished, where his grave stands in the **Bagh-e-Babur**.

UP link: **Agra** (Agra district) was Babur's capital and place of death, and the Aram Bagh (Ram Bagh) there is counted among the earliest Mughal gardens. **Sambhal** (Sambhal district) was the jagir where Humayun fell ill.

TRAP ALERT

Babur **died at Agra** but is **buried at Kabul**. Humayun is buried in Delhi, Akbar at Sikandra (Agra), Jahangir at Shahdara (Lahore), Aurangzeb at Khuldabad.

Chapter 13: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Invitation and First Battle of Panipat (date, tactics, artillery)	5	1990-2021	Recurring
Khanwa, Chanderi and Ghaghra	4	2004-2015	Recurring (Khanwa asked 3 times)
Ancestry and early career (Chaghtai, Sar-e-Pul, Padshah at Kabul)	3	2010-2015	Steady
Baburnama (language, Hindu powers)	2	1995-2025	Revived (2025 A-R question)
Babri mosque	1	1992	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (12 PYQs + 3 one-liners). Daulat Khan's invitation and the four battles of 1526 to 1529 give 9 items, so the battle table in 13.3 is the core revision tool. Panipat is tested for its date, opponents, tactics and artillery, and Khanwa for Rana Sanga, jihad and the title Ghazi. The 2015 to 2025 papers moved to less obvious facts (Sar-e-Pul, Padshah at Kabul, Daulat Khan's invitation, the Turki language of the Baburnama). One item carries a Note: the 1990 question on the reason for Babur's victory, where other guides key artillery.

Chapter 14

Humayun and Sher Shah

Humayun (1530 to 1540 and 1555 to 1556) inherited an empire that was not yet consolidated. He faced rival brothers, Bahadur Shah of Gujarat and, above all, the Afghan Sher Khan of Bihar. Defeated at Chausa (1539) and Kannauj (1540), he spent fifteen years in exile before regaining Delhi in 1555. In the interval Sher Shah Suri (1540 to 1545) built an administration of roads, sarais, coinage and land measurement that Akbar later extended. This chapter covers Humayun's family, his battles with the Afghans, Sher Shah's rise, death and tomb, the Purana Qila, and Sher Shah's revenue and currency reforms. It contains **12 PYQs and 3 one-liners**. Sher Shah accounts for 11 of the 15 items.

14.1 Humayun's Family: Brothers, Wife and Sister

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Iltutmish - Father of Razia
- (b) Gulbadan Begum - Daughter of Babur
- (c) Hamida Banu Begum - Wife of Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Shah Turkan - Wife of Iltutmish

Ans. (c)

Hamida Banu Begum married Humayun in 1541, during his flight through Sindh, and was the mother of **Akbar**. She had no link with Alauddin Khalji. The other three pairs are correct. **Gulbadan Begum**, Babur's daughter and Humayun's half-sister, wrote the **Humayun-nama** at Akbar's request. **Shah Turkan**, a wife of Iltutmish, was the mother of Ruknuddin Firuz and controlled the court during his brief reign before Razia took the throne.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2008

Q. From the following names identify the one who was not the brother of Humayun.

- (a) Kamran
- (b) Usman
- (c) Askari
- (d) Hindal

Ans. (b)

Humayun, born at Kabul in 1508, was Babur's eldest son. Following the Timurid custom of sharing territory among sons, he left his three brothers large charges. **Kamran** held Kabul and Kandahar and took Punjab, which cut Humayun off from the recruiting grounds of Afghanistan. **Askari** received Sambhal and **Hindal** Alwar and Mewat. All three later wavered or turned against him during his struggle with Sher Khan. "Usman" was not a son of Babur.

UP link: **Sambhal** (Sambhal district), earlier Humayun's own jagir, went to Askari.

14.2 Humayun and the Afghans: Daurah, Chausa, Kannauj and the Return

U.P.B.E.O. (PRE) 2019

Q. Which of the following two rulers fought the battle near Kannauj of 17th May, 1540?

- (a) Humayun and Sultan Mohammad Nuhani
- (b) Sher Shah and Humayun
- (c) Sher Shah and Mirza Kamran
- (d) Mohammad Shah and Humayun

Ans. (b)

After the defeat at **Chausa** (26 June 1539, on the Ganga in present Buxar district, Bihar), Humayun raised a fresh army. Sher Khan, who had crowned himself **Sher Shah** after Chausa, met him on the Ganga near **Kannauj** on **17 May 1540**. The battle is also called the battle of **Bilgram**, after the village on the opposite bank. Humayun was routed, lost Agra and Delhi and went into exile. **Sultan Muhammad Nuhani** (Bahar Khan Lohani) of Bihar was Sher Khan's early master, who gave him the title Sher Khan for killing a tiger. Kamran never fought Sher Shah in a pitched battle.

UP link: Kannauj (Kannauj district) and Bilgram (Hardoi district) face each other across the Ganga.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order

- I. Battle of Daurah
- II. Battle of Kanauj
- III. Battle of Samugarh
- IV. Battle of Chausa

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) II, III, I, IV
- (b) I, IV, II, III
- (c) I, II, IV, III
- (d) II, I, IV, III

Ans. (b)

At **Daurah** (Dadrah) in 1532 Humayun defeated the eastern Afghans under Mahmud Lodi. Chausa (1539) and Kannauj (1540) followed. **Samugarh** (1658) belongs to the war of succession among Shah Jahan's sons, where Aurangzeb and Murad defeated Dara Shikoh. Daurah is the only Humayun victory in the list, which is why the source cites it to show that Sher Shah's side also lost battles.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Daurah (Dadrah)	1532	Humayun vs Afghans under Mahmud Lodi	Early success in the east
Chausa	26 June 1539	Sher Khan vs Humayun	Surprise attack. Sher Khan takes the title Sher Shah
Kannauj (Bilgram)	17 May 1540	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Humayun loses the empire and goes into exile
Sammel (Giri-Sumel)	1544	Sher Shah vs Maldeo of Marwar (Jaita and Kumpa)	Hard-won victory (14.3)
Kalinjar	1545	Siege by Sher Shah	Sher Shah dies in an explosion (14.4)
Machhiwara and Sirhind	1555	Humayun vs Sikandar Sur	Mughal restoration. Delhi regained

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Second Panipat	1556	Akbar (under Bairam Khan) vs Hemu	Mughal rule secured
Samugarh	1658	Aurangzeb and Murad vs Dara Shikoh	War of succession under Shah Jahan

Exile and return. Humayun fled through Sindh. Akbar was born at **Umarkot** in 1542. Humayun took refuge with **Shah Tahmasp** of Persia and with Persian help took Kandahar and Kabul from his brothers (1545). The Sur empire split after Islam Shah's death (1553), and Humayun reoccupied Lahore, defeated **Sikandar Sur** at **Sirhind** (1555) and re-entered Delhi. In January 1556 he fell from the stairs of the **Sher Mandal**, which he used as a library in the Purana Qila (Din-panah), and died. Lane-Poole wrote that he "tumbled through life and tumbled out of it".

Monument or work	Builder or author	Note
Humayun's Tomb, Delhi	Commissioned by his widow Bega Begum (Haji Begum)	Persian architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas . Completed about 1570. First garden tomb on the subcontinent. UNESCO World Heritage Site (1993)
Humayun-nama	Gulbadan Begum	Written at Akbar's request
Tazkirat-ul-Waqiat	Jauhar Aftabchi (Humayun's ewer-bearer)	Eyewitness memoir of Humayun
Qanun-i-Humayuni	Khwandamir	Humayun's court and institutions
Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi (Tuhfa-i-Akbar Shahi)	Abbas Khan Sarwani	Main source on Sher Shah. Written under Akbar

TRAP ALERT

Chausa (1539) came before **Kannauj** (1540). Humayun was defeated at both but went into exile only after Kannauj. Daurah (1532) was a Humayun victory.

14.3 Sher Shah's Rise: Education, Chunar and the Marwar Campaign

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which one of the following medieval era rulers mentioned below was highly educated ?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Ibrahim Lodi
- (d) Sher Shah

Ans. (d)

Sher Shah was born **Farid**, son of Hasan Khan Sur, who held the jagir of **Sasaram** in Bihar. After quarrels at home Farid went to **Jaunpur**, then a major centre of learning, and studied Arabic and Persian literature and history there. He later managed his father's parganas, which taught him revenue work at the village level. He entered the service of Bahar Khan Lohani (Sultan Muhammad Nuhani) of Bihar, who named him **Sher Khan**. He gained the fort of **Chunar** by marrying Lad Malika, widow of its governor, and with it a treasure that funded his rise. Alauddin Khalji, by contrast, was not formally educated.

UP link: **Jaunpur** (Jaunpur district), where Farid studied, and **Chunar** fort (Mirzapur district), his early base, which Humayun

besieged in 1532 and took in 1538.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. From which place were Jaita and Kumpa associated who impressed Sher Shah with their valour?

- (a) Malwa
- (b) Mewar
- (c) Bundelkhand
- (d) Marwar

Ans. (d)

In 1544 Sher Shah marched against **Maldeo**, the Rathore ruler of **Marwar**. Maldeo withdrew, reportedly after letters planted by Sher Shah made him doubt his own commanders. **Jaita and Kumpa** stayed and attacked with a small Rajput force at Sammel (Giri-Sumel) and nearly won. Sher Shah then remarked that he had almost lost the empire of Hindustan for a handful of millet (bajra), a reference to the poor, dry land of Marwar.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. With which medieval ruler would you associate the statement 'I would have lost the empire just for a handful of millet' ?

Ans. Sher Shah

TRAP ALERT

Jaita and Kumpa are from **Marwar** (Rathores), not Mewar (Sisodias). The two names differ by one letter, which is the trap.

14.4 Death at Kalinjar and the Tomb at Sasaram

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015, U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. Sher Shah was buried at -

- (a) Kalinjar
- (b) Sasaram
- (c) Jaunpur
- (d) Patna

Ans. (b)

Sher Shah's last campaign was the siege of **Kalinjar** fort in 1545. A gunpowder shell fired at the walls rebounded and set off an explosion near him, and he died of his burns in May 1545. He was buried at **Sasaram** (Rohtas district, Bihar) in an octagonal tomb that rises from an artificial lake, a high point of Afghan (Sur) architecture. His son Jalal Khan succeeded as **Islam Shah** (1545 to 1553).

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1993

Q. Death of Sher Shah Suri occurred in

Ans. Kalinjar

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Last expedition of Sher Shah Suri was against which State?

Ans. Kalinjar

UP link: **Kalinjar** fort stands in **Banda** district of Bundelkhand.

TRAP ALERT

Died at **Kalinjar** (UP), buried at **Sasaram** (Bihar). Both appear as options together. Jaunpur is where he studied.

14.5 The Purana Qila: Din-panah and Shergarh

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2016, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2009

Q. Who amongst the following got 'Purana Qila' of Delhi built in the present form?

- (a) Sher Shah Suri
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Babur
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (a)

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Who built the mosque "Qila-i-Kuhna" inside Purana Qila of Delhi

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Sher Shah
- (c) Akbar
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (b)

Humayun founded the city of **Din-panah** on the Yamuna in 1533. After 1540 Sher Shah rebuilt the citadel as his own fort, often called Shergarh, and gave the **Purana Qila** its present walls and gates. Inside it he built the **Qila-i-Kuhna mosque** and the octagonal **Sher Mandal**. When Humayun returned in 1555 he used the Sher Mandal as his library and died after falling from its stairs.

Monument	Builder	Place
Din-panah (city)	Humayun	Delhi
Purana Qila (present form)	Sher Shah	Delhi
Qila-i-Kuhna mosque, Sher Mandal	Sher Shah	Purana Qila, Delhi
Sher Shah's tomb	Sher Shah (completed under Islam Shah)	Sasaram, Bihar
Rohtas fort	Sher Shah	Near Jhelum, Pakistan
Humayun's Tomb	Bega Begum (Haji Begum)	Delhi

TRAP ALERT

Humayun founded **Din-panah**, but the Purana Qila as it stands and the **Qila-i-Kuhna mosque** are **Sher Shah's**. The 2021 question offered Humayun to catch this.

14.6 Sher Shah's Administration: Revenue, Coinage and Roads

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. With reference to Sher Shah Suri, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He was the architect of a brilliant administrative system.
2. However his qualities as a ruler were not more remarkable than his victories on the field of battle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a)

Sher Shah ruled for only five years, yet his reforms in revenue, currency, roads, the army and justice are why he is called the forerunner of Akbar. Statement 2 reverses the usual judgement. His record in war was mixed (Daurah was lost by the Afghans, and Marwar was won partly through a ruse), while his administration had a lasting effect. He also enforced the branding of horses (**dagh**), first introduced by Alauddin Khalji, and kept descriptive rolls of soldiers (**chehra**).

Level	Officers under Sher Shah
Sarkar (district)	Shiqdar-i-shiqdaran (law and order, army) and munsif-i-munsifan (revenue and civil cases)
Pargana	Shiqdar , amin or munsif (land measurement and revenue), fotedar (treasurer), two karkuns (clerks writing in Hindi and Persian)
Village	Muqaddam (headman), held responsible for crimes in his village, and patwari

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2008, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009, U. P. C. S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2004

Q. Which medieval ruler introduced the system of "patta" and "qabuliyat" to help the peasants ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Muhammad-bin-Tughluq
- (c) Sher Shah
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (c)

Sher Shah had cultivated land **measured** and fixed the state's share at **one-third** of the average produce. Land was graded good, middling and poor, and a schedule of crop rates, the **ray**, set the demand for each crop. Each peasant received a **patta** stating the area, the crops and the revenue due. The peasant signed a **qabuliyat** accepting it. This fixed the peasant's liability in writing and limited extortion by officials. **Todar Mal** served under Sher Shah before joining Akbar, and Akbar's **zabt** system built on these foundations (Chapter 15).

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Patta	Title deed given to the peasant stating land and revenue due	Sher Shah
Qabuliyat	Deed of acceptance signed by the peasant	Sher Shah
Ray	Schedule of crop rates for the state's share	Sher Shah
Jarib	Measuring rod or chain for land survey	Sher Shah, later Akbar
Jaribana and muhasilana	Fees paid by peasants to the surveyor and the tax collector	Sher Shah
Rupiya	Silver coin of 178 grains	Sher Shah
Dam	Copper coin of 380 grains	Sher Shah
Dagh and chehra	Branding of horses and descriptive roll of soldiers	Alauddin first, enforced by Sher Shah
Sarak-e-Azam	Great highway across North India (later Grand Trunk Road)	Sher Shah
Sarai	Rest house on highways, also a post station	Sher Shah

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2006

Q. What was the exchange rate of silver's rupiya ?

- (a) 16:1
- (b) 32:1
- (c) 48:1
- (d) 64:1

Ans. (d)

Sher Shah replaced worn and debased coins with pure ones in gold, silver and copper. His silver **rupiya** (178 grains) became the base of later Indian currency, and the copper **dam** weighed 380 grains. The source gives the exchange as **64 dams to one rupiya**. Sher Shah also built the **Sarak-e-Azam** from Sonargaon in Bengal across North India to Punjab, with other roads from Agra to Burhanpur, from Agra to Jodhpur and Chittor, and from Lahore to Multan. About 1,700 **sarais** lined the roads, with separate quarters for Hindus and Muslims, and served as posts for the horse mail (dak).

TRAP ALERT

Rupiya to dam was **1:64 under Sher Shah** but **1:40 under Akbar** (Ain-i-Akbari). If a question names Akbar, use 40.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Sher Shah's reforms have been asked as patta and qabuliyat (3 papers), the rupiya rate and a statement question. The ray, the Sarak-e-Azam and the shiqdar and munsif officers are the next items in the same set.

Chapter 14: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Sher Shah's administration, revenue and coinage	3	2004-2021	Recurring (patta and qabuliyat in 3 papers)
Sher Shah's education and Marwar campaign	3	2007-2022	Recurring
Sher Shah's death at Kalinjar and tomb at Sasaram	3	1993-2016	Recurring
Purana Qila and Qila-i-Kuhna mosque	2	2009-2021	Recurring
Humayun's family (brothers, wife, sister)	2	2008-2023	Steady
Humayun's battles with the Afghans	2	2017-2019	Recent

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (12 PYQs + 3 one-liners). Sher Shah dominates with 11 items, against 4 on Humayun. The Sher Shah questions fall into three groups: places (Jaunpur, Marwar, Kalinjar, Sasaram, Purana Qila), quotations (the handful of millet) and administration (patta, qabuliyat, rupiya). Humayun is tested through his family and the order of battles. No answer-key changes were needed in this chapter. The places table in 14.5 and the term table in 14.6 cover most of what has been asked.

Chapter 15

Akbar

Akbar (born 1542 at Amarkot, reigned 1556 to 1605) turned the Mughal hold on north India into a lasting empire. He came to the throne at thirteen under the regency of Bairam Khan, won the Second Battle of Panipat (1556), and then expanded the empire from Kabul and Kashmir to the Deccan. His Rajput alliances, the mansabdari system, Todar Mal's dahsala revenue settlement and the religious policy of sulh-i-kul became the base for his successors. This chapter covers the regency and the early nobles, the conquests, Rajput policy and Haldighati, the religious chronology from the abolition of jizya to Tauhid-i-Ilahi, social reforms, the army and the diwan, Todar Mal, the court scholars and translations, Fatehpur Sikri and Akbar's forts, and Akbar in world context. It contains **28 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. Administration in detail is in Chapter 19.

15.1 Accession, Bairam Khan's Regency and the Early Nobles

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024

Q. Consider the following statements with reference to Bairam Khan:

1. Akbar gave the title of Khan-i-Khana to Bairam Khan.
2. This title was not given at the time of appointment of Bairam Khan as Wazir of Empire.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Both 1 and 2
- (b) Neither 1 nor 2
- (c) Only 1
- (d) Only 2

Ans. (c)

Humayun died in January 1556. **Akbar** was enthroned at **Kalanaur** (Punjab) on 14 February 1556 with **Bairam Khan**, his guardian, as regent. Akbar made him **vakil** (the source calls the post Wazir of the Empire) and gave him the title **Khan-i-Khanan** with that appointment. So statement 1 is true and statement 2 is false. Bairam Khan's great service was the **Second Battle of Panipat** against Hemu.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Tughlaqabad (Delhi)	October 1556	Hemu vs Tardi Beg (Mughal governor of Delhi)	Hemu took Delhi and the title Vikramaditya. Tardi Beg fled and was executed by Bairam Khan
Second Panipat	5 November 1556	Akbar and Bairam Khan vs Hemu (general of Adil Shah Sur)	Hemu was struck in the eye by an arrow, captured and executed. Ended the Sur bid to recover north India
Haldighati	1576	Mughals (Man Singh, Asaf Khan) vs Maharana Pratap	See 15.4
Tukaroi	1575	Mughals vs Daud Khan Karrani	Opened Bengal and Bihar. See 15.2

TRAP ALERT

The title **Khan-i-Khanan** had three famous holders under Akbar: **Bairam Khan** (1556), **Munim Khan** (after Bairam's fall in 1560) and Bairam's son **Abdur Rahim** (1584, after the Gujarat campaign). Do not credit Abdur Rahim's title to his father or the reverse.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2010

Q. Who among the following was personally killed by Akbar?

- (a) Adham Khan
- (b) Bairam Khan
- (c) Baz Bahadur
- (d) Pir Muhammad Khan

Ans. (a)

Akbar dismissed Bairam Khan in 1560 and sent him towards Mecca. Bairam was killed at **Patan** (Gujarat) in 1561 by an Afghan with a personal grudge, not by Akbar. The years that followed, commonly dated 1560 to 1562, are called the **petticoat government** (V.A. Smith's term) because the harem party led by Akbar's wet nurse **Maham Anaga** and her son **Adham Khan** dominated the court. In 1562 Adham Khan stabbed the chief minister **Shamsuddin Ataga Khan**. Akbar struck him down and had him thrown from the terrace of the palace at **Agra**. Maham Anaga died soon after, and Akbar ruled in his own right from then on.

UP link: Adham Khan's death took place in the palace at **Agra** (Agra district), Akbar's capital before Fatehpur Sikri.

TRAP ALERT

Baz Bahadur of Malwa lost his kingdom to Adham Khan and Pir Muhammad in 1561 and later joined Mughal service. **Pir Muhammad Khan** drowned in the Narmada in 1562 while fleeing. Only Adham Khan died at Akbar's own hand.

15.2 Conquests: The Chronology of Expansion

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Consider the following events and arrange them into chronological order -

1. Akbar marries the Princess of Amber
2. Battle of Tukaroi
3. Mughal invasion of Malwa
4. Karrani's conquest of Orissa

Select the correct answer using the code given below :
Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- (b) 2, 1, 4 and 3
- (c) 2, 4, 3 and 1
- (d) 3, 1, 4 and 2

Ans. (d)

Malwa (1561) came first, then the Amber marriage (early 1562). **Sulaiman Karrani**, the Afghan ruler of Bengal, conquered Orissa in 1568. His son **Daud Khan Karrani** was defeated by Munim Khan and Todar Mal at **Tukaroi** in 1575 and killed after the battle of Rajmahal in 1576. Order: 3, 1, 4, 2. The table below is the full sequence of Akbar's conquests.

Year	Region	Opponent and key fact
1561	Malwa	Baz Bahadur. Campaign led by Adham Khan and Pir Muhammad

Year	Region	Opponent and key fact
1564	Garha-Katanga (Gondwana)	Rani Durgavati , regent for her son Vir Narayan. Defeated by Asaf Khan. She took her own life rather than be captured
1568	Chittor (Mewar)	Rana Udai Singh withdrew to the hills. Jaimal and Patta held the fort until February 1568
1569	Ranthambore	Surjan Hada surrendered
1569	Kalinjar	Raja Ramchand of Rewa surrendered the fort
1572 to 1573	Gujarat	Muzaffar Shah III. In 1573 Akbar made a famous rapid march to crush a revolt. First contact with the Portuguese
1574 to 1576	Bihar and Bengal	Daud Khan Karrani. Tukaroi 1575, Rajmahal 1576
1581	Kabul campaign	Half-brother Mirza Hakim submitted. Kabul annexed after his death (1585)
1586	Kashmir	Yusuf Shah Chak
1591	Sindh (Thatta)	Mirza Jani Beg. Campaign led by Abdur Rahim
1592	Orissa	Man Singh
1595	Baluchistan, Kandahar	North-west frontier secured
1596 to 1600	Berar, Ahmednagar	Chand Bibi defended Ahmednagar in 1595 to 1596. Ahmednagar fort taken 1600
1601	Asirgarh (Khandesh)	Akbar's last conquest

UP link: Kalinjar fort (Banda district) fell to Akbar in 1569. Sher Shah had died besieging the same fort in 1545.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Two chronology PYQs (2021 here and 2024 in 15.10) show UPPSC now sets order questions on Akbar's reign. Pairs worth fixing: Malwa 1561 before Garha-Katanga 1564, Chittor 1568 before Ranthambore and Kalinjar 1569, Gujarat 1572 to 1573 before Tukaroi 1575, Kashmir 1586 before Sindh 1591, Asirgarh 1601 last.

15.3 Rajput Policy: Alliance and Resistance

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2004, U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. The first matrimonial alliance with the Rajputs was established by Akbar with the house of :

- (a) Bundelas
- (b) Kachhwahas
- (c) Rathores
- (d) Sisodias

Ans. (b)

In January 1562, on his way to the dargah at Ajmer, Akbar met **Raja Bharmal** (Bihari Mal) of **Amber**, a **Kachhwaha**, at Sanganer. Bharmal accepted Mughal suzerainty and offered his eldest daughter in marriage. The marriage took place at **Sambhar** on the return journey. She is called **Harkha Bai** in the source and is popularly known as Jodha Bai. She became the mother of Salim (Jahangir), and was later titled Mariam-uz-Zamani. Bharmal's son **Bhagwan Das** and grandson **Man Singh** became leading Mughal commanders.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. Which of the following Rajputana state did not accept the supremacy of Akbar willingly ?

- (a) Amber
- (b) Mewar
- (c) Marwar
- (d) Bikaner

Ans. (b)

Rajput state	House	Relation with Akbar
Amber	Kachhwaha	First alliance, 1562. Bharmal, Bhagwan Das, Man Singh
Bikaner and Jaisalmer	Rathore (Bikaner), Bhati (Jaisalmer)	Submitted at the Nagaur durbar, 1570
Marwar (Jodhpur)	Rathore	Rao Chandrasen resisted. His brother and successors joined the Mughals
Ranthambore (Bundi)	Hada	Surjan Hada surrendered, 1569
Mewar	Sisodia	Never submitted to Akbar. Chittor taken 1568. Maharana Pratap resisted. His son Amar Singh made peace with Jahangir in 1615

TRAP ALERT

Bundelas are not a Rajputana house in this question. Their state was Orchha in Bundelkhand, and Bir Singh Bundela is linked to the murder of Abul Fazl (15.10). The first alliance is Kachhwaha (Amber), the lasting resistance is Sisodia (Mewar).

15.4 Maharana Pratap and the Battle of Haldighati (1576)

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2016, U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Who was the Commander in Chief of the Rajput Army, besides Maharana Pratap in the Battle of Haldighati?

- (a) Ibrahim Gardi
- (b) Hakim Sur
- (c) Tardi Beg
- (d) Mahmud Lodi

Ans. (b)

Haldighati, a pass near Gogunda in present Rajsamand district (Rajasthan), saw Maharana Pratap face a Mughal army under **Raja Man Singh** and **Asaf Khan** in June 1576. Pratap's vanguard was led by **Hakim Khan Sur**, an Afghan, with an Afghan contingent. A Bhil force also fought on Pratap's side. The Mughals held the field, but Pratap escaped. It was his last pitched battle. He then fought a guerrilla war from the hills, recovered much of Mewar, made **Chavand** his capital and died in 1597.

TRAP ALERT

Every distractor belongs to another battle. **Ibrahim Gardi** commanded Maratha artillery at Third Panipat (1761). **Tardi Beg** was the Mughal governor who lost Delhi to Hemu in 1556. **Mahmud Lodi** led the Afghans against Babur at Ghaghra (1529). Note the irony the examiner relies on: an Afghan led Pratap's vanguard while a Rajput led the Mughal army.

UPPSC (EXAM TAG NOT GIVEN IN SOURCE)

Q. In which year was the famous Battle of Haldighati fought between Akbar and Maharana Pratap?

- (a) 1576 A.D.
- (b) 1579 A.D.
- (c) 1597 A.D.
- (d) 1575 A.D.

Ans. (a)

The wrong years are traps from the same reign: **1575** is Tukaroi and the Ibadat Khana, **1579** is the Mahzar, and **1597** is the death of Maharana Pratap. Akbar did not fight at Haldighati in person.

15.5 Religious Policy I: Sufi Devotion to the Mahzar

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. The Mausoleum (Dargah) of which Chishti Saint was visited by Akbar ?

- (a) Muinuddin Chishti
- (b) Shaikh Nasiruddin Chirag Dehlavi
- (c) Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki
- (d) Shaikh Farid Ganj-i-Shakar

Ans. (a)

Akbar was devoted to the **Chishti** order. He went repeatedly to the dargah of **Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti at Ajmer** (NCERT counts fourteen visits), and walked there from Agra in 1570 to give thanks for the birth of Salim. He also visited **Shaikh Salim Chishti** at Sikri, whose blessing he credited for that birth (1569). The other options are Chishti saints of Delhi (Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki at Mehrauli, Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Dehli) and Punjab (Baba Farid at Pakpattan).

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2006, U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003

Q. Arrange the following events of Akbar's reign in their chronological order :

1. Abolition of Jizya
2. Construction of Ibadat Khana
3. Signing of Mahzar
4. Foundation of Din-i-Ilahi

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
- (b) 2, 3, 4, 1
- (c) 1, 3, 2, 4
- (d) 3, 4, 1, 2

Ans. (a)

Year	Step in religious policy	Detail
1562	Ban on enslaving prisoners of war	Also the first Rajput marriage
1563	Pilgrim tax abolished	Tax on Hindu pilgrims at holy places
1564	Jizya abolished	Poll tax on non-Muslims
1575	Ibadat Khana built at Fatehpur Sikri	House of worship for debates. At first only Muslim scholars. Opened to Hindus, Jains, Zoroastrians and Christians from 1578
1579	Mahzar	Drafted by Shaikh Mubarak (father of Abul Fazl and Faizi). Declared Akbar Imam-i-Adil, with power to choose among differing opinions of the jurists. Loosely called the "infallibility decree"

Year	Step in religious policy	Detail
1580	First Jesuit mission. Revolts in Bihar and Bengal	Fatwa from Jaunpur against Akbar
1582	Tauhid-i-Ilahi (Din-i-Ilahi)	A discipleship order around the emperor. See 15.6

TRAP ALERT

Order trap: jizya was abolished (1564) **eleven years before** the Ibadat Khana (1575). Students who assume debates came first pick (b). The pilgrim tax went a year before jizya.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Against which Mughal Emperor was a 'Fatwa' issued from Jaunpur ?

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (b)

In 1580 **Mulla Muhammad Yazdi**, qazi of Jaunpur, issued a fatwa calling on Muslims to rebel against Akbar. It came after the Mahzar and coincided with the revolts of Mughal officers in Bihar and Bengal, who also resented the stricter checks on their horses and accounts. The revolt was put down by 1581.

UP link: Jaunpur (Jaunpur district), the old Sharqi capital, was a centre of orthodox learning, which is why the fatwa came from there.

15.6 Religious Policy II: Sulh-i-Kul, Din-i-Ilahi and Other Faiths

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998

Q. The concept of 'Sulh-i-Kul' (universal peace and fraternity) adopted by Akbar was the result of :

- (a) Political generosity
- (b) Religious tolerance
- (c) Liberal cultural attitude
- (d) All the above

Ans. (d)

Sulh-i-kul means peace with all. Abul Fazl presents it as the core of Akbar's rule: the emperor stands above all sects and the state does not take sides between them. It had a political side (a loyal nobility of Turanis, Iranis, Rajputs and Indian Muslims), a religious side (tolerance, ending jizya and the pilgrim tax) and a cultural side (translations, painting, music). So (d) fits.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. Which historian said "Din-i-Ilahi" is a religion ?

- (a) Abul Fazl
- (b) Abdul Qadir Badauni
- (c) Nizamuddin
- (d) None of these

Ans. (d)

Abul Fazl calls Akbar's order **Tauhid-i-Ilahi** (divine monotheism), a Sufi-style discipleship with the emperor as spiritual guide. It had no scripture, priests or temples, and only a small circle joined (Birbal is commonly named as the only prominent Hindu member, and Man Singh declined). The name **Din-i-Ilahi** and its treatment as a separate

religion come from the **Dabistan-i-Mazahib**, a later work of Jahangir's time commonly attributed to Mohsin Fani. Hence the key (d). Badauni attacked Akbar for straying from orthodox Islam, but he is not the source of the Din-i-Ilahi label.

TRAP ALERT

Abul Fazl, Badauni and Nizamuddin Ahmad were all Akbar's contemporaries. None of them uses the name Din-i-Ilahi as a religion. The term enters from the Dabistan.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2012

Q. Famous Jain Scholar who was respected by Akbar?

- (a) Chandraprabhu Suri
- (b) Hari vijay Suri
- (c) Pushpadant
- (d) Yashobhadra

Ans. (b)

Akbar invited the Svetambara monk **Harivijaya Suri** in 1582. He stayed at court for some years and received the title **Jagadguru**. Under his influence Akbar gave up meat for periods and banned the killing of animals on certain days. Another Jain monk, **Jinachandra Suri**, was given the title **Yuga Pradhan**. Pushpadanta and Yashobhadra are figures of much earlier Jain tradition.

Faith	Representative at Akbar's court	Point to remember
Jain	Harivijaya Suri , Jinachandra Suri	Titles Jagadguru and Yuga Pradhan
Christian (Jesuit)	First mission 1580: Rodolfo Acquaviva and Antonio Monserrate. Later missions 1591 and 1595 (Jerome Xavier)	Came from Goa at Akbar's invitation. Akbar did not convert
Zoroastrian	Dastur Meherji Rana	Linked to the Ilahi calendar and solar reverence at court
Sufi (Chishti)	Shaikh Salim Chishti	Tomb inside the Jama Masjid court at Fatehpur Sikri
Orthodox ulema	Makhdum-ul-Mulk, Shaikh Abdun Nabi (sadr)	Signed the Mahzar, later fell from favour

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Jesuit missions and the Zoroastrian link are untested in UPPSC so far. A statement question on the 1580 mission (Acquaviva, Monserrate) or on Jinachandra Suri's title would extend the 2002 and 2012 Jain question.

15.7 Social Reforms and the Sources of Akbar's Popularity

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. Causes of Akbar's popularity were -

- A. Mansabdari system
- B. Religious policy
- C. Land Revenue System
- D. Social reforms

Select the correct answer by using codes given below :

- (a) A and B
- (b) B only
- (c) C only
- (d) A, B, C, D

Ans. (d)

Each item is part of Akbar's lasting record: the **mansabdari** system (15.8), the **dahsala** revenue settlement (15.9), the religious policy of the previous two clusters, and the social reforms below. The mansabdari and revenue systems outlived him and became the frame of later Mughal rule.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002

Q. Who among the following had ordered that a man should marry only one wife and could marry another only when the first wife was barren ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Sher Shah
- (c) Akbar
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Akbar tried to fix the age of marriage for boys and girls.
2. Akbar gave freedom to girls to marry at their own will and not under parental pressure.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes:

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c)

Social measure	What Akbar ordered
Age of marriage	Minimum 16 for boys and 14 for girls
Consent	Consent of the bride and groom, not only parental pressure
Monogamy	One wife. A second only if the first was barren
Widows	Hindu widows allowed to remarry
Sati	No woman to be forced to commit sati
Slavery	Ban on enslaving prisoners of war (1562)

TRAP ALERT

Enforcement was weak, so these are best described as orders or attempts. The 2020 statements use "tried to fix" and "gave freedom", which match the record. A statement saying Akbar **abolished** sati would be too strong.

15.8 Mansabdari and the Office of Diwan

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Military system in the reign of Akbar was based on :

- (a) Mansabdari
- (b) Zamindari
- (c) Feudalistic
- (d) Ain-i-Dahsala

Ans. (a)

In 1573 Akbar revived **dagh** (branding of horses) so that a commander could not show the same horse twice or swap good horses for poor ones. Around 1574 to 1575 he graded all officers by **mansab** (rank) on a decimal scale. Each mansabdar held a personal rank (**zat**) and, from the 1590s, a separate cavalry rank (**sawar**) fixing the horsemen he had to keep. Ain-i-Dahsala is a revenue system, not a military one. Details are in Chapter 19.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Mansab	Rank in the imperial service, fixing pay, status and troops	Akbar, about 1574 to 1575
Zat	Personal rank and salary of a mansabdar	Akbar
Sawar	Number of horsemen a mansabdar had to maintain	Akbar, from the 1590s
Dagh	Branding of horses	Alauddin first, Sher Shah, revived by Akbar 1573
Chehra	Descriptive roll of each soldier	Alauddin first, revived by Sher Shah and Akbar
Vakil	Chief minister, regent-like post	Bairam Khan, later Munim Khan
Diwan	Head of revenue and finance	Muzaffar Khan Turbati, Todar Mal, Shah Mansur
Khan-i-Khanan	Title, "Khan of Khans"	Bairam Khan, Munim Khan, Abdur Rahim
Sulh-i-kul	Peace with all	Akbar's religious policy
Mahzar	Declaration making Akbar arbiter among jurists	1579
Dahsala (zabti)	Ten-year average assessment	Todar Mal, 1580

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2002, 2003

Q. The first person to be given proper status of the Diwan by Akbar was -

- (a) Asaf Khan
- (b) Munim Khan
- (c) Muzaffar Khan Turbati
- (d) Raja Todar Mal

Ans. (c)

After Bairam Khan, Akbar split the powers once held by the vakil. Finance went to a separate **diwan**. From the 9th to the 30th year of the reign the post was held in turn by **Muzaffar Khan Turbati**, **Raja Todar Mal** and **Khwaja Shah Mansur**. Muzaffar Khan was the first to give the office a recognised place in the hierarchy. Todar Mal is the famous diwan, but not the first.

TRAP ALERT

Munim Khan was vakil and Khan-i-Khanan, not diwan. Choosing Todar Mal because he is the best-known finance minister is the commonest error here.

15.9 Todar Mal and the Dahsala Settlement

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. In which measures Todar Mal achieved fame ?

- (a) Military campaign
- (b) Land Revenue
- (c) Humor
- (d) Painting

Ans. (b)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Todar Mal was associated to
Ans. Land Revenue Reforms

In 1580, the 24th year of the reign, Akbar adopted the **Ain-i-Dahsala**, also called **Todar Mal's bandobast**. For each crop the average yield and the average price of the previous ten years were worked out, and **one-third** of the average produce was fixed as the revenue demand in cash, per bigha of measured land. Todar Mal was the chief architect, assisted by Khwaja Shah Mansur. Todar Mal was also a successful general (Tukaroi 1575, Bengal), so option (a) is not absurd, but his fame rests on revenue. Humour points to Birbal and painting to Abdus Samad and Daswanth.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Who among the following was the connecting link between Sher Shah and Akbar in land revenue administrative measures ?

- (a) Birbal
- (b) Todar Mal
- (c) Bhagwan Das
- (d) Bharmal

Ans. (b)

Todar Mal is commonly said to have served in Sher Shah's administration before he joined Akbar. He carried forward Sher Shah's principles of measuring land, fixing crop rates and taking one-third of the produce, and turned them into the dahsala.

Feature	Sher Shah	Akbar (dahsala, 1580)
Measurement	Land measured	Land measured with a standard gaz and bigha
Rate basis	Ray : a schedule of crop rates on average yield	Ten-year average of yield and prices
State share	One-third	One-third
Payment	Cash or kind	Mainly cash
Key official	Sher Shah himself	Todar Mal

UP link: Todar Mal is commonly said to have been born at **Laharpur** (Sitapur district), though some accounts place his origin in Punjab. Treat the birthplace as disputed.

TRAP ALERT

Bharmal and **Bhagwan Das** are the Amber Kachhwahas of 15.3. They link Akbar to the Rajputs, not to Sher Shah's revenue system.

15.10 Court Scholars, Translations and Painting

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024

Q. Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order:

1. Murder of Abul Fazl
2. Death of Sheikh Mubarak
3. Death of Faizi
4. Death of Daniyal

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 2, 1, 4, 3
- (b) 3, 2, 1, 4
- (c) 2, 3, 1, 4
- (d) 2, 4, 3, 1

Ans. (c)

Shaikh Mubarak, father of Faizi and Abul Fazl, died in 1593. **Faizi**, the poet laureate, died in 1595. **Abul Fazl** was killed in 1602 by Bir Singh Bundela of Orchha at the instigation of Prince Salim, who was then in revolt. Prince **Daniyal** died at Burhanpur in 1605, a few months before Akbar. Order: 2, 3, 1, 4. Note the father died before both sons.

UP link: Salim ran a rival court at **Allahabad** (now Prayagraj district) from 1600 until he was reconciled with Akbar in 1604. Abul Fazl was killed while returning from the Deccan to deal with this revolt.

Navaratna (by tradition)	Known for
Abul Fazl	Akbarnama, with the Ain-i-Akbari as its third volume. Ayar-i-Danish (Persian version of the Panchatantra tales, Kalila wa Dimna)
Faizi	Poet laureate. Persian version of Lilavati. Supervised part of the Mahabharata translation
Birbal (Mahesh Das)	Wit and courtier. Killed in the Yusufzai campaign, 1586
Tansen	Musician, came from the Rewa court
Todar Mal	Revenue (dahsala)
Man Singh	General. Haldighati, Bengal, Orissa
Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan	Son of Bairam Khan. Translated Baburnama from Turki into Persian. Hindi dohas
Mulla Do Piyaza, Fakir Aziao-Din	Appear in the later tradition only

TRAP ALERT

No contemporary source lists nine jewels. The navaratna list is a later tradition, so do not treat its membership as documented fact.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. Who among the following translated the Mahabharata into Persian?

- (a) Abdul Qadir Badauni
- (b) Abul Fazl
- (c) Nizamuddin Ahmad
- (d) Shaikh Mubarak

Ans. (a)

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2016, UPPCS (MAINS) 2015

Q. "Rajm-nama" is the Persian translation of which Hindu text?

Ans. Mahabharata

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2013

Q. Who translated the Ramayana into the Persian language in accordance with the wishes of Akbar?

Ans. Abul Qadir Badauni

Akbar set up a translation bureau (maktab khana) at Fatehpur Sikri. The Mahabharata became the **Razmnama** (book of war), a joint work of Naqib Khan, **Badauni** and others, with Faizi rendering parts in verse. Badauni, the scholar who actually translated sections, is the keyed answer. He also translated the **Ramayana**. His own history, the **Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh**, written in secret, is sharply critical of Akbar's religious policy, which makes it the counterweight to Abul Fazl's official Akbarnama.

Original work	Persian title or translator
Mahabharata	Razmnama . Naqib Khan, Badauni and others, Faizi for verse parts

Original work	Persian title or translator
Ramayana	Badauni
Lilavati (mathematics)	Faizi
Panchatantra tales (Kalila wa Dimna)	Abul Fazl (Ayar-i-Danish)
Atharvaveda	Haji Ibrahim Sirhindi
Baburnama (from Turki)	Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan

Chronicler	Work	Stance
Abul Fazl	Akbarnama, Ain-i-Akbari	Official, admiring
Badauni	Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Orthodox, critical
Nizamuddin Ahmad	Tabaqat-i-Akbari	Factual general history
Mohsin Fani (attributed)	Dabistan-i-Mazahib	Later account of religions, source of the name Din-i-Ilahi

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. Who of the following was awarded with the honour of "Zari Kalam" by King Akbar :

- (a) Muhammad Husain
- (b) Muqammal Khan
- (c) Abdussamad
- (d) Mir Sayyid Ali

Ans. (a)

The Ain-i-Akbari lists the calligraphers of the court. The foremost, **Muhammad Husain Kashmiri**, received the title **Zarrin Qalam** (golden pen). **Abdus Samad** and **Mir Sayyid Ali** were the Persian painters Humayun brought to India. They led Akbar's atelier and the illustrated **Hamzanama**. Their titles came from Humayun: Shirin Qalam (sweet pen) for Abdus Samad and Nadir-ul-Mulk for Mir Sayyid Ali. **Daswanth** and **Basawan** were leading Indian painters of the atelier.

TRAP ALERT

Zarrin Qalam (Muhammad Husain, from Akbar) and Shirin Qalam (Abdus Samad, from Humayun) are easily swapped. Golden pen is the calligrapher.

15.11 Fatehpur Sikri, Buland Darwaza and Akbar's Forts

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 1998

Q. Consider the following statements :

Assertion (A) : Constructed "Buland Darwaza" at Fatehpur Sikri.

Reason (R) : Akbar built this monument to commemorate the birth of his son Jahangir.

Which one of the following is correct in relation of above:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are wrong, but (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1993

Q. Which one monument was built by Akbar?

Ans. Buland Darwaza

Akbar began building at **Sikri** in 1568 to 1569, near the hermitage of Shaikh Salim Chishti, where Salim was born in 1569. After the Gujarat conquest (1572 to 1573) the city became **Fatehpur** (city of victory) Sikri, and it served as the capital until 1585, when Akbar moved to Lahore. The **Buland Darwaza** is the southern gate of the Jama Masjid. Most historians link it to the **Gujarat victory**. Its inscription of 1601 records the Deccan (Khandesh) conquest, which is why Percy Brown ties it to 1601. Either way it does not commemorate Jahangir's birth, so R is false.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. Akbar constructed in Fatehpur Sikri -

- (a) Moti Mahal
- (b) Panch Mahal
- (c) Rang Mahal
- (d) Hira Mahal

Ans. (b)

Building at Fatehpur Sikri	Feature for the exam
Buland Darwaza	Monumental southern gate of the Jama Masjid. Victory gateway
Jama Masjid	Congregational mosque. Encloses Salim Chishti's tomb
Tomb of Shaikh Salim Chishti	White marble tomb with fine stone screens
Panch Mahal	Five-storey pillared pavilion, each storey smaller than the one below. The source notes a plan like a Buddhist vihara
Diwan-i-Khas	Single central pillar carrying a circular platform
Diwan-i-Am, Khas Mahal, Ankh Michauli (treasury)	Palace and court buildings
Jodha Bai's palace , Birbal's house, Maryam's house, Turkish Sultana's house	Residences. The names are popular labels
Ibadat Khana	Hall of religious debates (1575). Its exact site is debated

UP link: Fatehpur Sikri lies in **Agra district**. It was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in **1986**. Agra Fort was inscribed in 1983. Akbar's own tomb is at **Sikandra** (Agra district), begun in his lifetime and completed by Jahangir.

TRAP ALERT

Rang Mahal is in Shah Jahan's Red Fort at Delhi. Moti Mahal and Hira Mahal are not among Akbar's Fatehpur Sikri buildings. Do not confuse Akbar's red sandstone Panch Mahal with Shah Jahan's marble Moti Masjid at Agra.

U.P.P.C.S. (RE. EXAM) (PRE) 2015

Q. Which of the following forts was not constructed in the reign of Akbar?

- (a) Red Fort of Delhi
- (b) Agra Fort
- (c) Allahabad Fort
- (d) Lahore Fort

Ans. (a)

Monument	Builder	Place
Agra Fort (red sandstone rebuilding from 1565, Jahangiri Mahal)	Akbar	UP , Agra district

Monument	Builder	Place
Fatehpur Sikri , Buland Darwaza	Akbar	UP , Agra district
Allahabad Fort (1583)	Akbar	UP , Prayagraj district
Lahore Fort (rebuilt)	Akbar	Pakistan
Attock fort (1581)	Akbar	Pakistan
Humayun's tomb (completed about 1570)	Built under Akbar, commissioned by Humayun's widow	Delhi
Akbar's tomb, Sikandra	Begun by Akbar, completed by Jahangir	UP , Agra district
Red Fort, Delhi (1639 to 1648)	Shah Jahan	Delhi (Shahjahanabad)

UP link: Akbar built the **Allahabad Fort** in 1583 at the confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna and named the city **Ilahabas**, later Allahabad. The Uttar Pradesh cabinet renamed the city **Prayagraj** on 16 October 2018. The Ashokan pillar with Samudragupta's Prayag prashasti stands inside this fort.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Akbar's UP buildings have now been asked four times (Buland Darwaza twice, Panch Mahal, forts). A Fatehpur Sikri match question pairing Diwan-i-Khas, Panch Mahal and Salim Chishti's tomb with their features, or a UNESCO-year question (Agra Fort 1983, Fatehpur Sikri 1986), fits this pattern.

15.12 Akbar in World Context: Contemporary and Enlightened Despot

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002

Q. Indian ruler, contemporary of Queen Elizabeth-I of England, was

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Shah Jahan
- (c) Aurangzeb
- (d) Bahadur Shah

Ans. (a)

Ruler	Reign	Link to Akbar
Akbar	1556 to 1605	Mughal emperor
Elizabeth I (England)	1558 to 1603	Chartered the English East India Company on 31 December 1600. Ralph Fitch reached Akbar's court in the 1580s
Shah Abbas I (Safavid Iran)	1588 to 1629	Rival over Kandahar, taken by the Mughals in 1595
Jahangir	1605 to 1627	Contemporary of James I. Thomas Roe came to his court

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Who among the following emperors may be called "an enlightened despot" ?

- (a) Babur
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Akbar
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

An **enlightened despot** holds absolute power but uses it for reform and the welfare of subjects. The label comes from 18th century Europe (Frederick the Great of Prussia) and is applied to Akbar by later historians. Akbar fits on both counts: all authority sat with him (the Mahzar even made him arbiter in religious law), yet he used it for tolerance, social reform and an orderly revenue system. Aurangzeb was absolute but not reformist in this sense. Babur and Humayun had no time to build such a state.

Chapter 15: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Court scholars, translations, painting	5	1995-2024	Recurring (2 one-liners, 2024 chronology)
Fatehpur Sikri, Buland Darwaza and forts	4	1993-2015	Recurring
Religious chronology, Chishti links, Jaunpur fatwa	3	2003-2012	Recurring
Sulh-i-kul, Din-i-Ilahi and Jain scholars	3	1998-2012	Steady
Social reforms and popularity	3	1990-2020	Steady (revived 2020)
Todar Mal and dahsala	3	1992-2012	Steady
Regency, Bairam Khan, Adham Khan	2	2010-2024	Recent (2024)
Rajput policy	2	2004-2016	Steady
Haldighati	2	2016	Occasional
Mansabdari and the diwan	2	1992-2003	Older
Akbar in world context	2	2002-2009	Occasional
Conquests chronology	1	2021	Recent

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 32 items (28 PYQs + 4 one-liners). Two clusters lead: the court scholars and translations (5 items, with the Persian translations of the epics asked three times) and Fatehpur Sikri with Akbar's forts (4 items, all UP monuments). The newest questions (2021 and two in 2024) are chronology and statement types: conquests in order, deaths of the Mubarak family and Daniyal, and Bairam Khan's title. So the date tables in 15.2, 15.5 and 15.10 are the highest-value revision. Older papers favoured direct attribution (Todar Mal, Muzaffar Khan Turbati, Harivijaya Suri, Zarrin Qalam). No answer key needed a correction in this chapter.

Chapter 16

Jahangir

Jahangir (Prince Salim, reign 1605 to 1627) inherited a settled empire from Akbar and largely kept its institutions. His reign is remembered for the chain of justice, the rise of Nur Jahan and her family, the 1615 settlement with Mewar, the loss of Kandahar in 1622, the first English envoys at the Mughal court, his Persian memoir the Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri, and the high point of Mughal painting. In Agra it gave us the tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula and the completed tomb of Akbar at Sikandra. This chapter covers the accession and the revolts of the reign, Nur Jahan's group, Mewar and the frontiers, the English and Dutch visitors, the Tuzuk and painting, and the Mughal tombs. It contains **11 PYQs** and **3 one-liners**. The European visitors alone account for 8 items.

16.1 Salim's Accession, the Chain of Justice and the Revolts of the Reign

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003

Q. The killer of Abul Fazl was rewarded by :

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Man Singh
- (d) None of these

Ans. (b)

Prince Salim was born in 1569 at **Fatehpur Sikri** and was named after the Chishti saint **Shaikh Salim Chishti**. In 1600 he rebelled and held his own court at **Allahabad**. Akbar recalled **Abul Fazl** from the Deccan, and in 1602 Salim had him killed on the way by **Bir Singh Deo Bundela** of Orchha. After Akbar's death Salim was crowned at Agra in 1605 as **Nuruddin Muhammad Jahangir Badshah Ghazi**. He promoted the nobles who had backed him, Bir Singh Deo among them. That is why the reward came from Jahangir and not from Akbar, who mourned Abul Fazl.

UP link: Salim's birthplace **Fatehpur Sikri** and his coronation at **Agra** are in Agra district. His rebel court of 1600 to 1604 sat at **Allahabad** (now **Prayagraj**, renamed in 2018). Bir Singh Deo later built a large temple of **Keshava Deva at Mathura** (Mathura district).

In the **Tuzuk** Jahangir says that soon after his accession he hung a golden **chain of justice** (zanjir-i-adl) from the Shah Burj of the **Agra Fort** to a stone post on the bank of the Yamuna, so that any aggrieved person could ring its bells. He also issued twelve ordinances (dastur-ul-amal), which among other things banned the making and sale of liquor and banned cutting off noses and ears as punishment.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2013

Q. Of the following who had rebelled against the Mughal Emperor Jahangir ?

- (1) Asif Khan
- (2) Khurram
- (3) Mahabat Khan
- (4) Khusrau

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 2,3 and 4 only

Ans. (d)

Rebel	Year	What happened
Khusrau (eldest son)	1606	Fled from Agra to the Punjab within months of the accession. Defeated near Bhairawal and captured. Guru Arjan Dev, the fifth Sikh Guru, had received him, and Jahangir records in the Tuzuk that he ordered the Guru's execution (Lahore, 1606). Khusrau died in 1622 in Khurram's custody at Burhanpur
Khurram (later Shah Jahan)	1623 to 1626	Rose against the court after the 1622 order to march to Kandahar and Nur Jahan's support for Shahryar. Pursued by Parvez and Mahabat Khan . Submitted in 1626 and sent his sons Dara and Aurangzeb to court as hostages
Mahabat Khan	1626	Threatened by Nur Jahan's party after crushing Khurram, he seized Jahangir in his camp on the Jhelum. Nur Jahan later freed the emperor
Asaf Khan	None	Nur Jahan's brother and Khurram's father-in-law. Did not rebel. He backed Khurram's accession in 1627

TRAP ALERT

Asaf Khan intrigued for Khurram but never took up arms against Jahangir, so statement 1 fails and code (d) is right. Do not confuse the 1606 revolt of Khusrau with the 1600 revolt of Salim himself against Akbar.

16.2 Nur Jahan and the "Junta"

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. Who of the following was not a member of Noor Jahan's Junta?

- (a) Jahangir
- (b) Ghiyas Beg
- (c) Asaf Khan
- (d) Khurram

Ans. (a)

Mehrunnisa, daughter of the Persian noble **Mirza Ghiyas Beg**, was the widow of Sher Afgan, a jagirdar in Bengal. Jahangir married her in **1611** and gave her the titles **Nur Mahal** and then **Nur Jahan**. Coins were struck and orders issued in her name. Historians describe the group around her as a "junta": her father **Itimad-ud-Daula** (Ghiyas Beg), her mother Asmat Begum, her brother **Asaf Khan** and Prince **Khurram**, who married Asaf Khan's daughter **Arjumand Banu Begum** (Mumtaz Mahal) in 1612. Jahangir was the ruler they influenced, not a member.

The group split around 1620 to 1622, when Nur Jahan married her daughter Ladli Begum (from her first marriage) to Prince **Shahryar** and backed him. This pushed Khurram into revolt (161). Some

historians, notably S. Nurul Hasan, question how far a closed junta really controlled policy, so treat the word as a convention.

TRAP ALERT

Two Mehrunnisas. **Nur Jahan's** birth name was Mehrunnisa, and Aurangzeb also had a daughter named **Mehrunnisa** (Chapter 18). Read the question for the period before choosing.

16.3 Mewar (1615), Kandahar (1622) and the Deccan

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2008, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2008

Q. In whose reign was the 'Treaty of Chittor' signed between the Mughals and the Rana of Mewar ?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (b)

Akbar took Chittor in 1568 but never subdued Mewar. Under Jahangir, Prince **Khurram** pressed **Rana Amar Singh** (son of Rana Pratap) hard, and in **1615** the Rana submitted. The terms were mild. The Rana accepted Mughal suzerainty but was excused personal attendance at court. His son **Karan Singh** went to court and received a mansab of 5000. **Chittor** was returned on condition that its fort would not be refortified. No marriage alliance was demanded.

Frontier	Event	Year
Mewar	Treaty with Rana Amar Singh after Khurram's campaign	1615
Deccan	Khurram's campaign against Malik Ambar of Ahmadnagar. Khurram received the title Shah Jahan	1616 to 1617
Kangra	Fort captured	1620
Kandahar	Lost to Shah Abbas I of Persia. Khurram refused to march, which led to his revolt	1622

TRAP ALERT

Mewar under Akbar = Haldighati (1576) against Rana Pratap, with no settlement. Mewar under Jahangir = **treaty of 1615** with Amar Singh. The source calls it the "Treaty of Chittor".

16.4 The English and the Dutch at Jahangir's Court

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1993

Q. Who of the following was sent first by East India Company in the court of Jahangir ?

- (a) Sir Thomas Roe
- (b) Vasco-da-Gama
- (c) Hawkins
- (d) Job Charnock

Ans. (c)

Captain William Hawkins commanded the East India Company ship Hector, which reached **Surat in 1608**. He went to Agra, where he stayed from 1609 to 1611. Jahangir gave him a **mansab of 400**, the title "**English Khan**" and an Armenian wife. Portuguese opposition prevented him from winning a trading farman, and he left in 1611. **Vasco da Gama** (1498) came a century earlier and never visited a Mughal court. **Job Charnock** founded the Calcutta settlement in 1690.

U.P.P.C.S. (RE. EXAM) (PRE) 2015

Q. Mughal Emperor Jahangir gave the title 'English Khan' to **Ans. William Hawkins**

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. With reference to the captain Hawkins, which of the following statements is correct?

- (1) He came to India in 1611 as an envoy of James-I.
- (2) He was very well versed in Turkish language.
- (a) Both (1) and (2)
- (b) Only (1)
- (c) Neither (1) nor (2)
- (d) Only (2)

Ans. (d)

Statement 1 fails on the date. Hawkins arrived in **1608**, and 1611 is the year he **left** the court. He did carry a letter from James I, but he came on a Company voyage, and the first ambassador sent by the king was Roe. Statement 2 is correct. Hawkins spoke **Turkish**, and Jahangir, who knew Turki, enjoyed talking to him without an interpreter.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008

Q. Sir Thomas Roe came to India as a British Ambassador during the reign of,

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Aurangzeb
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (c)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2013

Q. Who was the envoy of British King James-I who was sent to Jahangir's court?

Ans. Thomas Roe

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Thomas Roe was received in audience by Jahangir at :

- (a) Agra
- (b) Ajmer
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Fatehpur Sikri

Ans. (b)

Sir Thomas Roe was the ambassador of **King James I**. He landed at Surat in 1615 and was received by Jahangir at **Ajmer** in January 1616. The emperor was camped at Ajmer to direct the Mewar campaign (16.3), which explains the place. Roe followed the court to Mandu and Gujarat and left in 1619. He did not get a formal commercial treaty, but secured farmans and concessions, partly through Prince Khurram, then governor of Gujarat, that let the English trade and keep factories. Captain Best's defeat of a Portuguese fleet off Surat (Swally, 1612) had already won the English a farman for a factory at Surat in 1613.

TRAP ALERT

Agra and **Fatehpur Sikri** are the reflex answers for any Mughal audience. Roe's audience was at **Ajmer**, because of the Mewar campaign. Hawkins = first, Company man, 1608. Roe = first royal ambassador, 1615.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (MAINS) 2010

Q. A Dutch traveller, who has given a very valuable account of the reign of Jahangir was

- (a) Francisco Pelsaert
- (b) Hawkins
- (c) Niccolo Manucci
- (d) Peter Mundy

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2017

Q. Which one foreign travellers visited India during the reign of Jahangir?

Ans. Francisco Pelsaert

Francisco Pelsaert was a factor of the Dutch East India Company at **Agra** in the 1620s. His report, the **Remonstrantie**, describes trade, prices and the hard condition of peasants and artisans under Jahangir. **UP link:** Pelsaert's account is largely about **Agra** and its markets.

Traveller	Origin	Ruler	Note or work
William Hawkins	England (East India Company)	Jahangir, 1608 to 1611	Mansab of 400, "English Khan", spoke Turkish
Sir Thomas Roe	England (ambassador of James I)	Jahangir, 1615 to 1619	Audience at Ajmer, January 1616. Journal of the embassy
Edward Terry	England	Jahangir	Roe's chaplain. Wrote an account of the Mughal court
Francisco Pelsaert	Holland (Dutch East India Company)	Jahangir, 1620s	Remonstrantie. Based at Agra
Peter Mundy	England	Shah Jahan , 1628 to 1634	Famine of 1630 to 1632, Agra
Niccolao Manucci	Venice	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb , from 1656	Storia do Mogor. Served Dara Shikoh

TRAP ALERT

Hawkins was English, not Dutch, and **Manucci** and **Peter Mundy** came under Shah Jahan. Only Pelsaert fits both "Dutch" and "Jahangir".

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Hawkins and Roe have been asked five times across 1993 to 2023, and the 2023 question moved to statement form. A sequence question (Hawkins, Roe, Pelsaert, Mundy, Bernier) or a Roe-Ajmer-1616 statement is the natural extension.

16.5 The Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri and Painting under Jahangir

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2001, U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. Which of the following Mughal Emperor wrote his autobiography in Persian ?

- (a) Babur
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

Jahangir wrote his memoir, the **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** (Jahangirnama), in **Persian**. He wrote it himself for roughly the first seventeen years of his reign, after which Mutamad Khan and later Muhammad Hadi continued it. It records his orders, hunts, observations of birds, animals and plants, and his views on painting. **Babur** wrote his memoir, the Tuzuk-i-Baburi (Baburnama), in **Turki** (Chaghatai Turkish). Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan translated it into Persian under Akbar. **Akbar** wrote no memoir. The Akbarnama is Abul Fazl's history.

Work	Author	Language	Subject
Tuzuk-i-Baburi (Baburnama)	Babur	Turki	Babur's memoir
Humayun-nama	Gulbadan Begum (Babur's daughter)	Persian	Life of Humayun
Akbarnama and Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	Persian	History of Akbar's reign and administration
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir	Persian	Jahangir's own memoir
Iqbalnama-i-Jahangiri	Mutamad Khan	Persian	History of Jahangir's reign

Mughal painting reached its peak under Jahangir. He claimed in the Tuzuk that he could name the artist of each face in a group painting. The studio moved from illustrating books to **portraits**, court scenes and **studies of nature**.

Painter	Title	Known for
Ustad Mansur	Nadir-ul-Asr	Birds, animals and flowers. Studies of a zebra and a Siberian crane
Abul Hasan	Nadir-uz-Zaman	Court scenes and portraits. Son of Aqa Riza
Bishandas	None	Portraits. Sent with the embassy to Shah Abbas of Persia to paint the Shah and his court
Manohar, Daulat, Govardhan	None	Portraits and darbar scenes

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

No PYQ in this source has yet asked about Jahangir's painters. Ustad Mansur (Nadir-ul-Asr) and Abul Hasan (Nadir-uz-Zaman) suit a match question with titles.

16.6 Mughal Tombs: Sikandra, Itimad-ud-Daula and Shahdara

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991, U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. Which Mughal emperor has no mausoleum in India?

- (a) Aurangzeb
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Humayun
- (d) Babur

Ans. (b) & (d)

Note: the source keys two options. Both are correct. Babur is buried at Kabul (Afghanistan) and Jahangir at Shahdara near Lahore (Pakistan). Humayun lies in Delhi and Aurangzeb at Khuldabad (Maharashtra).

Emperor	Tomb	Place today
Babur (d. 1530)	Bagh-e-Babur. First buried at Agra, later moved	Kabul, Afghanistan
Humayun (d. 1556)	Humayun's Tomb, built under Akbar	Delhi
Akbar (d. 1605)	Tomb at Sikandra , completed by Jahangir	Agra, UP
Jahangir (d. 1627)	Tomb at Shahdara , built under Shah Jahan	Lahore, Pakistan
Shah Jahan (d. 1666)	Beside Mumtaz Mahal in the Taj Mahal	Agra, UP
Aurangzeb (d. 1707)	Simple open grave at Khuldabad	Maharashtra
Bahadur Shah Zafar (d. 1862)	Exiled after 1857	Yangon, Myanmar

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 14 items (11 PYQs + 3 one-liners). More than half are about the Europeans at Jahangir's court, and UPPSC returned to Hawkins as recently as 2023 in statement form. Fix three facts: Hawkins 1608 (English Khan, Turkish), Roe 1615 to 1619 (James I, Ajmer 1616), Pelsaert (Dutch, Remonstrantie). The rest of the chapter is single attribution questions on the 1615 Mewar settlement, the Persian Tuzuk, Nur Jahan's group and the rebels. One item carries a dual key (Babur and Jahangir buried outside India). Agra links (Itimad-ud-Daula, Sikandra, the chain of justice at Agra Fort) are the untested UP angles.

Jahangir died in 1627 on his way back from Kashmir. His tomb at Shahdara is outside India, as is Babur's at Kabul. The last emperor, **Bahadur Shah Zafar**, is also buried outside India (Yangon), but he is not among the options.

Monument	Builder	Place
Tomb of Akbar	Planned by Akbar, completed by Jahangir (about 1613)	Sikandra, Agra
Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula	Nur Jahan , for her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg (1622 to 1628)	Agra , left bank of the Yamuna
Shalimar Bagh	Jahangir (about 1619)	Srinagar
Nishat Bagh	Asaf Khan	Srinagar
Tomb of Jahangir	Built under Shah Jahan	Shahdara, Lahore

UP link: the tomb of **Itimad-ud-Daula** in **Agra** (Agra district) is the first Mughal building faced entirely in **white marble** with extensive **pietra dura** (inlay of coloured stones). It is often called the "Baby Taj" because it anticipates the Taj Mahal. **Akbar's tomb at Sikandra** (Agra district) has a five-storeyed main structure, with a marble top storey added under Jahangir.

TRAP ALERT

"Baby Taj" = Itimad-ud-Daula (Agra, Nur Jahan). "Second Taj" = Bibi ka Maqbara (Aurangabad, Aurangzeb's reign, Chapter 18). The two nicknames are easily swapped.

Chapter 16: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
English and Dutch visitors (Hawkins, Roe, Pelsaert)	8	1993-2023	Recurring (5 PYQs + 3 one-liners)
Accession and revolts (Abul Fazl's killer, rebels)	2	2003-2013	Occasional
Nur Jahan's junta	1	2015	Occasional
Mewar treaty 1615	1	2008	Occasional (2 papers)
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri in Persian	1	2001-2010	Occasional (2 papers)
Tombs outside India	1	1991-2016	Occasional (2 papers)

Chapter 17

Shah Jahan

Shah Jahan (Prince Khurram, reign 1628 to 1658) presided over the most splendid court of the Mughal age. He is remembered above all as a builder: the Taj Mahal and the marble halls of the Agra Fort, and a new capital at Shahjahanabad with the Red Fort and the Jama Masjid. His reign also saw the annexation of Ahmadnagar (1633), costly failures in Balkh and Kandahar, a refined court culture of poets, Sanskrit scholars and jewels, and the scholarship of his eldest son Dara Shikoh. It ended in the war of succession of 1657 to 1659 and eight years of captivity in the Agra Fort. This chapter contains **11 PYQs and 4 one-liners**. Dara Shikoh alone accounts for 6 items.

17.1 Accession, the Move to Delhi and Court Ceremony

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Who among the following shifted the capital of the Empire from Agra to Delhi?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

Khurram was crowned at **Agra** in 1628 with the title **Abul Muzaffar Shihabuddin Muhammad Sahib Qiran-i-Sani** ("second lord of the auspicious conjunction", recalling Timur). In **1639** he founded a new city at Delhi, **Shahjahanabad**, and moved the court there in **1648** when the Red Fort was ready. Akbar had moved his court from Agra to Fatehpur Sikri and then Lahore, never to Delhi.

UP link: **Agra** (Agra district) was the main Mughal capital until 1648 and remained a royal city. Shah Jahan was crowned there, built inside its fort, and spent his last years there as a captive (17.5).

U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2010, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which Mughal Emperor abolished the Persian Court Custom of 'Sijda' which was begun by Balban?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

Balban brought the Persian customs of **sijda** (prostration) and **paibos** (kissing the feet) into the Delhi court to raise the dignity of the throne. Akbar allowed sijda before the emperor. In 1636 to 1637 **Shah Jahan** abolished sijda and **zaminbos** (kissing the ground) and banned wearing the emperor's portrait on the turban. He replaced them with **chahar taslim**, four salutations. Manucci remarks that the new form later became hard to tell apart from sijda.

Court custom	Introduced or ended	Ruler
Sijda and paibos	Introduced in the Delhi court	Balban
Nauroz at court	Introduced	Balban
Jharokha darshan	Introduced	Akbar
Sijda and zaminbos	Abolished , replaced by chahar taslim	Shah Jahan (1636 to 1637)

Court custom	Introduced or ended	Ruler
Jharokha darshan, tuladan	Discontinued	Aurangzeb

TRAP ALERT

Balban introduced sijda, Shah Jahan abolished it. Aurangzeb ended jharokha darshan, not sijda. The "Akbar" option tempts because Akbar ended many customs, but he kept sijda.

17.2 Shah Jahan the Builder: Shahjahanabad, Agra and the Taj

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2002, U.P.P.S.C.(GIC) 2010

Q. Who among the following deserves the credit for the construction of 'Lal Qila'?

- (a) Sikandar Lodi
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (d)

The **Red Fort** (Lal Qila, Qila-i-Mubarak) of Delhi was built from 1639 to 1648 in red sandstone as the palace-fortress of Shahjahanabad. Its main gates are the **Lahori Gate** (west) and the **Delhi Gate** (south). Inside are the Diwan-i-Aam, the Diwan-i-Khas with the famous Persian verse "If there is a paradise on earth, it is this", the Rang Mahal and the water channel Nahr-i-Bihisht. The Red Fort Complex became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2007.

TRAP ALERT

The **Agra Fort** was built by **Akbar** (from 1565) in red sandstone, and Shah Jahan added the marble buildings inside it. The **Delhi Red Fort** is Shah Jahan's own. "Lal Qila" in a question means the Delhi fort.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. Which of the following among Mughal Emperor constructed Jama Masjid of Delhi?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

The **Jama Masjid** (Masjid-i-Jahan Numa) of Delhi was built by Shah Jahan on a raised plinth facing the Red Fort and completed in the mid-1650s. It has three gateways. The **eastern gate**, facing the fort, was used by the emperor, and the northern and southern gates by the public.

Monument	Builder	Place
Taj Mahal	Shah Jahan, for Mumtaz Mahal (Arjumand Banu Begum, d. 1631). Chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori . Built about 1632 to 1653	Agra, UP. UNESCO 1983
Agra Fort: Diwan-i-Khas, Khas Mahal, Musamman Burj	Shah Jahan (fort itself by Akbar)	Agra, UP. UNESCO 1983
Moti Masjid, Agra Fort	Shah Jahan (completed about 1654)	Agra, UP

Monument	Builder	Place
Jama Masjid, Agra	Jahanara Begum, Shah Jahan's daughter (1648)	Agra, UP
Red Fort (Lal Qila)	Shah Jahan (1639 to 1648)	Delhi. UNESCO 2007
Jama Masjid , Delhi	Shah Jahan	Delhi
Moti Masjid, Red Fort	Aurangzeb	Delhi
Shalimar Bagh	Shah Jahan	Lahore

UP link: the **Taj Mahal**, the **Agra Fort** and the **Moti Masjid** in the Agra Fort are all in **Agra district**. The Taj and the Agra Fort were inscribed as UNESCO World Heritage Sites in 1983, among India's first. The Taj is faced with white Makrana marble from Rajasthan and decorated with pietra dura, a technique first used on a large scale in the tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula (Chapter 16).

TRAP ALERT

Two Moti Masjids. The one in the **Agra Fort** is Shah Jahan's. The one in the **Delhi Red Fort** is **Aurangzeb's** (Chapter 18). Two Jama Masjids too: Delhi by Shah Jahan, Agra by his daughter Jahanara.

17.3 Court Culture: Jewels, Poets, Sanskrit Scholars and Travellers

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. The famous diamond 'Kohinoor' was presented to Shah Jahan by,

- (a) Aurangzeb
- (b) Murad
- (c) Mir Jumla
- (d) Abul Hasan Qutb Shah

Ans. (c)

Mir Jumla was a Persian diamond merchant who rose to be wazir of Golconda, whose mines produced India's great diamonds. In 1656 he went over to the Mughals and presented Shah Jahan a very large diamond. Many accounts identify it with the **Koh-i-Noor**, though historians are not agreed that the stone Mir Jumla gave is the same one. Mir Jumla later served Aurangzeb as governor of Bengal and led the Assam campaign. The diamond was carried off by **Nadir Shah** in 1739 along with the **Peacock Throne** (Takht-i-Taus), Shah Jahan's jewelled throne. It later passed to Ranjit Singh and, after the annexation of the Punjab in 1849, to the British Crown.

TRAP ALERT

Abul Hasan Qutb Shah was the last Golconda king, defeated by Aurangzeb in 1687. Linking Golconda with the diamond makes him tempting, but the giver was his predecessor's wazir, Mir Jumla.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. Who was the 'Poet-Laureate' of Shah Jahan's reign?

- (a) Kalim
- (b) Kashi
- (c) Qudsi
- (d) Munir

Ans. (a)

Abu Talib Kalim, a Persian poet from Hamadan, held the title **Malik-ush-Shuara** (king of poets) at Shah Jahan's court. Haji Muhammad Jan **Qudsi** was another Persian poet at the same court, which makes him the closest distractor.

Ruler	Poet laureate (Malik-ush-Shuara)
Akbar	Ghazali Mashhadi, then Faizi
Jahangir	Talib Amuli
Shah Jahan	Abu Talib Kalim

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Which Mughal ruler patronized Kavindra Acharya Saraswati of Banaras, a great scholar of Sanskrit and Hindi ?

- (a) Jahangir
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. Who had led a deputation of Banaras pandits before the Mughal emperor to seek the abolition of pilgrim tax on Banaras and Allahabad?

Ans. Kavindracharya

Kavindracharya Saraswati was a Sanskrit scholar of **Banaras** with a famous library. He led a deputation of pandits to Shah Jahan and secured the remission of the **pilgrim tax** at Banaras and Allahabad. He wrote the Hindi work **Kavindrakalpalata**, which includes verses in praise of Shah Jahan. **Pandit Jagannath**, author of the **Rasagangadhara**, was another Sanskrit scholar at the court and received the title **Panditraj**. **Chandrabhan Brahman** was a Persian poet and munshi.

UP link: Kavindracharya worked at **Varanasi** (Varanasi district), and the tax he got lifted was levied at Varanasi and at **Allahabad** (Prayagraj district).

Traveller	Origin	Period in India	Work or note
Peter Mundy	England	1628 to 1634, Shah Jahan	Describes the Deccan and Gujarat famine of 1630 to 1632 and Agra
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	France (jeweller)	Six voyages, 1630s to 1660s	Travels in India. Describes the Peacock Throne and the great diamonds
Francois Bernier	France (physician)	About 1658 to 1669, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Travels in the Mogul Empire. Eyewitness to the war of succession
Niccolao Manucci	Venice	From 1656, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Storia do Mogor. Gunner in Dara Shikoh's army

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Shah Jahan's court figures (Mir Jumla, Kalim, Kavindracharya) were asked in 2015 and 2022. Pandit Jagannath (Panditraj) and the historians Abdul Hamid Lahori (Padshahnama) and Inayat Khan (Shahjahannama) are the untested names in the same group.

17.4 Deccan and North-West Frontier Policy

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2009

Q. Who among the following was the governor of Deccan for the major part of Shah Jahan's reign?

- (a) Dara Shikoh
- (b) Murad Baksh
- (c) Shah Shuja
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (d)

Aurangzeb was viceroy of the Deccan twice, from **1636 to 1644** and again from **1652** until he marched north in the war of succession. In his second term the revenue officer **Murshid Quli Khan** extended the zabti system to the Deccan. Aurangzeb attacked Golconda (1656) and Bijapur (1657) but Shah Jahan, advised by Dara, made him accept peace. Of the other princes, Shuja governed Bengal, Murad Gujarat, and Dara stayed at court.

Front	Event	Year
Bundelkhand	Revolt of Jujhar Singh Bundela of Orchha crushed	1628 to 1635
Bengal	Portuguese expelled from Hugli	1632
Ahmadnagar	Fort of Daulatabad taken and the Nizam Shahi kingdom annexed	1633
Bijapur and Golconda	Treaties of 1636. Golconda accepted Mughal overlordship. Deccan organised into four subas	1636
Kandahar	Recovered when the Persian governor Ali Mardan Khan surrendered it	1638
Balkh and Badakhshan	Central Asian campaign under Murad and then Aurangzeb. Abandoned	1646 to 1647
Kandahar	Lost to Persia. Three sieges failed (Aurangzeb twice, Dara once)	1649, 1652, 1653

TRAP ALERT

Ahmadnagar was annexed under **Shah Jahan** (1633). Bijapur (1686) and Golconda (1687) fell to **Aurangzeb as emperor** (Chapter 18). Kandahar was lost twice: 1622 under Jahangir and 1649 under Shah Jahan.

17.5 Dara Shikoh, the War of Succession and Shah Jahan's Captivity

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992, 2009, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006

Q. Upanishads were translated into Persian during the reign of :

- (a) Shah Jahan
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (a)

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2004, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000

Q. The Upanishads were translated into Persian by Dara Shikoh under the title

Ans. Sirr-i-Akbar

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. Who was the author of Sirr-i-Akbar?

Ans. Dara Shikoh

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2014

Q. Who was given the title of 'Shah Buland Iqbal' by Shah Jahan?

Ans. Dara Shikoh

Dara Shikoh (1615 to 1659), Shah Jahan's eldest son, was a Sufi of the **Qadiri** order, a disciple of Mian Mir and Mulla Shah Badakhshi. In 1657, with the help of pandits, he completed the **Sirr-i-Akbar** ("the great secret"), a Persian translation of about 50 Upanishads (the source gives 52). A Latin version of it by Anquetil-Duperron (Oupnek'hat, 1801 to 1802) carried the Upanishads to Europe. His own work **Majma-ul-Bahrain** ("the mingling of the two oceans") compares Sufi and Vedantic ideas. Shah Jahan gave him the title **Shah Buland Iqbal**. Stanley Lane-Poole called him "the Little Akbar" for his liberal outlook.

Work	Nature
Sirr-i-Akbar (1657)	Persian translation of the Upanishads
Majma-ul-Bahrain	Original work comparing Sufism and Vedanta
Safinat-ul-Auliya, Sakinat-ul-Auliya	Biographies of Sufi saints
Persian versions of the Bhagavad Gita and the Yoga Vasishtha	Translations made under his patronage

TRAP ALERT

Sirr-i-Akbar has nothing to do with Emperor Akbar. Under Akbar the **Mahabharata** (Razmnama) and Ramayana were translated, not the Upanishads. Translation = Sirr-i-Akbar. Original work = Majma-ul-Bahrain.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003

Q. The First Muslim to study Hindu scriptures was :

- (a) Amir Khusrau
- (b) Dara Shikoh
- (c) Amir Hasan
- (d) Shuja

Ans. (b)

The key holds only "among the given options". Dara studied the Upanishads, the Gita and the Yoga Vasishtha closely and had them translated. Long before him, **Al-Biruni** (11th century) learnt Sanskrit and studied Hindu texts for his Kitab-ul-Hind, and Akbar's translation bureau rendered several Sanskrit works into Persian. Amir Khusrau and Amir Hasan were Persian poets of the Sultanate. **Shuja** was Dara's brother, governor of Bengal.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Where was Dara Shikoh buried?

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Agra
- (c) Aurangabad
- (d) Lahore

Ans. (a)

Shah Jahan fell ill in September 1657 and his four sons fought for the throne. Dara was beaten at **Samugarh** (1658) and **Deorai** (1659), handed over by an Afghan chief he had trusted, paraded through Delhi and executed in 1659. Contemporary accounts, including Manucci's, say his body was buried in the **Humayun's Tomb** complex in Delhi. The exact grave is not marked, and in 2020 the Ministry of Culture set up an Archaeological Survey of India panel to try to identify it. The source mentions a story that his head was buried at Agra, but Delhi is the accepted answer.

Aurangzeb took the **Agra Fort** in June 1658 and kept Shah Jahan a prisoner there until his death in **1666**, with his daughter **Jahanara** caring for him. He was buried beside Mumtaz Mahal in the Taj. **UP link:** Samugarh lies near Agra, and the battle of Bahadurpur near **Varanasi** (1658), where Dara's son Sulaiman Shikoh defeated Shuja, was also fought in present UP. The full sequence of battles is in Chapter 18.

Son	Post in 1657	Fate
Dara Shikoh (eldest)	At court, heir favoured by Shah Jahan	Defeated at Samugarh and Deorai. Executed 1659. Buried in Humayun's Tomb complex, Delhi
Shah Shuja	Governor of Bengal	Defeated at Bahadurpur (1658) and Khajwa (1659). Fled to Arakan
Aurangzeb	Viceroy of the Deccan	Won. Emperor 1658
Murad Bakhsh	Governor of Gujarat	Allied with Aurangzeb, then imprisoned and executed (1661)

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Dara Shikoh has six items across 1992 to 2017, the densest cluster of the chapter. Majma-ul-Bahrain and the Qadiri link are the next facts in line, and the war of succession is the bridge to Aurangzeb.

Chapter 17: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Dara Shikoh: Surr-i-Akbar, title, burial	6	1992-2017	Recurring (3 PYQs + 3 one-liners)
Court culture: Koh-i-Noor, Kalim, Kavindracharya	4	2000-2022	Recurring (3 PYQs + 1 one-liner)
Capital to Delhi and abolition of sijda	2	2008-2010	Occasional
Red Fort and Jama Masjid of Delhi	2	2002-2010	Occasional
Aurangzeb as Deccan viceroy	1	2009	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (11 PYQs + 4 one-liners). The pattern is "who did this" attribution: Dara and the Upanishads, Shah Jahan and the Red Fort, Jama Masjid and sijda, Mir Jumla and the diamond. Dara Shikoh is the single most tested person in this chapter. UPPSC asked about the Sanskrit scholar Kavindracharya twice (2000, 2022), both times with a Varanasi angle. Surprisingly, the Taj Mahal itself has no direct PYQ in this source, so the Agra monuments table in 17.2 is preparation for an untested but obvious UP question. Separate the two Moti Masjids and the two Jama Masjids before the exam.

Chapter 18

Aurangzeb

Aurangzeb (reign 1658 to 1707) took the title Alamgir ("conqueror of the world") after winning the war of succession against his brothers. He ruled for nearly fifty years and carried the empire to its greatest extent with the conquest of Bijapur (1686) and Golconda (1687). His reign also saw a stricter religious and court policy, the reimposition of jizya in 1679, revolts by Jats, Satnamis, Bundelas, Sikhs, Afghans and Rajputs, and a long war with the Marathas that kept him in the Deccan from 1682 until his death at Ahmednagar in 1707. This chapter covers the succession and coronations, personal piety and religious policy, the revolts, the Deccan, the royal family, and the buildings of the reign. It contains **16 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. The succession battles and the Deccan together account for 9 items.

18.1 The War of Succession and the Two Coronations

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1994

Q. Assertion (A) : Aurangzeb succeeded Shah Jahan to the Mughal throne.

Reason (R) : The law of primogeniture was followed.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (c)

The Mughals had no fixed law of succession. Following the Timurid custom, every son had a claim, and the sword decided. Aurangzeb was the **third** son of Shah Jahan, after Dara Shikoh and Shah Shuja, so **primogeniture** (succession of the eldest son) was clearly not followed. A is true and R is false.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2009

Q. Who of the following Mughal emperor was crowned twice?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (d)

Aurangzeb crowned himself hurriedly at Delhi in **July 1658**, soon after taking the Agra Fort and imprisoning Shah Jahan. With Dara still at large, a formal second coronation followed at Delhi on **5 June 1659**, after the victory at Deorai. He then took the full title **Abul Muzaffar Muhiuddin Muhammad Aurangzeb Bahadur Alamgir Padshah Ghazi**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2022

Q. Consider the following events of the reign of Aurangzeb and arrange them in chronological order:

1. Battle of Deorai
2. Defeat of Shuja near Banaras
3. Battle of Samugarh
4. Victory at Dharmat

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Code:

- (a) 1, 3, 4 and 2
- (b) 4, 2, 1 and 3
- (c) 2, 4, 3 and 1
- (d) 3, 4, 2 and 1

Ans. (c)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Arrange the following battles in chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- I. Battle of Sarnal II. Battle of Bilgram
- III. Battle of Dharmat IV. Battle of Jajau

Codes :

- (a) II, I, III, IV
- (b) II, III, IV, I
- (c) III, II, I, IV
- (d) III, I, II, IV

Ans. (a)

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Bilgram (Kannauj)	1540	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Humayun driven into exile
Sarnal (Gujarat)	1572	Akbar vs Ibrahim Husain Mirza	Part of Akbar's Gujarat campaign
Bahadurpur (near Banaras)	February 1658	Sulaiman Shikoh (Dara's son) and Mirza Raja Jai Singh vs Shah Shuja	Shuja pushed back to Bengal
Dharmat (near Ujjain)	April 1658	Aurangzeb and Murad vs Maharaja Jaswant Singh and Qasim Khan	First victory of Aurangzeb
Samugarh (near Agra)	May 1658	Aurangzeb and Murad vs Dara Shikoh	Decisive. Agra Fort taken in June
Khajwa (Fatehpur)	January 1659	Aurangzeb vs Shah Shuja	Shuja fled to Arakan
Deorai (near Ajmer)	March 1659	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	Dara's last battle. Second coronation followed
Jajau (near Agra)	June 1707	Prince Muazzam (Bahadur Shah I) vs Azam Shah	War of succession after Aurangzeb. Azam killed

UP link: four of these battles were fought in present Uttar Pradesh: **Bilgram** (Hardoi district, across the Ganga from Kannauj), **Bahadurpur** near **Varanasi**, **Samugarh** near **Agra**, and **Khajwa** in **Fatehpur district**.

TRAP ALERT

"Defeat of Shuja near Banaras" was not Aurangzeb's own battle. Shuja was beaten there by **Dara's** son Sulaiman Shikoh, two months before Dharmat. That is why it comes first in the 2022 order. Do not confuse it with **Khajwa** (1659), where Aurangzeb himself defeated Shuja.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Battle-order questions appeared in 2019 and 2022, both mixing the succession battles with other reigns. Khajwa (Fatehpur) is the untested UP battle in this sequence.

18.2 Zinda Pir: Personal Piety, Court Policy and Jizya

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Who among the following was called as a 'Zinda Pir'?

- (a) Bahadur Shah I
- (b) Shah Alam II
- (c) Aurangzeb
- (d) Adil Shah

Ans. (c)

Aurangzeb led an austere personal life. He avoided wine and display, said his prayers regularly and is said to have met part of his personal expenses by stitching caps and copying the Quran. Contemporaries therefore called him a "royal dervish", and his Muslim subjects called him **Zinda Pir** ("living saint").

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2002

Q. Who re-imposed Jizya ?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Aurangzeb
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Humayun

Ans. (b)

Akbar abolished jizya, the poll tax on non-Muslims, in 1564. **Aurangzeb reimposed it in 1679**. The table lists the main documented measures of his religious and court policy. Historians differ on how far these were driven by belief and how far by political and financial needs, and the exam asks only for the facts.

Measure	Detail
Fatawa-i-Alamgiri	Digest of Hanafi law compiled by a board of ulema under Shaikh Nizam Burhanpuri
Muhtasibs	Officers appointed to enforce public morals
Court ceremony	Jharokha darshan, tuladan and Nauroz celebrations discontinued. The kalima removed from coins
Music and history	Court musicians dismissed. Official history writing stopped after the first ten years (Alamgirnama by Mirza Muhammad Kazim)
Jizya	Reimposed in 1679
Temples	The Maasir-i-Alamgiri of Saqi Mustaid Khan records orders of 1669 against temples, including the Vishwanath temple at Varanasi (1669) and the Keshava Deva temple at Mathura (1670). Farmans granting land to some temples and maths, such as the Jangam math at Varanasi, also survive

UP link: two of the temples named in the Maasir-i-Alamgiri stood at **Varanasi** and **Mathura**, both in present UP.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998, 2000, U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. Which one of the following emperors had the highest number of Hindu generals in the Mughal army:

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (d)

The answer surprises students who equate Akbar with Rajput alliances. M. Athar Ali's study of the Mughal nobility shows that in the second half of Aurangzeb's reign (1679 to 1707) about **31.6 per cent** of the higher mansabdars were Hindus, against about 22.5 per cent under Akbar and 22.4 per cent under Shah Jahan. More than half of Aurangzeb's Hindu nobles were **Marathas** drawn in during the Deccan wars.

TRAP ALERT

Do not answer from the reputation of the ruler. The question is about **numbers and share** of Hindu nobles, and the data point to Aurangzeb.

18.3 Revolts of the Reign and Prince Akbar's Rebellion

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Which son of Aurangzeb revolted against his father, weakening his father's position against the Rajputs?

- (a) Azam
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Muazzam
- (d) Kam Baksh

Ans. (b)

When Maharaja **Jaswant Singh** of Marwar died at Jamrud in 1678, Aurangzeb took Marwar under direct control. The Rathors under **Durgadas Rathore** protected Jaswant Singh's infant son **Ajit Singh**, and Rana Raj Singh of Mewar joined them. In 1681 Aurangzeb's son **Prince Muhammad Akbar**, sent against them, went over to the Rajputs and proclaimed himself emperor. The revolt collapsed, and Durgadas escorted Akbar to the Maratha ruler **Sambhaji**. Aurangzeb made peace with Mewar in 1681 and moved to the Deccan in 1682 to deal with the threat. Akbar later fled to Persia and died there.

Revolt	Leaders	Region	Course
Jats	Gokula (1669), then Rajaram and Churaman	Mathura and Agra region	Gokula defeated and executed (1670). Rajaram plundered Akbar's tomb at Sikandra (1688). Led later to the Jat state of Bharatpur
Satnamis	Satnami sect, mostly peasants and artisans	Narnaul (Haryana), 1672	Crushed by an imperial army
Bundelas	Champat Rai, then his son Chhatrasal	Bundelkhand	Chhatrasal built a kingdom with its capital at Panna. Bajirao I aided him in 1729
Sikhs	Guru Tegh Bahadur , then Guru Gobind Singh	Punjab	Guru Tegh Bahadur executed at Delhi (1675). Guru Gobind Singh founded the Khalsa (1699)

Revolt	Leaders	Region	Course
Afghans	Yusufzais, Afridis (Aimal Khan), Khushhal Khan Khattak	North-west frontier	Revolts from 1667. Aurangzeb went to the frontier himself in 1674
Rajputs	Durgadas Rathore for Ajit Singh. Rana Raj Singh of Mewar	Marwar and Mewar, from 1679	Prince Akbar's revolt (1681). Peace with Mewar 1681. Marwar resistance continued after 1707

UP link: the Jat revolt began around **Mathura** (Mathura district), and Rajaram's raid struck **Akbar's tomb at Sikandra** (Agra district). Bundelkhand includes the UP districts of **Jhansi**, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, **Mahoba**, **Banda** and Chitrakoot. After Chhatrasal's death (1731) the Peshwa's share of his kingdom included Jhansi and Kalpi (Jalaun district).

TRAP ALERT

Four sons, four roles. **Muhammad Akbar** rebelled in 1681. **Muazzam** succeeded as Bahadur Shah I. **Azam** died at Jajau (1707) and supervised the building of the Bibi ka Maqbara. **Kam Bakhsh** was killed in 1709 near Hyderabad.

18.4 Deccan Policy: Shivaji, Bijapur, Golconda and the Marathas

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2008, 2009, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A (SPL) (PRE) 2010, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A (SPL) (MAINS) 2010, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2011

Q. With which Mughal General did Shivaji sign the Treaty of Purandar is 1665 ?

- (a) Diler Khan
- (b) Jai Singh
- (c) Jaswant Singh
- (d) Shaista Khan

Ans. (b)

In 1665 Aurangzeb sent the Kachhwaha **Mirza Raja Jai Singh** of Amber against Shivaji. After the Mughals besieged **Purandar**, Shivaji signed the treaty in **June 1665**. He gave up 23 forts and kept 12, his son Sambhaji received a mansab of 5000, and he agreed to help the Mughals against Bijapur. **Diler Khan** was Jai Singh's colleague at the siege, which makes him the close distractor. **Shaista Khan**, Aurangzeb's maternal uncle, was the governor surprised by Shivaji's night raid at Pune in 1663.

Year	Event
1659	Shivaji kills Afzal Khan of Bijapur
1663	Night attack on Shaista Khan at Pune
1664	First sack of Surat
1665	Treaty of Purandar with Jai Singh
1666	Shivaji at Aurangzeb's court in Agra . Placed under watch, he escapes
1674	Coronation at Raigad
1680	Death of Shivaji. Sambhaji succeeds
1686	Bijapur annexed (Sikandar Adil Shah)
1687	Golconda annexed (Abul Hasan Qutb Shah)
1689	Sambhaji captured and executed. Rajaram moves to Jinji
1707	Aurangzeb dies at Ahmednagar with the Maratha war unfinished

UP link: Shivaji's visit and escape of **1666** took place at **Agra** (Agra district).

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2004, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. Two of the following states, which Aurangzeb had conquered in the Deccan, were :

- (a) Ahmednagar and Bijapur
- (b) Bidar and Bijapur
- (c) Bijapur and Golconda
- (d) Golconda and Ahmednagar

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. When did Aurangzeb achieve victory over Bijapur?

Ans. 1686

As Deccan viceroy under Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb attacked Golconda (1656) and Bijapur (1657) but was ordered to make peace. As emperor he finished the work: **Bijapur fell in 1686** and **Golconda in 1687**. **Ahmadnagar** had been annexed in 1633 under Shah Jahan, and **Bidar** was taken in 1657, also in Shah Jahan's reign, so options (a), (b) and (d) each contain a state that was not conquered by Aurangzeb as emperor.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Who was the ruler of Golconda when Aurangzeb seized the fort of Golconda in 1687?

- (a) Abul Hasan Qutb Shah
- (b) Sikandar Adil Shah
- (c) Ali Adil Shah II
- (d) Shayasta Khan

Ans. (a)

Abul Hasan Qutb Shah, also called **Tana Shah**, was the last Qutb Shahi king. After a siege of about eight months the fort was entered when a gate was opened by bribery, which the source compares to Akbar's "golden key" at Asirgarh (1601). **Sikandar Adil Shah** was the last ruler of **Bijapur**, and **Ali Adil Shah II** was his predecessor. **Shaista Khan** was a Mughal general.

TRAP ALERT

Pair the last kings correctly: **Bijapur 1686 = Sikandar Adil Shah**. **Golconda 1687 = Abul Hasan Qutb Shah**. Both Adil Shah options belong to Bijapur.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Saint Ramdas is associated with the period of rule of :

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (d)

Samarth Ramdas (1608 to 1681) of Maharashtra, author of the **Dasbodh**, lived through the reigns of Jahangir, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb. He is linked with Aurangzeb's reign because his influence peaked then, and Maratha tradition regards him as a spiritual guide of Shivaji. Do not confuse him with **Guru Ram Das**, the fourth Sikh Guru, a contemporary of Akbar.

The Maratha forts of this period are now a World Heritage property. The serial site "**Maratha Military Landscapes of India**", 12 forts including Raigad, Rajgad, Pratapgad and Jinji, was inscribed as India's 44th World Heritage Site in July 2025.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The Treaty of Purandar has been asked in five papers (2008 to 2011). With the 2025 World Heritage listing of the Maratha forts, a question linking forts to events (Raigad and the 1674 coronation, Jinji and Rajaram) is a reasonable next angle.

18.5 The Royal Family: Sisters and Daughters

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Who among the following was the daughter of Emperor Aurangzeb?

- (a) Jahan Ara
- (b) Roshan Ara
- (c) Gauhar Ara
- (d) Mehrunnisa

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. To whom Aurangzeb bestowed upon the title of 'Sahibat-uz-Zamani'?

- (a) Shaista Khan
- (b) Amin Khan
- (c) Jahan Ara
- (d) Roshan Ara

Ans. (c)

Name	Relation to Aurangzeb	Note
Jahan Ara	Elder sister (eldest daughter of Shah Jahan and Mumtaz Mahal)	Sided with Dara. Cared for Shah Jahan in captivity. Given the title Sahibat-uz-Zamani by Aurangzeb. Built the Jama Masjid at Agra
Roshan Ara	Sister	Supported Aurangzeb in the war of succession
Gauhar Ara	Sister	Supported Murad
Zeb-un-Nissa	Daughter	Persian poet, pen name Makhfi
Mehr-un-Nissa	Daughter	The answer to the 2005 PYQ
Zinat-un-Nissa, Badr-un-Nissa, Zubdat-un-Nissa	Daughters	None

The **-ara** names (Jahan Ara, Roshan Ara, Gauhar Ara) are Shah Jahan's daughters, so all three are Aurangzeb's sisters. Aurangzeb's daughters have **-nissa** names. After Shah Jahan's death in 1666 Aurangzeb was reconciled with Jahan Ara and honoured her as Sahibat-uz-Zamani. Shaista Khan and Amin Khan are male nobles, which removes (a) and (b) at once.

TRAP ALERT

Mehrunnisa was also Nur Jahan's birth name (Chapter 16). In a question about Aurangzeb's family, it means his daughter.

18.6 Buildings of the Reign and Aurangzeb's Death

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2000, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Which one of the following tombs is called the 'Second Taj Mahal'?

- (a) Tomb of Anarkali
- (b) Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula
- (c) Tomb of Rabia-ud-Daurani
- (d) None of these

Ans. (c)

The **Bibi ka Maqbara** at **Aurangabad** is the tomb of Aurangzeb's wife **Dilras Banu Begum**, known as **Rabia-ud-Daurani**. It was built in the 1660s under the supervision of their son **Azam Shah** and closely copies the plan of the Taj Mahal, hence "Second Taj" or "Taj of the Deccan". It is smaller and less refined. Aurangabad city was renamed **Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar** after the Centre approved the change in February 2023. The **tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula** in Agra is the "Baby Taj", and the **tomb of Anarkali** is in Lahore.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2001, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002

Q. Moti Masjid in the Red Fort at Delhi was built by :

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (d)

Aurangzeb added a small marble mosque, the **Moti Masjid**, inside the Delhi Red Fort for his private prayers, soon after his accession. The far larger **Badshahi Mosque** of Lahore (1673 to 1674) is his main building. Shah Jahan built the Moti Masjid inside the **Agra Fort** and the Jama Masjid outside the Delhi Red Fort.

Monument	Builder	Place
Moti Masjid (Red Fort)	Aurangzeb	Delhi
Moti Masjid (Agra Fort)	Shah Jahan	Agra, UP
Badshahi Mosque	Aurangzeb (1673 to 1674)	Lahore, Pakistan
Bibi ka Maqbara	Azam Shah, for his mother Rabia-ud-Daurani	Aurangabad, now Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar
Tomb of Aurangzeb	Simple open grave near the dargah of Shaikh Zainuddin	Khuldabad, Maharashtra

Aurangzeb died on **3 March 1707 at Ahmednagar** and was buried, as he wished, in an unroofed grave at **Khuldabad** near Aurangabad. Ahmednagar has since been renamed **Ahilyanagar** (Maharashtra cabinet decision March 2024, gazette notification October 2024). His sons fought a fresh war of succession, decided at **Jajau** (1707) in favour of Bahadur Shah I.

TRAP ALERT

Moti Masjid of the **Red Fort** = Aurangzeb. Moti Masjid of the **Agra Fort** = Shah Jahan. "Second Taj" = Bibi ka Maqbara. "Baby Taj" = Itimad-ud-Daula.

Chapter 18: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Deccan: Purandar, Bijapur and Golconda, Ramdas	5	1992-2020	Recurring (4 PYQs + 1 one-liner)
Succession: primogeniture, two coronations, battle order	4	1994-2022	Recurring (order questions 2019, 2022)
Piety and policy: Zinda Pir, jizya, Hindu nobles	3	1998-2017	Steady
Royal family: daughter, Sahibat-uz-Zamani	2	2005-2014	Occasional
Buildings: Second Taj, Moti Masjid	2	2000-2013	Occasional (4 papers)
Prince Akbar's revolt	1	2007	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 17 items (16 PYQs + 1 one-liner), the largest of the three later-Mughal chapters. Two blocks dominate: the Deccan (Purandar alone in five papers, Bijapur 1686 and Golconda 1687) and the war of succession, which UPPSC now tests through chronological-order questions (2019, 2022). Several items reward elimination by rule rather than recall: Aurangzeb was the third son, so no primogeniture, the "-ara" princesses are Shah Jahan's daughters, and Ahmadnagar and Bidar fell under Shah Jahan. The revolts table has no direct PYQ yet, but the Jat revolt around Mathura and Chhatrasal in Bundelkhand are the obvious UP angles.

Chapter 19

Mughal Administration

The Mughal state was built by Akbar (1556 to 1605) on three linked institutions: a central government of specialised ministers under the emperor, the **mansabdari** system that ranked every officer and tied pay to military duty, and a measured land-revenue system worked out by **Raja Todar Mal** and fixed in the **Ain-i-Dahsala** of 1580. Revenue was collected through a ladder of territorial units: subah, sarkar, pargana and village. This chapter covers the nature of the state and the central officers, the provincial and local units, mansabdari and jagirdari, land revenue with its terms and land classes, coinage, and a few stray topics (Europeans in Mughal service, the tobacco ban, the Shihab canal). It contains **18 PYQs and 2 one-liners**. Read it with the Sultanate administration in Chapter 7, because many Mughal terms (sarkar, pargana, shiqdar, amil, khalisa) continue from the Sultanate and Sher Shah.

19.1 Nature of the State and the Central Officers

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE.) 2021

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : The Mughal Empire was originally a Military State.

Reason (R) : The vitality of the development of the Central Government System depended on its military power.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

Ans. (a)

Historians debate whether "military state" is the right label, but the key rests on how the empire actually worked. Every high officer, civil or military, held a **mansab** (military rank) and had to maintain a fixed number of cavalry. The empire was won and held by its army, and the centre stayed strong only while the emperor commanded the army and the mansabdars. That is why (R) explains (A). The same logic shows in the decline: when the jagir system and the army weakened after Aurangzeb, central authority collapsed.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Which of the following was the head of the army in Mughal period ?

- (a) Shane-e-Peel
- (b) Mir Bakshi
- (c) Wazir
- (d) Sawahenigar

Ans. (b)

The **Mir Bakhshi** headed the military department. Orders appointing mansabdars of every grade passed through him. He kept the muster rolls, saw to the branding of horses (dagh) and the inspection of troopers, and fixed where troops were posted. News writers (waqia-navis) in the provinces sent reports through his office, so he also supervised intelligence. The emperor himself was the supreme commander. The Mir Bakhshi was its chief administrator, not a field general. The distractors are a **shahna-i-pil** (officer in charge of

elephants), the **wazir** (finance) and the **sawanih-nigar** (a news reporter).

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. In Mughal era duty of Mir Bakshi was

Ans. Supervision of land revenue officials and head of Military department

Officer	Department or duty	Note
Wakil (vakil-us-saltanat)	Chief minister and regent with wide powers	Bairam Khan held it for the young Akbar. Akbar then cut its powers and made it largely honorary
Diwan or Wazir (diwan-i-kul)	Finance and revenue. Checked all income and expenditure	Took over the real work of the wakil after Akbar's reforms
Mir Bakhshi	Military department, mansabdar appointments, muster, branding, intelligence reports	Head of the army administration
Sadr-us-Sudur	Religious affairs, charity and revenue-free grants (madad-i-maash, suyurghal)	Often also the chief qazi
Qazi-ul-Quzat	Chief judge. Justice under Islamic law	Emperor was the final court of appeal
Mir Saman (khan-i-saman)	Royal household, stores and the karkhanas (state workshops)	Not a revenue officer
Muhtasib	Censor of public morals, also checked weights and measures	Given greater weight by Aurangzeb
Daroga-i-Dak Chauki	Imperial post and intelligence	Worked with the news writers

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists :

List-I (Emperor)	List-II (Diwan)
A. Akbar	1. Ghiyas Beg Itimad-ud-Daulah
B. Jahangir	2. Asad Khan
C. Shah Jahan	3. Muzaffar Khan
D. Aurangzeb	4. Sadullah Khan

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 1 4 3 2
- (b) 2 3 1 4
- (c) 3 2 1 4
- (d) 3 1 4 2

Ans. (d)

Muzaffar Khan Turbati was Akbar's diwan in the early reforms of the 1560s and 1570s, before Todar Mal rose to the office. **Ghiyas Beg**, father of Nur Jahan, became Jahangir's diwan with the title **Itimad-ud-Daula**. **Sadullah Khan** was Shah Jahan's diwan. **Asad Khan** served Aurangzeb as wazir for the last three decades of the reign. Start with the surest pair: Itimad-ud-Daula with Jahangir (B-1) leaves only option (d).

UP link: Ghiyas Beg's tomb, the **Itimad-ud-Daula** at **Agra**, was built by Nur Jahan. It is the first Mughal building faced in white marble with pietra dura inlay.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Officer)	List-II (Assigned Duty)
A. Diwan-i-Tan	1. Look after the office
B. Mustarfi	2. Maintained a proper list of main events and firmans
C. Mushrif	3. Look after the Jagir and Salaries
D. Waqia-navis	4. Examine the income expenditure of State

Codes :

A B C D

(a) 2 4 1 3

(b) 3 4 1 2

(c) 1 3 2 4

(d) 4 1 2 3

Ans. (b)

The diwan ran a large office. Under him the **diwan-i-tan** handled salaries and jagirs (tan means pay), and the **diwan-i-khalisa** handled crown lands. The **mustarfi** (printed Mustarfi) was the auditor of income and expenditure. The **mushrif** was the chief accountant who ran the office records. The **waqia-navis** recorded events and farmans and sent news to the court. Waqia-navis is the easiest anchor because "waqia" means event. Diwan-i-tan with jagirs and salaries then leaves only (b).

TRAP ALERT

Do not mix the two military-sounding officers. The **Mir Bakhshi** is the military paymaster and recruiter. The **diwan-i-tan** is a finance officer who assigned the jagirs that paid mansabdars. Salary questions can point to either, so read whether the stem asks about appointment and muster or about pay and jagir.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Four of the five items here are from 2020 and 2021, all on officer and function. The untested names in the table (sadr-us-sudur, mir saman, muhtasib) suit the same match format.

19.2 Subah, Sarkar, Pargana: Provincial and Local Units

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2009

Q. What was the district called during the Mughal period?

- (a) Iqta
- (b) Sarkar
- (c) Tarf
- (d) Suba

Ans. (b)

Akbar divided the empire into **12 subahs** (provinces) in 1580. Conquests in the Deccan raised the number to 15 by the end of his reign. Each subah was divided into **sarkars** (districts), each sarkar into **parganas** (also called mahals), and each pargana into villages. The **iqta** was the Sultanate's revenue assignment and province, and **tarf** was a division of a province in the Deccan kingdoms (Bahmani reforms of Mahmud Gawan). Neither is the Mughal district.

Unit	Officer	Duty
Subah (province)	Subahdar (sipahsalar, nazim)	Governor: army, law and order
	Provincial diwan	Revenue and finance. Appointed by and reporting to the central diwan, a check on the subahdar
	Bakhshi, sadr, qazi, waqia-navis	Provincial branches of the central departments
Sarkar (district)	Faujdar	Military commander, law and order
	Amalguzar	Revenue collector of the sarkar
Town	Kotwal	Police, markets, sanitation and order in cities
Pargana (mahal)	Shiqdar	Law and order, general administration
	Amil	Revenue assessment and collection
	Qanungo	Keeper of pargana revenue records. A hereditary local office
	Fotadar, karkun	Treasurer and clerk
Village	Muqaddam, patwari	Headman and village accountant

UP link: Three of Akbar's original 12 subahs, **Agra, Allahabad** (now Prayagraj, renamed 2018) and **Awadh**, covered most of present-day Uttar Pradesh. Akbar built the Allahabad fort at the Sangam in the 1580s.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. The term 'Chakla' has been used in Medieval Indian History sources. This was

- (a) Identical to Parganah
- (b) Identical to Sarkar
- (c) Territorial unit between Suba and Parganah, but not identical to Sarkar
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (c)

Under **Shah Jahan** a group of parganas was combined into a new unit called the **chakla**. It sat above the pargana and below the subah, but it was a separate revenue grouping and did not coincide with the sarkar. That rules out (a) and (b). The chakla became an important unit later in Bengal under the nawabs.

TRAP ALERT

The order runs subah, sarkar, pargana, village. A question that asks for the district wants **sarkar**, not subah. The chakla is the extra unit and is "between" subah and pargana without being a sarkar.

19.3 The Mansabdari System and Jagirs

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. With reference to Mansabdari system, which of the statements is/are correct?

1. Mansabdari system was the official nobility of the state, started by Akbar.
2. A Mansabdari was hereditary.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) Both 1 and 2
(c) 2 only
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a)

Mansab means rank or position. Every officer of the empire, civil or military, was a **mansabdar**, so the mansabdars formed the official nobility. The rank fixed his status, his pay and the troops he had to keep. Akbar built the system in stages. The source dates its start to his 11th regnal year (1567). Many textbooks date the full system to 1573 to 1575, when fixed grades, branding of horses and descriptive rolls of troopers were enforced. The dual rank of **zat** and **sawar** appears around his 40th regnal year (1595). Appointment, promotion and dismissal lay with the emperor alone, and the rank lapsed with service. It was **not hereditary**. On a noble's death his assets were checked against dues to the state (escheat, zabt) before anything passed to his heirs.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Mansab	Rank. Fixed status, pay and military duty	Akbar
Zat	Personal rank. Fixed status and personal salary	Akbar, dual rank from about 1595
Sawar	Number of cavalymen the mansabdar had to maintain	Could not exceed the zat
33 grades	Ranks from 10 to 10,000. Above 5,000 normally reserved for princes	Akbar. Man Singh and Mirza Aziz Koka reached 7,000
Mashrut	Conditional rank, a temporary rise in sawar for a special task	From Jahangir onward
Du-aspa sih-aspa	Troopers with two or three horses, added to the sawar rank without raising zat	Jahangir (first given to Mahabat Khan)
Dagh and chehra	Branding of horses and descriptive roll of each trooper, to stop false musters	Akbar revived dagh (used earlier by Alauddin Khalji and Sher Shah)
Naqdi	Mansabdar paid in cash	Alternative to jagir
Jagir (tankwah jagir)	Assignment of land revenue in place of salary. Transferable	Jagirdars were moved every few years
Watan jagir	Hereditary homeland of an autonomous chief, held as a jagir	Rajput chiefs. The one hereditary exception
Khalisa	Crown land. Revenue went to the imperial treasury	Paid for the emperor and his household
Month scale	Jagirs rated by the months of pay they actually yielded	Shah Jahan, as real collection fell below the paper estimate (jama)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Which one of the following is not true about the Mughal Mansabdari System ?

- (a) There were 33 divisions.
(b) They got conditional or Mashrut rank.
(c) Their 'Sawar' rank could exceed the 'Zat' rank.
(d) All civil and military officers were given mansabs.

Ans. (c)

The sawar rank could equal the zat but **never exceed** it. That makes (c) the false statement. The 33 grades, the conditional (mashrut) rank and the single cadre for civil and military officers are all genuine features. The relation of sawar to zat fixed the **class** of a mansabdar within his grade.

Class	Sawar rank compared with zat	Example (zat 1,000)
First	Sawar equal to zat	1,000 zat, 1,000 sawar
Second	Sawar half or more of zat, but less than zat	1,000 zat, 500 to 999 sawar
Third	Sawar less than half of zat	1,000 zat, below 500 sawar

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (MAINS) 2010, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2010

Q. Consider the following statements about Mughal Mansabdari and select the correct answer by using codes below:

1. 'Zat' and 'Mansab' designations were granted.
2. Mansabdars were hereditary officials.
3. There were three classes of Mansabdars.
4. Their salary was paid by Diwan Office.

Code :

- (a) Four statements are true.
(b) Four statements are false.
(c) Only 1, 2 & 3 are true.
(d) Only 1 & 3 are true.

Ans. (d)

Statement 2 is false, since mansabs were not hereditary. That alone removes (a) and (c). Statement 3 is true (the three classes in the table above), which removes (b). Only (d) survives. The source treats statement 4 as false because mansabdars were paid either in cash or by a jagir. Statement 1 is loosely worded. The pair actually granted was **zat and sawar**, both parts of the mansab.

TRAP ALERT

Elimination beats recall here. Once you know mansabs were not hereditary and that there were three classes, the code leaves one answer. Do not lose time on the vague statements 1 and 4.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Mansabdari has drawn three questions on the same three facts: not hereditary, sawar never above zat, three classes. Jahangir's du-aspa sih-aspa, the dagh and chehra pair and the watan jagir exception are the natural next statements.

19.4 Land Revenue: Todar Mal's Bandobast and Its Terms

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1995

Q. What was the principal source of State income in Mughal India :

- (a) Booty
- (b) Escheat
- (c) Land Revenue
- (d) Tax

Ans. (c)

Land revenue was the backbone of Mughal finance, as it had been under the Sultans. Babur and Humayun made no lasting revenue settlement. Sher Shah measured land and fixed crop rates (the **rai**), but his system lapsed after Islam Shah. Akbar rebuilt it through a series of experiments, led first by Itimad Khan and Muzaffar Khan Turbati and then by **Raja Todar Mal**. The result, called **Todar Mal's bandobast**, was the **zabti** system. In 1580 the **Ain-i-Dahsala** fixed cash rates for each crop from the average produce and prices of the previous ten years. The state share under Akbar was generally **one-third** of the produce. It rose to about half under Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb, and revenue farming (**ijara**) spread in the later period. Booty and escheat were occasional income only.

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Maal	Land revenue	General Mughal usage
Zabti (zabt)	Measurement of land and cash rates per crop per bigha	Akbar. Core provinces from Lahore to Allahabad, Malwa and Gujarat
Ain-i-Dahsala (dahsala)	Ten-year average of produce and prices used to fix cash rates	Akbar, 1580 (24th regnal year)
Jarib and Ilahi gaz	Bamboo measuring chain joined by iron rings, and the standard yard	Replaced the hemp rope that shrank and stretched
Ghalla-bakhshi or batai	Crop sharing: the harvest divided between state and peasant	Old method, still allowed. Forms: khet batai, lang batai, rasi batai
Kankut	Estimate of the standing crop, then the state share fixed	Used where measurement was not done
Nasaq	Rough assessment from past records, often fixed on the village as a lump sum	Bengal and other areas
Jama and hasil	Assessed revenue and revenue actually collected	Gap between them led to the month scale
Patta and qabuliyat	Title deed to the peasant and his deed of acceptance	Sher Shah, continued by Akbar
Taqavi	State loans to peasants for seed and cattle	Akbar and later
Karori	Officer in charge of collecting a crore of dams	Akbar's experiment of 1574 to 1575

Classification of land under Akbar

Class	Condition	Revenue
Polaj	Cultivated every year, never left fallow	Full rate every year
Parauti	Left fallow for a year or two to regain strength	Full rate when cultivated
Chachar	Fallow for three or four years	Concessional rate, rising to full
Banjar	Fallow for five years or more	Lowest rates to bring it back under the plough

TRAP ALERT

The four classes go in order of how long the land lay fallow: polaj (never), parauti (1 to 2 years), chachar (3 to 4), banjar (5 or more). A jumbled-order question is the usual trap. Polaj and parauti together paid the full rate.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2009

Q. In Mughal administrative vocabulary 'Maal' represents

- (a) Land Revenue
- (b) Salaried
- (c) Allowance
- (d) None of these

Ans. (a)

Maal (mal) meant land revenue, and the **malguzar** was the person who paid it. The word survives in the modern term **malguzari** for land revenue.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2017

Q. Which of the following systems were prevailing basis of land revenue collection in the Deccan during the reign of Akbar?

- (a) Kankut
- (b) Number of plows
- (c) Zabt
- (d) Galla Bakhshi

Ans. (b)

Todar Mal's zabti system covered the core provinces of north India. The Deccan territories that Akbar annexed late in his reign (Khandesh, Berar and part of Ahmadnagar, about 1600) had no such measured system, and peasants paid by the **number of ploughs** they worked. Measurement came to the Deccan later. **Malik Ambar** of Ahmadnagar reformed revenue on the lines of Todar Mal, and under Shah Jahan the Deccan diwan **Murshid Quli Khan** extended zabt there.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Revenue terms are the core of this chapter but the Ain-i-Dahsala, the land classes and the batai, kankut and nasaq methods have not yet been asked directly in this source. A match of method with meaning, or an order question on polaj to banjar, fits the recent pattern of term questions.

19.5 Mughal Coinage: Shahrukhi, Mohur, Rupiya and Dam

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2017

Q. Which of the following rulers popularized a silver coin named 'Shahrukhi'?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Babur
- (c) Humayun
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (b)

Babur brought the Central Asian **shahrukhi**, a thin broad silver coin named after the Timurid ruler Shah Rukh, and issued it with copper coins. Humayun continued it. The standard Mughal system came from **Sher Shah**, whose silver **rupiya** and copper **dam** Akbar adopted, adding the gold **mohur**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : Akbar, like Sher Shah, tried to regulate the currency of the state.

Reason (R) : As in Sher Shah's currency, the chief copper coin of Akbar's time was the Dam.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (a)

Note: the source keeps (a), but records that the Commission's official key was (b). Both (A) and (R) are true. The dispute is only about whether the continuity of the dam explains Akbar's effort to regulate currency. In the exam hall, (b) was the answer that scored.

Akbar, like Sher Shah, standardised weight and purity and made the mohur, rupiya and dam the coins of trade across the empire. **One rupiya equalled 40 dams**, and the state kept its revenue accounts in dams. The source argues that the continuity of the dam explains Akbar's policy. The Commission read (R) as a true but separate fact.

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2008

Q. During the Mughal rule, the copper coin was known as

Ans. Daam

Coin	Metal	Ruler or context
Shahrukhi	Silver	Babur
Rupiya	Silver	Sher Shah. Adopted by Akbar
Dam	Copper. 40 dams to a rupiya	Sher Shah. Revenue unit of the Mughals
Mohur	Gold	Akbar and later emperors
Ram-Siya coin	Silver and gold, with Rama and Sita and a Devanagari legend	Akbar, late in the reign
Zodiac coins	Gold and silver with signs of the zodiac	Jahangir

Coin	Metal	Ruler or context
Coins in Nur Jahan's name	Gold and silver	Jahangir's reign

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Who among the following rulers issued some coins with figures of Rama and Sita and Devanagari legend 'Rama-Siya'?

- (a) Bhoja
- (b) Siddharaja Jayasimha
- (c) Zain-ul-Abidin
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (d)

Late in his reign Akbar issued a small series of coins showing **Rama and Sita** with the Devanagari legend **Ram-Siya**. They belong to the same phase as his Ilahi coinage and his policy of sulh-i-kul. The distractors are rulers known for tolerance or patronage (Bhoja of Malwa, the Chaulukya Siddharaja Jayasimha, Zain-ul-Abidin of Kashmir), but none issued such coins.

TRAP ALERT

Copper coin: Sultanate **jital**, Sur and Mughal **dam**. Silver: Sultanate **tanka**, Babur's **shahrukhi**, Sher Shah and Mughal **rupiya**. Gold: Mughal **mohur**. Match the coin to the period before the ruler.

19.6 Europeans in Mughal Service, the Tobacco Ban and Canals

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Who among the following was appointed as a physician in the Mughal service?

- (a) Bernier
- (b) Careri
- (c) Manucci
- (d) Tavernier

Ans. (c)

Niccolao Manucci, a Venetian, reached India in 1656 and joined the artillery of **Dara Shikoh**. After Dara's fall he took up medicine and served as a physician, including to the prince Shah Alam (Muazzam), and wrote the **Storia do Mogor**. Bernier is the trap. He was a trained French physician and briefly attended Dara Shikoh, but he served mainly in the household of the noble **Danishmand Khan**, not in an imperial appointment. Tavernier was a jewel merchant and Careri a traveller who met Aurangzeb in the Deccan in 1695.

Traveller	Origin	Ruler or period	Role or work
Francois Bernier	French	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Physician. Travels in the Mogul Empire
J. B. Tavernier	French	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Jewel merchant. Six voyages
Niccolao Manucci	Italian (Venetian)	Dara Shikoh to Aurangzeb	Gunner, then physician. Storia do Mogor
Gemelli Careri	Italian	Aurangzeb (1695)	Traveller
William Hawkins	English	Jahangir	Envoy of the East India Company
Sir Thomas Roe	English	Jahangir (1615 to 1619)	Ambassador of James I

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. The Mughal Emperor who prohibited the use of tobacco was

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Babur
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (c)

The Portuguese brought tobacco to India around 1604 to 1605, late in Akbar's reign. Smoking spread fast, and **Jahangir** banned it in **1617**, as he records in his memoirs (Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri). Aurangzeb is the tempting wrong answer because of his many moral edicts, but the tobacco ban is Jahangir's.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2020

Q. Which of the following Mughal period canals, was constructed by restoring the Rajabwah of Firuz Shah?

- (a) Shekhnū-Ni
- (b) Shahab Nahar
- (c) Nahar-i-Bihisht
- (d) Nahar-i-Agra

Ans. (b)

Firuz Shah Tughluq cut a canal from the Yamuna towards Hisar, the **Rajabwah**, which later silted up. Under Akbar, **Shihabuddin Ahmad Khan**, governor of Delhi, had it repaired to extend cultivation, and it came to be called the **Nahr-i-Shihab**. Under Shah Jahan, **Ali Mardan Khan** extended the Yamuna canal to the new capital Shahjahanabad. There it fed the **Nahr-i-Bihisht**, the "stream of paradise" that ran through the Red Fort, which is why that option tempts.

TRAP ALERT

Firuz Shah dug the canal. Shihabuddin revived it under Akbar, and Ali Mardan Khan extended it under Shah Jahan. Nahr-i-Bihisht is the palace channel inside the Red Fort, not the revived Rajabwah.

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 20 items (18 PYQs + 2 one-liners). Mughal administration is tested through terms and officers: what Mir Bakhshi, diwan-i-tan, mustaufi, mushrif and waqia-navis did, what sarkar, chakla and maal meant, and which coin belonged to whom. Mansabdari questions keep returning to three facts (not hereditary, sawar never above zat, three classes), so a single elimination trick answers most of them. The 2020 and 2021 papers produced four items, three of them match or assertion types. One item carries a Note: the 2019 dam assertion, where the Commission keyed (b) and the source argues for (a). Revise the officer table in 19.1, the unit table in 19.2 and the revenue terms in 19.4 first.

Chapter 19: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Nature of the state and central officers (Mir Bakhshi, diwans, office staff)	5	1992-2021	Rising (2020, 2021 twice)
Coinage (shahrukhi, dam, Ram-Siya)	4	2008-2019	Steady
Mansabdari system	3	2009-2019	Recurring
Land revenue (maal, Deccan ploughs)	3	1995-2017	Steady
Europeans, tobacco ban, Shihab canal	3	2005-2020	Occasional
Subah, sarkar, chakla	2	2009-2018	Occasional

Chapter 20

Music and Painting in the Mughal Period

Mughal painting grew from a Persian seed. Humayun brought two Persian masters to India, Akbar built a large imperial workshop around them, and under Jahangir the art reached its peak in portraits and studies of birds and animals. When Aurangzeb withdrew court patronage, painters moved to the Rajput and Pahari courts, where regional schools flourished. Music followed a parallel path: the dhrupad tradition of Gwalior and Vrindavan reached Akbar's court through Tansen, Shah Jahan was a keen patron, Aurangzeb ended court music, and khayal rose under the later Mughals. This chapter covers the foundation of Mughal painting, Jahangir's painters, the regional schools, Swami Haridas, Tansen and dhrupad, and the emperors' own musical interests. It contains **12 PYQs and 3 one-liners**. Read it with Chapter 8 (Sultanate art) and the Mughal architecture chapter.

20.1 Foundation of Mughal Painting: Humayun and Akbar

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009, 2012, U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (MAINS) 2010

Q. The foundation of the Mughal painting was laid by

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (b)

During his exile in Persia and Afghanistan, **Humayun** took into his service two Persian painters of the Safavid court, **Mir Sayyid Ali** and **Abdus Samad**. They followed him to Kabul and then to India in 1555, and they set up the first organised Mughal painting workshop. So the foundation is Humayun's. **Akbar** built on it. He expanded the workshop (tasvirkhana) into a large imperial studio with many Indian artists, and its blend of Persian technique with Indian themes and colour became the Mughal style. Akbar is the trap because the style matured under him.

Painter	Ruler	Specialty or work
Mir Sayyid Ali	Humayun, Akbar	Persian master. First head of the Hamzanama project. Title Nadir-ul-Mulk
Abdus Samad	Humayun, Akbar	Persian master. Completed the Hamzanama. Title Shirin Qalam (sweet pen)
Daswanth	Akbar	Indian painter trained by Abdus Samad. Illustrated the Razmnama (Persian Mahabharata)
Basawan	Akbar	Indian painter known for portraits, landscapes and colour. Akbarnama illustrations
Abul Hasan	Jahangir	Portraits and court scenes. Title Nadir-uz-Zaman
Ustad Mansur	Jahangir	Birds, animals and flowers. Title Nadir-ul-Asr
Bishandas	Jahangir	Portraits. Sent with the embassy to Persia to paint Shah Abbas

Painter	Ruler	Specialty or work
Aqa Riza	Jahangir	Persian painter in Salim's atelier. Father of Abul Hasan
Farrukh Beg, Manohar, Govardhan	Akbar and Jahangir	Leading painters of the imperial studio

Akbar's studio illustrated the **Hamzanama** (the tales of Amir Hamza), a project of about 1,400 large paintings on cloth, along with Persian versions of the Mahabharata (Razmnama) and the Ramayana, the Tutanama, the Baburnama and the Akbarnama.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1991

Q. Which statement is true about the Mughal paintings ?

- (a) Battle Scene
- (b) Animal birds and natural scene
- (c) Courtier depicting
- (d) All of the above

Ans. (d)

Mughal painting covered all three themes. Under Akbar the stress was on narrative manuscripts full of battles, hunts and court life. Under Jahangir it shifted to single portraits of courtiers and to natural history, with **Ustad Mansur** as the master of birds, animals and natural scenes.

20.2 Jahangir and the Golden Age of Mughal Painting

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. Jahangir mainly patronized which of the following arts?

- (a) Painting
- (b) Architecture
- (c) Sculpture
- (d) Music

Ans. (a)

Mughal painting reached its peak under **Jahangir** (1605 to 1627), so his reign is called the **golden age of Mughal painting**. In Mughal practice different painters often did the face, body and feet of one figure. Jahangir claimed in his memoirs that he could tell each painter's hand in such a picture. His studio moved away from crowded manuscripts towards single portraits, natural-history studies and album pages. **Abul Hasan** painted his accession scene for the opening page of the **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri**. Architecture is the pull of Shah Jahan, and sculpture was not a Mughal court art.

UP link: As prince Salim, Jahangir kept his own painting workshop at **Allahabad** (now Prayagraj) during his revolt against Akbar (1600 to 1604). Aqa Riza and the young Abul Hasan worked for him there.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2012

Q. Who among the following were Jahangiri painters? Select the correct answer for the codes given below

1. Abdus Samad
2. Abul Hasan
3. Aqa Riza
4. Mir Sayyid Ali

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 3 and 4
- (d) 4 and 1

Ans. (b)

Abul Hasan and his father **Aqa Riza** were Jahangir's painters. **Abdus Samad** and **Mir Sayyid Ali** were the two Persian founders under Humayun and Akbar. Know one founder and the code falls: any option with Abdus Samad or Mir Sayyid Ali goes, leaving only (b).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Who among the following painters was given the title of 'Nadir-ul-Zaman' by Jahangir?

- (a) Abul Hasan
- (b) Farrukh Beg
- (c) Bishandas
- (d) Aqa Riza

Ans. (a)

Jahangir gave his two finest painters titles of honour. **Abul Hasan**, the portrait and court painter, became **Nadir-uz-Zaman** (wonder of the age). **Ustad Mansur**, the painter of birds and animals, became **Nadir-ul-Asr** (wonder of the era). Mansur's studies of a zebra, a turkey cock and a Siberian crane, and of the flowers of Kashmir, are his best-known works.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. Which painter of Jahangir's reign was conferred the title of 'Nadir-ul-Asr'?

Ans. Mansur

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998

Q. The greatest painter of birds at Jahangir's Court was:

Ans. Mansur

TRAP ALERT

The two titles are near twins. **Zaman** goes with **Abul Hasan** (portraits), **Asr** with **Mansur** (birds). A useful hook: Mansur and Asr both end in "r". Mir Sayyid Ali's title Nadir-ul-Mulk is a third look-alike from Humayun's time.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Jahangir's painters account for five items, including the two titles and the "birds" question. Bishandas (portraits, Shah Abbas), Daswanth and Basawan (Akbar), and the Hamzanama are the untested names that fit a painter-ruler-specialty match.

20.3 Decline at Court and the Regional Schools

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1994

Q. The 'Pahari School,' 'Rajput School,' 'Mughal School' and 'Kangra School' represent different styles in the art of :

- (a) Architecture
- (b) Painting
- (c) Dancing
- (d) Music

Ans. (b)

All four are schools of **painting**. Shah Jahan preferred formal portraits and court scenes such as those of the Padshahnama, and the studio shrank. **Aurangzeb** withdrew imperial patronage, and many painters moved to Rajput and hill courts. The **Rajput** (Rajasthani) schools grew in Mewar, Bundi, Kota, Kishangarh, Marwar and Jaipur. **Pahari** painting is the art of the hill states of the western Himalaya, in present-day Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and Tehri Garhwal in Uttarakhand. **Kangra** is one branch of the Pahari school, not a separate region, which is the hidden point of the question.

School	Centre	Feature or famous work
Mughal	Imperial court (Agra, Fatehpur Sikri, Lahore, Delhi)	Persian technique with Indian themes. Portraits, natural history, manuscripts
Rajput: Kishangarh	Kishangarh, Rajasthan	Bani Thani by Nihal Chand under Raja Sawant Singh (Nagari Das), 18th century. Elongated faces and almond eyes
Rajput: Mewar, Bundi, Kota	Rajasthan	Ragamala sets, Krishna themes, hunting scenes
Pahari: Basohli	Jammu region	Bold primary colours, strong lines, Rasamanjari sets
Pahari: Guler and Kangra	Himachal Pradesh	Soft lines and natural colours. Kangra peaked under Raja Sansar Chand. Gita Govinda and Krishna themes
Deccani	Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar	Persian and Turkish influence with rich colour and gold

TRAP ALERT

Basohli and Kangra are both Pahari, but opposite in feel: Basohli is bold and bright, Kangra soft and lyrical. Bani Thani belongs to Kishangarh in Rajasthan, not to the hills.

20.4 Swami Haridas, Tansen and the Dhrupad Tradition

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2009

Q. Musicians like Tansen, Baiju Bawra and Gopal Nayak had received training from the master Swami Haridas. How many music worship centres have been set up by the followers of Swami Haridas ?

- (a) 5
- (b) 4
- (c) 3
- (d) 2

Ans. (a)

Swami Haridas was a saint-musician of Vrindavan who composed **dhrupads** in Braj Bhasha and sang them as worship of Krishna. The Haridasi (Sakhi) sect traces itself to him. The source gives the number of musical worship centres of the sect as **five**. Tradition names

Tansen, Baiju Bawra, Gopal Nayak and Madanlal among his pupils. Haridas never joined a royal court. A popular legend says Akbar went in disguise with Tansen to hear him sing.

UP link: Swami Haridas lived and sang at **Vrindavan** in **Mathura** district. Nidhivan in Vrindavan is linked with him by tradition.

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. The Dhrupad singers included in the reign of Akbar was/were

1. Tansen
2. Haridas
3. Surdas
4. Vilas Khan

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) All the four

Ans. (a)

Tansen and **Swami Haridas** were the leading dhrupad singers of Akbar's time, one at court and one in Vrindavan. **Surdas** is known as the blind Bhakti poet of Braj and the Sursagar, so the key leaves him out. **Vilas Khan**, Tansen's son, belongs to Jahangir's court in the source. A raga, Bilaskhani Todi, is named after him.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1999

Q. Where is Tansen's tomb located ?

- (a) Agra
- (b) Gwalior
- (c) Jhansi
- (d) Jaipur

Ans. (b)

Tansen, born near Gwalior and named Ramtanu in the source, served **Raja Ramchandra** of Rewa (the Baghela kingdom of Bhata) until Akbar summoned him in 1562. He became one of the **navaratnas** of Akbar's court and is remembered as **Mian Tansen**. His tomb stands in **Gwalior**, beside the tomb of his spiritual guide, the Sufi **Muhammad Ghaus**. A music festival in his name is held there every year. Ragas traditionally credited to him carry the prefix Mian: Mian ki Todi, Mian ki Malhar, Mian ki Sarang, and also Darbari Kanada.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Which king had given patronage to Tansen before Akbar?

Ans. Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata

TRAP ALERT

Tansen's tomb is at **Gwalior**, not Agra or Fatehpur Sikri where he sang at court. His patron before Akbar was the Baghela **Raja Ramchandra of Rewa**, not Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior, who died decades earlier.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Who among the following was not a great entity in the field of Hindustani music?

- (a) Raja Man Singh Tomar
- (b) Tansen
- (c) Sadarang - Adarang
- (d) Mal Gurjari

Ans. (d)

Mal Gurjari (Mal Gujar) is a **raga**, not a person. It is one of the Gujar ragas credited to **Raja Man Singh Tomar** of Gwalior (1486 to

1516), the great patron of dhrupad, whose queen Mrignayani was a Gujar. The treatise **Man Kutuhul** is attributed to him. **Sadarang** (Niyamat Khan) and **Adarang** (Firoz Khan) were musicians at the court of **Muhammad Shah Rangila** (1719 to 1748) whose compositions shaped the **khayal**.

Musician or patron	Ruler or court	Contribution
Raja Man Singh Tomar	Gwalior (1486 to 1516)	Patron of dhrupad. Man Kutuhul. Gujar ragas
Swami Haridas	Vrindavan, no court	Saint-musician, dhrupad in Braj. Guru of Tansen by tradition
Baiju Bawra	Gwalior tradition	Dhrupad singer of legend, rival of Tansen in popular stories
Tansen	Raja Ramchandra of Rewa, then Akbar	Navaratna. Mian ragas. Tomb at Gwalior
Vilas Khan	Jahangir (per source)	Tansen's son. Bilaskhani Todi
Lal Khan Gunasamudra and Jagannath	Shah Jahan	Court singers
Sadarang and Adarang	Muhammad Shah Rangila	Khayal compositions

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Five items here, from 1999 to 2021. A match of musician with patron (Tansen with Ramchandra and Akbar, Sadarang with Muhammad Shah, Man Kutuhul with Man Singh Tomar) or a chronological order from Man Singh Tomar to Sadarang suits the pattern.

20.5 The Emperors and Music: Akbar to Aurangzeb

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. Which Mughal ruler of the following had learnt Hindu Music from Lala Kalawant?

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Akbar
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (c)

Akbar took a personal interest in music. He played the **naqqara** (kettledrum) well, and the source records that he learned Hindu (Indian) music from **Lal Kalawant**. Abul Fazl's Ain-i-Akbari lists the musicians of his court, Tansen among them. Shah Jahan was himself a fine singer and kept dhrupad singers at court.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which one of the following musical instruments was mastered by Aurangzeb ?

- (a) Sitar
- (b) Pakhawaj
- (c) Veena
- (d) None of the above

Ans. (c)

Aurangzeb ended singing and music at court and dismissed the court musicians, regarding music as against Islamic law. The picture is not one of total suppression. He was himself skilled on the **veena**, music continued in the households of nobles and in the harem, and the largest number of Persian works on Indian classical music was written during his reign. Faqirullah's **Rag Darpan** (1666), a Persian

rendering of Man Singh Tomar's Man Kutuhāl, is the standard example.

TRAP ALERT

"Aurangzeb banned music" is true for court performance only. Statements that he could play no instrument, or that no music books were written in his reign, are false. Option (d) "None of the above" is the trap for students who stop at the ban.

Chapter 20: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Jahangir and his painters (Abul Hasan, Mansur, titles)	5	1998-2016	Recurring
Haridas, Tansen, dhrupad and Hindustani music	5	1999-2021	Recurring, returned in 2019 and 2021
Foundation of Mughal painting and its themes	2	1991-2012	Repeated (one item asked in three papers)
Emperors and music (Akbar, Aurangzeb)	2	2007-2016	Occasional
Schools of painting	1	1994	Rare

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (12 PYQs + 3 one-liners). Two blocks carry the chapter: Jahangir's painters and the Tansen and Haridas circle, with five items each. Painting questions test attribution (Humayun as founder, Jahangir as the peak, Abul Hasan as Nadir-uz-Zaman, Mansur as Nadir-ul-Asr and painter of birds). Music questions test people and places (Tansen's tomb at Gwalior, Raja Ramchandra as his first patron, Haridas's dhrupad) and one nuance about Aurangzeb, who banned court music yet played the veena. Revise the painter table in 20.1 and the musician table in 20.4 first.

Chapter 21

Mughal Literature

The Mughal age produced memoirs by the emperors themselves, official Persian histories, independent and critical chronicles, Persian translations of Sanskrit classics, and the high tide of Hindi Bhakti and Riti poetry. Urdu also took shape in this period. UPPSC tests the area mainly through **authorship**: who wrote which work, in which language, under which ruler, and which work came first. This chapter covers the Baburnama and its translations, Gulbadan Begum and other Mughal women of letters, Persian at Akbar's court and the Akbarnama, the Persian chronicles from Babur to Aurangzeb, translations into Persian, Hindi Bhakti and Riti poets, and the Sufi premakhyan. It contains **17 PYQs and 3 one-liners**.

21.1 The Baburnama: A Turki Memoir and Its Translations

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Who translated 'Baburnama' into English?

- (a) Leyden and Erskine
- (b) William Hawkins
- (c) Finch
- (d) William Jones

Ans. (a)

Babur wrote his memoir, the **Tuzuk-i-Baburi** or **Baburnama**, in his mother tongue **Turki** (Chaghatai Turkish), not Persian. It was put into Persian twice. The version by **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan** was presented to Akbar in 1589. The first English translation was by **John Leyden and William Erskine** (1826). Annette Beveridge later made a fresh English translation directly from the Turki. The distractors fail on profile: **William Hawkins** and **William Finch** were English visitors to Jahangir's court, and **William Jones** founded the Asiatic Society (1784) and translated Kalidasa's *Abhijnanashakuntalam*.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2009

Q. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Babur : Tuzuk-i-Baburi
- (b) Humayun : Humayun Nama
- (c) Sher Shah : Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi
- (d) Akbar : Tabaqat-i-Akbari

Ans. (a)

The trap is the word in the title. Only Babur wrote the work that bears his name. The **Humayun-nama** was written by his half-sister **Gulbadan Begum**, not by Humayun. The **Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi** (also called *Tuhfa-i-Akbar Shahi*) was written by **Abbas Khan Sarwani** in Akbar's reign. The **Tabaqat-i-Akbari** was written by **Nizamuddin Ahmad**. Babur also left a Turki **Diwan** of poems and the **Mubayyan**, a Turki verse work on Islamic law.

TRAP ALERT

A title named after a ruler is usually written **about** him, not **by** him. Among the Mughals only **Babur** (Baburnama) and **Jahangir** (Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri) wrote their own memoirs.

21.2 Gulbadan Begum and Mughal Women of Letters

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2004, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2004

Q. Gulbadan Begum was the daughter of-

- (a) Babur
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Ans. (a)

Gulbadan Begum (1523 to 1603) was Babur's daughter, Humayun's half-sister and Akbar's aunt. At Akbar's request she wrote down from memory what she knew of Babur and Humayun, for use by Abul Fazl in the Akbarnama. Her **Humayun-nama** (Ahwal-i-Humayun Badshah) is in Persian. It gives a rare inside view of the royal household and records the quarrels between Humayun and his brother Kamran.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998, I.A.S. (PRE) 1994

Q. Who wrote historical records in the Mughal period?

Ans. Gulbadan Begum

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2004, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2002

Q. Who wrote Humayun Nama?

Ans. Gulbadan Begum

TRAP ALERT

Two works share the name Humayun-nama. **Gulbadan Begum** wrote the memoir. **Khwandamir** wrote the **Qanun-i-Humayuni**, also called Humayun-nama, on Humayun's rules and institutions (see the match in 21.4). If Gulbadan is an option, she is the intended answer.

U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Delhi's education centre which was known as 'Madarsa-e-Begum' was established by whom?

- (a) Gulbadan Begum
- (b) Maham Anaga
- (c) Ziaunnisa
- (d) Zeenat Unnisa

Ans. (b)

Maham Anaga, Akbar's foster mother (anaga) and the mother of Adham Khan, built the **Khair-ul-Manzil** mosque in 1561, opposite the Purana Qila in Delhi. It had a madrasa attached, hence the name **Madrasa-e-Begum**. **Zinat-un-Nissa**, a daughter of Aurangzeb, is linked with the Zinat-ul-Masajid mosque in Daryaganj, Delhi, which is the trap behind option (d).

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. The mosque-the Khair-ul-Manzil opposite to the Purana Qila in Delhi was constructed by whom?

Ans. Maham Anaga

Mughal woman	Relation	Contribution
Gulbadan Begum	Daughter of Babur	Humayun-nama, Persian memoir
Maham Anaga	Akbar's foster mother	Khair-ul-Manzil mosque and madrasa, Delhi (1561)
Haji Begum (Bega Begum)	Wife of Humayun	Humayun's Tomb, Delhi
Nur Jahan	Wife of Jahangir	Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula, Agra

Mughal woman	Relation	Contribution
Jahanara	Daughter of Shah Jahan	Munis-ul-Arwah, a life of Muinuddin Chishti
Zeb-un-Nissa	Daughter of Aurangzeb	Persian poet, pen name Makhfi
Zinat-un-Nissa	Daughter of Aurangzeb	Zinat-ul-Masajid, Daryaganj, Delhi

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Gulbadan Begum has come in five papers since 1994. Jahanara's Munis-ul-Arwah and Zeb-un-Nissa's pen name are the untested names in the same family.

21.3 Persian at Court, the Akbarnama and the Rise of Urdu

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Court Language during Mughal period was -

- (a) Arabic
- (b) Turkish
- (c) Persian
- (d) Urdu

Ans. (c)

Babur wrote in Turki, but **Persian** was the language of the Mughal court and administration. Akbar made it the language of revenue records at every level, so Hindu clerical groups such as Kayasthas and Khatris learnt Persian and served the state. His translation bureau, the **Maktab Khana**, rendered Sanskrit, Arabic, Turki and Greek works into Persian. **Arabic** remained the language of religious learning. **Urdu** was still taking shape and was not the court language.

UP link: the Maktab Khana worked at **Fatehpur Sikri** (Agra district), Akbar's capital in the 1570s and early 1580s.

Rise of Urdu. Urdu grew out of the Hindavi or Khari Boli of the Delhi region with a large Persian and Arabic vocabulary. The name comes from *zaban-i-urdu-i-mualla*, the language of the exalted camp, and it was long called Rekhta or Hindavi. Its first literary home was the Deccan (**Dakhani**). **Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah** of Golconda was the first poet to leave a full diwan in it. **Wali Dakhani** came to Delhi in 1700 and his verse set off Urdu poetry in the north. In the 18th century **Mir Taqi Mir** and **Sauda** took it to its height, and Mir spent his last years in Lucknow.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2014

Q. Akbar Nama was completed by Abul Fazl in -

- (a) Seven years
- (b) Eight years
- (c) Nine years
- (d) Ten years

Ans. (a)

Note: the source key is (a), based on a writing span of 1590 to 1596. Other standard accounts say Abul Fazl worked on the Akbarnama for about thirteen years, from about 1589 until his death in 1602, revising it repeatedly. The source itself reports that UPPSC excluded this question from evaluation. Keep (a) only as the book's key.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2023

Q. What is the name of the third volume of Akbarnama written by Abul Fazl ?

- (a) Sipah-Abadi
- (b) Sulh-i-Kul
- (c) Manzil-Abadi
- (d) Ain-e-Akbari

Ans. (d)

The **Akbarnama** of **Abul Fazl** is in three volumes. The first two are a narrative history: Akbar's Timurid ancestry, Babur and Humayun, and then Akbar's reign year by year to 1602. The third volume is the **Ain-i-Akbari**, a gazetteer of the empire completed in 1598. The two clever distractors are **parts of the Ain itself**, and **Sulh-i-Kul** (peace with all) is Akbar's policy, not a book.

Book (daftar) of the Ain-i-Akbari	Subject
1. Manzil-Abadi	Imperial household and its upkeep
2. Sipah-Abadi	Army, mansabdars, civil officers and servants
3. Mulk-Abadi	Fiscal side: revenue rates, the twelve subas and their statistics
4 and 5	Religious, literary and cultural traditions of the people of India, and Akbar's sayings

Abul Fazl was killed in 1602 on his way back from the Deccan by **Bir Singh Deo Bundela** of Orchha, at the instigation of Prince Salim (Jahangir). The Akbarnama narrative stops there. His brother **Faizi** was Akbar's poet laureate.

TRAP ALERT

Manzil-Abadi and Sipah-Abadi sound like separate books. They are the first two daftars **inside** the Ain-i-Akbari. The Ain is the third volume of the Akbarnama, not a separate work.

21.4 Persian Chronicles from Babur to Aurangzeb: Who Wrote What

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Which of the following is not correctly matched? (books) (writers)

- (a) Tabaqat-i-Nasiri - Minhaj-i-Siraj-Juzjani
- (b) Tarikh-i-Firuzshahi - Shams-i-Siraj-Afif
- (c) Tughluqnama - Ibn Battuta
- (d) Humayun Nama - Gulbadan Begum

Ans. (c)

The **Tughluqnama** is a work of **Amir Khusrau** on the rise of Ghiyasuddin Tughluq. **Ibn Battuta** wrote the Arabic travel account, the **Rehla**. The Tarikh-i-Firuzshahi has two authors, Barani and Shams-i-Siraj Afif, so (b) is correct as given. The Sultanate works are covered in Chapter 9 (9.6).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2003

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Hasan Nizami	1. Alamgir Nama
B. Khwandamir	2. Nuskha-i-Dilkusha
C. Muhammad Qazim	3. Humayun Nama
D. Bhimsen	4. Tajul Maasir

Code :

A B C D

(a) 4 3 1 2

(b) 3 2 4 1

(c) 2 4 3 1

(d) 1 3 2 4

Ans. (a)

This match mixes one Sultanate historian with three Mughal ones. **Hasan Nizami** wrote the Taj-ul-Maasir on Aibak. **Khwandamir** came to India with Babur and wrote the Qanun-i-Humayuni (Humayun-nama). **Muhammad Kazim** wrote the official **Alamgirnama** on the first ten years of Aurangzeb, after which Aurangzeb stopped official history-writing. **Bhimsen** wrote the Nuskha-i-Dilkusha on Aurangzeb's Deccan wars.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Bhimsen Kayastha	1. Chahar Chaman
B. Chandrabhan Brahman	2. Futuh-i-Alamgiri
C. Ishwardas Nagar	3. Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh
D. Sujanrai Bhandari	4. Tarikh-i-Dilkusha

Codes :

A B C D

(a) 1 2 3 4

(b) 2 3 4 1

(c) 3 4 1 2

(d) 4 1 2 3

Ans. (d)

All four are **Hindu writers of Persian**, a group UPPSC likes. **Bhimsen** (Burhanpuri) served in the Deccan and wrote the Tarikh-i-Dilkusha, also called Nuskha-i-Dilkusha. **Chandrabhan Brahman** was Shah Jahan's munshi and wrote the **Chahar Chaman** on court life. **Ishwardas Nagar** wrote the **Futuh-i-Alamgiri** on Aurangzeb's reign. **Sujan Rai Bhandari** wrote the **Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh** (1695), a general history of India.

Work	Author	Language	Ruler or subject
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	Babur	Turki	Babur's own memoir
Humayun-nama	Gulbadan Begum	Persian	Babur and Humayun, written for Akbar
Qanun-i-Humayuni (Humayun-nama)	Khwandamir	Persian	Humayun's rules and institutions

Work	Author	Language	Ruler or subject
Tazkirat-ul-Waqiat	Jauhar Aftabchi	Persian	Humayun, by his ewer-bearer
Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi	Abbas Khan Sarwani	Persian	Sher Shah, written under Akbar
Akbarnama and Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	Persian	Akbar, official history
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Abdul Qadir Badauni	Persian	Akbar, unofficial and critical of his religious policy
Tabaqat-i-Akbari	Nizamuddin Ahmad	Persian	General history up to Akbar
Tarikh-i-Alfi	Mulla Ahmad Thattavi and others	Persian	Akbar, history for the Islamic millennium
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir	Persian	Jahangir's own memoir
Iqbalnama-i-Jahangiri	Mutamad Khan	Persian	Jahangir
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	Persian	Shah Jahan, official history
Shahjahannama	Inayat Khan	Persian	Shah Jahan
Amal-i-Salih	Muhammad Salih Kamboh	Persian	Shah Jahan
Chahar Chaman	Chandrabhan Brahman	Persian	Shah Jahan's court
Alamgirnama	Muhammad Kazim	Persian	Aurangzeb, first ten years
Maasir-i-Alamgiri	Saqi Mustaid Khan	Persian	Aurangzeb, written after his death
Futuh-i-Alamgiri	Ishwardas Nagar	Persian	Aurangzeb
Nuskha-i-Dilkusha	Bhimsen Burhanpuri	Persian	Aurangzeb's Deccan wars
Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh	Sujan Rai Bhandari	Persian	General history of India (1695)
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	Khafi Khan	Persian	Mughal history to Muhammad Shah's time, written privately

TRAP ALERT

Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh (Badauni, Akbar) and **Muntakhab-ul-Lubab** (Khafi Khan, later Mughals) share the first word. **Alamgirnama** (Muhammad Kazim) and **Maasir-i-Alamgiri** (Saqi Mustaid Khan) are both about Aurangzeb. Match the second word, not the first.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Three author-matching items so far (2003, 2017, 2019), two built on Aurangzeb-era writers. Badauni, Khafi Khan and the Shah Jahan historians (Lahori, Inayat Khan) are the untested names in this table.

21.5 Translations into Persian: Hitopadesha, Panchatantra and the Maktab Khana

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013

Q. Who among the following had translated 'Hitopadesha' into Persian ?

- (a) Dara Shukoh
- (b) Faizi
- (c) Abdul Qadir Badauni
- (d) Tajul Mali

Ans. (d)

The **Hitopadesha** was put into Persian around 1450, before the Mughals, by **Taj-al-Din Mufti al-Maliki** under the title **Mufarrih-ul-Qulub**. Some books print his name as "Tajul Mali", which is the form in the options. The three distractors were real translators, but of other texts: **Dara Shikoh** the Upanishads, **Faizi** the Lilavati and Nala-Damayanti, and **Badauni** the Ramayana and parts of the Mahabharata.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1999

Q. Anwar-e-Suhaili is a translation of :

- (a) Panchatantra
- (b) Mahabharata
- (c) Ramayan
- (d) Sur Sagar

Ans. (a)

The **Panchatantra** reached Persian through its Arabic form, **Kalila wa Dimna**. **Husain Waiz Kashifi** retold it as the **Anwar-i-Suhaili** at the Timurid court of Sultan Husain Mirza in Herat in the late 15th century. Akbar found its style too ornate and had **Abul Fazl** simplify it as the **Iyar-i-Danish** (Touchstone of Wisdom). **Sur Sagar** is the Braj work of Surdas, not a Sanskrit text.

Original	Persian title or form	Translator	Ruler or period
Panchatantra (Kalila wa Dimna)	Kalila wa Dimna Bahramshahi	Nasrullah Munshi	Ghaznavid Bahram Shah, 12th century
Panchatantra (Kalila wa Dimna)	Anwar-i-Suhaili	Husain Waiz Kashifi	Sultan Husain Mirza of Herat
Anwar-i-Suhaili simplified	Iyar-i-Danish	Abul Fazl	Akbar
Hitopadesha	Mufarrih-ul-Qulub	Taj-al-Din Mufti al-Maliki	c. 1450, pre-Mughal
Mahabharata	Razmnama	Naqib Khan, Badauni and others, preface by Abul Fazl	Akbar, Maktab Khana
Ramayana	Persian Ramayana	Badauni	Akbar
Lilavati (mathematics)	Lilavati	Faizi	Akbar
Nala-Damayanti	Nal Daman	Faizi	Akbar
Atharvaveda	Persian version	Haji Ibrahim Sirhindi	Akbar
Fifty Upanishads	Sirr-i-Akbar (1657)	Dara Shikoh	Shah Jahan's reign

Dara Shikoh also wrote the **Majma-ul-Bahrain** (Mingling of the Two Oceans, 1655). It is an original treatise comparing Sufi and Vedantic ideas, not a translation. The illustrated Razmnama was

produced in the 1580s, and the Persian Ramayana followed.

TRAP ALERT

Sirr-i-Akbar (Great Secret) is the Upanishad translation.

Majma-ul-Bahrain is Dara's own comparative work. **Razmnama** means Book of War and is the Mahabharata. Do not mix the three.

21.6 Hindi Bhakti and Riti Poets of the Mughal Age

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Which one of the following, wrote the famous works 'Ram Chandrika' and 'Rasikpriya'?

- (a) Keshav
- (b) Matiram
- (c) Raskhan
- (d) Senapati

Ans. (a)

Keshavdas (1555 to 1617) was the court poet of Orchha in Bundelkhand. His **Rasikpriya** and **Kavipriya** lay down the rules of poetics, so he is regarded as the founder of the **Riti** (mannerist) tradition in Hindi. The **Ramchandrika** retells the Rama story. **Matiram** wrote the Rasraj and Lalit Lalam, **Senapati** the Kavitta Ratnakar, and **Raskhan** the Prem Vatika and Surjan Raskhan.

Poet	Main works	Language	Patron or context
Tulsidas	Ramcharitmanas, Vinay Patrika, Kavitavali, Gitavali	Awadhi and Braj	Rama bhakti, Akbar's contemporary
Surdas	Sursagar	Braj	Ashtachhap poet, disciple of Vallabhacharya
Nand Das	Ras Panchadhyayi	Braj	Ashtachhap poet
Rahim (Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan)	Dohas, Barvai Nayika Bhed	Braj and Awadhi	Akbar's noble, son of Bairam Khan
Raskhan	Prem Vatika, Surjan Raskhan	Braj	Muslim devotee of Krishna
Keshavdas	Rasikpriya, Kavipriya, Ramchandrika	Braj	Orchha court, Riti founder
Bihari	Bihari Satsai (about 700 dohas)	Braj	Mirza Raja Jai Singh of Amber
Bhushan	Shivraj Bhushan, Shiva Bawani, Chhatrasal Dashak	Braj	Shivaji and Chhatrasal Bundela
Matiram	Rasraj, Lalit Lalam	Braj	Riti poet
Senapati	Kavitta Ratnakar	Braj	Riti poet

UP link: **Tulsidas** is commonly said to have been born at Rajapur in **Chitrakoot district** (another tradition names Soron in Kasganj district). By tradition he began the Ramcharitmanas at **Ayodhya** in 1574 and died at **Varanasi**. **Surdas** is associated with Gaughat near **Agra** and the Braj country. **Raskhan**'s samadhi is at Mahaban near Gokul in **Mathura district**.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004, P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. The poet heart King, who wrote praising verses for Lord Krishna under the name of Nagari Das was -

- (a) Raja Umed Singh
- (b) Raja Ram Singh
- (c) Raja Chhatrasal
- (d) Raja Sawant Singh

Ans. (d)

Raja Sawant Singh of **Kishangarh** (Ajmer district, Rajasthan), an 18th century ruler, wrote Krishna poetry under the pen name **Nagari Das**. The Kishangarh rulers followed the Nimbarka sect. His court painter Nihal Chand created the Kishangarh style, best known for the Bani Thani portrait. **Chhatrasal** fails because he was the patron of Bhushan, not a Krishna poet himself.

UP link: Sawant Singh gave up his throne and spent his last years at **Vrindavan** (Mathura district).

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2021

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists :

List-I (Books)	List-II (Author)
A. Ras Panchadhyayi	1. Vrindavan Das
B. Chaitanya Bhagavata	2. Jayananda
C. Chaitanya Mangal	3. Nand Das
D. Bhakti Ratnakar	4. Narahari Chakravarti

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 3 4 2 1
- (b) 2 3 4 1
- (c) 3 1 2 4
- (d) 4 3 1 2

Ans. (c)

Only A is a Hindi work. **Nand Das**, an Ashtachhap poet of Braj, wrote the **Ras Panchadhyayi** on the Rasa dance of Krishna. The other three are **Bengali Vaishnava** lives of Chaitanya and his movement: **Vrindavan Das** wrote the Chaitanya Bhagavata, the earliest Bengali life of Chaitanya. **Jayananda** wrote a Chaitanya Mangal (Lochan Das wrote another of the same name). **Narahari Chakravarti** wrote the 18th century Bhakti Ratnakar. The best known life, the Chaitanya Charitamrita, was written at Vrindavan by **Krishnadas Kaviraj**.

TRAP ALERT

Two works are called Chaitanya Mangal (Jayananda and Lochan Das). If Lochan Das appears in place of Jayananda, he is also correct for that title.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Which of the following (Poetess-Compositions) is not correctly matched?

- (a) Daya Bai - Vinay Malika
- (b) Sahajobai - Sahaj Prakash
- (c) Son Kumari - Poem of Swarn Beli
- (d) Gangabai - Ganesh Dev Leela

Ans. (d)

Sahajo Bai (Sahaj Prakash) and **Daya Bai** (Dayabodh, Vinay Malika) were 18th century disciples of the saint **Charandas** of Delhi. **Gangabai** was a poetess of the Krishna bhakti tradition. Her verses

survive as **Gangabai ke Pad**, so the pairing with Ganesh Dev Leela is wrong.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The 2023 item shows UPPSC moving to women poets of the bhakti tradition. Mirabai (Padavali) and the Sahajo Bai and Daya Bai pair under Charandas are the likely names.

21.7 Sufi Premakhyan in Hindi: Which Came First

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2014

Q. Which of the following Hindi works was written first?

- (a) Indravati
- (b) Padmavat
- (c) Madhumalati
- (d) Mrigavati

Ans. (d)

The **premakhyan** is the Sufi love romance in Awadhi. A human love story stands for the soul's search for the divine. The line runs from Mulla Daud's Chandayan (1379, see Chapter 9, 9.9) through the four works below.

Order	Work	Author	Commonly dated
1	Mrigavati	Qutban	1503
2	Padmavat	Malik Muhammad Jayasi	1540
3	Madhumalati	Manjhan	1545
4	Indravati	Nur Muhammad	1744

UP link: Qutban wrote the Mrigavati under **Husain Shah Sharqi** of **Jaunpur**. **Jayasi** takes his name from **Jais**, now in **Amethi district** (formerly in Rae Bareilly district), where a memorial to him stands.

TRAP ALERT

Padmavat is the best known, so students pick it as the oldest. Mrigavati is 37 years earlier. Indravati is an 18th century work and is always last.

Chapter 21: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Gulbadan Begum and Mughal women of letters	5	1994-2018	Recurring
Hindi Bhakti and Riti poets	4	2004-2023	Recurring
Persian at court and the Akbarnama	3	2012-2023	Recurring
Persian chronicles: author matching	3	2003-2019	Recurring
Baburnama and its translations	2	2009-2017	Occasional
Translations into Persian	2	1999-2013	Occasional
Sufi premakhyan chronology	1	2014	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 20 items (17 PYQs + 3 one-liners). The chapter is about authorship. Twelve of the 20 items ask who wrote or translated a work, and most traps are titles that name a ruler the work is about (Humayun-nama, Tabaqat-i-Akbari) or near-identical first words (Muntakhab, Chaitanya Mangal). Gulbadan Begum is the single most repeated name. Recent papers (2017 to 2023) have moved to Hindu writers of Persian under Aurangzeb, Bengali Vaishnava texts, women bhakti poets and the internal parts of the Ain-i-Akbari. The master table in 21.4 and the poet table in 21.6 answer most items. One item carries a Note: the Akbarnama duration question, which the source says UPPSC dropped from evaluation.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 22

Mughal Period: Miscellaneous

This chapter collects the Mughal-period PYQs that test facts across reigns rather than one ruler: English travellers at the Mughal court, the sequence of emperors, battles from Tarain to the Third Battle of Panipat, the revolts against Aurangzeb, women rulers in chronological order, imperial tombs, monuments and their builders, court festivals and centres of learning, and terms for coins, revenue officers and ships' crews. Chronology and matching dominate. It contains **25 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. Battles alone account for 6 items.

22.1 English Travellers at the Mughal Court

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2016

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below the lists:

List-I	List-II
A. Hawkins	1. 1615-1619
B. Thomas Roe	2. 1608-1611
C. Manucci	3. 1585-1586
D. Ralph Fitch	4. 1653-1708

Code :

A B C D

(a) 1 2 3 4

(b) 2 1 4 3

(c) 1 2 4 3

(d) 2 1 3 4

Ans. (b)

Anchor the four on the emperors. **Ralph Fitch** came under Akbar. **Hawkins** (1608 to 1611) and **Thomas Roe** (1615 to 1619) came under Jahangir. **Manucci** came under Shah Jahan and stayed through Aurangzeb's reign. Fitch reached India in 1583. The listed 1585 to 1586 is the part of his stay when he travelled in north India, so it still fits him.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2021

Q. Arrange the following foreign travelers in chronological order of their arrival in India.

I. William Hawkins II. Ralph Fitch

III. Sir Thomas Roe IV. Nicholas Downton

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes :

(a) II, I, IV and III

(b) IV, II, I and III

(c) I, III, II and IV

(d) III, II, IV and I

Ans. (a)

Traveller	Origin	Ruler visited	Period or work
Ralph Fitch	English merchant	Akbar	Reached India 1583, visited Agra and Fatehpur Sikri
William Hawkins	English, East India Company envoy	Jahangir	Surat 1608, Agra 1609, left 1611. Title English Khan

Traveller	Origin	Ruler visited	Period or work
William Finch	English merchant	Jahangir	Came with Hawkins (1608)
Nicholas Downton	English, East India Company commander	Jahangir	At Surat 1614-1615
Sir Thomas Roe	English, envoy of James I	Jahangir	Court from 1615 to 1619, won trading rights
Edward Terry	English chaplain to Roe	Jahangir	A Voyage to East India
Francois Bernier	French physician	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Travels in the Mogul Empire
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	French jeweller	Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb	Travels in India
Niccolao Manucci	Venetian (Italian)	Shah Jahan to Aurangzeb	In India from 1653, Storia do Mogor

UP link: Fitch saw Agra and Fatehpur Sikri and then went down the river to Allahabad (now Prayagraj, renamed in 2018) and Benares. Hawkins and Roe both dealt with Jahangir, whose court was mostly at Agra or on tour.

TRAP ALERT

Hawkins came **before** Roe. Hawkins was an East India Company captain whose trade concessions were soon withdrawn under Portuguese pressure. Roe was the first royal ambassador of the English king and succeeded. Downton falls between the two.

22.2 Mughal Emperors in Sequence and Key Milestones

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2001, 2003, U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002

Q. Select the correct chronological order for the following Muslim rulers from the codes given below the names :

1. Ahmad Shah Abdali 2. Muhammad Shah

3. Jahangir 4. Bahadur Shah II

Code :

(a) 1, 2, 3, 4

(b) 4, 3, 2, 1

(c) 3, 2, 1, 4

(d) 2, 1, 3, 4

Ans. (c)

Emperor	Reign	Hook for chronology
Babur	1526-1530	First Battle of Panipat
Humayun	1530-1540, 1555-1556	Lost to Sher Shah, regained Delhi in 1555
Akbar	1556-1605	Second Battle of Panipat, died 1605
Jahangir	1605-1627	Hawkins and Roe at court
Shah Jahan	1628-1658	Taj Mahal, war of succession among his sons
Aurangzeb	1658-1707	Died 1707 in the Deccan
Bahadur Shah I	1707-1712	First of the later Mughals
Muhammad Shah	1719-1748	Nadir Shah's invasion (1739)

Emperor	Reign	Hook for chronology
Shah Alam II	1759-1806	Third Panipat (1761) and Buxar (1764) in his reign
Bahadur Shah II (Zafar)	1837-1857	Last Mughal, exiled to Rangoon after 1857

Ahmad Shah Abdali was not a Mughal. He was the Afghan ruler who invaded India several times and defeated the Marathas at Panipat in 1761, which places him between Muhammad Shah (died 1748) and Bahadur Shah II.

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. Which of the following statements are correct?

1. Ahmad Shah Abdali fought the third battle of Panipat.
2. Babur established the Delhi Sultanate.
3. Shah Jahan fought the war of succession.
4. Jahangir was a lover of beauty and nature.

Code :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 are correct
(b) 1 and 3 are correct
(c) 1 and 4 are correct
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 are correct

Ans. (c)

Statement 2 is plainly wrong: Babur founded the **Mughal Empire**, and the Delhi Sultanate began with Qutbuddin Aibak in 1206. Statement 3 is judged wrong because "the war of succession" (1657 to 1658) was fought among Shah Jahan's sons, **Dara, Shuja, Aurangzeb and Murad**, while Shah Jahan lay ill. Statement 4 is true: Jahangir's memoir is full of notes on flowers, birds and animals, and he patronised painters such as Mansur. Even if one hesitates over statement 3, only code (c) contains 4 and leaves out 2.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Match the following :

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Third Battle of Panipat	1. 1192
B. Second Battle of Tarain	2. 1707
C. Death of Akbar	3. 1761
D. Death of Aurangzeb	4. 1605

Code :

- A B C D
(a) 1 2 3 4
(b) 4 3 2 1
(c) 3 1 4 2
(d) 2 4 3 1

Ans. (c)

Four anchor years worth memorising: **1192** (Second Tarain), **1605** (Akbar dies), **1707** (Aurangzeb dies, the start of the later Mughal decline) and **1761** (Third Panipat).

22.3 Battles of the Mughal Age: Who Fought and When

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Battle of Haldighati	1. Babur
B. Battle of Bilgram	2. Akbar
C. Revolt of Khusrav	3. Humayun
D. Battle of Khanwa	4. Jahangir

Code :

- A B C D
(a) 2 3 4 1
(b) 1 3 2 4
(c) 3 2 4 1
(d) 2 4 1 3

Ans. (a)

Khusrav, Jahangir's eldest son, rebelled in 1606, in the first year of his father's reign. He was defeated and blinded. Guru Arjan Dev, who was accused of blessing him, was executed in 1606. The **Battle of Bilgram** is another name for the Battle of Kannauj (1540), where Sher Shah defeated Humayun.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which of the following is not correctly matched ?

- (a) Babur - Battle of Khanwa
(b) Humayun - Battle of Chausa
(c) Akbar - Battle of Haldighati
(d) Jahangir - Battle of Balkh

Ans. (d)

The **Balkh** campaign (1646 to 1647) was Shah Jahan's attempt to win the Timurid homeland in Central Asia. Princes Murad and Aurangzeb led it, and it failed. Note that (b) is accepted as correct even though Humayun **lost** at Chausa. The pair tests who took part, not who won.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1998

Q. Select the correct chronological order of the following battles from the codes given :

List-I	List-II
A. Third Battle of Panipat	1. 1601 A.D.
B. Battle of Haldighati	2. 1761 A.D.
C. Second Battle of Tarain	3. 1576 A.D.
D. Battle of Asirgarh	4. 1192 A.D.

Code :

- A B C D
(a) 1 2 3 4
(b) 4 3 2 1
(c) 2 3 4 1
(d) 3 4 2 1

Ans. (c)

Asirgarh (1601), the great fort of Khandesh, was taken from Miran Bahadur Faruqi. It was Akbar's last conquest. At **Haldighati** (1576) Akbar's army under Raja Man Singh fought Maharana Pratap of Mewar.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Arrange the following events in correct chronological order and choose the correct answer from the code given below.

1. Battle of Kannauj 2. Battle of Daurah
3. Battle of Samugarh 4. Battle of Chausa

Code:

- (a) 2, 4, 3, 1
(b) 4, 2, 1, 3
(c) 4, 2, 3, 1
(d) 2, 4, 1, 3

Ans. (d)

The source prints the third item as "2. Battle of Samugarh", a numbering slip. The codes treat it as item 3. **Daurah** (Dadrah, 1532) was Humayun's victory over the Afghans under Mahmud Lodi. Then come Sher Shah's two wins over Humayun, **Chausa** (June 1539) and **Kannauj** (May 1540). **Samugarh** (29 May 1658) decided the war of succession in favour of Aurangzeb and Murad against Dara Shikoh.

UP link: the Battle of Kannauj was fought near **Bilgram** (Hardoi district), across the Ganga from Kannauj. **Samugarh** lies a short distance east of **Agra**.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2016

Q. Consider the following battles and arrange these in chronological order.

- I. Battle of Kannauj II. Battle of Chanderi
III. Battle of Talikota IV. Battle of Chausa

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Codes:

- (a) I, II, IV, III
(b) II, IV, I, III
(c) IV, II, I, III
(d) I, IV, II, III

Ans. (b)

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order :

- I. Battle of Kannauj II. Battle of Chausa
III. Battle of Talikota IV. Battle of Khanwa

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Codes:

- (a) IV, II, I, III
(b) IV, I, II, III
(c) IV, II, III, I
(d) II, IV, I, III

Ans. (a)

The two 2016 papers used the same skeleton, Chausa then Kannauj then Talikota, and changed only the Babur battle (Chanderi 1528 or Khanwa 1527). Chausa always comes before Kannauj: Humayun lost twice to Sher Shah, first in 1539 and finally in 1540.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Second Tarain	1192	Muhammad Ghorī vs Prithviraj Chauhan	Turkish rule in north India
First Panipat	1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Mughal rule founded
Khanwa	1527	Babur vs Rana Sanga	Rajput confederacy broken

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
Chanderi	1528	Babur vs Medini Rai	Malwa frontier secured
Ghaghra	1529	Babur vs the Afghans of Bihar and Bengal	Babur's last major battle
Daurah (Dadrah)	1532	Humayun vs Afghans under Mahmud Lodi	Early Humayun victory
Chausa	1539	Sher Khan vs Humayun	Sher Khan took the title Sher Shah
Kannauj (Bilgram)	1540	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Humayun driven into exile
Second Panipat	1556	Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs Hemu	Mughal rule restored
Talikota	1565	Deccan Sultanates vs Vijayanagara	Fall of Vijayanagara
Haldighati	1576	Akbar's army under Man Singh vs Maharana Pratap	Mewar resistance continued
Asirgarh	1601	Akbar vs Miran Bahadur of Khandesh	Akbar's last conquest
Balkh campaign	1646-1647	Shah Jahan's armies in Central Asia	Failed
Samugarh	1658	Aurangzeb and Murad vs Dara Shikoh	Decided the war of succession
Third Panipat	1761	Ahmad Shah Abdali vs Marathas under Sadashiv Rao Bhau	Maratha advance in the north checked

TRAP ALERT

Talikota (1565) is a Deccan battle with no Mughal side, but it keeps appearing in Mughal chronology items as the last entry. Kannauj and Bilgram are the same battle, so never place them apart in an order.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Six battle items from 1998 to 2025, four of them ordering questions. The 2025 item brought in Daurah and Samugarh, so less familiar names such as Ghaghra (1529) and Dharmat (1658) are the natural next additions.

22.4 Revolts Against Aurangzeb

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) (RE-EXAM) 2023

Q. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Jat Rebellion	i. 1554 A.D.
B. Bundela Rebellion	ii. 1672 A.D.
C. Satnami Rebellion	iii. 1669 A.D.
D. Sikh Rebellion	iv. 1675 A.D.

Codes:

- (a) A-i, B-ii, C-iv, D-iii
 (b) A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
 (c) A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i
 (d) A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv

Ans. (d)

Note: the key (d) pairs the Bundela rebellion with 1554. That year falls in the Sur period and does not match the Bundela resistance to Aurangzeb, which was led by Champat Rai and then by his son Chhatrasal from about 1671. The other three dates are standard and fix the code, so (d) is the only workable option.

Revolt	Year	Leader	Region or trigger
Jat	1669	Gokula, later Rajaram and Churaman	Mathura region, peasant revolt
Satnami	1672	Satnami sect	Narnaul (Haryana)
Sikh	1675	Guru Tegh Bahadur executed in Delhi	Guru Gobind Singh founded the Khalsa in 1699
Bundela	From c. 1671	Champat Rai, then Chhatrasal	Bundelkhand
Rajput (Marwar)	1679	Durgadas Rathore for Ajit Singh	Succession after Jaswant Singh's death

UP link: the Jat revolt began among the peasants of the **Mathura** region in 1669 under Gokula. Chhatrasal's Bundelkhand includes today's **Jhansi** and **Banda** districts of UP. Chhatrasal was also the patron of the poet Bhushan (Chapter 21).

22.5 Women Rulers in Chronological Order

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2001, U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. Arrange the chronological order of the following options and find out the correct answer with the help of the given codes :

1. Ahilya bai 2. Durgavati
 3. Padmini 4. Tarabai

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
 (b) 3, 2, 4, 1
 (c) 3, 4, 1, 2
 (d) 2, 1, 3, 4

Ans. (b)

Order	Queen	Kingdom	Period
1	Padmini	Mewar (Chittor), wife of Rana Ratan Singh	Alauddin Khalji's siege of Chittor, 1303
2	Durgavati	Gond kingdom of Garha-Katanga	Died 1564 fighting Akbar's general Asaf Khan

Order	Queen	Kingdom	Period
3	Tarabai	Marathas, widow of Rajaram	Led the Maratha state from 1700
4	Ahilyabai Holkar	Holkars of Indore (Malwa)	Ruled 1767 to 1795 from Maheshwar

The Padmini story is known mainly from Jayasi's Padmavat (1540), and historians debate how much of it is historical. The siege of Chittor in 1303 is documented. For chronology the 1303 anchor is enough.

UP link: Ahilyabai Holkar rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath temple at **Varanasi** in 1780.

22.6 Where the Emperors Are Buried

UPPSC (EXAM TAG NOT GIVEN IN SOURCE)

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Emperor)	List-II (City where the tomb is located)
A. Babur	1. Agra
B. Humayun	2. Lahore
C. Jahangir	3. Delhi
D. Shah Jahan	4. Kabul

Code:

A B C D

- (a) 4 3 2 1
 (b) 3 4 1 2
 (c) 3 4 2 1
 (d) 4 3 1 2

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists :

List-I (Emperors)	List-II (Tombs)
A. Babur	1. Lahore
B. Akbar	2. Agra
C. Jahangir	3. Kabul
D. Shah Jahan	4. Sikandra

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
 (b) 4 3 2 1
 (c) 3 4 1 2
 (d) 2 1 3 4

Ans. (c)

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Where is the Tomb of Akbar located ?

Ans. Sikandra (Agra)

Emperor	Tomb and place	Built by or note
Babur	Bagh-e-Babur, Kabul	First buried at Aram Bagh, Agra, later moved to Kabul
Humayun	Humayun's Tomb, Delhi	Haji Begum, architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas

Emperor	Tomb and place	Built by or note
Akbar	Sikandra, Agra	Begun by Akbar, completed by Jahangir
Jahangir	Shahdara, Lahore	Built in Shah Jahan's reign
Shah Jahan	Taj Mahal, Agra	Beside Mumtaz Mahal
Aurangzeb	Khuldabad, Maharashtra	Simple open grave
Bahadur Shah II	Yangon (Rangoon), Myanmar	Died in exile, 1862

UP link: three imperial burials are in **Agra district**: Akbar at Sikandra, Shah Jahan in the Taj Mahal, and Babur's first, temporary grave at Aram Bagh.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2010

Q. Which one of the following is correctly matched ?

- (a) Khuldabad - Tomb of Shaikh Salim Chishti
- (b) Fatehpur Sikri - Tomb of itmad-ud-Daula
- (c) Agra - Tomb of Aurangzeb
- (d) Delhi - Tomb of Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan

Ans. (d)

The first three places are swapped round. **Salim Chishti** lies at **Fatehpur Sikri**, **Itimad-ud-Daula** at **Agra**, and **Aurangzeb** at **Khuldabad**. **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan**, Akbar's noble and the Hindi poet Rahim, is buried in his tomb near Nizamuddin in Delhi.

Renamed place: Khuldabad lies in the district earlier called Aurangabad. The Maharashtra government completed the renaming of Aurangabad as **Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar** by notification in September 2023.

TRAP ALERT

Aurangzeb is **not** buried in Agra or Delhi. He died near Ahmednagar in 1707 and lies at Khuldabad. Jahangir is the only Mughal emperor buried at Lahore.

22.7 Monuments and Their Builders

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (SPL) (PRE) 2010

Q. Match List - I with List - II and select the correct answer from the codes given below the list :

List - I	List - II
A. Babur	1. Jama Masjid (Sambhal)
B. Humayun	2. Dinpanah
C. Akbar	3. Jahangiri Mahal
D. Jahangir	4. Itimad-ud-Daula's Mausoleum

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 4 3 2 1
- (c) 3 4 1 2
- (d) 2 1 4 3

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the list :

List-I (Builder)	List-II (Monument)
A. Babur	1. Jama Masjid (Sambhal)
B. Humayun	2. Dinpanah
C. Akbar	3. Jahangiri Mahal
D. Jahangir	4. Akbar's Mausoleum's completion

Code :

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 1 2 4 3
- (c) 2 1 4 3
- (d) 4 3 2 1

Ans. (a)

The two items differ only in D. **Jahangiri Mahal** inside Agra Fort was built by **Akbar**, not Jahangir, which is the trap. **Dinpanah** was Humayun's city in Delhi, on the site later rebuilt by Sher Shah as the Purana Qila. Under Jahangir, his wife **Nur Jahan** built the tomb of her father Itimad-ud-Daula at Agra (completed 1628), the first Mughal building faced in white marble with pietra dura inlay. Jahangir also completed **Akbar's tomb at Sikandra** in 1613.

Sambhal Jama Masjid. An inscription in the mosque dates its completion to 1526 and credits it to Babur's officer Mir Hindu Beg. It is a protected monument. Since November 2024 the site has been the subject of a civil suit, and the matter is pending before the courts.

UP link: **Sambhal** is now a separate district (carved out of Moradabad in 2011). **Jahangiri Mahal**, **Itimad-ud-Daula** and **Sikandra** are all in **Agra**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2010, U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006

Q. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Alai Darwaza, Delhi	1. Alauddin Khalji
B. Buland Darwaza, Fatehpur Sikri	2. Akbar
C. Moti Masjid, Agra	3. Shah Jahan
D. Moti Masjid, Delhi	4. Aurangzeb

Code:

A B C D

- (a) 1 2 3 4
- (b) 3 2 1 4
- (c) 4 1 2 3
- (d) 1 4 3 2

Ans. (a)

There are two Moti Masjids to separate. The one in **Agra Fort** is Shah Jahan's, a large congregational mosque. The small one in the **Red Fort, Delhi**, was built by Aurangzeb for his personal use. The **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri marks Akbar's conquest of Gujarat (1573). The **Alai Darwaza** (1311) is a Sultanate gate.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Arrange the following monuments in chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- I. Rabia Daurani's Tomb, Aurangabad
- II. Sher Shah Suri's Tomb, Sasaram
- III. Humayun's Tomb, Delhi
- IV. Atala Mosque, Jaunpur

Codes :

- (a) I, II, IV, III
- (b) IV, II, III, I
- (c) II, I, III, IV
- (d) III, IV, II, I

Ans. (b)

Anchor each to a ruler. The **Atala Masjid** (1408) belongs to Ibrahim Shah Sharqi of Jaunpur. **Sher Shah's tomb** at Sasaram (Bihar) was completed around his death in 1545. **Humayun's tomb** was begun in the 1560s under Akbar and completed about 1572. **Rabia-ud-Daurani's tomb**, the Bibi ka Maqbara, was built about 1660 for Aurangzeb's wife Dilras Banu Begum. Sources credit it to Aurangzeb or to his son Prince Azam Shah.

UP link: the Atala Masjid stands in **Jaunpur**. Its foundation was laid under Firuz Shah Tughluq in 1376 and it was completed by Ibrahim Shah Sharqi.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2005

Q. Govind Palace, an excellent specimen of Hindu architecture is located at -

- (a) Datia
- (b) Khajuraho
- (c) Orchha
- (d) Gwalior

Ans. (a)

The seven-storeyed **Govind Mahal** (Datia Palace) at **Datia** in Madhya Pradesh was built by **Raja Bir Singh Deo Bundela** of Orchha, commonly dated to 1614. Bir Singh Deo was Jahangir's ally, the man who killed Abul Fazl in 1602. He also built the Jahangir Mahal at **Orchha**, which is why Orchha is the tempting wrong answer.

Monument	Builder	Place
Alai Darwaza	Alauddin Khalji (1311)	Delhi
Atala Masjid	Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (1408)	Jaunpur
Jama Masjid, Sambhal	Babur's reign (1526)	Sambhal
Kabuli Bagh mosque	Babur	Panipat
Dinpanah	Humayun	Delhi
Sher Shah's tomb	Sher Shah	Sasaram, Bihar
Humayun's Tomb	Haji Begum	Delhi
Jahangiri Mahal	Akbar	Agra Fort
Buland Darwaza , Salim Chishti's tomb	Akbar	Fatehpur Sikri
Allahabad Fort	Akbar (1583)	Prayagraj
Akbar's tomb (completed)	Jahangir	Sikandra, Agra
Itimad-ud-Daula	Nur Jahan, in Jahangir's reign	Agra
Govind Mahal , Jahangir Mahal	Bir Singh Deo Bundela	Datia and Orchha, MP

Monument	Builder	Place
Moti Masjid (Agra Fort), Taj Mahal	Shah Jahan	Agra
Moti Masjid (Red Fort), Badshahi Mosque	Aurangzeb	Delhi and Lahore
Bibi ka Maqbara	Aurangzeb or Prince Azam Shah (c. 1660)	Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar (Aurangabad)

TRAP ALERT

Jahangiri Mahal was built by Akbar. Jahangir Mahal at Orchha was built by Bir Singh Deo. Neither was built by Jahangir himself.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Builder-matching has run from 2005 to 2019 with the same core names. The Allahabad Fort (Akbar, now Prayagraj) and Itimad-ud-Daula as the first marble pietra dura building are the UP angles not yet asked directly in this set.

22.8 Court Festivals and Centres of Learning

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2001

Q. Mughals adopted "Nauroj" festival from -

- (a) Zoroastrians
- (b) Jews
- (c) Mongols
- (d) Turks

Ans. (a)

Nauroz is the Persian New Year, a festival of pre-Islamic, **Zoroastrian** Iran. Akbar made it the main court festival, celebrated for nineteen days from the sun's entry into Aries, in line with his solar **Ilahi** calendar. Badauni calls it Nauroz-i-Jalali. Aurangzeb discontinued the court celebration.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2016

Q. During the Mughal period, the Madrasa which was specialized in the teaching of 'Muslim Jurisprudence,' was located in -

- (a) Lucknow
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Sialkot
- (d) Hyderabad (India)

Ans. (a)

Firangi Mahal in Lucknow, a building once owned by a European merchant, was granted by Aurangzeb in the 1690s to the family of the scholar Mulla Qutbuddin Siharvi. It became the leading centre for **fiqh** (Islamic jurisprudence) and the rational sciences. **Mulla Nizamuddin** of this family framed the **Dars-i-Nizami** syllabus, still followed in many madrasas. In **Delhi**, the madrasa of **Shah Waliullah** (Madrassa-i-Rahimiya) stressed hadith and tafsir instead.

UP link: Firangi Mahal is in **Lucknow**.

TRAP ALERT

Delhi is the tempting answer for any Mughal institution. For jurisprudence (fiqh) the answer is Lucknow. For hadith it is Shah Waliullah's Delhi.

22.9 Terms: Coins, Revenue Officers and Ships' Crews

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 2019

Q. Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

- (a) Dam - Copper coin
- (b) Desai - Revenue Collector
- (c) Diwan - Revenue Chief of a province
- (d) Jarib - A type of tax

Ans. (d)

The **jarib** was the measuring rod or chain used to survey land for revenue, not a tax. Akbar replaced the old hemp rope, which shrank and stretched with moisture, with lengths of bamboo joined by iron rings. The **dam** was the copper coin (40 dams to the rupee). The **diwan** of a suba headed provincial revenue, kept separate from the military governor (subedar) as a check. The **desai** was a hereditary revenue official in Gujarat and the Deccan, similar to the deshmuks.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. During the Mughal period 'Muallim' was -

- (a) A tax
- (b) An administrative unit
- (c) A ruler
- (d) A ship

Ans. (*)

Note: the source key is (*). A muallim was the navigator on a ship, who fixed the ship's position from the sun and stars. None of the options is exact. Option (d) is the closest, since the muallim was a member of a ship's crew, not a ship. If forced to choose, mark (d).

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Dam	Copper coin, 40 to the rupee	Sher Shah, continued by the Mughals
Rupiya	Silver coin of about 178 grains	Introduced by Sher Shah
Mohur	Gold coin	Mughals
Jarib	Measuring rod or chain for land survey	Akbar's bamboo jarib
Diwan (provincial)	Head of revenue in a suba	Akbar's system, separate from the subedar
Desai	Hereditary revenue official	Gujarat and the Deccan, like the deshmuks
Muallim	Navigator of a ship	Ship's crew
Nakhuda	Master or captain of a ship	Ship's crew
Nauroz	Persian New Year festival	Akbar's court

TRAP ALERT

The word **jarib** sounds like a levy, which is the trap. Taxes in this period carry names such as jizya, zakat or kharaj. Jarib is a unit of measurement.

Chapter 22: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Battles: matching and chronology	6	1998-2025	Recurring (latest 2025)
Monuments and their builders	5	2005-2019	Recurring
Imperial tombs	4	1992-2010	Recurring (older papers)
Emperors in sequence and key milestones	3	2001-2010	Recurring (older papers)
English travellers at the Mughal court	2	2016-2021	Occasional
Court festivals and centres of learning	2	2001-2016	Occasional
Terms: coins, revenue, ships	2	2014-2019	Occasional
Revolts against Aurangzeb	1	2023	Emerging
Women rulers in chronology	1	2001-2002	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 26 items (25 PYQs + 1 one-liner). This is a chronology and matching chapter: 20 of the 25 PYQs are ordering, List-I List-II or pair-matching items. Battles, tombs and builders make up 15 items, and most UP-linked answers sit in Agra (Sikandra, Itimad-ud-Daula, Jahangiri Mahal, Moti Masjid, the Taj). Since 2016 the pattern has moved to traveller order, revolts against Aurangzeb and less familiar battles such as Daurah and Samugarh. The battle table in 22.3 and the monument table in 22.7 cover most items. Two items carry Notes: the Muallim question keyed (*), and the revolts match, where the Bundela date of 1554 does not fit the history but the code still resolves to (d).

Chapter 23

Sikh Sect

Sikhism grew from the teaching of Guru Nanak (1469 to 1539) into an organised community under ten Gurus, and then into a military order, the Khalsa, under Guru Gobind Singh in 1699. Its history runs alongside the Lodis and the Mughals: Nanak preached under Sikandar Lodi, Guru Arjan Dev was executed under Jahangir and Guru Tegh Bahadur under Aurangzeb. After 1708 Banda Bahadur led the first Sikh revolt, and in the later 18th century the Sikhs organised into misls. This chapter covers Guru Nanak, the succession and contributions of the Gurus, the two executed Gurus, the Khalsa and Nanded, and Banda Bahadur. It contains **9 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. UPPSC asks direct attribution questions here: which Guru did what.

23.1 Guru Nanak: Birthplace, Period and Teaching

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Which of the following was the birthplace of Guru Nanak?

- (a) Amritsar
- (b) Nabha
- (c) Nankana
- (d) Nanded

Ans. (c)

Guru Nanak was born in 1469 at **Talwandi** (Rai Bhoi di Talwandi), now **Nankana Sahib** in Pakistani Punjab. The source gives 15 April 1469. The birth anniversary (Gurpurab) is, however, celebrated on Kartik Purnima by tradition. He spent his last years at **Kartarpur** on the Ravi, which he founded, and died there in 1539. Kartarpur is now in Narowal district of Pakistan. Across the river, in Gurdaspur district of Indian Punjab, stands **Dera Baba Nanak**.

TRAP ALERT

Every option is a Sikh-linked place, which is the trap. **Nankana** = birth of Nanak. **Amritsar** = founded by Guru Ram Das. **Nanded** = death of Guru Gobind Singh (23.4). **Nabha** = a later Phulkian princely state. The source's phrase "Dera Baba (Kartarpur, Pakistan)" mixes two places: Kartarpur is in Pakistan, Dera Baba Nanak is in India.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

The Integrated Check Post of the **Kartarpur Corridor** at Dera Baba Nanak was inaugurated on 9 November 2019, in the 550th birth anniversary year of Guru Nanak. It links Indian pilgrims to Gurdwara Darbar Sahib, Kartarpur. A question can pair Nanak's birthplace (Nankana Sahib) with his place of death (Kartarpur).

U.P. P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2008

Q. In whose regime did Guru Nanak Dev found the Sikh religion?

- (a) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (b) Sikandar Lodi
- (c) Humayun
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (b)

Nanak began his mission around 1499, while working at **Sultanpur Lodhi**. This falls in the reign of **Sikandar Lodi** (1489 to 1517). Nanak lived on through Ibrahim Lodi, Babur and the first reign of Humayun, and died in 1539, the year of the Battle of Chausa. **Firuz Shah** (died 1388) is too early, and **Akbar** (from 1556) came after Nanak's death.

Teaching of Guru Nanak	What it means
One God (Ik Onkar)	Monotheism. God is nirguna: without form or attributes
No incarnation, no idol worship	Rejects avatar doctrine and ritual
Nam japna, kirat karni, vand chhakna	Remember the Name, earn honestly, share with others
Equality	Rejects caste distinctions. Community kitchen (langar) and shared worship (sangat)
Householder path	Spiritual life inside family and work, not renunciation
Language	Hymns in the spoken language, later collected in the Adi Granth

Nanak belongs to the **nirguna** stream of the Bhakti movement, with Kabir and Ravidas, whose verses also sit in the Adi Granth.

23.2 Succession and the Ten Gurus

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (PRE.) 2021

Q. Which of the following was declared as his successor by Guru Nanak?

- (a) Bala
- (b) Lehna
- (c) Mardana
- (d) Sri Chand

Ans. (b)

Nanak passed over his own sons and chose his disciple **Lehna**, whom he renamed **Angad** (a limb of the Guru). Succession by merit, not by birth, became the early Sikh rule. **Sri Chand**, Nanak's elder son, founded the ascetic **Udasi** order. **Mardana** was Nanak's Muslim companion who played the rabab, and **Bala** is the companion named in the Janamsakhi traditions.

U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Which of the following Guru started 'Gurmukhi'?

- (a) Guru Nanak
- (b) Guru Amar Das
- (c) Guru Ram Das
- (d) Guru Angad

Ans. (d)

Gurmukhi means "from the mouth of the Guru". Guru Angad is credited with standardising its alphabet from scripts already in use in Punjab, so that the Gurus' hymns could be written down. The Adi Granth is written in Gurmukhi. Each Guru has one or two signature contributions, and UPPSC asks them as attributions.

Guru	Period as Guru	Key contribution
1. Nanak	1469 to 1539 (life)	Founder. Born Talwandi (Nankana Sahib). Settled Kartarpur. Chose Lehna
2. Angad (Lehna)	1539 to 1552	Gurmukhi script standardised. Strengthened langar. Khadur Sahib
3. Amar Das	1552 to 1574	Langar before audience. Manji system of 22 preaching seats. Goindval baoli. Opposed sati and purdah

Guru	Period as Guru	Key contribution
4. Ram Das	1574 to 1581	Founded Ramdaspur (Amritsar), land granted by Akbar per tradition. Dug the tank. Guruship hereditary in his line from here
5. Arjan Dev	1581 to 1606	Compiled the Adi Granth (1604) . Completed Harmandir Sahib . Founded Tarn Taran. Executed 1606 under Jahangir
6. Hargobind	1606 to 1644	Akal Takht . Two swords of miri and piri. Militarised the community. Held at Gwalior fort by Jahangir. Moved to Kiratpur
7. Har Rai	1644 to 1661	Met Dara Shikoh. Kept a standing troop at Kiratpur
8. Har Krishan	1661 to 1664	Child Guru. Died in Delhi of smallpox (Gurdwara Bangla Sahib)
9. Tegh Bahadur	1664 to 1675	Founded Anandpur (Chak Nanki). Executed 1675 in Delhi under Aurangzeb (Gurdwara Sis Ganj)
10. Gobind Singh	1675 to 1708	Born Patna 1666. Khalsa 1699 at Anandpur. Zafarnama to Aurangzeb. Declared the Guru Granth Sahib the eternal Guru. Died at Nanded 1708

TRAP ALERT

Amar Das organised the langar and the manjis, but **Ram Das** founded Amritsar. **Arjan Dev** compiled the Adi Granth and completed the Harmandir Sahib, while **Hargobind** built the Akal Takht facing it. The Adi Granth became the **Guru Granth Sahib** only when Gobind Singh ended personal Guruship in 1708. Gobind Singh added the hymns of Tegh Bahadur to it.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1996

Q. The city of Amritsar in Punjab was established by:

- Guru Nanak
- Guru Gobind Singh
- Guru Tegh Bahadur
- Guru Ram Das

Ans. (d)

Sikh tradition, recorded in the Amritsar district gazetteer, says Akbar granted about 500 bighas of land, which had a natural pool, to **Guru Ram Das** (some accounts say to his wife Bibi Bhani). Ram Das dug the holy tank, the **Amrit Sarovar**, and the town that grew round it was first called **Ramdaspur** or Chak Guru. He began the temple, and his son **Guru Arjan** completed the Harmandir Sahib in the middle of the tank. The city took its name from the tank.

Akbar's goodwill also shows in the tradition that he visited Guru Amar Das at Goindval and ate in the langar with ordinary people. Treat both the visit and the land grant as tradition, not as documented Mughal grants.

23.3 Conflict with the Mughals: Guru Arjan Dev and Guru Tegh Bahadur

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2002

Q. Which of the following Sikh Gurus were penalized with death by the Rulers of the time :

- Guru Angad
- Guru Arjan Dev
- Guru Har gobind
- Guru Tegh Bahadur

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- 2 and 4
- 2 and 3
- 1 and 3
- 1 and 2

Ans. (a)

Guru Arjan Dev: in 1606 Jahangir's rebel son **Prince Khusrav** fled from Agra towards Lahore and met the Guru near **Tarn Taran**. The Guru received him and helped him. After crushing the revolt, Jahangir ordered the Guru's death in 1606 on a charge of conspiracy. Jahangir records his displeasure with the Guru in his memoir, the Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (PRE) 2001

Q. Which Sikh Guru helped rebel prince Khusrav with shelter and wealth

Ans. Guru Arjan Dev

Guru Tegh Bahadur was executed in Delhi in **1675** on Aurangzeb's orders after refusing to convert. Sikh tradition links his stand to the Kashmiri Pandits who sought his protection. **Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib** in Chandni Chowk marks the place of execution, and Gurdwara Rakab Ganj marks his cremation. His execution turned the community further towards armed resistance under his son Gobind Singh.

Guru	Ruler	Year	Why
Arjan Dev (5th)	Jahangir	1606	Help to rebel Prince Khusrav
Tegh Bahadur (9th)	Aurangzeb	1675	Refused conversion. Executed in Delhi
Hargobind (6th)	Jahangir	Not executed	Held for a time at Gwalior fort, then released
Angad (2nd)	None	Not executed	No recorded conflict with the state

TRAP ALERT

Hargobind is the close distractor: Jahangir imprisoned him at Gwalior but released him. Imprisonment is not execution. Pair the rulers correctly: Arjan with Jahangir, Tegh Bahadur with Aurangzeb.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

2025 marked the **350th year** of Guru Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom. The Union Ministry of Culture listed a 350th Shaheedi Diwas commemoration, and both Delhi and **Uttar Pradesh** declared 25 November 2025 a public holiday for it. A UPPSC question on the ninth Guru, the year 1675 or Sis Ganj is a reasonable next angle.

23.4 Guru Gobind Singh, the Khalsa and Nanded

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006

Q. The Guru who founded the 'Khalsa' was :

- (a) Har Rai
- (b) Har Kishan
- (c) Tegh Bahadur
- (d) Gobind Singh

Ans. (d)

On Baisakhi day **1699** at **Anandpur Sahib**, Guru Gobind Singh founded the **Khalsa** (the pure). Five volunteers, the **Panj Pyare**, were initiated first with khande di pahul (baptism by the double-edged sword). Men of the Khalsa took the name **Singh** and women **Kaur**. Every Khalsa Sikh was to keep the five Ks.

The five Ks	Meaning
Kesh	Uncut hair
Kangha	Wooden comb
Kara	Steel bangle
Kachchha (kachera)	Short breeches
Kirpan	Sword or dagger

The Khalsa removed the **masands** (the Guru's regional agents, who had grown corrupt) and tied every Sikh directly to the Guru. Gobind Singh fought the hill rajas and Mughal forces, lost his four sons in the wars of 1704 to 1705, and wrote the **Zafarnama**, a Persian letter of protest to Aurangzeb. The Dasam Granth is attributed to him.

U.P. LOWER SUB. (PRE) 2002

Q. Nanded is considered sacred by Sikhs due to whose Mausoleum ?

- (a) Guru Amar Das
- (b) Guru Angad
- (c) Guru Arjan Dev
- (d) Guru Gobind Singh

Ans. (d)

After Aurangzeb died in 1707, Gobind Singh met the new emperor Bahadur Shah I and travelled with him to the Deccan. At **Nanded** on the Godavari (Maharashtra) he was stabbed by an Afghan assailant and died in 1708. Before his death he ended the line of human Gurus and declared the **Guru Granth Sahib** the eternal Guru. **Takht Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib** stands at the site.

Takht (seat of authority)	Place	Link
Akal Takht	Amritsar, Punjab	Built by Guru Hargobind
Keshgarh Sahib	Anandpur Sahib, Punjab	Birth of the Khalsa, 1699
Damdama Sahib	Talwandi Sabo, Bathinda, Punjab	Gobind Singh stayed here after 1705
Patna Sahib (Harmandir Ji)	Patna, Bihar	Birthplace of Gobind Singh, 1666
Hazur Sahib	Nanded, Maharashtra	Death of Gobind Singh, 1708

TRAP ALERT

Gobind Singh is linked to three places in three states: born at **Patna** (Bihar), founded the Khalsa at **Anandpur** (Punjab), died at **Nanded** (Maharashtra). Nanded appears in both 23.1 and 23.4 as an option.

23.5 Banda Bahadur and the Rise of the Misls

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2014

Q. The original name of Banda Bahadur was,

- (a) Mahesh Das
- (b) Lakshman Dev
- (c) Dwarka Das
- (d) Harnam Das

Ans. (b)

Lachhman Dev (Lakshman Dev) became a bairagi ascetic named **Madho Das** and lived at Nanded. He met Guru Gobind Singh there in 1708, became his follower and received the name **Banda Singh Bahadur**. Sent to Punjab, he led a peasant-based Sikh rising, sacked **Sirhind** in 1710, set up a base at **Lohgarh** and struck coins in the name of the Gurus. He is credited with breaking the power of the big zamindars in the territory he held. Mughal forces besieged him at **Gurdas Nangal** and captured him in 1715. He was executed in Delhi in 1716, in the reign of **Farrukhsiyar**.

TRAP ALERT

Mahesh Das is the original name of **Birbal**, Akbar's courtier. It is a borrowed distractor from the Mughal chapters.

Stage	Period	Key facts
Banda Bahadur's revolt	1708 to 1716	Sirhind 1710, Lohgarh, executed under Farrukhsiyar
Dal Khalsa and the misls	From the 1740s	Sikh bands organised into 12 misls (confederacies). Gurmata decisions at Amritsar. Rakhi protection levy
Afghan invasions	1748 to 1767	Ahmad Shah Abdali's raids weakened Mughal and Afghan hold on Punjab
Ranjit Singh	Lahore 1799	Head of the Sukerchakia misl. United the misls into the kingdom of Punjab. Treaty of Amritsar with the English, 1809

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Banda's execution falls in Farrukhsiyar's reign, which links this chapter to the later Mughals (Chapter 25). A cross-chapter question pairing Banda with Farrukhsiyar, or Ranjit Singh with the Sukerchakia misl, fits the UPPSC pattern.

Chapter 23: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Succession and Gurus' contributions (Lehna, Gurmukhi, Amritsar)	3	1996-2021	Recurring
Executed Gurus and Prince Khusrav	2	2001-2002	Occasional
Guru Nanak: birthplace and period	2	2007-2008	Occasional
Gobind Singh: Khalsa and Nanded	2	2002-2006	Occasional
Banda Bahadur	1	2014	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 10 items (9 PYQs + 1 one-liner). Every item is a direct attribution question: a place, a successor, a script, a founder or a ruler. The ten Gurus table in 23.2 alone answers seven of the ten items. Options are drawn from other Gurus or other Sikh places, so learn each Guru with one place and one contribution. Recent papers (2014, 2017, 2021) moved from Nanak and Gobind Singh to the less obvious figures: Lehna, Angad and Banda Bahadur.

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Chapter 24

Maratha State and Confederacy

The Marathas rose in the hills of the Western Ghats in the 17th century. Shivaji (commonly dated 1627 or 1630 to 1680) built an independent kingdom out of the lands of Bijapur and the Mughals, was crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad in 1674 and ruled through a council of eight ministers, the Ashtapradhan. After a long war with Aurangzeb, power passed in the 18th century from the Chhatrapati to the Peshwa, and the kingdom became a confederacy of great families. Its northern drive ended at the Third Battle of Panipat in 1761. This chapter covers the rise of the Marathas, Shivaji's career and capital, his administration and revenue claims, his successors, the Peshwas, the confederacy, and Panipat. It contains **19 PYQs and 6 one-liners**. Chronological-order questions on rulers and Peshwas are the single most repeated type.

24.1 Why the Marathas Rose

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1992

Q. Which is/are correct reasons of Maratha's Rise?

- (a) Religious Consciousness
- (b) Geographical Security
- (c) Political awakening
- (d) High quality of leadership
- (e) all of the above

Ans. (e)

The source treats the rise as a regional movement, not the work of one man. Shared language, religion, literature and homeland gave the people of Maharashtra a sense of common identity. The Bhakti saints of Maharashtra (Eknath, Tukaram, Ramdas) spread this through Marathi devotional verse.

Factor	How it helped
Geography	Hills, forests and narrow passes of the Sahyadri. Easy to defend, ideal for forts and guerrilla war
Religious and cultural awakening	Marathi Bhakti saints. Shared language and literature
Military experience	Maratha chiefs had served Bijapur and Ahmadnagar as soldiers and revenue officers
Weak Deccan Sultanates	Bijapur and Golconda in decline, Mughals far from base
Leadership	Shivaji, later Baji Rao I and other Peshwas

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Shivaji had to face opposition from the big Deshmukhs.

Reason (R): These Deshmukhs were not in favour of an independent Maratha State and wanted to remain as feudal lords of Bijapur. Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

Ans. (a)

Deshmukhs were hereditary local chiefs who collected revenue and kept armed retainers under the Deccan Sultans. Under Bijapur they kept their privileges and autonomy. An independent Maratha state threatened that, so the big Deshmukhs, such as the More family of **Javli**, opposed Shivaji. He overcame them by force and by winning over smaller chiefs. The reason directly explains the assertion.

24.2 Shivaji: Forts, Campaigns and Coronation

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2015

Q. When was Shivaji born and when did he assume the title of Chhatrapati?

- (a) 1626, 1675
- (b) 1625, 1671
- (c) 1627, 1661
- (d) 1627, 1674

Ans. (d)

Note: the source key (d) follows the birth year 1627. The Maharashtra government observes Shiv Jayanti on 19 February 1630, a date many historians now accept. Only (d) has the correct coronation year, 1674, so (d) stands either way.

Shivaji was born at **Shivneri** fort near Junnar (Pune district), son of **Shahji Bhonsle**, a Bijapur noble, and **Jijabai**. He grew up at Pune on his father's jagir under the guardian Dadaji Konddev. He died at Raigad in 1680.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1999

Q. Who was the commander sent by Sultan of Bijapur for repression of Shivaji in 1659 ?

- (a) Inayat Khan
- (b) Afzal Khan
- (c) Shaista Khan
- (d) Sayyid Banda

Ans. (b)

Bijapur sent its senior general **Afzal Khan** in 1659. He met Shivaji for talks below **Pratapgarh** fort, and Shivaji killed him there. **Shaista Khan** was the **Mughal** governor of the Deccan (Aurangzeb's maternal uncle), not a Bijapur commander. He occupied Pune and Shivaji raided his quarters at Lal Mahal in 1663. **Sayyid Banda** is named in accounts of the Pratapgarh meeting as Afzal Khan's attendant.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Arrange the following events related to Chhatrapati Shivaji in chronological order and select the correct answer from the code given below.

- I. The victory on the Fort of Chakan
- II. The episode of Afzal Khan
- III. Start of clash with the Mughals
- IV. Attack and sack of Surat.

Code:

- (a) I, III, II, IV
- (b) I, II, III, IV
- (c) II, IV, III, I
- (d) II, III, I, IV

Ans. (a)

Year	Event in Shivaji's career
1627 or 1630	Born at Shivneri

Year	Event in Shivaji's career
1646 (commonly dated)	Takes Torna from Bijapur, then builds Rajgad
1648 (source date)	Chakan fort
1656	Javli taken from the More family
1657	First clash with the Mughals : raids near Junnar and Ahmadnagar
1659	Afzal Khan killed at Pratapgadh
1663	Night raid on Shaista Khan at Lal Mahal, Pune
1664	First sack of Surat (again in 1670)
1665	Treaty of Purandar with Mirza Raja Jai Singh of Amber: 23 forts surrendered, 12 kept
1666	Visit to Aurangzeb's court at Agra , house arrest and escape
1672	Victory over a Mughal army at Salher
1674	Coronation at Raigad as Chhatrapati
1677 to 1678	Karnataka campaign: Jinji (Gingee) and Vellore
1680	Death at Raigad

UP link: the Agra episode of 1666 took place in present-day **Agra** (Agra district). Shivaji, angry at being placed among lesser nobles at the court, was kept under watch and escaped with his son Sambhaji, in tradition hidden in fruit baskets.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Shivaji defeated the Mughals in the battle of-

- (a) Purandar
- (b) Raigarh
- (c) Salher
- (d) Shivner

Ans. (c)

At **Salher** (Nashik district) in 1672 the Marathas defeated a Mughal force in open battle, a rare pitched-battle win in a war otherwise fought from forts. Every distractor is a fort tied to another event: **Purandar** = the 1665 treaty, a setback for Shivaji. **Raigarh** = capital and coronation. **Shivneri** = birthplace.

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1990

Q. Where was the capital of Shivaji ?

- (a) Raigarh
- (b) Satara
- (c) Purandar
- (d) Tanjore

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Where was Shivaji formally crowned as Chhatrapati?

Ans. Raigarh

Shivaji was crowned at **Raigad** (Raigarh) in June 1674 and took the title **Chhatrapati**. The ceremony was performed by **Gaga Bhatt** (Vishweshwar Bhatt), who declared him a Kshatriya. **Satara** became the capital of Shahu after 1708. **Tanjore** (Thanjavur) was ruled by Shivaji's half-brother Venkoji (Ekoji), founder of the Thanjavur Maratha line.

UP link: Gaga Bhatt was a scholar of **Banaras** (Varanasi district).

Maratha Military Landscapes of India (12 forts)	District, State	Exam link
Salher	Nashik, Maharashtra	Victory over the Mughals, 1672
Shivneri	Pune, Maharashtra	Birthplace of Shivaji
Lohagad	Pune, Maharashtra	Hill fort
Raigad	Raigad, Maharashtra	Capital and coronation, 1674
Rajgad	Pune, Maharashtra	Shivaji's early capital
Pratapgarh (Pratapgad)	Satara, Maharashtra	Afzal Khan episode, 1659
Panhala	Kolhapur, Maharashtra	Siege of 1660
Vijaydurg	Sindhudurg, Maharashtra	Coastal fort, Maratha navy
Sindhudurg	Sindhudurg, Maharashtra	Island fort built by Shivaji
Suvarnadurg	Ratnagiri, Maharashtra	Island fort
Khanderi	Raigad, Maharashtra	Island fort
Gingee (Jinji)	Villupuram, Tamil Nadu	Taken 1677. Rajaram's base 1689 to 1698

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

Maratha Military Landscapes of India, a serial property of these 12 forts, was inscribed in July 2025 at the 47th session of the World Heritage Committee in Paris as India's **44th World Heritage Site**. Eleven forts are in Maharashtra and one, **Gingee**, is in Tamil Nadu. The odd-one-out state and the fort-to-event pairs above are the likely question shapes.

24.3 Shivaji's Administration: Ashtapradhan, Coins, Chauth and Sardeshmukhi

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2013, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1991, 1995

Q. Ashtapradhan was a Council of Ministers :

- (a) In the Gupta administration
- (b) In the Chola administration
- (c) In the Vijayanagara administration
- (d) In the Maratha administration

Ans. (d)

The **Ashtapradhan** was Shivaji's council of eight ministers, complete by 1674. They worked like secretaries. They advised the king and carried out his orders, but did not hold independent charge of their departments. Each was answerable to the king. Except the Panditrao and the Nyayadhish, all could be sent to lead campaigns.

Minister	Other name	Function
Peshwa	Mukhya Pradhan	Chief minister. General administration
Amatya	Majumdar	Finance and revenue accounts
Mantri	Waqia-navis	Record of the king's daily activities and court proceedings
Sachiv	Shurunavis	Royal correspondence
Sumant	Dabir	Foreign affairs
Senapati	Sar-i-Naubat (Sarnobat)	Army: recruitment, organisation, supplies

Minister	Other name	Function
Panditrao	Sadr	Religious grants to scholars and religious works
Nyayadhish	Chief justice	Civil and military justice

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Q. At the time of Shivaji, the post of 'Sarnobat' was related with

Ans. Military administration

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Assertion (A) : In matters of State Shivaji was advised by a Council of Ministers.

Reason (R) : Each minister held independent charge of his department.

Ans. (A) is true, but (R) is false.

TRAP ALERT

Do not mix the councils. **Ashtapradhan** = Marathas. The **Gupta**, **Chola** and **Vijayanagara** states had ministers too, but no eight-member body by this name. Also, the Ashtapradhan was **advisory**. That is why R fails in the 1997 one-liner. In the 18th century the **Peshwa** post, first in this list, grew into the real power in the state.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Which of the following coins was NOT a silver coin in the Kingdom of Chhatrapati Shivaji ?

- (a) Rupaya
- (b) Lari
- (c) Taka
- (d) Ruka

Ans. (d)

The source lists **rupaya**, **lari** and **taka** as silver coins current in Shivaji's kingdom and the **ruka** as a copper coin. Many coins of other states also circulated. After his coronation Shivaji struck his own gold **Shivrai hon** and copper **shivrai**.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. The Maratha claim of revenue for protection is known by what name?

- (a) Sardeshmukhi
- (b) Chauth
- (c) Abwab
- (d) Jamadani

Ans. (b)

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Chauth	One-fourth of the land revenue of a neighbouring or Mughal territory, paid to escape Maratha raids. A protection levy	Shivaji and later Marathas
Sardeshmukhi	An extra one-tenth claimed as hereditary sardeshmukh (head deshmukh) of the region	Shivaji and later Marathas
Swarajya	Land directly under Maratha rule	Shivaji
Mughlai	Land outside Swarajya from which chauth was collected	Shivaji
Deshmukh	Hereditary local revenue chief	Deccan Sultanates, Marathas
Ashtapradhan	Council of eight ministers	Shivaji
Sar-i-Naubat	Commander of the army (Senapati)	Shivaji

Term	Meaning	Ruler or context
Abwab	Extra cesses over and above land revenue	Mughal and Bengal Nawabs' revenue system
Saranjam	Revenue assignment to a military chief for maintaining troops	Later Marathas, Peshwa period

TRAP ALERT

Chauth = **protection** (one-fourth). Sardeshmukhi = **hereditary right** (one-tenth). Both were later recognised in 1719 Mughal grants to the Marathas (24.5). **Abwab** are cesses, not a protection claim, and **Jamdani** is best known as the figured muslin of Dhaka.

24.4 Shivaji's Successors and the War with Aurangzeb (1680 to 1749)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2005

Q. Arrange the following in the correct chronological order:

1. Chhatrapati Shahuji
2. Rajaram
3. Sambhaji
4. Shivaji-II

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) 3 2 1 4
- (b) 3 2 4 1
- (c) 2 3 1 4
- (d) 1 2 3 4

Ans. (b)

Ruler	Reign	Relation	Key facts
Sambhaji	1680 to 1689	Elder son of Shivaji	Sheltered Aurangzeb's rebel son Akbar. Captured and executed by Aurangzeb, 1689
Rajaram	1689 to 1700	Younger son of Shivaji	Escaped to Jinji , held out there till 1698 against Zulfiqar Khan. Ruled as Shahu's representative
Shivaji II (with Tarabai as regent)	1700 to 1707/08	Son of Rajaram	Tarabai led the war against Aurangzeb
Shahu	1707/08 to 1749	Son of Sambhaji	Mughal captive from 1689. Released 1707. Beat Tarabai's side at Khed (1707). Capital Satara. Appointed the Peshwas

TRAP ALERT

Shahu is the trap in order questions. He is Sambhaji's son, but he ruled **after** Rajaram and Shivaji II because he was a Mughal prisoner from 1689 to 1707. Tarabai's line later ruled from **Kolhapur**. The Treaty of Warna (1731) settled the Satara and Kolhapur division.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2012, U.P. R.O./A.R.O (MAINS) 2013

Q. At the time of Aurangzeb's death, the Maratha leadership was in the hands of ?

- (a) Sambhaji
- (b) Rajaram
- (c) Jijabai
- (d) Tarabai

Ans. (d)

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (PRE) 2008

Q. Which Maratha woman led the struggle against the Mughal Empire from 1700 A.D. onwards?

Ans. Tarabai

When Rajaram died in 1700, his widow **Tarabai** placed her young son on the throne as Shivaji II and ran the war herself. The Marathas raided Mughal territory deep into Gujarat and Malwa. Aurangzeb died at Ahmadnagar in **1707** with the Deccan unconquered. **Jijabai** was Shivaji's mother. **Sambhaji** and **Rajaram** were already dead by 1707.

24.5 The Peshwas: Chronology and Achievements

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2004, U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2025

Q. Arrange the following in chronological order of their rule and select the correct answer from the code given below.

1. Bajirao I
2. Balaji Bajirao
3. Balaji Vishwanath
4. Madhav Rao I

Code :

- (a) 1, 3, 2, 4
- (b) 3, 1, 4, 2
- (c) 3, 1, 2, 4
- (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Consider the reign of following Peshwas and arrange them in chronological order, I. Balaji Vishwanath

- II. Baji Rao I
- III. Narayan Rao
- IV. Madhav Rao I

Select the correct answer using the code given, below, Code -

- (a) I, II, IV, III
- (b) II, I, IV, III
- (c) I, II, III, IV
- (d) I, III, II, IV

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2024

Q. Consider the following Peshwas and arrange them in ascending chronological order:

1. Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)
2. Balaji Baji Rao
3. Narayan Rao
4. Balaji Vishwanath

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 4, 2, 3, 1
- (b) 3, 4, 1, 2
- (c) 1, 2, 3, 4
- (d) 1, 3, 2, 4

Ans. (a)

Three Peshwa order questions in 2023, 2024 and 2025 make this one table worth memorising in full.

Peshwa	Tenure	Key facts
Balaji Vishwanath	1713 to 1720	Appointed by Shahu. Helped the Sayyid brothers. Won Mughal grants of 1719 recognising Shahu's Swarajya and his right to chauth and sardeshmukhi of the six Deccan provinces

Peshwa	Tenure	Key facts
Baji Rao I	1720 to 1740	Elder son of Balaji Vishwanath. Beat the Nizam at Palkhed (1728). Expanded north into Malwa, Gujarat and Bundelkhand. Raid to Delhi (1737). Bassein taken from the Portuguese (1739) by his brother Chimaji Appa
Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb)	1740 to 1761	Office became hereditary. Treaty of Sangola (1750). Maratha power to Attock (1758). Defeat at Panipat (1761)
Madhav Rao I	1761 to 1772	Revived Maratha power after Panipat. Mahadji Scindia restored Shah Alam II to Delhi (1772)
Narayan Rao	1772 to 1773	Murdered in 1773
Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)	1773 to 1774	Claim challenged by the ministers' council led by Nana Phadnavis. Treaty of Surat (1775) with the English led to the First Anglo-Maratha War
Sawai Madhav Rao	1774 to 1795	Infant Peshwa. Nana Phadnavis in control. Treaty of Salbai (1782)
Baji Rao II	1796 to 1818	Treaty of Bassein (1802) with the English. Peshwaship abolished 1818

TRAP ALERT

Do not confuse the two Balajis. **Balaji Vishwanath** is the first Peshwa (1713). **Balaji Baji Rao** (Nana Saheb Peshwa) is the third, the Peshwa of Panipat. Keep him apart from **Nana Saheb** of 1857, the adopted son of Baji Rao II, and from **Nana Phadnavis**, the minister.

UP link: Baji Rao I entered **Bundelkhand** in 1729 to help Raja Chhatrasal Bundela against **Muhammad Khan Bangash**, the Nawab of **Farrukhabad** (Farrukhabad district), and received a share of Chhatrasal's territory. **Jhansi** later came under a Maratha governor's family. After 1818 the British pensioned **Baji Rao II** off to **Bithoor** (Kanpur Nagar district), where his adopted son Nana Saheb grew up.

24.6 From Kingdom to Confederacy

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 1997

Q. Assertion (A) : By 1750 the Maratha kingdom had become a Confederacy presided over by the Peshwa.

Reason (R) : The successors of Shahu depended on the will of the Peshwa.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Ans. (a)

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. The Maratha King became a non-entity and the Peshwa, the virtual ruler from the time of

Ans. Balaji Baji Rao

Power slid from the Chhatrapati to the Peshwa under Shahu, who left affairs to his Peshwas. Under **Balaji Baji Rao** the office became hereditary. After Shahu died in 1749, the **Treaty of Sangola** (1750) completed the shift: the Chhatrapati at Satara became a nominal king, and the Peshwa at **Pune** became the real head. The great military families held their own territories and acknowledged the Peshwa as

head of a **confederacy**.

House	Seat	Founder or notable ruler
Peshwa	Pune	Balaji Vishwanath line. Head of the confederacy
Gaekwad	Baroda (Vadodara)	Pilaji Gaekwad
Holkar	Indore	Malhar Rao Holkar. Ahilyabai Holkar (capital Maheshwar)
Scindia (Shinde)	Gwalior (earlier Ujjain)	Ranoji Scindia, Mahadji Scindia
Bhonsle	Nagpur	Raghuji Bhonsle. Raids into Bengal and Orissa

UP link: **Ahilyabai Holkar** built the present **Kashi Vishwanath** temple at Varanasi in 1780. Mahadji Scindia controlled Delhi and the Mughal emperor in the 1780s and 1790s, and Maratha armies operated across the Doab.

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (MAINS) 2016

Q. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Marathas emerged as the strongest native power in India after the decline of the Mughal Empire.

Reason (R): Marathas were the first rulers who had a clear concept of United Indian Nation.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below.

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true

Ans. (c)

The Marathas were the strongest Indian power of the mid-18th century, so A is true. But their sense of identity was regional, and their raids for chauth alienated the Rajputs, Jats and others. The source states plainly that they lacked a concept of a united Indian nation, so R is false.

TRAP ALERT

In UPPSC A-R items on the Marathas, the assertion is usually true. Check the reason for over-claims: "first rulers", "united Indian nation", "independent charge" (1997 one-liner). Over-claims make R false.

24.7 The Third Battle of Panipat (1761) and the Rohillas

U.P. P.C.S. (PRE) 1994, 1993, U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. In the Third Battle of Panipat, Marathas were defeated by,

- (a) Afghans
- (b) Britishers
- (c) Mughals
- (d) Rohillas

Ans. (a)

U.P. LOWER SUB. (SPL) (PRE) 2004

Q. The Third Battle of Panipat was fought between

Ans. Marathas and Ahmad Shah Abdali

On **14 January 1761** the Afghan ruler **Ahmad Shah Abdali** (Durrani) crushed the Maratha army led by **Sadashiv Rao Bhau**. The Peshwa's son **Vishwas Rao** and Bhau were killed. The Marathas had **Ibrahim Khan Gardi's** trained artillery, but they were cut off from supplies, and the **Jats** under Suraj Mal left the Maratha camp before the battle while the Rajputs stayed away. Abdali's allies included the Rohilla **Najib-ud-Daula** and the Nawab of Awadh, **Shuja-ud-Daula**. The Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao died a few months later.

Battle	Year	Victor vs Defeated	Significance
First Panipat	1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Founded Mughal rule
Second Panipat	1556	Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs Hemu	Restored Mughal rule
Third Panipat	1761	Ahmad Shah Abdali vs Marathas (Sadashiv Rao Bhau)	Checked Maratha expansion in the north for about a decade

TRAP ALERT

The Rohillas fought **alongside** the Afghans but the defeat is credited to the **Afghans** under Abdali. The British and Mughals did not take part. Also, Panipat was not the end of the Marathas: under Madhav Rao I and Mahadji Scindia they returned to Delhi by 1772.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006

Q. Who of the following Rohilla Chiefs was the confidant of Ahmad Shah Abdali ?

- (a) Ghulam Qadir Rohilla
- (b) Najib Khan
- (c) Ali Muhammad Khan
- (d) Hafiz Rahmat Khan

Ans. (b)

In January 1757 Abdali entered Delhi and plundered **Mathura** and **Agra**. Before leaving he set up Alamgir II as emperor, Imad-ul-Mulk as wazir, and the Rohilla chief **Najib Khan** (Najib-ud-Daula) as Mir Bakhshi and his chief agent in India. Najib remained Abdali's main ally at Panipat.

Rohilla chief	Role
Ali Muhammad Khan	Founder of Rohilla power in Rohilkhand (Aonla, Bareilly) in the 1740s
Hafiz Rahmat Khan	Regent of Rohilkhand. Killed in 1774 when Awadh and East India Company forces invaded (Rohilla War)
Najib Khan (Najib-ud-Daula)	Abdali's confidant, Mir Bakhshi from 1757, ally at Panipat. Founded Najibabad
Ghulam Qadir	Najib's grandson. Seized Delhi and blinded Shah Alam II in 1788

UP link: **Rohilkhand** covers Bareilly, Moradabad, Rampur, Budaun, Bijnor and Shahjahanpur districts. **Najibabad** is in Bijnor district. The Rohilla state of **Rampur** survived as a princely state until 1949. Abdali's 1757 plunder struck **Mathura** (Mathura district) and **Agra**.

Chapter 24: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Shivaji: birth, campaigns, Salher, capital and coronation	6	1990-2016	Recurring
Ashtapradhan, coins, chauth	5	1991-2018	Recurring (Ashtapradhan in 3 papers)
Peshwa chronology	3	2004-2025	Rising (2023, 2024, 2025)
Successors of Shivaji and Tarabai	3	2005-2013	Steady
Confederacy and Maratha power (A-R)	3	1997-2016	Steady
Third Battle of Panipat and Rohillas	3	1993-2012	Recurring (Panipat in 4 papers)
Reasons for the rise, Deshmukhs	2	1992-2024	Revived (2024)

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 25 items (19 PYQs + 6 one-liners), one of the larger chapters in the Medieval book. Five items are chronological-order questions (Shivaji's events, his successors, and three Peshwa lists), and four are Assertion-Reason items. Recent papers (2023, 2024, 2025) asked Peshwa order three years running and an A-R on the Deshmukhs, so the Peshwa table in 24.5 and the successor table in 24.4 carry the most weight. The 2025 World Heritage inscription of 12 Maratha forts gives a ready link from Shivaji's career to current affairs.

Chapter 25

Disintegration of the Mughal Empire

Aurangzeb died in 1707. In the next fifty years the Mughal throne changed hands repeatedly, nobles became kingmakers, Nadir Shah sacked Delhi (1739) and Ahmad Shah Abdali raided north India again and again. Governors turned their provinces into hereditary states: Awadh (1722), Hyderabad (1724) and Bengal. Rajputs, Jats, Rohillas, Sikhs and Marathas carved out their own territories. By 1803 the emperor lived under British protection, and in 1858 the dynasty ended with the exile of Bahadur Shah Zafar. This chapter covers the later Mughals in order, Farrukhsiyar and the Sayyid brothers, Muhammad Shah's reign, the last emperors, the successor states of Awadh and Hyderabad, and Sawai Jai Singh II. It contains **14 PYQs and 1 one-liner**. It is the last chapter of the Medieval book and the bridge to Modern India.

25.1 Succession after Aurangzeb and the Later Mughals in Order

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2012

Q. Who succeeded Aurangzeb after his death in 1707 A.D.?

- (a) Bahadur Shah - I
- (b) Jahandar Shah
- (c) Muhammad Shah
- (d) Akbar - II

Ans. (a)

Aurangzeb's sons fought for the throne. Prince **Muazzam**, aged about 63, defeated his brother Azam at Jajau near Agra in 1707 and took the title **Bahadur Shah I** (also called Shah Alam I). He ruled from 1707 to 1712, made peace with the Rajput states, released the Maratha prince **Shahu**, and fought Banda Bahadur's Sikh revolt. Every later emperor in the options came after him.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. Consider the following Mughal Emperors and arrange them in chronological order :

- I. Farrukhsiyar II. Jahandar Shah
- III. Bahadur Shah IV. Muhammad Shah

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code -

- (a) I, IV, II, III
- (b) I, III, IV, II
- (c) III, II, I, IV
- (d) IV, II, I, III

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2018

Q. Arrange the following into chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- A. Muhammad Shah B. Jahandar Shah
- C. Alamgir II D. Ahmad Shah

Codes :

- (a) A C D B
- (b) B A D C
- (c) C A B D
- (d) D B C A

Ans. (b)

Emperor	Reign	Key facts
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam)	1707 to 1712	Won Jajau (1707). Released Shahu. Peace with Rajputs
Jahandar Shah	1712 to 1713	Real power with wazir Zulfiqar Khan . Abolished jizya. Encouraged ijara (revenue farming)
Farrukhsiyar	1713 to 1719	Raised by the Sayyid brothers . Banda Bahadur executed (1716). Farman of 1717 to the English. Deposed and killed 1719
Rafi-ud-Darajat, Rafi-ud-Daula	1719	Puppets of the Sayyids, each for a few months
Muhammad Shah ("Rangeela")	1719 to 1748	Fall of the Sayyids (1720). Awadh (1722) and Hyderabad (1724) become autonomous. Baji Rao's raid on Delhi (1737). Nadir Shah (1739)
Ahmad Shah	1748 to 1754	Abdali's raids into Punjab. Deposed by his wazir
Alamgir II	1754 to 1759	Abdali sacks Delhi and Mathura (1757). Battle of Plassey (1757). Murdered 1759
Shah Alam II	1759 to 1806	Battle of Buxar (1764). Treaty of Allahabad (1765) : Diwani of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa to the Company. Blinded by Ghulam Qadir (1788). Under British protection from 1803
Akbar II	1806 to 1837	British pensioner. Gave Ram Mohan Roy the title Raja and sent him to England
Bahadur Shah II (Zafar)	1837 to 1857	Proclaimed leader of the 1857 revolt. Exiled to Rangoon, died 1862

TRAP ALERT

Remember the first four as **B-J-F-M**: Bahadur Shah I, Jahandar Shah, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah. After Muhammad Shah come **Ahmad Shah**, then **Alamgir II**. Do not confuse **Ahmad Shah** the Mughal emperor (1748 to 1754) with **Ahmad Shah Abdali** the Afghan invader.

UP link: after Buxar, Shah Alam II signed the **Treaty of Allahabad** (1765) with Robert Clive at Allahabad, now **Prayagraj** (renamed 2018), and lived there under Company protection until he left for Delhi in 1771. Bahadur Shah I's succession battle at **Jajau** was fought near **Agra**.

25.2 Farrukhsiyar, the Farman of 1717 and the Sayyid Brothers

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Q. Which of the following Mughal Emperors granted duty-free trading facilities to the English in Bengal?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Bahadur Shah
- (d) Farrukh siyar

Ans. (d)

In **1717** Farrukhsiyar issued a **farman** to the English East India Company. In Bengal the Company could trade without paying customs duties in return for a fixed annual payment of **Rs 3,000**. It also got rights to issue dastaks (passes) for its goods and to rent more villages near Calcutta. The farman came out of the Company's embassy under John Surman. Later, the misuse of dastaks for private trade by Company servants was a major cause of conflict with the Nawabs of Bengal.

TRAP ALERT

Jahangir allowed the English a factory at Surat (after Thomas Roe's mission, 1615 to 1619). That is permission to trade, not duty-free trade in Bengal. The **1717 farman** belongs to **Farrukhsiyar**.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (MAINS) 2017

Q. Who among the following were the 'King makers' during Mughal period?

- (a) Hussain Ali and Abdullah
- (b) Nasir Khan and Zakariya Khan
- (c) Shah Hussain and Abdul Hussain
- (d) Muhammad Zaman and Muhammad Junaidi

Ans. (a)

The **Sayyid brothers**, **Abdullah Khan** (wazir) and **Husain Ali Khan** (mir bakhshi), dominated the court from 1713 to 1720 and led the **Hindustani** faction. They put Farrukhsiyar on the throne in 1713, deposed him in 1719, and then raised three puppets: Rafi-ud-Darajat, Rafi-ud-Daula and Muhammad Shah. A coalition of **Turani** and **Irani** nobles backing Muhammad Shah overthrew them in 1720: Husain Ali was murdered and Abdullah defeated and imprisoned.

Faction	Origin	Leading figures
Hindustani	Indian-born Muslims, Afghans, and some Hindu allies	Sayyid brothers
Turani	Central Asian (Sunni)	Chin Qilich Khan (Nizam-ul-Mulk), Muhammad Amin Khan
Irani	Persian (mostly Shia)	Saadat Khan (Awadh), Zulfiqar Khan's family

UP link: the Sayyid brothers belonged to the **Sayyids of Barha**, a clan settled in the Muzaffarnagar region of the Doab (Muzaffarnagar district).

25.3 Muhammad Shah "Rangeela": Nadir Shah, Court and Music

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2004

Q. The Mughal Emperor at the time of Nadir Shah's attack was,

- (a) Ahmad Shah
- (b) Alamgir II
- (c) Muhammad Shah
- (d) Rafi-ud-Darajat

Ans. (c)

Nadir Shah, ruler of Iran, invaded in 1739 and defeated the Mughal army at **Karnal** (Haryana) in February 1739. He entered Delhi, and after a riot against his troops ordered a massacre. He left with huge wealth. The contemporary writer **Anand Ram Mukhlis** lists the haul, which included the **Koh-i-Noor** and Shah Jahan's **Takht-i-Taus** (Peacock Throne). Muhammad Shah was the last Mughal to sit on the Peacock Throne. The invasion exposed Mughal weakness to everyone, including the Marathas and the Afghans.

Invader	Years	Mughal emperor	Key events
Nadir Shah (Iran)	1739	Muhammad Shah	Karnal. Sack of Delhi. Koh-i-Noor and Peacock Throne taken
Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani, Afghanistan)	1748 to 1767 (repeated raids)	Ahmad Shah, Alamgir II, Shah Alam II	Sack of Delhi, Mathura and Agra (1757). Third Panipat (1761)

TRAP ALERT

Nadir Shah = **1739**, **Muhammad Shah**, Karnal. Abdali = **1748 onward**, several emperors, Panipat 1761. **Rafi-ud-Darajat** ruled only in 1719, twenty years before Nadir.

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2004

Q. A group of eunuchs and ladies dominated in the Government under

- (a) Muhammad Shah (1719-48)
- (b) Ahmad Shah (1748-54)
- (c) Alamgir (1754-59)
- (d) Shah Alam II (1759-1806)

Ans. (a)

Muhammad Shah earned the name **Rangeela** (pleasure-loving) for his indifference to administration and his love of wine, music and spectacle, such as animal fights. The source says eunuchs and a group of court women came to dominate his government. Real power slipped to provincial governors and to the Marathas.

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2023

Q. Tappa style of music was refined and developed in which of the following Mughal Emperor's Court?

- (a) Jahangir
- (b) Shah Jahan
- (c) Muhammad Shah
- (d) Akbar

Ans. (c)

Muhammad Shah's court was a centre of Hindustani music. The court musicians **Niamat Khan "Sadarang"** and Adarang are linked with the growth of **khayal**. **Tappa**, a brisk and ornate form drawn from the songs of Punjabi camel drivers, is credited above all to **Shori Mian** (Ghulam Nabi Shori, 1742 to 1792), who was a court singer of

Asaf-ud-Daula, Nawab of Awadh. Among the four options, only Muhammad Shah belongs to the 18th century, which is why (c) is keyed.

TRAP ALERT

Akbar = Tansen and dhrupad patronage. Shah Jahan = dhrupad and court music too. **Jahangir** = painting more than music. The 18th-century forms (**khayal** at Muhammad Shah's court, **tappa** with Shori Mian and Awadh) point to the later Mughal period.

UP link: Shori Mian's patron Asaf-ud-Daula ruled Awadh from **Lucknow**. Tappa later took root in the **Banaras** (Varanasi) and Lucknow traditions.

25.4 The Last Mughal Emperors: Akbar II and Bahadur Shah Zafar

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2005

Q. The last Mughal Emperor was Bahadur Shah. His father's name was-

- (a) Akbar Shah- I
- (b) Akbar Shah- II
- (c) Aurangzeb
- (d) Shah Jahan

Ans. (b)

Bahadur Shah II, the poet **Zafar** (1837 to 1857), was the son of **Akbar Shah II** (1806 to 1837). By then the emperor was a British pensioner whose authority ran only inside the Red Fort. In 1857 the rebel sepoys proclaimed him emperor. After the fall of Delhi he was tried, exiled to **Rangoon**, and died there in 1862.

TRAP ALERT

There is no Mughal emperor called "Akbar Shah I". The great Akbar (1556 to 1605) is simply Akbar. The "II" in Akbar II and Bahadur Shah II distinguishes them from Akbar and from Bahadur Shah I (1707 to 1712).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2006

Q. Which one of the following statements is not correct about Bahadur Shah Zafar ?

- (a) He was an emperor without an empire
- (b) Ibrahim Zauq and Asadullah Khan Ghalib were his poetry teachers
- (c) Hasan Askari was his spiritual guide
- (d) He received less than one lakh rupees as pension from East India Company

Ans. (d)

The source states that Zafar received **Rs 1 lakh a month** as pension from the Company, plus income from his other properties. So "less than one lakh" is the incorrect statement. The rest are correct: he ruled nothing beyond the fort, his poetry teacher (ustad) was **Ibrahim Zauq** and, after Zauq's death, **Ghalib**, and **Hasan Askari** was his spiritual adviser.

25.5 Successor States: Awadh and Hyderabad

U.P.P.C.S. (SPL) (MAINS) 2008

Q. Who among the following was the first Nawab of Oudh?

- (a) Asaf-ud-Daula
- (b) Saadat Khan
- (c) Shuja-ud-Daula
- (d) Safdar Jang

Ans. (b)

Successor states were provinces whose Mughal governors became hereditary rulers while still acknowledging the emperor in name. The **Turanis** founded Hyderabad, and the **Iranis** founded Awadh. **Saadat Khan** was made governor (subahdar) of **Awadh** in 1722 and laid the base of independent rule there. He died in 1739, the year of Nadir Shah's invasion. His nephew and son-in-law **Safdar Jang** dropped even nominal obedience to the emperor.

Nawab of Awadh	Rule	Key facts
Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk	1722 to 1739	Founder. Irani noble from Nishapur
Safdar Jang	1739 to 1754	Also Mughal wazir. His tomb is in Delhi
Shuja-ud-Daula	1754 to 1775	Joined Abdali at Panipat (1761). Defeated at Buxar (1764). Capital at Faizabad
Asaf-ud-Daula	1775 to 1797	Moved the capital to Lucknow . Built the Bara Imambara
Wajid Ali Shah	1847 to 1856	Last Nawab. Awadh annexed by the British in 1856

UP link: Awadh is the core of present-day central and eastern Uttar Pradesh. The early Nawabs ruled from **Faizabad**, near Ayodhya (Faizabad district was renamed Ayodhya in 2018). **Lucknow** became the capital in 1775. Awadh's annexation in 1856 fed the revolt of 1857 in Lucknow.

TRAP ALERT

The first Nawab is **Saadat Khan**, not Safdar Jang (second) or Shuja-ud-Daula (third). **Asaf-ud-Daula** is famous for Lucknow, not for founding Awadh.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (PRE) 2023

Q. With reference to the Burhan-ul-Mulk Saadat Khan, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Saadat Khan was the founder of independent state of Awadh.
2. He took part in the conspiracy against the Sayyid Brothers.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code -

- (a) Only 2
- (b) Both 1 and 2
- (c) Neither 1 nor 2
- (d) Only 1

Ans. (b)

Saadat Khan backed Muhammad Shah in the 1720 plot against the Sayyid brothers. The pleased emperor raised his mansab to 5,000 zat and 7,000 sawar and gave him the title **Burhan-ul-Mulk**. Two years later he was posted to Awadh. Both statements are correct. This ties 25.2 (Sayyids) to 25.5 (Awadh).

U.P.P.C.S. (MAINS) 2011

Q. Who among the following was the founder of independent Kingdom of Hyderabad ?

- (a) Qamaruddin Khan
(b) Muhammad Amin Khan
(c) Asad Khan
(d) Chin Qilich Khan

Ans. (d)

Chin Qilich Khan, titled **Nizam-ul-Mulk** and later **Asaf Jah**, was the leading Turani noble. He served briefly as wazir, then left for the Deccan. In October 1724 he defeated and killed the Mughal governor Mubbariz Khan at **Shakar Kheda** and became the real ruler of the Deccan. His Asaf Jahi dynasty ruled Hyderabad until 1948. The distractors are other nobles: **Qamaruddin Khan** and **Muhammad Amin Khan** were Turani wazirs of Muhammad Shah, and **Asad Khan** was Aurangzeb's wazir and father of Zulfiqar Khan.

Successor or new state	Founder or key ruler	Date	Notes
Awadh	Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk	1722	Irani. Faizabad, then Lucknow
Hyderabad	Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah (Chin Qilich Khan)	1724	Turani. Shakar Kheda
Bengal	Murshid Quli Khan	Diwan 1700, governor 1717	Capital Dhaka to Murshidabad. Later Alivardi Khan (1740), Siraj-ud-Daula
Mysore	Haidar Ali	From 1761	Power taken from the Wodeyar rulers
Rajput states	Sawai Jai Singh II (Amber), Ajit Singh (Marwar)	Early 18th century	Autonomous, still served the emperor
Jats	Churaman, Badan Singh, Suraj Mal	Mid 18th century	Bharatpur and Deeg. Suraj Mal took Agra (1761)
Rohillas	Ali Muhammad Khan	1740s	Rohilkhand: Bareilly, later Rampur
Bangash Nawabs	Muhammad Khan Bangash	Early 18th century	Farrukhabad
Sikhs and Marathas	See Chapters 23 and 24		

UP link: four of these powers sat in present-day UP or ruled parts of it: **Awadh** (Faizabad, Lucknow), the **Rohillas** (Bareilly, Rampur and the rest of Rohilkhand), the **Bangash Nawabs** of **Farrukhabad** (the town is commonly said to be named after Farrukhsiyar), and the **Jats**, who held **Mathura** and **Agra** districts under Suraj Mal.

25.6 Sawai Jai Singh II and the Observatories

U.P.P.C.S. (PRE) 2005

Q. Among the following who had constructed an astronomical observatory popularly known as Jantar Mantar at Delhi?

- (a) Akbar
(b) Shah Jahan
(c) Suraj Mal
(d) Jai Singh- II

Ans. (d)

U.P. P.C.S. (MAINS) 2007

Q. Where observatories were constructed by Maharaja Jai Singh-II ?

1. Delhi 2. Jaipur
3. Ujjain 4. Varanasi

Code :

Ans. 1, 2, 3, and 4

Sawai Jai Singh II of Amber (ruled 1699 to 1743) was the leading Rajput ruler of the 18th century. He founded **Jaipur** (1727) and built observatories at **Delhi**, **Jaipur**, **Ujjain**, **Varanasi** and **Mathura**. He prepared astronomical tables called the **Zij-i-Muhammadshahi**, dedicated to Muhammad Shah, and had Euclid's Elements translated into Sanskrit. **Suraj Mal** is the Jat ruler of Bharatpur, and is the distractor drawn from the same period.

Observatory	Place	Note
Jantar Mantar	Delhi	Commonly dated 1724. The question's answer
Jantar Mantar	Jaipur	Largest. UNESCO World Heritage Site (2010)
Vedh Shala	Ujjain	Madhya Pradesh
Man Mandir observatory	Varanasi	On the roof of Man Mandir palace at the ghat
Observatory	Mathura	No longer survives

UP link: two of the five observatories were in UP, at **Varanasi** (Varanasi district) and **Mathura** (Mathura district). The 2007 one-liner lists four of the five and leaves out Mathura.

LIKELY NEXT ANGLE

A five-item version adding **Mathura**, or a pairing of Jai Singh II with Zij-i-Muhammadshahi, is the natural extension. Note that Mathura is the only one that no longer survives.

Cause of decline	What happened
Wars of succession	No fixed rule of succession. Eight emperors between 1707 and 1759
Weak rulers and kingmaker nobles	Zulfiqar Khan, the Sayyid brothers
Factions	Turani, Irani and Hindustani groups fought for office
Jagirdari crisis	Too many mansabdars, too few productive jagirs. Revenue fell short
Strain of Aurangzeb's long wars	Decades of Deccan campaigns drained the treasury and army. Conflicts with the Marathas, Jats, Sikhs and Rajputs
Regional powers	Governors and chiefs founded hereditary states
Foreign invasions	Nadir Shah (1739) and Abdali (1748 to 1767)
European companies	Plassey (1757), Buxar (1764), Diwani (1765)

Chapter 25: Topic Heat Map

Topic	PYQs	Years	Trend
Later Mughals: succession and chronology	3	2012-2023	Rising (order questions 2018, 2023)
Muhammad Shah: Nadir Shah, court, tappa	3	2004-2023	Recurring
Awadh and Hyderabad	3	2008-2023	Recurring
Farrukhsiyar's farman and the Sayyid brothers	2	2010-2017	Steady
Akbar II and Bahadur Shah Zafar	2	2005-2006	Occasional
Jai Singh II and observatories	2	2005-2007	Occasional

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: 15 items (14 PYQs + 1 one-liner). Three questions turn on the order of the later Mughals, so the emperor table in 25.1 is the core revision tool. Awadh is the UP favourite (2008, 2023). **Across the Medieval book**, the 25 chapters hold 456 items in all. The same question shapes recur: (1) chronological order of rulers, Peshwas or events, (2) "who was the first" or "who founded", (3) ruler-to-measure, book-to-author and monument-to-builder attribution, and (4) Assertion-Reason. Bhakti and Sufi saints, Akbar and the Mughal miscellany carry the most items. UP places (Agra, Fatehpur Sikri, Jaunpur, Kannauj, Varanasi, Awadh, Rohilkhand) run through every period, and recent papers (2023 to 2025) have favoured order questions and A-R items.

Appendix: PYQ Heat Map of the Medieval History Book

Every chapter in one view. **PYQs** are full questions, **1-L** are one-liners, and **Total** is their sum. The decade columns count how many items were asked at least once in that decade, so a question repeated across decades is counted in each. Use the table to decide revision order: high totals with strong 2020s counts come first.

Ch	Chapter	PYQs	1-L	Total	1990s	2000s	2010s	2020s
1	Muslim Invasion of India	18	4	22	8	7	8	1
2	Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty	12	2	14	3	6	8	1
3	Khalji Dynasty	14	1	15	3	3	7	2
4	Tughluq Dynasty	18	2	20	5	11	8	0
5	Sayyid and Lodi Dynasties	5	1	6	2	2	5	1
6	Vijayanagara Empire	8	3	11	1	6	4	0
7	Delhi Sultanate: Administration	11	4	15	4	4	6	3
8	Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture	4	1	5	0	3	2	1
9	Delhi Sultanate: Literature	20	4	24	3	8	6	7
10	Delhi Sultanate: Miscellaneous	12	0	12	3	4	6	1
11	Provincial Dynasties of North India and the Deccan	20	4	24	1	10	7	6
12	Bhakti and Sufi Movement	41	8	49	7	17	21	6
13	Mughal Dynasty: Babur	12	3	15	5	2	7	2
14	Humayun and Sher Shah	12	3	15	1	6	6	4
15	Akbar	28	4	32	7	11	11	4
16	Jahangir	11	3	14	2	5	8	1
17	Shah Jahan	11	4	15	1	9	6	1
18	Aurangzeb	16	1	17	3	10	5	2
19	Mughal Administration	18	2	20	2	7	7	4
20	Music and Painting in the Mughal Period	12	3	15	4	3	9	1
21	Mughal Literature	17	3	20	2	6	10	3
22	Mughal Period: Miscellaneous	25	1	26	2	7	14	3
23	Sikh Sect	9	1	10	1	6	2	1
24	Maratha State and Confederacy	19	6	25	7	7	10	4
25	Disintegration of the Mughal Empire	14	1	15	0	7	5	3
	Total	387	69	456	77	167	188	62

UPPSC PATTERN

Exam Insight: The five heaviest chapters are Bhakti and Sufi Movement (49), Akbar (32), Mughal Period: Miscellaneous (26), Maratha State and Confederacy (25), Delhi Sultanate: Literature (24). The chapters with the most items asked in the 2020s are Delhi Sultanate: Literature (7), Provincial Dynasties of North India and the Deccan (6), Bhakti and Sufi Movement (6), Humayun and Sher Shah (4), Akbar (4), Mughal Administration (4), Maratha State and Confederacy (4). Revise these first, then move down the Total column.